

I've potty trained my three autistic/adhd boys. Here's what worked for all them

I have three little boys, an older son, and identical twins that were born when my oldest was 17 months old. All of my boys are autistic and at least as we know right now two are adhd as well. We definitely struggle with some demand avoidance, not full blown PDA but pretty close.

I can't describe how many times I've gone on Reddit trying to figure out how it potty train them. Most traditional methods (ex put your child on the potty every 15 minutes) did not work for my kids.

These past three years have been hell, I've potty trained one of them each summer. My older son withheld poop for 9 days at one point, while my twins smeared their poop for months, sometimes happening several days a week. Trust me when I say I at least feel like I've seen it all.

I am now finishing up potty training our last and it's gone the fastest since I've learned so much and fixed different mistakes I've made. Here is what has made potty training finally work every single time after much trial and error with the fastest results.

No more diapers/pull ups AT ALL (not even at night)

What delayed potty training the most was keeping diapers/pull ups on at night or for car rides or special occasions etc. My boys would get very confused when they would sometimes wear them and sometimes not. Doing this delayed potty training my first two for MONTHS. It was easier to just rip the band aid off. We would put a potty in their room overnight and hope for the best lol. For our twins poop smearing mainly happened at night because they didn't want the diaper on anymore at night and would take their poop out and then try to get it off their hands then getting it everywhere. Layer up the bed with multiple layers of protectors and sheets that you can just pull off. For my twins, everything had to be taken out of the room besides their blanket, a wipeable toddler mattress which we specifically bought to potty train, and their sensory swing to make clean up easiest, my oldest who didn't smear didn't need this. Sometimes a toy or two that I wouldn't mind having to wipe down as well would be in their room. This sounds like it would be a horrible idea but all three of my boys have actually taken to this quickly. My twins most shockingly didn't even pee at all most nights, my second never had any overnight accidents. My older son continued to pee himself every night so once he was fully trained during the day we went back to wearing overnight diapers at night for everyone's sanity. BUT he had to be fully day trained first, peeing and pooping, for us to be able to do that so it didn't start to become a crutch for him with pooping since he withheld.

2\.. Commit at least a week, more preferably two weeks to stay home without leaving the house

They need to be comfortable and confident going at home before you can start attempting going anywhere else

3\.. Have them completely naked at home, if they're cold just a shirt.

Try to schedule potty training over the summer which makes this easier to play inside and outside.

Once they are consistently going you can reintroduce clothes but having to pull off pants or underwear just get in the way at first

4\.. Do not tell them when to go. Do not force them to sit. Don't suggest. Don't use timers. It has to be their choice.

As hard as this is, do not tell them when to go. After you initially let

them know they're going to be using the potty from now and showing them where pee and poop go and take the diapers away, back off. My three would IMMEDIATELY lose it if they even thought I was suggesting they should sit and try to go. They would refuse and it would set us back. There will be a lot of accidents at first. If they started to pee or poop on the floor, I would guide them over to the potty, have them sit if they allowed it, and remind them that pee and poop goes in the potty. Sometimes I'd pick up the poop with toilet paper and put it in the potty to show them visually where it should go. Do not get mad. Do not scold. Just remind. They need time to realize what their body feels like when they have to go and make that connection of what they need to do when they feel that way. Expect to clean up a lot. It gets easier as the days go on. My last that I potty trained loved watching the Miss Rachel potty video and we got the matching toys. It was less threatening for him to see the information delivered that way than have me do it.

5\. Have multiple potties throughout the house

Have one in every single room you'll be in so they constantly see that visual reminder and they don't have to go far.

6\. Use rewards for both pee and poop with visual aides

This was critical to my boys success and worked for all them. Each needed something a little different. My oldest actually barely needed anything. For my last (which was the quickest) I made little posters for all over the house with his picture, a picture of the potty with a fake pee cartoon in it (thank you paint haha), and a picture of his favorite candy and a grid of numbers 1 - 20. I had 5 of these throughout the house so everytime he peed in the potty he would get some candy and we would go around the whole house putting a sticker on each of his charts (he is one of those kids that will forget if he doesn't see it which is why we needed a chart basically in each room but some kids would only need one). 20 sounds like a lot but within the first two days he filled up all 20 spots with stickers and got a little book as a reward. He loves reading. I remade a new chart and the next had 40 numbers. That took 5 days for him to complete. Does it make them get a little obsessed with trying to get all the stickers. Yes. Will it make them want a sticker for every little pee. Yes. But it works. We also have juice those first two days so he was going more. Poop had a separate chart. Breaking that barrier of having them go the first time is so hard. For that one I had his picture, a picture of a potty with a fake poop cartoon, and a picture of a toy that he picked. As soon as he pooped the first time (which took a few days) the whole family got super excited

for him and he got his present. Instant motivator for him. For the next two poops he got two more toys that were smaller than the first to keep the momentum going. Then he got a five sticker chart and then a book. And so on making it spread out further and further the more comfortable he got. My two other boys didn't ever need a toy like that to get them to go. They didn't resist as much. They both just got candy like they did for pee. My youngest just kept happily pooping on the floor so I had to up the anti for him lol. He really rigged the game hahaha

7\. Make your life as easy as possible ❤️

Those first few days are ROUGH and you have to be so hyper vigilant. You get whatever is going to make you happy. Take out. Ice cream. Have something to look forward to for that evening. Do whatever you can to make yourself happy while you're on the struggle bus. Tag off with your partner if they had to go to work the second they get home and rest.

This is so hard and you deserve it. You're doing amazing ❤️
8\ Progression and slowly scaffold and slowly removed rewards as they become better. After they've had two full days of success with minimal or no accidents move to the next step and make the rewards a little longer to get and less until you're not doing any rewards anymore. start with potties all over the house only one potty in the room you're in, moving it throughout the house during the day potty in the bathroom potty in the bathroom with clothes on transition to the toilet (potty still in room overnight unless they're reliable enough to go to the bathroom overnight) Start to leave the house when your child can reliably pee in the potty. There's no specific timeline for this. It was just an instinct with each of them.

We have the same potty in the house in our car. Once my boys were comfortable peeing in the house and wouldn't become averse anymore to me asking them to go, we would start venturing out of the house for short trips with full underwear and pants on. I'd have them pee before we left the house, pee in the potty in the car when we got to our destination, pee in the car in the potty when we left our destination, and then resume whatever we were doing at home. Of course bring back up clothes but when I've kept the visits short my boys have never had accidents in public

*** this is a caveat for my particular boys but socially they did not have the language to or realization that they should call for me once they pooped. Once they were fully trained my second especially would poop, pull up his pants, and be on his way without asking me to wipe (they all have fine motor delay and struggle with things like that so I had to be the one to do it). Each of them varied a bit but for my

second I actually had to make a chart with stickers reminding him to call for me to wipe him when he was done pooping.

I hope this helps!!!! I wish I had read something like this when we first started our potty training journey so I wanted to pass on at least what I learned. My biggest takeaway though has been accommodating to what each of my boys needed. They each needed it done in a slightly different way using that main framework. Some needed more, some less. All of them were 4/4.5 when they were potty trained. I honestly didn't even attempt sooner because I could see it wasn't happening.

If you have any questions, let me know!!!!

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Kommentarbereich

Avatar von u/shesgotmoxie

shesgotmoxie

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vor 6 Monaten

Thanks, I\m definitely going to do a lot of things differently with my second. We're still in the good at pee but won't poop on the potty stage with my three year old boy. Any advice for getting unstuck? He refuses to do the makes method again.

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Shes_The_Albatross

Poster*in

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vor 6 Monaten

How is he pooping? Is he going in a diaper? If he is when he's ready I would just fully take it away. My oldest used it as a crutch until I did that. If he's refusing even when you take the diaper away I would stay in touch with your pediatrician to make sure he's doing okay if it's been several days. My oldest didn't go for 9 days..... I was like dude how is that even possible. But the pediatrician was checking in to make sure he was still okay. He finally went because he had to so bad. After that he was good. It was weird like he just had to finally get it over with and then he was good. My third was just pooping on the floor so we needed the reward to motivate him and then when we saw he had to go we stayed in the room with him and kept reminding him where

poop goes until he sat and finally did it. Hope that helps!

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Avatar von u/shesgotmoxie

shesgotmoxie

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vor 6 Monaten

Yeah, he'll only go in a pull up and even then he wants to withhold. He has to get a full cap of miralax every day to make him poop. Otherwise he'll withhold and then cry and scream because it hurts. I've been trying to get him to sit on the potty wearing the pull up but he won't do that. He poops on his hands and knees and refuses to try any other position.

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Shes_The_Albatross

Poster*in

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vor 6 Monaten

Is he by any chance neurodivergent? It's interesting that even in the pull up he's struggling. It sounds like the sensory experience of pooping is really dysregulating for him. I'd probably pull back with potty training right now and take a pause until he's 4. Has he ever seen an OT?

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Avatar von u/shesgotmoxie

shesgotmoxie

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vor 6 Monaten

He was evaluated for autism when he was 2 and the result was neurotypical. He had no problem with pooping before we potty trained at 2.5. He did well with both poop and pee at home for a week but when he went back to daycare he pooped in his underwear and then started withholding. The withholding led to constipation which led to pain during poop. I feel like he can't let go of the fear of the pain. Honestly, I waited way too long to put him on miralax. He had painful poop for about 9 months. I probably just need to let him have soft easy poop for at least 6 months before trying to get him on the potty for poop.

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Setze diesen Thread fort

Avatar von u/No-Can-443

No-Can-443

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vor 6 Monaten

Thank you for your post, I love it, especially point 4!! This is essential and so many \"potty guides\" and coaches etc. get this wrong imho...

I'm not with you on the rewards part. To get the reasoning why, I can wholeheartedly recommend \"Alfie Kohn: \"Unconditional Parenting. Moving from Rewards and Punishments to Love and Reason.\" and/or \"Punished by Rewards. The Trouble With Gold Stars, Incentive Plans, A's, Praise and other Bribes.\" I know you said you don't care, but for anyone who does this might provide an interesting perspective!

Otherwise, as I said, this is superb potty-training advice :D

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Shes_The_Albatross

Poster*in

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vor 6 Monaten

Thanks for the comment! Hahah I should probably rephrase that, it's a bit sassy. As a family we typically don't use rewards and punishments either. I tried not to with potty training as well, which I think led to things taking longer. But I found with my boys, especially with them having communication delays and with a lot of inattentiveness due to adhd, having repeated verbal reminders and conversations wasn't affective for them. Having that tangible reward that mattered to them coupled with it giving them a dopamine hit really pushed things over the edge for them.

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Avatar von u/No-Can-443

No-Can-443

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vor 6 Monaten

Don't worry, I didn't take any offence and I think one can tell where you're coming from! Plus I have to admit that I personally have little experience with potty training non-neurotypical children, but what I know from training an autistic child I can confirm that this took a vastly different approach from what we would do usually. As this post will however be read by all parents, including of children that are neurotypical - as they should by the way, it's a very good, empathetic and in-depth guide (!), I just wanted to add it to give some perspective / show up alternatives to that particular point, especially as you already mentioned some might want to \"skip\" that part.

In the end, everybody is free to approach this however they want ofc and if you usually don't use rewards/punishments I assume your children won't suffer long-term psychological damage from doing so once 😊
Congrats on getting all your kids trained btw, 3 boys nonetheless, I bet that wasn't easy and the advice you give was hard-earned!

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4 weitere Antworten

Avatar von u/Kira_E_E_mommy08

Kira_E_E_mommy08

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vor 6 Monaten

My son will be 4 in September, and he will go pee in the potty all day at home with no accidents, but when he needs to poop he wants a pull-up. He goes to the actual toilet. When he goes to poop he used to poop on the floor, but now he wants a pull-up and will even put one on himself just to poop on and take it off. He also doesn't like waiting on the toilet for poop so he will dig it out with his hand sometimes. He only drinks milk, juice, smoothies, water, and yogurt. No solids, so constipation is an issue but is easily cleared up with pear juice, leading to a total mess. He is nonverbal, so I feel like it's a little harder. We use pull-ups for trips away from home, naps, and nighttime. He also goes to 3k half day, and they use pull-ups there as well. Idk what to do anymore.

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Bumpy2017

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vor 6 Monaten

This is very similar to how I trained my son with global developmental delay except we used pull ups overnight and it didn't seem to interfere. We're still in the damn pull ups overnight though so I think another round of training is in order. Like the idea of wipeable mattress!

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ActualOpinion8619

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vor 6 Monaten

GIRL I've never needed to read something so bad. I am on the tail end of potty training my autistic almost 4 y/o, she turns 4 on 8/28 and I also have an almost 2 y/o that is now showing a lot of interest watching big sissy go on the potty! First week was rough, lots of clean up but we are getting through it now, on week 3 with my younger babe and just still working on poop with my older babe. TYSM for this post 🙌🙌🙌🙌

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Shes_The_Albatross

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vor 6 Monaten

Awwww I'm so glad you found it helpful!!!! Congrats on almost finishing up with her! It truly is a herculean task!

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Right_Performance553

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vor 6 Monaten

My son is autistic as well and dribbles a lot and withholds his pee forever. Even with us giving him all the juice in the world. Then he cries because he's so in pain from holding it and it won't come out. Second he has a diaper on, he goes and no UTIs whatsoever. Should I take off the underwear? If I have a potty in every room, was it hard to transition to the toilet? Did you put the potty in the trunk (we have an SUV and have him pee on the potty there or did you put it in passenger seat?

When he withholds right now we give him bubbles to blow and have him play with water toys and a bowl on the potty, but it's still not working! Also he has pediasure before bed so he has a super full diaper in the morning. He won't sleep wet and pees frequently so I feel like we would be up all night, but maybe that's what it takes for a week.

We've also been bad at staying at home, we are always out and about at parks and playgrounds because my son hates being inside with a passion and we don't have a backyard. We did stay in for a week but we didn't

know what we were doing but it was absolute hell, even with TV and our sensory bin, salad spinners , fans and door toys, we almost got divorced lol!

Anyway your tips are super helpful; just wanting to know the logistics. My son is 3.5 has one word phrases.

Also we will be using a rewards system just for this... lol. Again, what can take a NT child weeks to learn, takes months or years for our kids so ANYTHING that can speed up very important milestones for our kids is a plus.

Appreciate the comment about not taking them to the potty all the time, and letting them know.

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Shes_The_Albatross
Poster*in

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vor 6 Monaten

Hmmm so part of me is thinking maybe you should hold off for now for maybe another year since he's only 3.5 especially since it seems like maybe the sensory aspect of peeing without the diaper is really upsetting him. I could be wrong but that's what it sounds like. I guess my question would be how long has he withheld pee before you give him the diaper to go? If it's hours and hours then yeah I'd definitely wait for sure. But if you give him the diaper after 30 minutes/an hour I'd give it a bit longer. I would hope that finally getting him to go one or two times would finally break that anxiousness that he's feeling and then it wouldn't bother him but like I said before if it's more of a sensory sensitivity I'd hate to be making him so uncomfortable and I'd probably wait and then enlist the help of an OT if it's still persisting.

With the potties yes we have them everywhere and they're all exactly the same one, even the one in the car. I start out with them everywhere and then after we have success for several days I move down to just one that I carry around with us, once that's successful I move it to the bathroom and then once thats successful I take that away completely and just use the toilet. It takes a while but has really helped. In the car we have a minivan but I do keep it in the trunk. I think keeping it on a seat would make them anxious because it would be really high up.

If he's peeing that much at night and hates the sensory aspect of being wet, I think trying for a while with the diapers on at night makes sense as long as it doesn't halt progress. If unfortunately did for all of my boys.

Not having a backyard is such a struggle and your comment about almost getting divorced made me laugh. Lol I feel that to my core and trust me

I've experienced that with my wife lol. If it's going to be too much to stay home I would just go places where you can constantly stop to have bathroom breaks. But if your son can be demand avoidant then I'd recommend staying home for a few days and forcing yourself again because the demand of requesting him to go over and over again while you're out of the house could throw him over the edge and make him become resistant. That's what happened with my boys.

Hope this helps!!!!

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Right_Performance553

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vor 6 Monaten

Yes, thank you that really makes sense.

I'm sad because he was loving sitting on the potty and going and I feel like I actually could have trained him at 2.5. But now he's SO used to the diaper and potty training is such a thing at daycare that he is really so much more conscious of it. I might try for another block one more time, just to make sure and then yes, give up. He gets more and more stubborn as he ages, so we just get worried how hard will it be to break the habit later on.

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Avatar von u/Sweet_Midnight_954

Sweet_Midnight_954

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vor 6 Monaten

I applaud those posting here. I am a new special needs teacher and have an almost 6 year old with no diagnosis, verbal and not trained. He thinks it's funny to run, pull all his clothes off, be naked and not allow teacher to pull up his pull ups or pants, rolling on the floor, kicking and not sitting for more than 15 seconds before his flushing. Teacher is with him as I fear he will flail and hit his head on the floor or the toilet. Any ideas on how to direct or help in the process?

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Avatar von u/buddy276

buddy276

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vor 5 Monaten

I've literally done everything you said for 7 months now. Its literally driving me insane that he still won't do it

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Avatar von u/Thick_Upstairs5603

Thick_Upstairs5603

post 2:Potty training an Autistic child. Help!

My son is turning 7 next week. We would really like to get rid of pull ups and move on the big boy underwear. He is dry in the mornings. He will even occasionally go without prompting. I feel like we have tried everything, reward systems, punishments and nothing seems to work. I think his mother and I would try anything at this point.

Any ideas?

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Kommentarbereich

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 13 Jahren

I work at a school with children who have severe autism. One of the parents asked our class to try to help her child be potty trained. After 3 months it finally happened. The mom would bring in juice boxes or any liquid, and we would basically just give the child stuff to drink throughout the day. Every 15-30 minutes we would take him to the

bathroom. He hated it at first because he was missing the normal classroom routine, but we found that reading to him while he sat for at least 5 minutes each time made him calmer. We would turn the faucets on to help encourage him.

Eventually he was so submerged in the routine that he started going with no fuss to sit on the toilet. Every time we would document if he had gone to the bathroom or not and we just kept going with the same practice. Finally, one day, about 6 weeks in, he did it for the first time, which we made a huge deal out of so that he knew the gravity of the situation and how proud everyone was.

So in short, what we've done is pump liquids into the child, validate every positive step towards independently going to the restroom, find something that consumes some time to wait on the bathroom, and do all of this frequently. Hope this helps!

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Avatar von u/jinxycat22
jinxycat22

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vor 13 Jahren

Have you tried a sitting schedule? In the center where I used to work we would have the children go to the toilet every 30 minutes - hour (depending on the child) and they would sit for 5-10 minutes until something was produced (any little bit!) or until the 5-10 minutes was up and the child was sitting quietly. If something was produced we gave the child access to a reinforcer that was held specifically for potty training. Playing on an iPad and edibles seemed to work the best, although I know they aren't the most natural. We would gradually increase the time between sitting. If the child requested to go we would throw a party (not literally...but we would make sure the child knew what they did was AWESOME). Sorry if this sounds confusing but if you have any more questions feel free to contact me

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grahamlester

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vor 13 Jahren

Potty-trained my low-functioning son about 15 years ago. All I remember is we had to take him every 15 minutes at first and then gradually extended the length of time. It took about six months as I recall but it worked. This book would be useful, but don't expect to get it done in 24 hours!

<http://www.amazon.com/Toilet-Training-Less-Than-Day/dp/0671693808>

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thismoil

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vor 13 Jahren

Yep I've heard from many people who have potty trained tons of autistic kids that this book tells you the best way to go about it.

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Avatar von u/SubOptimalGatsby
SubOptimalGatsby

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vor 13 Jahren

(My credentials...) I'm a behavioral therapist working with children

across the spectrum\...ages from as young as a year and a half up to 16. Potty training is one of the most common skills we teach where I work. The method that has worked best for me is taking baseline date\...checking the diaper every 15 or so minutes\...and sitting on the toilet every half hour for no more than a minute. The reason for such a short period of time is that you do not want the bathroom to become aversive\...Gradually build up the duration spent on the toilet. The diaper check will allow you to see how long he can hold it before he must eliminate. There are also usually physical clues that the child must use the toilet. Doing the pee pee dance, hiding, grabbing themselves\...When that occurs, run to the bathroom. When he does eliminate on the toilet, you make a huge deal out of it. He is now the first man to have walked on the moon. It needs to be immediate, also. I will typically use some sort of edible reinforcement. If a client really likes M&M\'s then the only time s/he has access to them is after a successful toileting. Sometimes it\'s best to place the child in underwear for the day because they do not like the sensation of wet underwear and that can help motivate them to use the toilet. There will be ups and downs. Then, typically, it\'ll be like a light bulb went on and your son will acquisition the skill. Hopefully this made sense, and I didn\'t repeat anything already covered.

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Avatar von u/SkinnerRox
SkinnerRox

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vor 13 Jahren

I have never heard of this! The ABA center where I work we do the intensive toileting (spending an entire day in the restroom) with the forced success (when they start to go-rush and put the client on the toilet). This method works really well, however is so intensive for parents. This idea seems a lot more feasible.

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Avatar von u/SubOptimalGatsby
SubOptimalGatsby

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vor 13 Jahren

We borrow heavily from A Work in Progress and that\'s close to how toilet training is laid out in there. The all day program sounds rather\...intense. How aversive is it for the children?

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Avatar von u/SkinnerRox
SkinnerRox

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vor 13 Jahren

It certainly isn\'t as aversive as changing diapers the rest of your life\....just time consuming :) Most parents use it as a last resort. I will check that out.

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Avatar von u/SubOptimalGatsby
SubOptimalGatsby

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vor 13 Jahren

I meant aversive for the child. I have found potty training can often be much more stressful for parents than for the child\...and it can be

pretty stressful for the child. At least the ones I have worked with.

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girlypimp

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vor 13 Jahren

Have you tried having him help clean up after soiling himself? I felt soooo mean because my son hated it so much, but he uses the potty now.

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Chowderhead1

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vor 13 Jahren

My brother was 8 before he was toilet trained. What worked with him was my parents said \"All the boys and girls in last name castle pee and poo

in the toilet!\" (kind of sang it) over and over to him - if your guy is anything like my brother, he LOVES repetition. Everytime he pooped or peed in his diaper, they would say it over again. He started repeating it (ad nauseum lol) when he was playing trains, and I guess something just clicked and he started using the toilet all the time.

Good luck! :)

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insuranceguy

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vor 13 Jahren

We've used BootyCampMom.com for our son who is the same age as yours. Its a very difficult program and we really had to go through hell with our son, but it has worked really well in the end. We did everything by the book and it took about 3 weeks. ymmv. good luck!

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FoobarMontoya

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vor 13 Jahren

Ha wish I would have seen this before I typed 1012 paragraphs about that program. Saved my sanity, it did.

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Avatar von u/shmauzau

shmauzau

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vor 13 Jahren

What is he interested in? Maybe if he learns that he needs to be able to use the potty to pursue a certain interest, it might help.

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Avatar von u/Somizi

Somizi

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vor 13 Jahren

My son is almost 6 and it wasn't until he was 5 that he finally was potty trained.

We used a timeline - light on, pants down, sit, go potty, wipe, flush, wash hands, lights off.

Each had a picture with it and it was right on the mirror. Aside from just breeding it as a game (we'd go pee together and make it a father/son race!)

We had the most trouble with going #2. He finally started to find it

gross and didn't want it on his bottom, so he'd say when he had to go and we'd take a book or his little tablet and sit for 10 minutes. It's not easy, but I swear they will all learn at their own pace. We must walk along their path and guide them in the right direction.

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\[gelöscht\]

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vor 13 Jahren

FooBarMontoya

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vor 13 Jahren

My oldest son who is 7 is autistic. We potty trained him at 4 or 5... it was brutal, nothing we read and no advice we received worked. It all led to the same end: frustrated parents, a crying child, and shit everywhere.

Somehow we caught wind of a program called Booty Camp... Oprah maybe?? I was highly skeptical. My wife was desperate and pushed despite my objections... we were "attachment parenters" and this was a lot to swallow in that context. I relented and within two days of starting the program he was 90% successful. Within two weeks he was perfect. I don't remember how much it cost, but it wasn't cheap. Nevertheless it was worth every penny.

When it came time to potty train my youngest (who's typical), we brushed off the old materials and it was even easier. We probably could have done a more traditional method, but it's really hard to top the effectiveness (and speed) of this method.

If you decide to pursue, let me know if you want more opinions. I think the bottom line is this method works, even if your child has receptive language difficulties.

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Avatar von u/karmaqwe3n

karmaqwe3n

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vor 13 Jahren

Thanks so much for everyone putting in, i am gathering myself to attempt to potty train my 3y.o asd boy and I'm nervous! Thanks again, and thanks for posting this!

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raw157

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vor 13 Jahren

Hi there. I teach in a moderate-intensive high school special education classroom and am currently working on my masters in behavior interventions (aba). I'm currently going through this at the high school level with a 15 year old student. We are trying to get him on a bathroom schedule.

So, without knowing the child or anything about the child, I think I can give some suggestions. First off, make going to the potty rewarding for the child. If the child likes books, give them a book when they get to the toilet. Slowly fade this reward so it's not every time.

You also need to teach the child some way to communicate they need to use the restroom. If it's verbal, great. Sign language or picture cards are great too. You need to respect the child telling you they need to go. Even if they don't actually go, and just them associating the sign

with the room is a start.

I'm on my phone right now so I'll add more and edit this. It's annoying typing a wall of text on the phone.

Alright, got to my computer. I would really avoid punishment when it comes to using the bathroom. Now, if he's peeing on the walls, fine punish him. However, I would not punish for not using the toilet. You don't want him to have a negative association with the bathroom.

I would also work on a schedule with him. I'm on the fence with toilet-schedules. You want it to be as natural as possible. When nature calls, as they say. However, a schedule is better than being in pull ups. I would take some data on when he goes (write down the time you notice) and try to figure out a pattern. If you can get a schedule of when he eats and drinks going (I know life gets in the way) but it can only help.

Much of this depends on your child's understanding of cause and effect.

This can develop late in children with ASD. Like I said, I don't know your child, so that one is up to you.

Good luck and if you have questions or anything, I'd love to help!

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Avatar von u/IHeartDay9

IHeartDay9

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vor 13 Jahren

I tried with my daughter for a couple of years with limited success. She knew how to go, but she just didn't want to. When summer holidays came around, I just switched her to regular underwear. It turns out that she hates the toilet less than she hates peeing on herself. It took a few weeks, and she still has the occasional accident (once or twice a month) almost a year later, but she's more or less fine. We did the sitting her down every half an hour or so. Once she knew that she didn't have a diaper to pee in, she started to really try to hold it. We paid attention to her cues, and if she seemed like she really had to go, we'd sit her down. There was a fair bit of peeing in front of or just inside the bathroom for the first few months, from when she'd wait too long, but she got the idea.

Now if I could just get her to lose the potty seat before kindergarten, and teach her to wipe properly, it'd be perfect. Oh yeah, she's not big on unfamiliar toilets.

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Avatar von u/squeadunk

squeadunk

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vor 13 Jahren

At school, this has worked for me:

I bought a doll that can actually pee. The one I have is a blue soft cloth one that cost \$15 on amazon. They can get spendy if you need a more realistic one.

Then you need prizes. Toy cars, m & m's, skittles, stickers, etc.

For my pee pee doll I used yellow food coloring in the water so it is visible.

Visual of bathroom routine.

We sit in the bathroom in chairs and read a story book about going potty (there's a bunch out there with varying levels of anatomical

correctness).

Doll follows the routine.

Doll goes pee pee in the potty.

We jump up and down, cheer, and dance. Doll gets a sticker.

Then it's little Johnny's turn to sit on the potty. If he goes at all, he gets a BIG potty party.

Other things to note: get him out of pull ups. It whisks the wetness away and doesn't make him uncomfortable enough to deal with the potty. Either put him in big boy pants and be ready to make him uncomfortable and need to change himself every time he wets himself

OR

Put the big boy pants on UNDER his pull-up so that wetness is next to his skin to make it uncomfortable.

He needs to KNOW that he's wet and that it doesn't feel good to be wet.

Another idea that has had some success at our school is to buy big boy underpants with his favorite characters (doing the above no pull-ups or underwear then pull-up thing) and tell him that they are sad if they get wet.

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Avatar von u/nocreativenamesleft

nocreativenamesleft

Poster*in

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vor 13 Jahren

Thank you all for your awesome suggestions. We have a lot of work coming but these are a great start.

post 3: Alright so, a few things. TL;DR how the heck do you potty train an autistic 3 year old, and general tips for raising him

Buckle up, this is gonna be a little weird but bare with me, and please give no judgement. Please don't make snide remarks about how I'm polyamorous or bisexual, thank you!!!

Okay so I've (27F) been living with my girlfriend (24F) and fiance

(50M) for about a year.

My fiance has 3 kids (20, 15, 10M), all of which can mostly fend for themselves so I don't really have to watch over them other than the 10 year old occasionally. Our god child (9F) /my roomie's daughter also lives with us.

Then, my girlfriend has a 3 year old boy.

Ever since I've known her she's struggled with mental health issues. Been super depressed so she hasn't been able to do much aside from sit in bed and go to the bathroom. She barely even cooks for herself so half the time I have to make food for her, which I don't mind, I make food for the rest of the family too. So I've kinda taken over taking care of her son for the past year to help her out because I used to struggle with those issues as well and I totally get it (tbh part of me thinks it's unchecked post partum but I'm not gonna get into that)

Anyways I'm still new to this whole parent thing. I've had no kids of my own. My partners, my roomies, and my kids all say I'm doing wonderfully because I'm a stay at home mom and cook and clean and all that jazz but I still feel like idk. I'm not doing enough.

We struggle to afford the things I want to give them. We get our food from food banks, we get our clothes from drives. We can afford bills and basic necessities, but I want to be able to give them more than just the

base materials for life. It doesn't help that my girlfriend and I can't really work because of our mental health problems, hers being severe depression and mine being CPTSD and schizoaffective (I'm heavily medicated so the only thing that really impares me is if my brain is idle for too long I have flashbacks or my trauma weasles its way into my brain and. Most jobs don't require much thinking but yeah) Anyways, that aside. The 3 year old is autistic. He can barely talk, and his mom tried potty training him but gave up because she's not that patient with him.

I finally got it to where he'll let me wash his hair when I give him a bath without screaming bloody murder, but there's still a lot of stuff I struggle with.

Like how do I even begin potty training him? We have both a little potty for him, along with a toilet seat cover. I've been encouraging him to use the potty more, but he'd just. Rather go in his pullup. We tried giving him candy as a reward but he'd do this thing where he'd sit on the potty, not go, then expect candy and get mad at us for not giving it to him because he didn't go, then stopped.

Should I try giving him stickers or toys instead? Let him pick an activity to do? Idk. I just need help.

Another thing is his struggle with speech. I've been slowly teaching him to talk more and more. Putting on educational shows for him, reading to him often, asking him questions. It's to the point where he can form short sentences now like "Where is _ _ _ _?" or "I love you!" or

"Can I _ _ _ _?" but he still struggles.

And another thing I worry about is he's not as close with his mom as he is with me. He hugs me and tells me he loves me and cuddles me all the time but he won't with his mom because. She's too depressed to really. Do anything besides sit in bed and sleep all day or scroll on her phone. She's getting better day by day because she's on new meds so it's only a matter of time, but I still worry. I want him to have that same bond with his mom that he does with me.

Anyways, TL;DR, I need help with getting my step kiddo potty trained and speaking more

Also sorry I'm putting it under family problems. Idk what else to put this under since there's a lot of different things I cover

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Kommentarbereich

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 2 Jahren

catbus1066

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vor 2 Jahren

Children with autism often have misfires between their brain and their bladders. Like, they don't know they need to go until they're going. Mine is this way. He'll start to pee and theen run (while peeing) to his potty 🐼 or just stand there like WHAT DO I DO.

But we are working on it anyway even if it's not going great 😊 I'd encourage getting him back into early interventions, if possible.

Maybe start with just the simple act of sitting on the potty, and then

big praise/prizes for actually using it.

10

\[gelöscht\]

Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

I could do that!!! I\'m thinking maybe I can start doing a thing where I time him like.. say, every hour, sit him on the potty for 20 minutes and encourage him to go and reward him with stuff. Problem is I\'m totally broke and can\'t afford to get stickers n such for him, so maybe I\'ll have to get creative with my rewards? Idk, I\'m an artist, I\'ll figure something out lol.

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Avatar von u/diceosaurus

diceosaurus

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vor 2 Jahren

This is a good idea but I\'d maybe cut the time down to like potty every 30-40 minutes or so, just in case they\'re peeing a lot more than once an hour. As far as rewards go, I feel you on the money thing. You could try rewarding him with something he likes to do? Or read his favourite book after, or some such? Even just tons of praise can work. Sounds like you\'re doing a great job, though. I\'m proud of you for stepping up.

3

\[gelöscht\]

Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

Thank you so much!!!

And yeah I\'ll try doing that. Maybe reading to him after he goes potty. If that doesn\'t work, I\'ll probably doodle him little things and give him to them. Not stickers because they won\'t stick. But just doodles. Or let him use my nice art supplies and draw!!

3

catbus1066

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vor 2 Jahren

Marshmallows works for my kiddo, or a single m&m if he\'s sitting on the potty, and a handful if he pees. Screen time works for some folks with autistic kids. Or a few friends, their kids want tickles as a prize! It just varies kid to kid :)

3

\[gelöscht\]

Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

Ohhhh we tried something like that and he just ended up getting on and off the potty over and over again for 30 minutes and expecting a shit ton of candy xD he\'s a smart little guy. Tried to cheat the system aha. So I gotta change up the way I do stuff. He\'s very food motivated too. So I think I\'ll only give him treats when he potties, not when he sits down.

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akm215

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vor 2 Jahren

I would be careful here w/ the three year old and potty training. That\'s still young for pre verbal or non conversational autistic kids, especially boys. I think the best way to go about it is to show him that\'s where pee and poop is supposed to go, but follow his lead otherwise. Read potty training books, let him see you and his other parents using the toilet, narrate it and make it fun. The rest happens on his time because you gotta be careful to not make him adverse to the potty in general.

This part is completely not what you asked for, but i do worry about his other mom. Is she getting therapy or meds. Honestly, it seems like she needs some heavy duty help to feel ok again. This is said with no judgement. At. All. I\'ve been there, but even the guilt she must be feeling. Idk, it just really worries me.

6

\[gelöscht\]

Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

Yeah, but I also think it\'s time to start showing him because he\'s showing a lot of interest in it. Like sometimes he pulls his pullup down and just sits on it and tries without me asking to or encouraging him. She\'s on meds. But I honestly don\'t know what goes through her head. It\'s also hard to get therapy in the state of Texas for cheap for the issues we have. She has other disorders besides depression but I don\'t wanna get into it. Both of us have been on a waiting list for years through our free psych, both of them. We go through places in our area for free meds like JPS and MHMR. We\'ve been referred to sliding scale therapists, but when we go to them they p much tell us we\'re too much and refer us to a specialist that costs about \[extract_itex]100-300 per visit with no insurance, and both of us don\'t have insurance and go through the free programs since we have no jobs and VERY little income.

It honestly makes me feel like I\'m a failure as a mom because I can\'t get all the things my kids want/need besides food and clothes and general stuff places provide for free. We even have to be picky with what cleaning supplies to get so it\'s hard to clean the house. And the 3 year old doesn\'t have many toys he can play with.

It doesn\'t help that he\'s SUPER picky with food so a lot of stuff I make for him goes to waste and I have to make more food for him so he can pick and choose what he wants when we\'re already so limited on food. We can\'t afford a lot of his safe foods because we get stuff from the food bank mostly. Worst part is what he\'ll eat changes every day, and if he doesn\'t like it, he won\'t eat at all. And I\'m not mad about it, I\'ll do anything he needs me to do, he can\'t help it. It\'s just a little rough when you\'re considered poor and the economy is shit and inflation is a thing you know?

Since I\'m getting married soon I made a wishlist on amazon for both things we need for the house/art stuff so I can make art/graphic design for money, and a wishlist for him, and telling my friends and family to buy stuff from those lists as wedding gifts. The other kids are covered because their parents take care of them, but my fiance and I are the

main ones providing for him right now. Pullups and wipes aren't the cheapest either, which is why I'm pushing to potty train him sooner than later because I just can't afford it. I doordash and do commissions on the side but it's still not enough. Everyone in this area tips like shit, or at least, I only get the orders with shitty tips, so I have to choose between gas or spending money. Luckily the kiddo and mama are on medicaid so we can afford doctors appointments, but psychiatric care is still a bitch and a half to get. It's like Texas doesn't care about you unless you're dying or pregnant. Other than that, you're screwed lol.

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Avatar von u/daffodil0127
daffodil0127

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vor 2 Jahren

My daughter took until she was almost 5 to be potty trained. She just wasn't ready at 3. We had her sit on the potty with books or in front of the tv, which kept her occupied. Then when she finally did go, lots of over the top praise kept her motivated. Scheduled times to use it was helpful too, because she wasn't always aware of when she needed to go. She didn't really respond to rewards but acting like she had just climbed Mt. Everest and cheering her on was what worked. Your child might have different things that are motivating, like a favorite treat or toy. If he doesn't have much screen time with an iPad or whatever, that might work to keep him on the toilet. I would suggest having him urinate sitting down instead of standing, at least until he's comfortable using the toilet. Good luck, and be patient. He may get it, he may not. There's plenty of disabled kids who wear pull ups to school or when out of the house.

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\[gelöscht\
Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

I can do that!!! Thank you so much!!! I'm pretty good about giving him high fives and cheering for him and he seems to get super excited with those!!!

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2 weitere Antworten

\[gelöscht\
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vor 2 Jahren

Setting a timer, and saying "In x mins we're going to go to the potty." I started with going every 30 min. I've rolled it back to an hour because my guy(4) has started to initiate going on his own. Pee only though. Something about pooping on the potty upsets him. Getting undies that he wants to wear helped too. It's cookie monster for my son.

4

\[gelöscht\
Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

Ah! Gotcha!!! I can do that :) We do have underwear he picked out for himself, we just gotta train him to use it!!!

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desiladygamer84

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vor 2 Jahren

Our son is 3 and now afraid of sitting on the potty/toilet. Our pediatrician says it will take time. The timeline for an autistic kid is not the same as an NT child, so we've been told not to rush it. We've bought plenty of potty books but he hates sitting. Have you seen if early intervention will come to the home instead? With our kid, it's very much encouraged to follow his interests and what he enjoys and develop speech as to what we are doing with those activities. So just play with him, do what he likes doing.

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\[gelöscht\]

Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

My girlfriend's not doing anything about early intervention. Idk she just tells me she's trying and no one will get back to her. But idk. I want to put him in it but I'm unable to until I have power of attorney over him. Until then, I'm stuck with handling everything and teaching him on my own. It's a good job I wanted to be a teacher for a job originally and studied on that lol

3

Shell_N_Cheese

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vor 2 Jahren

As a mom with severe depression diagnosed, I could not imagine just checking out of being a mom

8

\[gelöscht\]

Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

Yeah, I don't either because I struggle with something similar but I'm not gonna get into that. Either way, I stepped up and I'm gonna make sure he's taken care of.

6

Whateveryousay333

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vor 2 Jahren

I was so depressed I had to cut my hair off from not brushing it . You best believe I took care of him . It was so so so hard but it depressed me more thinking someone would take my child from me. That's the thoughts I held on too among many others . I wasn't super mom but I did the bare minimum in times like these because he didn't ask to be here . This makes me sad I hope she snaps out of it soon. That poor baby doesn't understand. :(

He is lucky to have you op .

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ExaminationPutrid626

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vor 2 Jahren

I\'m working with my 2 yr old on potty training and we went straight to underwear so he could feel that sensation. We also have a step up to the toilet type seat instead of the little potty to cut out that step. I also have a toy character and phonics cards in a basket with a bunch of undies and clean shorts, half the time he goes to the toilet just so I'll do phonics 🤪

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\[gelöscht\]

Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

Hm, maybe I could do that 0:

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LittleMissMedusa

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vor 2 Jahren

First off, I think it\'s super cool to hear from more \"non-traditional\" family structures. Secondly, you sound like a wonderful person, and great parent. I\'m still struggling with the potty training myself, and the speech. And the general raising. And the mental health issues (my own, not his). In terms of sensory stuff, my kiddo also used to screech whenever I washed him, or moisturised his body, or brushed his teeth. His OT suggested instead of rushing through things like we usually do (to get them done because of how awful it is) to slow down and be more deliberate with our actions. Slow, firm pressure rather than quick, light touch. I\'m sorry I can\'t be of much help. I\'m also looking for advice about potty training. Good luck to you and your lovely family.

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\[gelöscht\]

Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

Hey, it\'s no problem!!! I\'m big on gentle parenting so I\'ve always done gentle touching and what not. I\'ve started asking him gently before doing something (like washing his hair) and when he says yes, I\'ll do it. But when he says no, I explain to him why it\'s important we do and then he lets me and that seems to keep him calm. I also let him play in the water for a bit since he loves to play in the water. I hope we can both find out how to potty train our kiddos soon!!!

4

Trifecta_life

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vor 2 Jahren

Another thing to keep in mind, Autism has a developmental delay aspect that may show up differently for different children. This lad may have a year or two till it fully 'clicks' (even if he's showing interest and attempting).

It sounds like this kid has a bunch of people in his life who love him to bits - that also goes a very long way!

2

\[gelöscht\]

Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

Yeah, that is true. It\'s just hard for me to afford pullups atm, but I always find a way!

And yeah he does!!! We love him bunches.

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Trifecta_life

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vor 2 Jahren

If you have hard floors, you could focus on bladder rather than bowel and deal with the mess. It\'s something I did. Carpet is not a good option for this strategy though!

Also do some research on interoception- it\'s the awareness of our body signals and plays a big part in toileting. The books around 'the out of sync child' could be a place to start - it\'s what got my ball rolling in the whole diagnostic process.

1

Avatar von u/Cupid873

Cupid873

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vor 2 Jahren

We live in the UK and children where we live start school at 3 so need to be potty trained by then as they won\'t change them in school.

I found it really hard with our son but once it clicked he just did it.

We used stickers (bulk bought Pokémon ones off amazon as that\'s what he loved), were advised not to make a big deal, not to constantly ask him just every hour stick him on potty without any conversation.

Is he in diapers? We used pants and found this worked best as he hated

feeling wet and kind of realised quite quickly if he had an accident it wasn\'t like a diaper, same thing really if they were themselves just ignore it and change them without saying anything. It\'s hard going, try not to over complicate it though and you\'ll be fine 😊

2

\[gelöscht\]

Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

I could do that!!! That\'s an awesome idea, I\'ll have to try that!!

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Avatar von u/1LurkinGurkin

1LurkinGurkin

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vor 2 Jahren

So keep going with what you\'re doing with speech. Maybe add in some key sign language words - I have no idea where you live so I can\'t provide you with a link because every country/state/province/territory/region has its own dialect.

When I toilet trained my 2 asd kids we had toilet treats. Mum did a wee on the toilet then Mum gets a treat and everyone made a big song and dance about it. Sister does a poo on the toilet then sister gets to have a treat and NOONE else does. We used M&ms in a big jar and it was a BIG deal to be able to pick out a colour to eat when no one else could have one. My kids got to hand out the treats to everyone. It made my kids

realise that they were missing out and would only get one when they used the toilet correctly.

The only time this is awkward is when you have a visitor over and your 3yr old interrogates them on if they did a wee or a poo and if they needed a Toilet Treat or not hahahaha.

2

\[gelöscht\]

Poster*in

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vor 2 Jahren

LMAO I can def do that. I do need to teach him more signs!! He already knows hungry and thirsty.

2

thisisnotkaty

•

vor 2 Jahren

I just attended a class through the Seattle Children's Autism center on potty training! My 3year old also isn't potty trained. They recommended a strict regimented 3 day program. Where you're taking the child to the bathroom every 15-30-45 minutes. Seeing if there is anything produced? Lol if they're not in the bathroom the child needs to be drinking water or watered down juice, eating salty snacks like goldfish, potato chips, whatever the child will eat or drink. The goal is to get them to drink as much liquid as possible to get them into the bathroom. No diapers/pull-ups during the day only at night during the 3 days. If you're interested in more information, feel free to dm me. The Center also gave me some resources I can pass along! I have also not tried this method. I was going to wait for the summer to let him run free without a diaper during the day. Lol

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Sad_Perspective2844

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vor 2 Jahren

We took our son to the forest camping (he was 4.5), told him "Sweden doesn't have any nappies" and let him run around naked. Potty training took one day. Surprisingly painless. And we were outside so any "accidents" we could treat as a success. Good luck! Both my boys were that age when they were ready. I'm sure it won't be long for you either.

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Ethan_Lethal

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vor 2 Jahren

Routine, and a ninja-like focus on never deviating from it. That's how we managed a lot of the early issues, sleep, eating, potty, school, etc. post 4: I feel like giving up potty training our ASD 4 yo. It's so hard. We are on day two of trying to potty train our 4 year old autistic son. He's fairly high functioning and seems ready, but I'm just at a loss and feel like giving up. I'm curious if anyone has real life

suggestions that worked for their kids. Yes, I've read alllllll the other threads, but all ND / ASD kids are so different when it comes to stuff like this.

We're taking 2 solid weeks off ABA to try and hammer this out at home. At the moment he's bottomless and definitely doesn't like feeling the

pre drip down his leg. He certainly knows how to hold it and knows when he needs to go, he's just refusing to \"release\" it (#1 or #2) when sitting on the potty. We have both a little potty and an insert on our normal potty and he's been wanting to sit on both. He's not food motivated, so using food as rewards does not work. Currently I'm giving him a new sequencing card (he's obsessed with them) anytime even a tiny bit of pee comes out. He's really only gone successfully twice, so there hasn't been too many opportunities for big rewards. I've tried letting him watch videos while sitting there, but I don't know if that's making him not focus on his body? He doesn't enjoy bubbles or the typical sensory activities people recommend doing on the potty. For now, he's just holding it for 2ish hours until he can't hold it anymore and then he goes on the floor. We're very neutral and positive about it, no shaming. He says \"poop and pee go in the potty\". It's just connecting the dots. He's naturally a VERY stubborn kid, so it's sometimes hard to discern if he's refusing to go because we're asking him to. Our OT is coming over today, but they can only do so much in a 45 min session. I know all kids learn this at their own pace and time, but he just really seems ready and I don't want to miss out on this 2 weeks opportunity.

Any suggestions are appreciated. Thanks! 😊

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Kommentarbereich

WaltzNo3253

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vor 3 Monaten

You're definitely not alone a lot of autistic kids know the urge but have a really hard time actually \"releasing\" on the potty, and it's usually more of a sensory/motor issue than stubbornness. What helped us was keeping everything super calm and predictable, giving him the option to stand at first, avoiding pressure so his body didn't tense up, using his special interests as rewards, and even trying a bit of warm water on the legs to help trigger the reflex. Progress can be slow and messy, but even tiny wins usually snowball once their body figures out what to do. This video explained the whole release difficulty really simply and made things click for us, so sharing in case it helps you too:

<https://youtu.be/QnshpM5cAkY?si=MABfcUQILtOsn86r>

4

anonymoussanthologies

Poster*in

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vor 3 Monaten

Thank you!!

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He_Who_Walks_Behind_

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vor 3 Monaten

Bribery worked for our AuDHD kiddo. He got a piece of candy and a sticker to put on a chart every time he went. When he filled the chart, we took him to the toy store and he was allowed to pick out anything he wanted. (Yes, I'm aware that not everyone can do this and that I'm very fortunate to be able to do so.) first chart had 7 stickers, second 14

and 3rd 21. By the time he was through all 3 charts, he was going on his own without prompting.

2

anonymoussanthologies

Poster*in

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vor 3 Monaten

I was thinking of doing some sort of sticker or "token" chart with about 7 to start. Maybe I'll do that.

2

Avatar von u/GarbageBright1328

GarbageBright1328

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vor 3 Monaten

Bribery worked for us too. We offered books from his favorite youtuber and that was the ticket!

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Avatar von u/The_Real_Grand_Nagus

The_Real_Grand_Nagus

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vor 3 Monaten

In my experience, you really can't force it. Sometimes they just take longer than other kids and it's frustrating, but it will eventually come along.

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Lilsammywinchester13

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vor 3 Monaten

I genuinely recommend doing a schedule first

Times his breaks and just take him around 30 before he normal goes

Yes it's annoying, but it's a lot less tears, messes, and meltdowns

They will connect the dots on their own eventually

Focus boards for them to have them focus on the task at hand helps

Free Focus Boards

Or that's what I did for both my kids, "potty training" was miserable

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anonymoussanthologies

Poster*in

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vor 3 Monaten

Great tips, thanks!!

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shiturdle

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vor 3 Monaten

My autistic kiddo had a hard time too. She's 11 and still wets the bed regularly. Oftentimes autistic kids have a hard time understanding the feelings they should have when they need to go. My kid still doesn't always know when she needs to poop so we have to prompt her to go to the bathroom.

It's frustrating but I know you can do it :)

post 5: Potty Training Hell

My daughter 3.5 year old and has level one autism. We're trying to

potty train again. We're on day 2 of I don't even remember how many attempts at this point. I hate it.

She struggles with interoception, so she doesn't seem to really understand when she needs to pee. I've heard so many parents say they just took diapers away, their kid peed themselves once, hated the feeling, so they were motivated. My kid does not seem to care at all. She'll pee herself and just keep playing in the puddle.

She also has pathological demand avoidance. If I try prompting her every 2 hours, it doesn't work at all. She just freaks out and refuses to sit on the toilet. I don't want to deal with power struggles 7 times a day either.

At this point, I only prompt her when she wakes up and before going to sleep. Otherwise, I just let her spoil herself and make her clean up. I'm just hoping she'll eventually decide changing her pants 10 times a day is more effort than using the toilet.

If that doesn't work, I guess I'll just try to get an IEP so she can start pre-k in the fall when she turns 4. Because we've literally tried everything.

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Kommentarbereich

MrsMeredith

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vor 9 Monaten

Has she ever checked for a secret pee?

That's the thing currently working for us.

"Time to go to the toilet." "No, I don't have to pee." - said with much anger and attitude. "Oh I know. But sometimes there's a secret pee that wants to come out. Do you want to check in my bathroom or yours?" "Let's

see if there's a secret pee on your toilet."

Lo and behold there is quite often a secret pee.

I think it works though because it kind of acknowledges that she's not feeling like she has to pee yet.

16

Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

I haven't heard of this one before. That's adorable and hilarious. I'll see if this works.

1

MrsMeredith

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vor 9 Monaten

Good luck!

2

Fritemare

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vor 9 Monaten

Have you tried leaving her bare bottomed? That's what ended up working for my son. If he had on undies, he would use them like a diaper. I also used bribery. Anytime he peed/pooped in the toilet, piece of candy.

Anytime he agreed to sit and try, I gave him my phone to play with. He only gets my phone on the toilet, so it was a huge motivator for him. I know some people have potty timers or watches. Maybe she's more willing to listen to a potty timer? Make a huge production when the timer goes off, like \"yay it's potty time woohoo let's go see if you need to pee!\"

Play media related to potty time as well. Elmo and Cocomelon both have potty training songs. There are books too, I'd suggest one that has buttons she can push.

13

Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

We tried bare bottom. She'll just continue to play in the pee. She doesn't care.

We tried bribes. She doesn't care about candy or chocolate. She barely eats enough to sustain herself as is. She doesn't really care about stickers either. She'll sit on the toilet to watch Bluey on my phone, but she can't just watch Bluey all the time. That's not sustainable. She doesn't want to listen to a potty watch. She understands that's just an agent of her parents.

We have tons of books and shows about the potty. She happily reads them, then doesn't go.

She won't tell me why she's so resistant to potty training either.

7

tagalong2

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vor 9 Monaten

Why is watching Bluey on the toilet not sustainable? My 3.5yo is PDA too, and we had some success with letting him watch a diecast car race on YouTube if he made a pee in the potty. After a week or so, we started tapering off the TV reward and started basically telling him to go potty before we do any preferred activities/give any preferred toys. We instructed his daycare teachers to do the same, and they had success with that strategy. So far so good, though he hasn't pooped in the potty yet, just in a diaper before bed. Working on it ͡°(ツ)͡°

5

Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

I can't tell if this is a serious question. Because I want her to go to school some day and her teachers won't let her use their phones to watch Bluey on the toilet.

-4

tagalong2

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vor 9 Monaten

I'm serious. It's just a tool to get used to peeing on a toilet, then phase it out. Idk, personally I try to pick my battles with my lvl3

3.5yo, and watching 5 minutes worth of bluey or whatever in order to learn an important skill is not one of them. You do you, though. They don't allow screens at his school and they always report he does well with toileting. Hope you figure it out...

7

Setze diesen Thread fort

6 weitere Antworten

EnthusiasticFailing

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vor 9 Monaten

We are currently potty training and have a pile of books next to the potty.

He is bare bottomed, and whenever its potty time (every 30 minutes if he potties and 15 if he hadn't) we pause what we are doing and he gets to read books on the potty and then he gets to flush the toilet which is his favorite.

Did he draw on the carpet with his pee? Yes. Does he poop standing up every time he has ever pooped since potty training has started without any hint he is about to poop? Also yes.

But we are only interested in progress not perfection and we are now 90% peeing in the potty. As soon as we can get a poop in the potty we are slapping some pants on and going to block two!

4

Avatar von u/heyimnew2116

heyimnew2116

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vor 9 Monaten

I agree with some of the other comments, it sounds like she isn't ready. I would let her go back to wearing diapers for now. It sounds like it is too stressful for both of yall right now.

6

Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

She's not really stressed. If she can't figure out the body signals after a week of no diapers, I'll just put a diaper on and continue to have her OT work on interoception. She doesn't get upset when I tell her to put on dry pants. As for me, being inconvenienced and frustrated is kinda par for the course for parenting.

2

Avatar von u/Visual_Preference919

Visual_Preference919

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vor 9 Monaten

Ok here's my take- take a break and let her tell you when she's ready. Our 5.5 year old L2 son is just now starting to really get it. We tried for probably 2.5 full years before deciding to just focus on other skills because he was stressed out and we were stressed as hell. Once we took the pressure off and just started keeping books around about going potty, etc we just gave him opportunities to practice when he seemed relaxed. Last week he just randomly started to pee in the potty and he's starting to keep his training underwear dry! It totally caught us off

guard and we're thrilled he's going to go into kindergarten at least being able to pee in the potty

6

Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

We only try to potty training when her preschool is on break. When she's in school, we take breaks from potty training. We started on Monday, so it feels way too early to give up. Unless she starts crying about needing to change and clean up, I'm going to keep the diapers off until she's back in preschool on Monday or it clicks.

1

Minute_Parfait_9752

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vor 9 Monaten

Honestly, my autistic daughter had a terrible time withholding at daycare and constantly having meltdowns. I sent her there in pull-ups and carried on potty training at home. When she started to pee I would say \"hey!!\" And grab her, stick her on the potty and then point at the pee and be like \"you did a pee on the potty!\" And the odd time I got her on the potty and she would pee was similar. The first time she got up and sat on the potty and peed, I gave her a big toy and told her how proud I was. Then she had another break from daycare and we did a long run of no pull ups, and took her to daycare in pants after and she was fine (there were a few accidents but that's pretty normal with preschool kids)

She always pulled a poo face so that was a little easier to catch, and she didn't poo at daycare ever, and rarely out of the house.

If you can, I would definitely try to get her trained when having accidents is par for the course, because if she gets trained at 6, I can imagine that other children could be pretty dreadful. Whereas at 3/4, I just don't think it holds the same stigma.

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Avatar von u/Visual_Preference919

Visual_Preference919

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vor 9 Monaten

I mean I honestly feel like this stigma has more to do with how the parents feel than how the kids feel. I know plenty of NT kids who have issues reading their bodies. It's more common than you'd think. I worked in an elementary school and we had NT kids in our second grade classes having accidents with regularity. Other kids didn't really care or in many cases even notice. We got the kids cleaned up and changed (most

elementary schools will have you bring in spare clothes through at least kindergarten or they'll have extras on hand in case of accidents or sickness). TBH when a kid would throw up in a classroom- that was the real story with the kids. Or if someone was bleeding lol. As Miss Rachel has so eloquently stated- your kid isn't going to be putting the age they were potty trained on a college or job application lol. As parents we get so in our heads about this particular issue. But lastly I'll just say, a turning point for me in my self inflicted potty training anxiety

was when I watched a woman with a severely disabled teenager take her son to change his diaper at We Rock The Spectrum and I decided I have absolutely no room to be so worked up about my child who couldn't go in the toilet but could change his own pull up.

1

Avatar von u/ajrpcv

ajrpcv

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vor 9 Monaten

ABA potty trained my lvl 2 daughter at 4. I'll say, once she got it she had one accident and that was it.

5

Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

We're still on the fence about whether ABA is right for her.

1

Fun_Television_1289

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vor 9 Monaten

Does she have a diagnosis of GDD? Physically, our daughter is 3 1/2. But mentally, she's about 1 1/2. So while her age seems appropriate for potty training, her mental age isn't there yet

3

Avatar von u/Living-Teach-7553

Living-Teach-7553

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vor 9 Monaten

I don't know if both condition could be linked. My toddler was diagnosed with GDD at 5 months old, he met all his milestones late and very late. But he is daytime potty trained since he was 2.5 years old, we still use pull up for night time sleep.

2

Fun_Television_1289

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vor 9 Monaten

I think it varies kid to kid. A GDD isn't linear so while my daughter is roughly 2 years behind, another could be maybe 6 months behind.

2

Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

Nope. She meets all her milestones.

1

Mamanamespo

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vor 9 Monaten

Whats GDD?

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Fun_Television_1289

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vor 9 Monaten

Global developmental delay

1

1 weitere Antwort

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 9 Monaten

Avatar von u/AMos617

AMos617

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vor 9 Monaten

I feel your pain! My Level 1 son was 5 before he was officially out of
diapers. He was also SO scared of the loud, unpredictable automatic
flushing toilets at preschool, so I had some sympathy.

He is now 7 and I still need to wipe him. Reminding him to pee/poop when
he clearly needs to go always results in a fight/power struggle. I try
so hard to let him go when he wants to but he still has accidents.

3

ghostjournals

•

vor 9 Monaten

My oldest son was 5 when he started going to the potty. Closer to 5 1/2
when he started taking himself to go. It might just take more time than
you're anticipating, as others have said. My youngest is on the spectrum
too. He just turned 3 and he'll go pee if we take him, but he doesn't
let us know he has to go and he won't take himself yet. They're both
still in nighttime diapers to stay dry at night.

2

VanityInk

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vor 9 Monaten

I could have written this when my daughter was 3.5. The only thing that
worked for us was making toileting part of her schedule (we weren't
telling her to go. There was no timer demanding it. It just went "Oh.
Look the schedule says toilet after bathroom. Funny that." and she

followed it because it was her schedule but her choice to go). Once we
did that, she was out of pull-ups in a week (after trying off and on
since she'd turned 2). We did have to keep on the schedule thing,
though, for another year because of the same interoception issues.
She's nearly 6 now and STILL doesn't care if she's wet (she's not
night trained and entirely peed through her goodnite one night. She was
sitting in the middle of damp sheets, soaked from the waist down when I
went in the next morning and she complained when I made her change. She
legit DID NOT CARE about the sensation and was more annoyed with needing
to stop what she was doing to change). Around 5, she started noticing
when she needed to go and now at nearly 6 she takes herself reliably,
but at 3/4, we had to keep an eye on how much she was drinking since she
wouldn't notice until she was peeing, if then.

Good luck! Hang in there.

2

PossiblyMarsupial

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vor 9 Monaten

Hard solidarity. My son is 4.5, also PDA, and we're still at this point. Absolutely point blank refusal to even try to sit on the potty or toilet, doesn't care about peeing himself one bit, or what else he gets soaked in pee. He's about to start reception in September and I very much doubt he'll be potty trained then either. I have no clue how to go about it at this point because after 5 failed attempts with different methods just casual mentions cause huge, long lasting meltdowns. We're at a loss. We've backed the fuck off until the extreme stress response abates for him.

2

2 weitere Antworten

New-Day8202

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vor 9 Monaten

I feel you. I just got semi done with one twin, he's likely level 1 - IDK we were not given levels. Took like 6 months of hard work, sweat and tears from both of us. He likes rewards and it totally helped him. Little cheat toys, lollipops worked for him. My other twin we just started 2 weeks ago. I think it'll take a year with him. He has higher support needs and rewards don't seem to work. My guys will be 4 soon. And ABA helps out a lot.

2

thebenn

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vor 9 Monaten

My son is 10 and is in diapers we take him every 30 minutes 45 minutes sometimes when he stressed out and then he does things like take off a completely dry diaper and poop all over his bedding

2

Ok-reyes4987

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vor 9 Monaten

Ugh, I feel this so hard! We're on round...who knows what of potty training too, and it's brutal. Same deal with interception - he just doesn't notice or care when he's wet, and that whole "pee once and hate it" thing? Total myth ofor us. And prompting backfires immediately thanks to PDA. The more I ask, the harder he resists.

What's kind of helped here is removing the pressure entirely and using a visual schedule + some timers he can control himself. We've been using Goally because it lets him see his routine and gives him that autonomy without me hovering. He still has accidents, but its less of a battle now. Honestly, we're just aiming for gradual desensitization and zero power struggles. It's exhausting, but you are not alone!!!

2

Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

Timer works really for reminding her to eat instead of starving herself. It's been less helpful for using the bathroom.

2

Ok-reyes4987

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vor 8 Monaten

What about visual schedules for potty time?

1

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 9 Monaten

We had about 10 months of potty training hell before it finally clicked for my son.. 2 months shy of his 4th birthday. We're getting him assessed for autism, i think he is probably level 1 but TBD. There were lots of lows, lots of two steps forward, three steps back (he would initiate and then pee himself .. cleaned up so much poop off the floor and smeared into everything). We had a few hard weeks where he wasn't sleeping at night, just running around his room, we thought we were losing our minds... and then he started sleeping normally and then started using the potty completely on his own prompting. 🙏 I don't think you should give up, but I don't think you can force it either.

2

Avatar von u/Extension_Army4021

Extension_Army4021

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vor 9 Monaten

Sounds exactly like my kid, he's a little over 4. Honestly I feel like every attempt just sets us back. So irritating. I think he'll just have to decide on his own, but we're starting OT to hopefully help with the proprioception. Any way, just offering solidarity. I can't even count how many times people have asked, "but did you try just putting him in undies?" Must be nice 😞

2

emelleque

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vor 9 Monaten

I have a 4 y/o and have had similar experiences! Mainly the PDA struggles and interoception are our main hurdles several months after starting potty training. It helps to have the potty as part of a distinct routine, which is sometimes still a fight but at least feels like less of a direct demand to him. He has gone through so many meltdowns because he is in pain from needing to pee and just cannot regulate and coordinate voiding on the potty, and struggles more with withholding than accidents. He needs prompting 100% of the time. We are starting OT in a few days and hoping that will be helpful with the interoception piece and give us some more ideas!

2

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 9 Monaten

GrowingUpGarlicky

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vor 9 Monaten

This sounds EXACTLY like my son from all of your comments. Didn't care when he was wet or pooped. Unable to tell me when he needed to go. Non motivated. Refused to go to the potty, meltdowns about having to go so frequently.

I'll tell you right now - she isn't ready and you need to wait until she's older.

My son did not potty train until he was 5. And it was like a lightbulb went off in his head.

One day in the summer, I decided to buy him really cool underpants in the characters he most liked at the time (Star Wars and Mario). I had him wear them and he asked for his pull ups. So I bribed him and said "If you wear underpants ALL day, I'll buy you a talking Kylo Ren." It worked. We chucked pull ups for the most part aside from going in public for a while until he was more consistently not having accidents. We still use them occasionally for long car rides, airplane trips, etc. We started taking him potty around the clock starting with every 10 minutes, then 15, then 20, then 30, then 45, then 60, then 90, and now we're at 2- 2 1/2 hours.

Then we made up a potty time rewards system that worked for him. It was incredibly expensive, so it may not work for everyone. We made 2 different sticker charts in Star Wars theme called "Potty Wars" 😊. We had different tiered rewards as follows:

- Showing us or telling us you need to go potty - A sticker and a Star Wars tattoo
- Less than 3 accidents in 1 day - Sticker and a small toy (under \$5) - there were 10 of these prizes
- No accidents at all for a day - Sticker and a \$50 toy - there were 5 of these prizes
- Less than 2 accidents for a week - a brand new Star Wars bedroom upstairs (we needed to move him to a new bedroom anyway since we're trying for a sibling for him, but didn't want the move to be associated with a new baby coming)

Every time he went pee on the potty, he got 1 m&m. Every time he stayed dry between potty trips, he got 2 m&ms. Every time he went poop on the potty, he got 3 m&ms.

It took many, many months for him to earn that bedroom. We started in early June and he didn't earn it until the end of November when he was 5 1/2. And even since then, he has had regressions. His most recent regression where he was having frequent accidents was 3 weeks ago. But it was followed by a big developmental leap and he hasn't had a single accident in about 2 weeks when he was having them at least a couple times per week.

You need to go at her pace, when she's ready. They can't kick her out of developmental, public school for not being potty trained. And if she has an IEP, ask them to add a potty training goal and they will help her.

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GrowingUpGarlicky

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vor 9 Monaten

I forgot to add that prior to switching to underpants full time, for about a year, we were taking him at regular times throughout the day while he was still in pull ups. If you haven't switched to pull ups, do that now to give her more practice with the up and down of underpants rather than regular diapers. Preschool will recommend this too.

In terms of when we took him, we went 1st thing in the morning, after meals, before leaving the house, after coming home, once or twice in the afternoon, and before bed. This creates regularity and familiarity with the bathroom.

From every comment you've made, it truly sounds like she's really not

ready and you'll just be stressing both of you out by continuing with the diaper free journey. Use this time to teach her how to get her clothes down and back up and familiarizing her with the process of going potty rather than focusing on whether or not she's going on her own and \"getting it\". For my son, we STILL have to tell him it's time to go potty. He does not tell us on his own most of the time.

2

Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

She's in pull-ups. She changes her own diapers. She does still need help with wiping after a poop though.

We were taking her to the potty in pull-ups for a while, but she got really upset when we switched to undies. Her pediatrician said to take a break from all potty related activities for a month, then try again without any prompting except when she wakes up and goes to sleep. So that's what we're trying.

1

GrowingUpGarlicky

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vor 9 Monaten

Okay great, I'm one who considers pull ups diapers as well, but not everyone does. I wouldn't make the switch to underwear for a while. Like I mentioned, we didn't make that switch entirely until my son was 5 (and not for lack of trying.)

We tried potty training at 2.5 (before we had a diagnosis), at 3.5 with training underwear, and then at 4 with pull ups was when we started with the scheduled trips with no pressure. Just \"Hey, we're going to go sit on the potty.\" We would praise if he went, but not make a big deal if he didn't. And 5 was when we got to underwear.

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Avatar von u/Additional_Set797

Additional_Set797

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vor 9 Monaten

My daughter didn't care if she was wet either, her ABA clinic helped us potty train her and honestly if they didn't I would have given up, it took us almost a freaking year. I'm not saying you have to use ABA obviously I'm just saying if I had to do it alone I would have lost my dam mind. It does sound like maybe she isn't ready, while my daughter didn't care about being wet, she didn't really fight to sit on the potty. ABA did an intensive potty training for like 2 days and that's when it really started to click for her, but it still took months to be accident free.

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Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

What did ABA do to help her learn to understand her body cues?

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Avatar von u/Additional_Set797
Additional_Set797

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vor 9 Monaten

Honestly it was just a lot of letting her have accidents and things like oh you went pee we need to do that on the potty, they would also have her help clean up, not in the sense I thought this meant but maybe just put her dirty pants in the bin and get new ones. I'm not sure I could have don't that at home, it took her a long time to be able to hold her pee and realize when she actually had to go. The first day she had 15 accidents at ABA (8-4) and 4 at home. That went on for quite a while

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redditor-est2024

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vor 9 Monaten

I understand your struggle. We've been in potty training hell for a year. Our son is 4.5 years old. What's most irritating is that when he's completely naked, he goes to potty. He says uh oh, I need to go and then takes himself. But as soon as any type of fabric is on him, he decides to go in his pants/underwear. It's not like I can send him to places half naked, you know. 😞

We did write on his IEP that his diaper must be checked every 2 hours but school gave me such a hard time about it. They suggested I hardcore potty training him. (Mind you, I almost reached into the monitor and virtually slapped the teacher - meeting was online)

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Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543
DisasterThese6543
Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

Thanks. It's so incredibly hard. I really envy the people who say it

just "clicked" for their child.

If my kid self-initiated while naked, that'd be a major win for us at this point. lol. Have you tried dresses or skirts? You could call them kilts if you think he'd be resistant to "girl clothes." That way there is some fabric touching his bum and penis but wouldn't fully surrounding his bottom.

1

redditor-est2024

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vor 9 Monaten

Can I just say, you're a GENIUS? Off to find tutus! (I always wanted a girl so that the fact that you have a daughter is already envious for me ♥)

Good luck to both of us and hopefully we will post that our kids are finally fully potty trained one day!

2

Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543
DisasterThese6543
Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

Good luck. I hope it works. I've found my kid needs things broken down into more steps than neurotypical kids do.

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Unable-Food7531

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vor 9 Monaten

Reading her social stories like \"X learns to use the potty\" might help.

Edit: Or, as someone else said, straight up bribery/Manipulation.

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daniellasss

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vor 9 Monaten

She may simply not be ready. My son is turning 5 in August and fully potty trained only 2.5 months ago.

We tried everything before - he just needed more time.

3.5 is still a total norm for ASD kids not to be potty trained. She will get there when she's ready. Keep encouraging her, but don't force anything.

Trust the process. Rooting for you!

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Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

What do you mean by she's simply not ready? Are you suggesting she'll just stop struggling with interoception at some point? I don't really know how she'll grow out of that without practice.

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daniellasss

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vor 9 Monaten

I am not saying she will stop struggling - but based on what I have experienced with my son, and all the advice I got from several therapists - each child's individual development and maturing process plays a huge part in potty training. This is what I mean when I said that she may not be ready just yet. Of course I am just a fellow parent, but I recently wrote a post here where I celebrated my son's potty training success.

https://www.reddit.com/r/Autism_Parenting/comments/1k0t3r3/and_just_like_that_that_day_came_and_my_is_son/

It took him long to get there - but he did it, because one day it just.. \"clicked\" for him. He had accidents, but he understood that he needs to use the toilet - which is not something that he realised before. I tried everything, until his therapist told us to stop what we were doing, wait and give him time. We did and with consistent approach he just one day went to the toilet, sat on it and did what he had to. That

was the last time we used a diaper (and he is now in a process of not using it at night either).

His interoception is just fine and when I think about it now - it was definitely the process of development and maturing. He just needed more time to get there - which is probably an advice you will see here often.

Wish you the best of luck!!!

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daniellasss

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vor 9 Monaten

Another thing as I just reread your post - perhaps where I live there tends to be a different approach, less focus on behaviour (I live in Spain). I tried going the no-diaper way, and our therapist strongly advised to start at home only, never outside, at least not when he is ready and can use a toilet. This was to avoid a situation when the he feels shame or embarrassment and this could have a negative (even traumatic) effect on the potty training.

1

Euphoric-Peace980

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vor 9 Monaten

I used bribes and a lot of juice. We also did no clothes but I do not suggest that, only because they will try to be naked for the next three or more years. So fill them up with juice and then make them sit on the toilet every 30 minutes for five minutes, then he got a small piece of chocolate. This was only for peeing though, pooping is a whole nother ballgame. But I didn't really try to start with him until he was five.

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\[gelöscht\]

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vor 9 Monaten

We tried a couple times. When my son was 2.5 (before we knew about his ASD), then again at 3.5. Currently he\'s almost 4.5 and we are having more success. She might just not be ready yet. And that\'s ok!

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thunderboy13

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vor 9 Monaten

Don\'t give up. My kid held poop for 3 days before rushing to the potty.

1

2errlshuman

•

vor 9 Monaten

With the demand avoidance thing, would she try something she\'s \("not supposed\" to do, like going in the bathtub? That\'s what worked for my son, and then eventually he transitioned to the toilet.

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Avatar von u/DisasterThese6543

DisasterThese6543

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

I think asking her to be "bad" would break her little brain honestly. Her demand avoidance paradoxically comes from wanting to be "good." Her mental rigidity manifests as wanting to follow rules and instructions to the letter. She's a perfectionist. When she's asked to do something difficult and she doesn't get it on the first try, she kinda freaks out and tries to avoid it.

I think she's genuinely struggling to learn the body cues that allow

people to know they need to pee or poop. She doesn't feel them or doesn't feel them very strongly. So frequent reminders of this thing she's struggling to learn stress her out.

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2errlshuman

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vor 9 Monaten

Oh, poor sweet girl! I totally get that. You've done a wonderful job analyzing what is going on with her. Unfortunately I don't have another idea to offer, but I just wanted to say how lovely it is to hear a parent understand their child so thoroughly and empathetically.

1

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 9 Monaten

My one twin (who's turning 4 at the end of this month) is still in pull ups. He has GDD and is about 6 months behind his twin brother who potty trained at 2 1/2. We're waiting on a diagnosis but he's verbal and tells me all the time he needs to go potty. Then, we sit him down and nothing happens. He's pooped a few times on it because I caught him in the act and put him on the potty real quick. I admit I haven't been consistent enough because he was in pre-k that did not require kids to be potty trained. Now it's summer break and when we come back from vacation we'll attempt naked or undies as we did with my NT twin.

So I have no advice for you, just solidarity since we're in a similar situation. I just have this feeling we are in for the long haul with my son, but he does have ABA coming this summer so I hope the extra support will help.

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RepresentativeAny804

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vor 9 Monaten

She honestly might just not be ready. Take her with you to the bathroom every time you go (for pee at first). Talk to her about going to the bathroom. Let her see your pee in the toilet and you flush it. Read her books about potty. Show her videos about potty. In the public restroom talk to her about everyone goes potty. Right now she needs the exposure of this is something everyone does.

1

Ok-Shopping-6964

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vor 9 Monaten

My advise is to keep at it. So I created an alexa routine which says, \"Childname Potty\" every 45 mins 3 times. So whether he wants to go or not, once it says I take him to the bathroom remove his pants and make him stand for a min and give him a sliver of his favourite food. This made him trained in few weeks. It's tiring but it's worth it. He is still not fully trained, and have had accidents but almost diaper

free for some days.

Do not stop trying.

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Visible-Transition92

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vor 9 Monaten

Some great comments and suggestions in here. For me, my son wasn't fully potty trained until he was 5yo (right before he started Kindergarten). What helped my son was allowing him to choose his potty seat and urinal on Amazon, watching animated potty training videos on YouTube (mainly singalong ones. For example Cocomelon and Super Simple. and I heard Ms. Rachel worked for others), as well as going bare bottom. When I would give him a choice, he seems to always be more receptive and will use it since it was essentially his choice of item. But I pick the items or shows and have him pick from those (2-4 options). She may be more motivated if she is the one choosing...especially since, like my son, when we tell them to do something it makes them more adamant NOT to do it. But when I present my son with options, he then is more receptive and will do the task. Hopefully this makes sense :).

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honeybvbymom

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vor 8 Monaten

any update? currently in the same exact situation trying to potty train my son before school. we're on day 5 now and he's only peed once in the toilet which was on day 2 because i took him to potty first thing when he woke up.

the last two days he's been holding his pee before bedtime and ends up wetting himself overnight (i have him in undies and a night time diaper over). i'm ready to give up honestly. 😞😞 he just pees/poops himself and isn't phased. I haven't tried bare bottom which i'll prob try today but i have carpet in all the bedrooms and playroom lol! did you end up continuing or stopped?

1

IndependenceLow1500

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vor 8 Monaten

Avatar von u/WillowTreeOromia

WillowTreeOromia

•

vor 7 Monaten

Hello, i wanted to give my little input as we finally today had our very first success on the toilet. My daughter is \"mostly\" nonverbal, can speak but won't, uses random sounds like frog croaking or babbling and has poor receptive language, she also cant understand the sensation of a full bladder. She is going to be 3 in less than a month. About 4 months ago I purchased a kids toilet cushion because she definitely doesn't like the feeling of the toilet seat and she LOATHES the \"baby potty\". We began trialing going bottomless around the same time as I bought the cushion because she was demonstrating lots of success holding her urine, even through the entire night but still cant seem to connect the urge to pee with sitting on the toilet. I began taking her with me every time I use the restroom and she only half pays attention (she also has SPD). When I would finish i would get out her cushion and make her sit, even for a few seconds. It seems we've done this 2 million times at this point .Today after work, I got home and gave her a bath. After the bath I kept her bottomless and she brought me her cup + a bottle of water (she won't speak). After about 20min I heard her starting to void on

the floor so I jumped up and we ran to the bathroom..she sat on her cushion but didn\'t finish going..I knew she wasn\'t done...watched her like a hawk the next 15min and she started to void again...rushed her back to the potty and for the first time she went! I know this was just a one time thing for now but I wanted to say I felt so frustrated and like giving up after 4 months of taking her potty every 30-60min, sitting her there and having her hop right off. I\'m truly amazed she had her first successful usage before the age of 3 as she never seems to care about wet pants at all. I suppose the routine may have been key but I\'m not expecting a fully potty trained toddler any time soon. It\'s going to take lots more wet pants and unsuccessful trips but it can happen 🙏

1

Post 6: Advice on potty training 4 year old autistic child
Update - So we\'ve been going commando all day today, and I\'ve implemented a score chart with the big prize of his choice when he fills it up (he asked for a power wheels jeep) No accidents... Yet. Haven\'t flushed until he\'s in a room well away from the toilet. And no tantrums! So far so good!!
Unfortunately we\'re on a wait list for a therapist and his PCP told us (and I quote) \"well when he starts school he\'ll see other kids using the potty, that should convince him to try!\" 😞
He\'s four, turning five in a few months. I\'ve tried absolutely everything you can think of. And I just can\'t seem to get him to consistently use the potty. I feel like a failure because he\'s still in

pull ups. He won\'t use a stand alone training potty, will sort of sit on the training seat, but if you so much as look like you\'ll be flushing it\'s end game and he runs away. I don\'t want to resort to bribery, but I\'m literally at a loss of what to do. Does anyone have any advice?

36

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37

Kommentarbereich

ladylilliani

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vor 3 Jahren

My autistic daughter enjoyed the convenience of diapers for quite some time. She was potty trained at my parents house, so we knew she was capable. Just unwilling. We tried the normal stuff: sticker charts, candy, bare bottom, whatever. She didn\'t want to.

A few months after she turned 4, I told her that if she could spend a month out of diapers, I\'d get her her own cat.

Overnight - Potty trained.

Once she got her cat, she tried to go back into diapers, but I made it clear that that was unacceptable.

Now her NT brother is trying to get a cat out of it. He\'s getting to the same age as she was but he\'s hanging in there because he wants something out of it. So, maybe don\'t do that.

34

xx_echo

•

vor 3 Jahren

Omg the ultimate bribe 😂😂 I\'m sorry but that\'s hilarious, but I

guess it worked!

11

vixie2703

•

vor 3 Jahren

Haha that is a great story.. also have a feeling maybe they'll end up with 2 cats!

5

ladylilliani

•

vor 3 Jahren

We already had two to begin with! lol. We have three and that's all our city allows.

1

ladylilliani

•

vor 3 Jahren

Too well. My son was ready to potty train himself at around 3. A couple days in, my daughter pointed out that she got a cat out of it... What was he going to get? And then he regressed and hasn't gone back to potty training since.

1

Silvery-Lithium

•

vor 3 Jahren

I see another cat in your future.

4

tquinn04

•

vor 3 Jahren

I tried this approach. Not with a cat, but a big \$60 toy from target. It did not work on him. A cat might but then I would just be trading clean up his shit for cleaning up cat shit

4

ladylilliani

•

vor 3 Jahren

We already had two cats, so... It wasn't that much additional poop. Kids still shit more; we just had norovirus run through the kids. At least the cats get it into their box most of the time. But yeah. My life is mostly just cleaning up messes. All of them. It was definitely an off-the-cuff, unplanned moment for me because I had tried everything (within reason) and didn't know what else I could offer. Thankfully, hubby was on board and everything worked out. Now, what to do about kiddo #2...

2

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 2 Jahren

Get him a cat too

1

ladylilliani

•

vor 2 Jahren
He wants a dog\...

1

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 2 Jahren
did u get him a dog

1

Avatar von u/anime_lover713
anime_lover713

•

vor 1 Jahr
Once she got her cat, she tried to go back into diapers, but I made it

clear that that was unacceptable.
How did you make it clear that that was unacceptable?

1

somaticconviction

•

vor 3 Jahren
I worked in early Ed for a long time, and saw a lot of children with autism going through potty training. I was lucky to work with some amazing special education teachers. Here's what I saw
Accept a realistic time frame. Sometimes it does take a long time. I've seen kids take a year or more but they do get there. You are not a failure, you are on your kids developmental timeline.
Consistency and routine win the race.
Try social stories about using the potty to reinforce the routine
Don't knock bribery. External motivation can be very compelling and useful, if it works why not give it a try. I've seen sticker charts or time with favorite activities work well. I know some parents gave treats like popsicles at home for reinforcement.
For flushing I've seen people use social stories about flushing, giving kids opportunities to play with a flushing toy potty, and also letting kids wear those sound muffling headphones when using the bathroom. For some super sensory sensitive kiddos the echoey bathroom Plus the loud flushing was just too much so the agreement was that the grown up flushed once the kid was out of the bathroom. Overtime they were able to be in the room and then eventually flush themselves
It's just time and a lot of work. You are not a failure, it's very hard work, give yourself and your kiddo grace.

25

Avatar von u/Mysterious_Market962
Mysterious_Market962

•

vor 1 Jahr
Thank you.

1

Avatar von u/houseofa1000slutz

houseofa1000slutz

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vor 3 Jahren
I'm sorry, I literally have no advice bc I'm in the EXACT same spot as you. I'm just commenting to let you know you're definitely not alone in

your frustration.

I have a nonverbal 4 yo who is also on the spectrum. I have tried everything. He has no interest in mimicking his older bothers and peers, and no interest in bribes of any form. Sensory triggers are no joke, and have posed as huge barriers. I'm so sorry you're also experiencing this too. It truly sucks.

11

Avatar von u/Certain-Cow-3891

Certain-Cow-3891

•

vor 6 Monaten

I noticed your comment was 2 years ago, any update on getting your child potty trained? Mine is also nonverbal, 4yo and on the spectrum and I've been trying my best to get him potty trained.

1

Avatar von u/Maleficent_Goose_534

Maleficent_Goose_534

•

vor 4 Monaten

Same

1

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 3 Jahren

I have twin daughters with autism, so I know exactly what you are dealing with.

See if your closest children's hospital has any classes on this. My

wife and I went to 2 days of classes that was a community outreach thing at Children's for teaching parents how to potty train autistic children.

They taught us a method that they said they had used on people with as low as a 40 IQ. Basically if you can breath on your own, you can probably be potty trained with this method.

More or less, you pump the kid with whatever fluids they like. Sprite, fruit punch, whatever. You just keep it coming. And you keep them on the toilet. When they eventually pee, you reward them (we used M&Ms), and you let them off the toilet for a short break. Like 2 minutes to start. Then back on the toilet. Once they figure out pee = reward, you start going longer before putting them back on the toilet. 5 minutes. Then 10, 15, 20, and so on. Eventually the kid will have to go, but want their reward before the next potty time, and they'll go on their own. Then you reward the hell out of them.

You're going to spend a couple days sitting in the bathroom. Bring a good book.

Once they figure out how to pee on their own, #2 pretty much takes care of itself pretty soon after.

18

ProudUnderstanding93

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vor 3 Jahren

This is the method I used as well. I do have to say tho, my daughter hated peeing in the potty and held it at the beginning so we had to have her sit on the potty for a long time until she couldn't hold it anymore or she'd wet herself instead. We also had to completely ditch diapers

2

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 2 Jahren

genius

1

Avatar von u/West_Inspector5415

West_Inspector5415

•

vor 1 Jahr

But how did you keep them on the toilet for that long? My daughter is fighting me and trying to get up constantly.

1

mamabear27204

•

vor 9 Monaten

I tried this method last year and he got constipated badly from refusing to go outside his diaper. He\'d hold it in for 5 hrs! when hed at least go pee, he\'d go out of his way to always piss on the floors rather than using the toilet. So This method could work, or it could end in disaster with a badly backed up tot, in my experience. Id be careful. I had to take him to his docs for advice on unblocking him.

1

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 3 Jahren

I had to take away daytime pull ups and kept my daughter bottomless while at home. It took close to a year for her to become reliably consistent to get to the bathroom on time at home. When we were out and about (rarely), she wore a pull up. Also on long car rides. She\'ll be 5 in a couple weeks and we just gave up pull ups in the car and at other houses. We started training her at 3.

She does still have accidents, but they are few and far between. She has had none in the car or in public since she stopped wearing them in public. I always make sure she goes as soon as we get to our destination, and check in with her periodically. Then she goes right before we leave.

She still wears them at night, but I know that could last for a while before she can hold it overnight. She\'s dry in the morning a few days a week, but not consistently enough to take them yet.

7

nixonforzombiepres

•

vor 3 Jahren

My oldest isn\'t autistic but has ADHD, what actually worked for us was using cloth diapers instead of pull ups. He hated the sensation of being

wet/dirty and commercial diapers/pull-ups wisk away moisture so they don\'t feel it. The cloth diapers let them feel everything so they want out of them really quick.

7

thatflashinglight

•

vor 3 Jahren

Commenting because although I (unfortunately) don't have advice, I'm here for solidarity. Our little one is supposed to start school this September and he's on the waitlist for a potential autism diagnosis but he is still in pull-ups as well and potty training isn't going at all. He's non verbal so he does not warn us when he has to go and if he goes in his pants he doesn't even tell us.

6

\[gelöscht\]

Avatar von u/amydubs2

amydubs2

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vor 3 Jahren

My son has ADHD and went to kindergarten in pull ups. Prior to that we tried every method you could think of. Daycare gave up on him. Even went to PT/OT and therapy. Roughly 6 months into kindergarten he was urinating in the potty consistently. His teachers were excellent about keeping him on a strict potty schedule. Once we saw he was coming home in the same pull up and stayed dry all day, we spent the next week in underwear and never went back. Remember even though your little one is chronologically age 4, he may may not be developmentally age 4. So remain patient and don't fight it. He will do it when he's developmentally ready.

6

d8911

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vor 3 Jahren

We turned it into a fun multi day event, ie the \'panty party\'. Covered everything in towels or blankets, let her pick out whatever snacks she wanted (especially salty or sour), whatever drinks she wanted, and whatever panties she liked best.

We also jammed in t shirts and underwear with her (no pants) for the 3 day weekend. Minimal shows, TONS of one on one attention, coloring books, crafts, building toys, etc\... Didn't ask if she had to go to the bathroom just loudly announced whenever we did. My daughter has a PDA profile and thrived on the control and equalizing.

3

pigsweat1000000miles

•

vor 3 Jahren

I think every kid I know (working as a nanny, friends' kids, my kids' daycare) was bribed for potty training. So you need to feel horrible if you go that route! Here's an episode of Peds Doc Talk that discusses rewards in a way that made me feel a little better.

My daughter struggles with the flushing sound. I don't know what will work for you, but I didn't push flushing until well after she was potty trained because I didn't want it to set her back. She is ready to go to kindergarten and she is pretty good about closing the lid and flushing at home (it's more sanitary, and it muffles the noise). Super loud public bathrooms still freak her out, so we may need to do some trouble shooting when she gets to school. But I'm pretty sure the teachers won't be fazed by a kid that doesn't want to flush at first. Especially if we're on top of it from the beginning.

Good luck to you! This sounds really tough and it seems like you're doing so much to work on this!

2

LonelyChampionship54

Poster*in

•

vor 3 Jahren

THANK YOU EVERYONE. So much good advice in here, I swear I\'m not in tears with all the support. We\'re going to dedicate this weekend to starting working with some of this, he seems like he\'s ready because he can tell me when he\'s wet (not pooped yet tho). We\'re not gonna be forceful, that just makes him panic and shut down. But one step at a time and hopefully things go well! Thank you, again, everyone! 💕

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LonelyChampionship54

Poster*in

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vor 3 Jahren

Update - So we\'ve been going commando all day today, and I\'ve implemented a score chart with the big prize of his choice when he fills it up (he asked for a power wheels jeep) No accidents\... Yet. Haven\'t flushed until he\'s in a room well away from the toilet. And no tantrums! So far so good!!

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Head_Spite62

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vor 3 Jahren

My son has DS. We tried multiple times to potty train him starting at around 2 1/2 with no success.

The first day of pre-k, the para took him into the bathroom to change him. He sat on the potty without pants on his own. Then got toilet paper and flushed the it on his own.

By the end of the school year he was full pee trained. We\'re confident that he would be completely trained we\'re it not for the constipation issues common with DS.

Watching and mimicking peers is a real thing.

8

Silvery-Lithium

•

vor 3 Jahren

The information paperwork we got from the Developmental pediatrician after our son was diagnosed last year said that is very common for autistic children to not be potty trained until they are 8 years old. My son will be 4 in October, and it has only been about a month of being 100% day time potty trained at home, 95% day time outside of the home. We first introduced a potty when he was 1 year old. We never did any of the \"leave them naked\" methods. We would have him sit on the potty and try before bedtime or just randomly. About a year ago we started to gave him a mini M&M every time he tried, 3 if he peed, and told him 5 if he would poop.

About 2 months ago we decided to take a dedicated weekend where we set timers that he could see for every 20 minutes, and we would give verbal warnings starting at 5, 3, 2, 1 minute until try to potty time. First

day was rough, day 2 was easier, and by day 3 he was starting to tell us \"I need to potty\" so we made the planned time stretches longer. Within

2 weeks we didn't have to give any reminders, he tells us, and has only had a single accident since.

We gave him a week lead up warnings of "you're a big boy now and big boys try to use the potty! No more diapers after Saturday, time for big boy underwear!" And we hyped it up so much when he would go- high fives and telling him we were proud of him, even if he only just sat there for a minute. We encouraged him to do whatever it was he wanted himself give him a few squares of TP to wipe himself, let him empty the training potty into the toilet, let him flush, etc.

Our son has a lot of flags for ADHD to go with the autism and sensory integration disorder and speech delay. I think he just couldn't feel when he needed to go, and then he didn't have the mental maturity to realize it was okay to pause what he was doing, go, and then come back to it.

We still put him in pull ups when going out, but that has been for our peace of mind in regards to carseat accidents. He has been dry and has only had minimal issues when needing to go while out. He automatic flush toilets and blow dryers are on my "I wish they would go away" list. I would recommend finding an OT as soon as possible, and obviously a method similar to what I said we did. I know that the method of using a "currency" is frowned on, but I think it can be used safely for certain things.

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squigglestorystudios

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vor 3 Jahren

My daughter has ASD lvl 2, and it took us over a year.

Wait until they're dry over night, then you know for sure they can hold and go when they want to.

Take away nappies/diapers completely and go bottomless for a week, my daughter wasn't allowed the option or she would just hold/refuse until she was given one.

Once you know they can hold it, set a timer for every 2-3 hours. Take them to the toilet on those times, if you push too hard, they will almost certainly push back.

Also if you want to be sneaky about it, give them their favourite drink 15 mins before the timer, it takes 15 minutes for drink to get to the bladder!

Find out which option they prefer, I had a mini potty, an insert and a

stepping stool. She hated the insert, would only use the mini potty when none was watching and eventually just wanted to use the big toilet like mum and dad.

If bribery works, use it. We had a giant jar of single serve mentos sweets that she would get one every time she went to the potty or informed us she needed to go. Getting her to do ANYTHING she didn't want to do was like pulling teeth, so any sort of positive reinforcement helped the process.

Buy a whole bunch of sacrificial undies and pants, and be careful about washing them off in the shower. We went through a whole 2 week period where she would poop her pants on purpose because then she got to play in the shower to clean herself off.

Make sure EVERY VISIT IS THE SAME: "Get your stool, lift the lid, step on the stool, turn around pull down your pants, sit down, pee/poop, are you finished? Wipe, put in toilet, close lid, flush, pull up pants, wash

your hands\" Repeat it over and over and over every visit. It\'s exhausting but routines help with expectations .
The hardest part about getting an ASD kid potty trained is getting them to CARE ABOUT GOING TO THE TOILET. If you can find out what makes your child care then you\'ve won half the battle. God speed, and regression is a real thing just keep everything consistent\...

1

Avatar von u/Even-Sweet-3222

Even-Sweet-3222

•

vor 1 Jahr

Same here I have tried everything she will b 4 in august if I tell her to get on potty sometimes she will sometimes it\'s a meltdown but she can get on big potty by herself wipe and flush and pull her pull up back up but she will go in her pull up 1 and 2 and never tell you or go to bathroom before she does it you ask if she is wet or poppy she will tell you no but she is she is a level 3 autistic

1

belle88

•

vor 5 Monaten

Now it\'s been about 7 months since your comment - how is it going? My 3.5 yr old son sounds very similar, except he can\'t wipe himself or pull his underwear up all the way yet.

1

mamabear27204

•

vor 9 Monaten

Im trying to potty train mine and hes 4\...but he holds his potty IN til I put the diaper back on. I\'ve tried everything but hes just unwilling. And he cant take directives enough for bribes or anything\...it just doesnt click. If I offer a sucker only if he goes, he just tries any way he can to get the sucker out of my hand. If I dont show him it, and just promise a sucker\...it doesnt click. He thinks its enough to just sit and hold his potty awhile, THEN he believes hes earned the sucker. Once I realized our communication was getting all sorts of crossed\...I realized he just doesnt understand enough for it. Ill try again at 5, or whenever he can comprehend what to do with the potty. I\'m a single mom, so I dont have a male around to help show him physically. And even then, theres no telling if he\'ll connect the dots. I\'ve had him with me while im on the toilet ever since he was born, so if showing him what I do was enough, he would have gotten it after his first birthday. Im at a loss.

post 7: Potty Training Nightmare

I\'m so sick of cleaning up shit. We\'ve been working on potty training for 8 months now with absolutely zero progress-except that he pulls down his pants about half the time AFTER shitting, so it gets everywhere. Also, like a lot of autistic children it seems, his poops are absolutely massive and just disgusting. Like man sized poop all smashed into his pants. We easily use a whole package of wipes per poop. X3 per day and holy hell it adds up!

Today, I watched him carefully and asked him 3 times if he needed to use the bathroom (nonverbal but sometimes he runs in the bathroom to pee if you ask him). He screamed and threw a fit every time I asked. Within 5

minutes of me asking, he squats down and craps himself right in front of me. I absolutely lost it. I yelled at him and smacked his butt. I'm an emotional wreck right now. In three months, I'm scheduled to have surgery to remove 80% of my abdominal wall. It will require serious physical therapy and a lift restriction for 3 months. He cannot go to daycare unless he's potty trained and we can't afford in home care for him. I need him to behave like a neurotypical 4 year old like yesterday but if we could just get him going to the toilet, I can have my surgery, because we can enroll him in daycare.

I'm literally going to die without this surgery. But we have tried EVERYTHING to get him potty trained to no avail. What the hell do I do? Just die? Have surgery and wait for my mesh to break? Honestly I'm so tempted to just say fuck it and stop treatment. I'll be dead within the year and then someone else can clean up his shitty pants. Unfortunately, the someone else is my poor husband, and I don't want to leave him alone to a lifetime of caregiving with no partner. Not that I'll be much help physically but at least he'll have moral support/a companion. This is

mostly a rant because we are just so stuck and I am so tired.

32

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74

Kommentarbereich

Mombietweets

•

vor 4 Jahren

It took my son til almost 6 to potty train and it finally happened because of ABA therapy. I know there is some controversy around ABA, but I would recommend looking into it. Your insurance should cover it and he could even do a full day schedule with a therapy provider.

14

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

•

vor 4 Jahren

I wish. We've been trying to get him into ABA since last summer. Everywhere is completely full. It's wild.

4

dontsaveher84

•

vor 4 Jahren

Waitlist is the only way to get in. Get on every single waitlist possible and call/email every 4-6 weeks. Be extra kind and sweet with the schedulers, they control everything.

2

GirlLunarExplorer

•

vor 4 Jahren

No advice. Just sympathy. Our 4.5 yo is verbal but REFUSES to poop on the potty. Most days he holds it till bedtime and then will poop legit 2 min after we leave the room but we've had several accidents at playgrounds too and it's so fucking v gross. All of his therapists are at a loss at what to do. And he knows where he needs to go but just

refuse to do it. At this point I\'m scared his baby sister will potty train before he does and she\'s only 3 months old !

12

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

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vor 4 Jahren

Ugh I feel you. There's something so repulsive about it to me. Like I know he's too old for this.

3

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 4 Jahren

I feel this so much. My son is 3.5 and will walk out of the room and hide somewhere in his room for a couple minutes and poop on himself. He knows to poop in the potty and I ask him a million times per day if he needs to go and he tells me no. Then 5 minutes later, he poops on himself. So frustrating

1

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 4 Jahren

Is there any chance of getting him in ABA therapy to specially work on potty training? Aware it is controversial with some folks, but my child has been in a center based program and had a lot of improvement with potty training there, now also can attend preschool, community outings and stay continent. Sometimes he likes to poop in his pull up at bedtime, but he can hold it and will sometimes go on the toilet. He's pretty much there with urine training. We also use fiber gummies to keep him regular, watched lots of books/videos about pooping on the potty which has helped. So sorry it is so frustrating.

5

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

•

vor 4 Jahren

Absolutely none. Waiting lists in my area are 18 months plus for services. One place I spoke to said they are just now getting around to calling people from 2018! We keep trying though.

1

EmotionalStudio7

•

vor 4 Jahren

BCBA here - not sure where you live, but since it sounds like ABA is not available at this time (which I understand, the staffing constraints are insane right now), get on a waitlist, and in the meantime look into your local regional center (center for state funded services for children and adults with disabilities) - some of them offer workshops that cover an ABA approach to toileting.

5

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

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vor 4 Jahren

Thank you. I'm going to look into this!

2

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 4 Jahren

Is there a pre-school near you that caters to autistic children? 4 is

pretty young on average for autistic children to be potty trained - our son is 6 and is still in diapers. However, we sent him to a preschool from 3-5 that was specifically for autistic kids and they didn't require them to be potty trained.

5

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

•

vor 4 Jahren

We have a preschool that's half day and they did help-sort of. He generally just holds it until he gets home now. So I know he feels it at least!

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mrsluzzi13

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vor 4 Jahren

I\m sorry you are having such a hard time. For my daughter we kept her naked and put her on the potty as soon as we recognized she needed to go. Eventually it became routine for her and she is fully potty trained and hasn\'t had an accident in about a year . My daughter is heavily into routine.

Someone else suggested a picture chart with all the steps. That helps us remember to wipe, wash hands, flush etc.

I know it seems impossible. Don\'t give up.

4

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 4 Jahren

My oldest was 6 before she was potty trained. My younger one is still 6 and not potty trained. Both are being taught the same way but the younger one is more stubborn. I don\'t know if you\'ve considered it but even if he was potty trained he may not last in daycare.

4

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

•

vor 4 Jahren

Idk what you mean by "he may not last". I'm definitely concerned about regressions. But for right now, I just have to tackle the problem in front of me. Roll with the punches as they come sort of a thing

1

Avatar von u/smgator

smgator

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vor 4 Jahren

I am a 1:1 aid for a middle school boy age 14. He lacks the understanding and the 8th sense to FEEL he needs to go to the bathroom, or if he is hungry or thirsty. So I put him in underwear and set a timer for every 2 hours. He has had 2 accidents this whole school year.

<https://www.sp4kids.com/blog/the-senses-explained-interoception> Read to your child and have them listen to A LOT of social stories about toileting. Also print out picture supports of the individual steps to going to the bathroom and tape them by the toilet and refer to them EVERY TIME.

<https://www.teacherspayteachers.com/Product/Bathroom-Social-Stories-Posters-for-Toileting-Hygiene-Life-Skills-Autism-2929806?st=206ff34d1161d8f3a6db043a115eef7a>

Good luck, it is super hard. Maybe the daycare will understand if they know your child is on the autism spectrum. They are harder to potty train.

4

llamadrama2021

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vor 4 Jahren

Oh honey I\'m right there with you. I gave up on potty training. He KNOWS he has to go, but refuses to go in the potty. And when he goes in his diaper, he grabs and smears everywhere. Did it on the bus on the way to school, resulting in a call from the teacher AND the principal. I\'m lucky they didn\'t kick him off the bus permanently. From what I\'ve read on here, potty training is nearly impossible for some kids. I think sometimes autistic kids just aren\'t ready mentally when their body is

ready. So you may want to go back to diapers just at least until after your surgery.

3

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

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vor 4 Jahren

I\'m beginning to understand that he may never be potty trained. It\'s still hard to accept. I\'m really concerned because of the nature of the surgery, I won\'t be able to change diapers for months-I will hardly be able to get myself to and from the bathroom. I\'m not sure what I\'m supposed to do. I can\'t just leave him to sit in his own filth and now that he takes his clothes off, I can\'t be running around after him with bleach either. I\'m really wedged firmly between a rock and a hard place



1

assortedchocolates3

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vor 4 Jahren

You mentioned you had a partner, why can\'t they do the potty stuff while you recover? I am sorry you are going through this and hope he will get it one day.

2

1 weitere Antwort

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 4 Jahren

Avatar von u/court_milpool

court_milpool

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vor 4 Jahren

Are there any autism preschool or special needs preschool he could

attend instead? Or moving to an area that has these? I'm sorry, I feel your frustration and I get it. Things are so frustrating with an autistic child but even worse when society around them is structured in ways that exclude them. It may be worth calling the special education schools for advice

3

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

•

vor 4 Jahren

He does attend a "special needs" pre-k program. It will be letting out for summer in 2 weeks however. He does hold it while there-so I know he's conscious of it at least.

2

daydreamingofsleep

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vor 4 Jahren

Try sharing your situation with the teacher, you need surgery and have to find full-day care. They may have a suggestion about somewhere they've heard another student going.

If they're hesitant to volunteer info for privacy reasons, ask if they would pass your number along to any other parent they believe may have helpful info.

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dancn1

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vor 4 Jahren

Idk what you're trying or if this is obvious, but we had success starting with a small mini potty / toilet right in the living room where he spent most of his time. He wouldn't go to the bathroom and use the proper toilet, but accepted the training potty. Added bonus that it was close enough that we could sometimes lift him and get him on it once he started to go to reinforce the behavior.

Then over time we were able to migrate the potty to the bathroom, and then to the real toilet. Could be worth a try if you haven't already!

Good luck.

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PeppermintBob

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vor 4 Jahren

Hello! I am an early intervention specialist and hopefully I can give some advice since you've been waiting ages for services.

Autism can cause problems with internal signals, basically the alarm for things like hunger or potty might not be as loud as it is for neurotypical kids. Your kid might not feel like they need to go potty

until it's too late.

Poop anxiety is real. Some kids are afraid or uncomfortable pooping on the toilet! It's super different from the comfort of a diaper or pants. Do whatever you need to do. There are no wrong answers. I have set kids on the potty watching YouTube on an iPad for 15-20 mins once every hour praying to get the timing right, that they will happen to go while sitting there, then immediately praise them and reward them with something they love, a favorite snack is an easy option.

Positivity is everything. Avoid having them hate "sit & try" potty time at all costs. All kids need to sit & try in order to potty train. Make it fun, sing songs, keep books next to the potty that they can flip through or a sound board toy, anything to keep them happy and sitting whenever it's time to "try".

Good luck, I'm really sorry to hear what you're going through and I hope you recover well from your surgery.

3

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

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vor 4 Jahren

I appreciate this. Unfortunately, my son is a bit atypical even for an autistic child so an iPad for example doesn't hold his attention. He's very difficult to connect with. A lot of the regular toilet training tips have not been successful so far. I would say maybe it's physiological, but he has shown us he can hold it (at school) and when we first started potty training, he went in the toilet for two weeks with no accidents (I was naive enough to consider him potty trained! 🙄)

I know he's physically capable. But that just adds to the frustration I think

1

PeppermintBob

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vor 4 Jahren

Hmmm can you think of anything that changed after the 2 weeks?

Is keeping a little potty (one of those plastic training ones) nearby an option to quickly put him on when you see him start to squat?

The lack of professional availability in your area sounds awful, I wish you could receive the help you really need :(

3

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

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vor 4 Jahren

The only thing I can think of is that we stopped paying him so much attention. That sounds awful, but we watched him like a hawk while potty training, following him everywhere always staring at his crotch lol. When he started to get it we're backed off a little bit, which he seemed to like. He really doesn't seek attention and is very much a play in the corner by himself kind of kid.

He is very anti little potty but he doesn't seem to mind sitting on the toilet so that would be a fight to go backward I think

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dontsaveher84

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vor 4 Jahren

Poop training is the worst! I have 3 with ASD and have been changing diapers non-stop for 12 years. My youngest refuses to poop train. I'm desperate to train him and figuring out if I'll try suppositories this summer.

Are you in the US? Find a LOCAL autism support group on Facebook to see

what resources are available in your area.

Contact your state's department of developmental disabilities to see if your son qualifies for ABA and/or respite care hours. Our ABA helped with potty training. We were able to train my daughter within a few months but after 4 years of potty training, my 8yo son is still pooping in a diaper every night and in his underwear 3-4 times a week.

Here are some of the things I do to keep my sanity with the messes. I keep disposable gloves (they're lifesavers), plastic bags, and baby wipes in each bathroom for cleanup. I get underwear on clearance and will toss the badly soiled ones. I put my son in the shower while I wash the soiled underwear in the toilet. I'll hold onto them TIGHT, lower them into the toilet bowl, and flush a few times to get most of the poop off. I use a handheld shower head to hose off the underwear in the shower and then hose as much poop off of my son as possible. Still wearing gloves, I use baby wipes as disposable wash cloths. I use some scented body wash and a couple of baby wipes to clean him up.

Your post inspired me to order kids' glycerin suppositories. They're supposed to make them poop in minutes. My plan is to use them around his usual poop time and sit him on the toilet with a tablet. I'm hoping after a few times of pooping in the potty, he'll get over what mental/physical block is keeping him from going in it regularly. Good luck with your kiddo and your surgery. I hope you find the resources you need to get through this.

5

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

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vor 4 Jahren

Thank you for the information, I've actually taken some ideas from your post!

4

dontsaveher84

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vor 4 Jahren

As far as recovery from your surgery, are you getting any kind of case hours for him? You can talk to your care worker about additional hours. When I had a hysterectomy, my mom took unpaid FMLA to help with the kids because I couldn't lift for 6 weeks. I requested extra respite hours and

was able to pay her that way (she couldn't have been off that long without pay, so the respite hours were a huge blessing).

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Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

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vor 4 Jahren

Care worker? I'm not sure who you're talking about here

1

Setze diesen Thread fort

Avatar von u/court_milpool

court_milpool

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vor 4 Jahren

There are some great ideas here! Thanks

2

Avatar von u/TooMuchMud

TooMuchMud

•

vor 4 Jahren

We solved this problem by using a reward board from ABA. We still have incidents, but not every day.

This sort of thing is hard to do without professional help, though.

Using ABA methods requires a lot of effort and is like having a job on top of all the other jobs we have.

2

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

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vor 4 Jahren

Definitely. It feels like two full time jobs at the moment.

2

swiss_baby_questions

•

vor 4 Jahren

Every kid with autism is so different, but I will share what helped us:

The Poop Song

This was integral for us, as my son loves music.

We also used this story: Pirate Pete

Maybe it won't help you, maybe it will help someone else who searches for potty training tips. Also, it took my son 6 months to potty train and it was humbling.

2

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

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vor 4 Jahren

Humbling is a great word for it ❤️

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HimylittleChickadee

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vor 4 Jahren

I\m so, so sorry for what you\'re experiencing. I hope things get better and that you get your surgery and are able to heal.

In the immediate, is there something your child really likes, like a candy or toy? As part of our potty training approach, we had a picture of a potty with a baggie stapled to it. In the baggie we put M&Ms (my

kiddo\'s favourite treat). We started with him just in his underwear and every 15 mins (timer set on phone) we pulled his underwear down and put him the potty and asked if he needed to pee / poo. After he was done peeing or pooing, or just sitting on the potty if he didnt need to go, we\'d show him the picture and give him an M&M, so he knew he\'d get a candy for just sitting on the potty.

If he looked like he was going to pee / poo or started to do that, we\'d carry him to the potty and let him finish on the potty. Then would show pic and give another candy.

After a while, he got used to sitting on the potty and we extended the time between to 30 mins, then 45 mins, and hour, etc. After a while, he\'d just get a candy when he pee\'ed or poo\'ed on the potty, not just for sitting on it.

Eventually he understood how to use the potty and we phased out the M&Ms in the potty training context.

This was the approach recommended by our therapist, who was really great and specialized in toileting. Not sure if this is an option for you, but just thought I\'d share. Best of luck to you ♥

2

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 4 Jahren

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 4 Jahren

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 4 Jahren

You need to set a schedule for him to use the bathroom, not ask. He can\'t tell you that he needs to go properly yet.

My son was 7 when he poo trained, it took Rewards not corporal punishment (ABUSE!) Schedule routine and knowing what comes next are what most children NT or ND thrive on.

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Avatar von u/Pink_Link07

Pink_Link07

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vor 4 Jahren

I\'m sorry I have no advice but I feel your frustration. My son isn\'t potty trained either & it\'s a struggle for us all. Would respite care or a night nurse instead of daycare be an option for him? I hope you can figure something out, hang in there ♥

1

Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

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vor 4 Jahren

Our services are really backed up where I live. I looked into respite care, but he doesn\'t qualify because he\'s not considered severe enough. We would have to pay a lot for it and it\'s 1.5 hours away 😞

1

CurvyNerdMom86

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vor 4 Jahren

I have no advice on the potty training as mine still doesn't get it either. However, have you looked into a PPEC daycare? Several of them will take autistic kids who require more support than a regular daycare can handle.

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Avatar von u/MuchSuspect2270

MuchSuspect2270

Poster*in

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vor 4 Jahren

No I haven't. Is it a chain? That would be helpful

1

CurvyNerdMom86

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vor 4 Jahren

Its medically needy daycare. There are different ones. I know I only have 1 within 30 minutes of my house so you may not have one around you.

1

Avatar von u/KARMAH1989

KARMAH1989

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vor 8 Monaten

Shit is ridiculous man. I hate this autism shit!!!! Mine is about to be 6 and only shits or pisses when he has on a pullup. I take the pullups off and put on waterproof underwear he pisses in those, im like can't you feel the uncomfortableness???? Wtf!!? But I know its this stupid condition! Im having another baby im pissed bc I know Im gonna be changing 2 sets of pampers if this kid doesn't get his ass on the toilet!!! Im frustrated because Im doing it all on my own and the idiot jerk father is gonna send a bish to my door talking about \"he heard I got fat\" heard \"I look good tho\" and can he come over ummmmm noooooo you cannot!!!! I been taking care of my son for years by myself we are just fine minus your in and out bullshit and wtf do you care how I look after 3 years of not being around?? Who tf is watching me in my neighborhood?? Even though im not fat mofos lyin on me but its cool😭😭 he's trying to make me uncomfortable so I can leave my apartment im not going anywhere he's jealous because he's homeless af! This guys almost 50 years old you should be worried about your son who's gonna have alot of problems due to his sickness!! Im tired of it all but I can't give up on my son everyday every morning every 30 minutes this kid will be on that toilet! Keep pushing Its a pain in the assssss but what can we do! Im not trying to change no grown ass mans diaper we gotta get this done nowww 100100100

1

mache noch nichts, lese nur die infos. es kommt noch mehr infos. MACHE NICHTS

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vor 2 Monaten

GOD BLESS YOU. Thank you thank you thank you

Post 8: Partner Angry that Child isn't potty trained yet

My daughter (4yrs in August) is yet to be potty trained. She is not

showing any signs of readiness (wakes up wet, doesn't notice or announce her soiled diaper, etc.), and is TERRIFIED of the potty. We try for a few days just to sit fully clothed and it leads to a panic attack. So we give it a break for a week and try again. This has been going on for a few months.

My partner is FURIOUS at me that she isn't potty trained, and it turned into a massive argument. He insists that it's my "unwillingness to try" and "lack of motivation", but completely disregards her complete fear and clear signs that she isn't ready. In his words, "if kids 100 years ago were potty trained by 18 months, you have no excuse with her".

How do I approach this? Does anyone have documents/sources that I could send him to help him understand the difference in potty training autistic kiddos vs. Neurotypical?

Signed - a very frustrated mother who wants the best for her child
59

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81

Kommentarbereich
unicorntrees

•

vor 9 Monaten

What has he tried to potty train her? Why is it your responsibility to have her trained?

Our kids are very close in age and we are also nowhere close to being potty trained.

72

Senior_Let5585
Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

Our current setup is that he works full time and I'm a SAHM to her and her brother (3, also ASD).

I just feel like he might be struggling with her delay as more of a frustration that she isn't like neurological kiddos?

My brain is fog and my wording here is terrible but I hope you know what I'm trying to convey

26

Froomian

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vor 9 Monaten

We kind of had the opposite situation here in that I couldn't train my son until my husband was away for a couple of weeks. He got very upset by poos on the floor and wee stains on the carpet, so it was just easiest for me to do it when I didn't have a big grey cloud over my shoulder spinning out about every little poo on the floor. EDIT: but sounds like your husband is a grey cloud anyway. And you don't need grey clouds around when toilet training. It needs to be chill or your child will pick up on the vibe.

9

EnthusiasticFailing

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vor 9 Monaten

Totally, we are working on potty training right now and the pee

everywhere is insane! But I try to laugh it off because I dont need him thinking he is being bad when he is just learning a new skill. Its not his fault that peeing on the carpet is kinda cool.

2

Avatar von u/Cat_o_meter

Cat_o_meter

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vor 9 Monaten

Does he understand anything about ASD?

2

Parttimelooker

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vor 9 Monaten

The autism specialist in my area told me that 4 was basically the earliest you would typically start trying for a child with autism to

potty train.

Your husband sounds like he\'s being kinda a dick

79

Mindless-Location-41

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vor 9 Monaten

More than kinda. He is being a completely unreasonable wanker asshole.

22

Parttimelooker

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vor 9 Monaten

Yeah I agree. I was trying to put it gently.

4

local_scientician

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vor 9 Monaten

Yeah they're full of it too. My kid is level 2, also has adhd, was fully toilet trained in the daytime by 3.5. I'm not saying all autistic kids should be using the toilet by then. You know your own kid. But he was ready and willing and able. Don't delay toilet training because of some "specialist" making grand sweeping statements.

9

Mindless-Location-41

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vor 9 Monaten

I\'m sure the issue is not the parent trying to start the potty training but rather the ASD child unable to complete the task for one of various reasons such as (1) slow development of digestive tract that causes build-up and constipation, (2) sensory issues, (3) many other possible reasons.

9

2 weitere Antworten

Parttimelooker

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vor 9 Monaten

I\'m not sure what your point is. You are worried that a woman (who by the way I do have massive respect for) said it\'s typical for most to be ready around age 4? (In response to my feeling discouraged with lack of

success)

My comment was not made to discourage op from trying to potty train because \"some expert\" said so.

Her husband besides other issues is misinformed about what is typical. Good for your kid. Most people want their kids potty trained as soon as possible. The problem you are addressing here is not a real one and is just being negative about someone you've never met for no reason.

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lily_reads

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vor 9 Monaten

You agree with your partner that you aren't doing it right, and tell them they should take over because they are obviously far more knowledgeable. 😊

The key is acting surprised when they fail to do the task they feel is \"so easy they don't understand how you haven't figured it out yet.\" I needed to rehearse this in advance in the mirror in order to make it seem truly genuine.

78

I_eat_all_the_cheese

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vor 9 Monaten

The problem here is that it will likely end in the partner taking it out on the child.

26

lily_reads

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vor 9 Monaten

Oh, partner will never make it that far. The beauty of this method is that the backpedalling begins swiftly and immediately, without any nagging from OP.

9

Defiant_Ad_8489

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vor 9 Monaten

Your partner sounds incredibly unreasonable. What are THEY doing to help except put all the responsibility on you? Sorry. That's frustrating to me. And if they're working then that isn't an excuse.

Anyway, if you search \"ABA potty training\" there are a ton of methods that also explain why it would be harder for our neurodivergent kids tend to take longer than other kids. A big one is interoception, which is being able to understand how one's inner body feels. Also there's many skills involved in the toileting process: pulling up/down clothes, sitting and peeing, washing hands, etc. And every kid is so different. My son didn't really start to not like being wet till about 3.5. We finally took the time and potty trained him at just after 4, but it will still be an ongoing process until he masters it since he doesn't even aim well when sitting.

Could we have done it earlier? Maybe. We tried at 3.5 and he was starting to get it but then got sick with COVID so we took a break. I didn't want him associating the toilet with being sick. But at 4 we just felt he was ready to do it.

I've found this resource to be a good one for potty training. She was able to potty trained her non speaking son at 2.

<https://allplayisok.com/blog/f/our-potty-training-process-the-beginning>
I know there's another one from an ABA provider that gets posted here a lot but I can't find the link at the moment. Maybe someone can help me out.

13

Avatar von u/Green_Ivy_Decor7

Green_Ivy_Decor7

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vor 9 Monaten

How does he act towards your daughter? Does he have a good relationship with her? It's one thing if he doesn't understand autism, but it's

different if he doesn't accept your daughter.

10

Senior_Let5585

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

They have an incredible relationship - this is the first time he's showing any push-back toward her needs at all.

She is glued to his hip the moment he gets home from work - reading, laughing, playing, etc.

I really don't know where this frustration is coming from on his end. I think it's a genuine lack of understanding potty training in regard to ASD/GDD like our daughter has.

10

Avatar von u/Green_Ivy_Decor7

Green_Ivy_Decor7

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vor 9 Monaten

Ok, I am glad that he has a good relationship with her otherwise. An honest conversation may still help and hopefully he is willing to learn more about ASD.

10

kristy795

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vor 9 Monaten

I'm frustrated for you from reading this. I wonder if someone made a comment about the potty training to your partner and that is what brought this on. I don't have any sources but all these kids go at their own pace. My daughter is 6 and we are just now fully potty trained. We waited until she was ready and tried not to push her too hard. It's really unreasonable for your partner to get angry with you over this, I hope you don't put up with too much nonsense from them. I hope things get better soon!

8

mmckenzie13

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vor 9 Monaten

Maybe try a kid plastic potty in a different room?

8

Senior_Let5585

Poster*in

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vor 9 Monaten

I was thinking of doing that - just having the potty out in the livingroom? I think the bathroom might be a trigger for this too

7

mmckenziel3

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vor 9 Monaten

Yeah environment can be intimidating so just have to experiment and see what else might work. Since each kid is different, I just get ideas from what others are trying and we have occupational therapy as well so they can throw out some things to try. My son is 5 and ASD L1 and he's potty trained mostly but still doing pull ups at night so it's been a journey that just takes time.

5

Necessary_Ad_9012

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vor 9 Monaten

This helped my kiddo. Turns out once she was able to communicate better she found the bathroom sounds cavernous and frightening. Further, the big toilet seemed like hanging over a deep pool. It all felt cold, loud, and dangerous. She was potty trained fully by age 5 but really until 4 we didn't try much. We made it a relaxed endeavor without pressure. One other big break though happened when we spent 3 days just naked in the living room and using the little Porta potty. Not having to wear clothes to try to take off, and just instantly sitting helped. Yes, we did have accidents but were fully prepped for cleaning (and if you're a parent, by the time kiddo is age 5 you've dealt with enough bodily

fluids it's a quick clean up and move on). The nakedness really seemed to helped her clue in because she felt the wetness when she had an accident. There was no diaper. She felt it on her leg. And that seemed to help her understand the sequence of what she felt. She finally picked up on this internal urge then led to wetness so if she didn't want that random leg wetness she needed to sit on the potty as soon as she felt that urge.

3

Standard-Trade-2622

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vor 9 Monaten

I have boys but we trained them both (one NT and one Level 1 ASD) at 2.5 with the little potty using the naked method. I was pretty clueless that my son was autistic at that point so nothing told me not to do it when other kids were. It was 2021 and we got stuck in Covid quarantine and then got Covid so we were home for like 2 weeks and by the time he went back to daycare he was going in the potty 90% of the time. We didn't get to overnight trained until he was almost 5 though.

We pretty much followed the "3 day methods" outlined by Big Little Feelings/the Oh Crap method but it took more like 14 days than the 3 they advertise. The problem is that you have to commit to just being like "ALL we are doing is staying home and potty training until this is done" and that's pretty damn hard. Not to mention exhausting.

FWIW, he HATED being totally naked so he ended up running around Winnie the Pooh style all the time. But if it's that huge of an issue for your husband then HE needs to take the initiative and do the research and 100% commit to clearing your schedules so one of you can be basically

staring at her every second of every day and following her around with a potty ready to throw her on it. And it has to be both of you because no one can do that on their own.

2

Necessary_Trash4705

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vor 9 Monaten

We tried with the potty in the living room but that wasn't really working, we did 3 days no clothing and that got the peeing down with a sticker chart (got the free pampers one and it came with 10 diapers). Poop has been a much longer struggle. The final push for us to put the potty in the living room was because he was kicking and flailing during diaper changes and we were getting hurt (not bad, but still annoying). We're slowly seeing him start to understand pooping on the potty. He's off diapers entirely and has had no overnight accidents yet!

2

bicyclecat

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vor 9 Monaten

This is how I got it done with my kid. I put it in the living room in front of the TV. Switching to the flush toilet was a second big challenge after that (the water and depth scared her, so I used a hospital urine collector insert and eventually cut the bottom out), and using public/new toilets a third big challenge after that. She was fully potty trained on the toddler potty at 3.5 but didn't use a public toilet until 7.5. It can be a long process with hurdles NT kids don't typically have. If your husband really doesn't get that he should take a long weekend to try himself and see how far he gets.

1

Avatar von u/ExigentCalm

ExigentCalm

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vor 9 Monaten

My son is 10. Still won't use the potty. Your husband needs to grow up and realize that your daughter isn't going to just snap out of it. This is the long haul. And sometimes it sucks.

5

Maru_the_Red

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vor 9 Monaten

My boys didn't get there until age 5.

You are not doing anything wrong. It's inconvenient, but that's life with an autistic child. Nothing worthwhile comes easy or for free.

Videos can help, YouTube has tons. There's a potty training DVD of Elmo from Sesame Street that was a massive help to our family.

4

Fritemare

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vor 9 Monaten

Hey, guess what? I have four kids. The first two, cake walks to potty trains. My youngest two? ASD, one of them has developmental delays as well. My second youngest was nearly 5, and my youngest was 6 before they were potty trained. My husband helped btw, he works at least 60 hours a

week. He works half a day Saturdays, and his only day off is Sunday. Guess what he spent his day\'s off doing? Helping me out! Your husband thinks you aren\'t trying? Let him give it a go!

4

Mamasan-

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vor 9 Monaten

My son wasn't potty trained till 6 and it was literally because he woke up with diarrhea and didn't want to wait for a diaper. I still thank the universe for that siding in our favor. Kids in general take longer to potty train then add on autism and it's a whole other thing.

3

Avatar von u/armandoalfredogarcia
armandoalfredogarcia

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vor 9 Monaten

My son is 7 years old and we are just getting consistent. Your husband is being toxic and needs patience. Maybe he needs to hear other parents and their day to day with children with ASD.

3

DigitalDawn

•

vor 9 Monaten

It sounds like your husband is delayed in his own growth if he isn't able to be mature and not lash out like that. My son was closer to four when he was potty trained. It wasn't a matter of "not trying hard enough," as I'm the kind of parent who always went above and beyond. What helped my son was just reasoning with him and getting him to accept the logic. I told him that older kids wore underpants and babies wore diapers. He didn't believe me, so I googled it, lol, and showed him photos. He never wore diapers again after that. What is causing the panic attacks? If she feels too pressured, or if it causes anxiety, that might be the issue. What is your approach? Do you

make it fun? Is scolding or disappointment ever involved? Things like that could sometimes cause my son to become avoidant.

3

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 9 Monaten

He works full-time, so what. Parenting is a 24 hour job. Dude needs to shore it and realize you're working as well. Raising 2 young children is no joke. It's all about effort. His failure to contribute to potty training your child is unacceptable.

3

Avatar von u/iSc00t
iSc00t

•

vor 9 Monaten

100 years ago they would have just beat the child until they were potty trained; for sure with no negative repercussions... Our 6 year old still isn't potty trained, but he is making some big strides recently (something finally clicked).

Wish I could say there was an easy way to explain things to your husband, but it's hard to change people's perception of this kind of

stuff. My wife and I are on really solid terms when it comes to our son, but even she gave me disapproval guilt for his delayed potty training.

:/

3

GlitterBirb

•

vor 9 Monaten

Personally, none of the children in my autism clinic age 7 and younger are fully independent on the potty. My son isn't either...5.5 still needs help with knowing when he has to poop.

https://sparkforautism.org/discover_article/toilet-training-autism/

He's going to have to accept raising a kid with autism is going to be different in many unexpected ways.

4

max0m0

•

vor 9 Monaten

My 7 year old son, although verbal and very capable in many ways, still struggles with potty training. He has trouble feeling when he needs to go and is easily distracted by engrossing activities. He still occasionally has accidents during the day and must wear pull ups overnight.

2

Weltanschauung_Zyxt

•

vor 9 Monaten

FWIW, neither of my kids were potty trained before four. My youngest was changing her own pull-ups before she transitioned to the toilet.

2

CatalinaLunessa21

•

vor 9 Monaten

SAME Edit to add: my 8 year old had an accident last night 😊

3

Gullible_Produce_934

•

vor 9 Monaten

My daughter (4, will be 5 soon) is just now at the point we're putting undies on her in school with no pull-up over it and she still poops in her pull-up, still sleeps in a pull-up, and is still on a pull-up when we go out. She is very used to going on the potty and has been doing so for over a year.. it's just taking a while. She's never been bothered by a wet or poopy diaper even since she was born. Some kids do things on their own time.

My son is 3, almost 3.5 and I haven't even really tried yet aside from sitting him on there occasionally and familiarizing him with the bathroom routine.. more because I know he's not ready. He's also developmentally about 18 mos, so I don't think we'll be ready for a while.

Have you tried a small potty for her to get used to it? I saw others suggested putting it in a different room as well. We always had ours in the bathroom and I would take my daughter in when I had to go and sit her down on the potty. Also, potty books, social stories, songs, etc.

Seems you've already got some advice on the marital front, all I'll say on that is being pissy at you about the situation isn't going to make this happen any faster and maybe he can come up with some ideas on how to help.

2

NeXXeR

•

vor 9 Monaten

Mine is 6 and is not 100% yet. Tell him to chill.

2

Avatar von u/WhatAGolfBall

WhatAGolfBall

•

vor 9 Monaten

Have him read \" ready sey potty\" it probably will open his eyes to the struggles people face as well as give you two some tips.

4-5 my son really made strides. So dont ever give up.

Also it seems like your husband may not really grasp the intensity of the issue.

Id recommend him looking at uniquely human as well. Just to try to get some perspective.

2

Extension-Ad-9371

•

vor 9 Monaten

Simple, have him join and autism parents facebook group and have him ask them. Maybe when he sees dozens of real life parents all saying the same thing hell get the memo

3

Tewfats

•

vor 9 Monaten

My partner's kids almost 9 and refuses to poo on the potty. If they can't accept that your kid is special needs then maybe you need to find a safer partner for your child. If I was to get upset because of a child's literal disability I shouldn't be in this relationship. It's ok to get frustrated and feel the feeling of frustration as a parent cause that's normal.... HOWEVER I know what I signed up for. How dare I be upset like what? Yea that's not ok

3

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 9 Monaten

Sounds like your partner doesn't understand autism. I suspect there's a lot more he disagrees with than what you're sharing here.

2

InteractionSavings44

•

vor 9 Monaten

She is not ready yet and she is telling you this by her reaction to even just sitting there fully clothed. Please give her time. Try again in 6 months. Bring her with you when you go. Demonstrate everything or read books, watch videos of characters using it. Autistic kids can have a difficult time learning to potty. There are many steps, there are loud

noises. She may be afraid of falling in, being sucked in who knows. She needs time. A lot of things are not going to match neurotypical timelines. Forget about what other kids do. Your kid isn't there yet. She will get there but pushing her before she is ready is just going to lead to frustration for everyone.

1

Avatar von u/Popular_Release4160
Popular_Release4160

•

vor 9 Monaten

If your husband is so knowledgeable about it, he should potty train her.



1

Avatar von u/Popular_Release4160
Popular_Release4160

•

vor 9 Monaten

For what it's worth, my daughter will be 5 in August and we are just now entertaining potty training.

2

mase27

•

vor 9 Monaten

Furious at you? Tell him to get off his ass and join in on the parenting, since he seems to think he can do a better job. What a DICK. That kind of attitude would absolutely result in divorce in my book.

1

No_Yes_Why_Maybe

•

vor 9 Monaten

You tell him to get the ball rolling and start the process he has his days off to give it a go.

0

Avatar von u/KittensPumpkinPatch
KittensPumpkinPatch

•

vor 9 Monaten

I don't have any advice (I wish I did!) but is waking up with a dry diaper, a sign of being ready to potty train? My kiddo has a crazy full diaper every morning.

1

Senior_Let5585

Poster*in

•

vor 9 Monaten

That's what my parents followed with me 🦄 lol I guess it's a thing?

1

UnicornFarts84

•

vor 9 Monaten

Trying to push her harder is only going to make that fear worse, and that's not something you want. How is she with a potty training potty? Could try to get her to go in there, then have her help you put it in

the big potty. You'll have to do it in steps and go slow.

1

ConcernedMomma05

•

vor 9 Monaten

Something that helped my son was putting a potty show on YouTube while he sat. Try it out.

And yes ND kids struggle with potty training. If he doesn't understand this - he needs to do his research

1

Throw_Away_8888888

•

vor 9 Monaten

Wow. My nephew with ASD is just now getting the hang of it at 8 years old. My other nephew (who is 6 and also ND) is terrified to be alone in the bathroom, and he needs someone with him. While I do understand that it can be frustrating, your husband needs to do some research and perhaps lend you a hand?

1

Dick_in_a_b0x

•

vor 9 Monaten

My son just started going independently and even as a precaution, he still uses training underwear. It'll come and you cannot compare the same milestone markers to that of a NT child. Just ask him to be patient and more understanding when it comes to potty training. My NT daughter wasn't fully trained until she was 4 going on 5. Hope this helps. Best of luck.

1

MrKattPopperManiac

•

vor 9 Monaten

Potty training is one thing there isn't great guidance in the community on for setting expectations. I get that because there is a wide spectrum of outcomes. But I think we should do better.

My hunch working in the population for daytime dryness is NT kids 18mo-3 yo. Level 1 3-6 yo. Level 2 4-8 yo and Level 3 5-12 yo. This doesn't even get into how asd kids almost universally seem to have gut issues and are dry waaay before they are clean.

This is a very rough spectrum, but I'm seeing parents saying "I'm at my wits end with my level 3 two year old, we've tried every type of potty training in the book".

Therapy and interventions can help, but your kiddo needs to be ready.

Pushing too hard really can hurt your kid. Encopresis is no joke and it often starts with kids pushing back on potty training.

Have your husband talk to any of your providers to understand the typical range. And please stand up for your kid. They don't deserve the blow back a furious parent must be giving on something they literally cannot control.

1

chinese_room

•

vor 9 Monaten

All my kids, ND and NT, were potty trained around the same time (4-5).

We'd started trying years earlier, but for whatever reason 4 was the magic number that they felt ready to work on transitioning. I guess there's a wide range of readiness for potty training, and that shouldn't be a source of shame for the kids or the parents.

I get your partner is frustrated, it's probably one more reminder that the life he'd imagined for your daughter is not the life she's going to have. It's not fair his anger is directed at you.

1

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 9 Monaten

My son wasn't ready until age 6 but then he got it in a week (a hectic week for sure with lots of protective sheets on bedding!) and he never used a potty. I read that it was easier to go straight to using the toilet with autistic children to lessen the confusion. Also went cold turkey from nappies and straight to underwear as he was attached to the nappies so was better to just switch. We tried so many times before then but he just wasn't ready and the communication barrier as he was pre-verbal for many years made it harder. But when he was ready it was a week and it was done with minimal fuss. Listen to your gut and don't be forced on this!

1

Avatar von u/Own_Ad_6137

Own_Ad_6137

•

vor 9 Monaten

Our daughter was the same just didn't have the slightest want to use the toilet, wouldn't tell us when she did a poo in her nappy. It was literally the last few months before she started primary school she just suddenly picked it up over a weekend and that was it. She still wears night nappies but hasn't had any issues. We

1

Froomian

•

vor 9 Monaten

My son is 6 and in a special school and of the 12 kids in his class he is the only kid in his class who is sort of potty trained. He still has to wear nappies if he is anywhere other than school or home. We have meetings with all the parents and an incontinence nurse and it is definitely completely normal for the majority of kids at the school to not be potty trained until much later than typical kids. Try and explain to your partner that this is not the same as parenting a typical kid.

1

Decent-Confusion-210

•

vor 9 Monaten

Whatever you do, don't fight over it and work on strategies that will be effective for the kid. You can debate on specifics but if you both disagree on if the kid's even ready, that's a bummer. My kid's five and a half and will do the deed if brought to the potty in time. He can pee standing like a man but that took 6 months of me doing it doors open for him to watch and get inspired (yeah totally pun intended). And I have lost hopes so many times but he does surprise us often with how he is

capable of doing things but is just not motivated most times

1

CatalinaLunessa21

•

vor 9 Monaten

My son wasn't fully potty trained until he was 6, and any changes meets regression for a few weeks/months (we are military so moves are fun lol). He is 8 now and thriving with no trauma from being a late bloomer. Protect their mental health and be patient mama, you got this. Edit to add: he had an accident last night, it's like he knew I was talking about him 😭

1

Avatar von u/External-You8373

External-You8373

•

vor 9 Monaten

Girl my kids didn't fully potty train till near PreK age. They'll do it when they do it and it he thinks he can do it better - let him.

1

Avatar von u/Big_Camera8397

Big_Camera8397

•

vor 9 Monaten

I\'m so sorry to hear that , I know kids on the spectrum who had diaper until over 4 years old , there is nothing wrong with it ,he is 5 years old now it\'s been over a year that he is potty trained and uses bathroom like any other NT kids. Who cares if they potty trained at 18 months old or at 4 years old , now that they are 5 they do it perfectly . Don\'t get stressed over it and also from a few autistic kids that I know around me they all got potty trained in their 4 years old . My son is 2.5 in the spectrum and It doesn\'t even cross my mind to start to potty train him yet . He can\'t even talk how can I make him to use bathroom

1

Avatar von u/Visual_Preference919

Visual_Preference919

•

vor 9 Monaten

I would honestly just show your husband this thread or any of the potty training threads on this sub. So many of us have had a long road to potty training. My 5.5 year old is just now starting to get it

1

MrsWhorehouse

•

vor 9 Monaten

That guy has got to go.

My daughter is 22 and 90% potty trained.

1

Avatar von u/cant_get_rightcant_get_right-

•

vor 9 Monaten

My son is 6 non verbal level three. We have been trying for years to potty train him. He understands what the toilet is for but makes no attempt to use it unless he is prompted. We will keep trying. Hopefully

he will learn while he still fits into child diapers.

1

MrsMcGwire

•

vor 9 Monaten

My 12 year old ASD son is not potty trained. His teachers at school assure me that he's not the only one that's still wear pull-ups.

1

azssf

•

vor 9 Monaten

You approach it by suggesting partner becomes more educated about ASD. If partner is uninterested, I suggest a discussion around his fitness to be a partner.

1

catbus1066

•

vor 9 Monaten

Tell him he's welcome to take this task on himself. 🙄

1

spoonfulofshooga

•

vor 9 Monaten

I had tried really slowly from when mine was 2 to start potty training (sitting kiddo down every 1-2 hrs, using reward charts, etc) and it didn't really work. I did have a plastic toilet that looked like a real toilet in areas she spends a lot of time in (play room, living room, bedroom) and I think that helped. I didn't force it but if I saw her popping a squat for #2, I would run over and have her sit on the plastic toilet and eventually she started to ask for the toilet herself for #2 (at 4yo) and then we started to have her sit in the morning and before bed for #1 and eventually something clicked at 6yo and she goes completely by herself on the big toilet (I had one of those small kid toilet seats that sit on the reg toilet seats)

1

Avatar von u/Cat_o_meter

Cat_o_meter

•

vor 9 Monaten

He's a jerk. He's also going to give her psychological damage if he doesn't loosen up. If he's not her dad leave

1

Avatar von u/Admirable_Mix3500

Admirable_Mix3500

•

vor 9 Monaten

My son is 4 and is a Level 2. We are currently potty training. My son would always poop at the same spot so I knew when he had to go. As soon as he made way to his spot, I would scoop him up and put him on the big toilet with a training seat. After the second time I did this, he started telling me when he needs to poop. He exclusively poops in the toilet now which is a game changer. He is still working on peeing. He would sometimes tell us he needs to poop but actually just needs to pee.

1

weirdkidmom

•

vor 9 Monaten

Tell your partner to learn about kids with autism!!!! This is completely normal!

You cannot force an autistic kid to potty train!

Your partner needs to chill! An autistic brain is wired differently! It works differently. Sometimes, the normal child growth timeline takes longer with an autistic than a neurotypical kids. And that includes potty training!!!!

1

Avatar von u/momoftwinsw

momoftwinsw

•

vor 8 Monaten

My daughter is 9 now, but she wasn't fully potty trained until she was 4.5.

Your husband needs to chill. Stressing you out about it is only going to cause your daughter to be more stressed about it.

Some advice: check out children potty books and read them often. We used an app that had a count down to everytime my daughter was supposed to sit in the potty. If she potty the app would shoot fireworks and she loved it. We also did a sticker chart.

Maybe you could use a sticker chart just to get her used to sitting on the potty- help her get more familiar with it.

It's been a while for us but maybe watch a social story on YouTube about using the potty.

1

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 8 Monaten

Your partner sounds like someone who needs to get a clue.

My boy turns 5 in July and he's still not potty trained. It is what it is. Autistic kids take much longer to master the toilet, if they ever can.

1

dogsarenicerpeople

•

vor 8 Monaten

Consider getting your kiddo into early intervention. She may need help with this from professionals. If your partner is being ableist and unhelpful, that's a separate issue where he needs to do some reading or therapy

1

post 9: **Finally done, finally being able to communicate 💩 and pee 🥹!! It was a struggle but since January we've been working hard 🥹.**

327

.*

76

Kommentarbereich

AddieMeadow

.*

vor 2 Jahren
**I am so proud of you and your kiddo that is such a huge big
achievement!!!! (And also your daughter is so so beautiful and her smile
is so precious it makes me feel so happy inside!) I send you many happy
cats 🐱 and such big congratulations!!**
33
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
Thank you so so much!! ❤️❤️❤️💪
9
Avatar von u/TekitiZi
TekitiZi
•
vor 2 Jahren
**🏆🏆🏆 Super huge accomplishment. Congrats to you both. Can't wait for
this day.**
11
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
**Yessss thank you I'm so stoked!!!! You got this all it takes is
consistency!! I was never perfect and over time I gave up but she
definitely picked up where I left off!!**

6
Spiritual-Shape-8139
•
vor 2 Jahren
**Yay! How old is she? My daughter just turned 6 and we are so close!
She's 90% accident free during the day but not night time trained yet!**
6
\[gelöscht\]
•
vor 2 Jahren
**You just made me feel much better about my parenting... my girl just
turned 5 and I only give her a 70%. I thought she was the only one who
struggled with this at this age**
3
4 weitere Antworten
1 weitere Antwort
Avatar von u/Awkward-Ad-2241
Awkward-Ad-2241
•
vor 2 Jahren
**Congrats. 3 turning 4 in April and he just doesn't get it. You ask him
if he has to poop and he adamantly says No! *2 minutes later * 🐛🐛🐛.
Then you ask him where do we poop? He adamantly says "in the potty!"
😓😓😓😓**
6
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee

CassieLeeLeeLee

Poster*in

•

vor 2 Jahren

No stress you got this. He will get it down!!!! Just get on his nerves ask him all day everyday lol!

3

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 2 Jahren

What helped with the #2? My girl is perfection when it comes to peeing on the potty. But we still have daily 🍑 accidents in her undies 😭

5

Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee

CassieLeeLeeLee

Poster*in

•

vor 2 Jahren

I just kept asking. I ask her multiple times a day because I'm paranoid lol 🤪. Just because I'm so scared for accidents and I have carpet 😭!

9

1 weitere Antwort

HappyMama87

•

vor 2 Jahren

Yay!! Congrats!!

It took my son til he was 5 (last year) because he really, really didn't like the feel of underwear and the huge change in texture from the comfort of a diaper etc. Sadly he was at the park earlier last year and a child his age asked him why he was still wearing diapers when his shirt came up enough to see it, and as soon as we got home, he made the change and asked for underwear - no turning back. He still doesn't like to #2 on the adult toilet at home because he's scared he'll get flushed down or something lol, so he still sits on a potty training toilet when he has to sit down, but we're getting there!

4

Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee

CassieLeeLeeLee

Poster*in

•

vor 2 Jahren

You know I actually switched from that!! I had the little potty training toilet but the attachment worked so much better. I felt like she would get used to it. I switched to the attachment and it's like she just started getting it quick!!

2

HappyMama87

•

vor 2 Jahren

That's awesome! I'm glad you were able to find a way to help your little one!!

1

\[gelöscht\]
•
vor 2 Jahren
Speak for yourself, but I\'m getting there. /j
3
1 weitere Antwort
RMoysters33
•
vor 2 Jahren
Great job! That\'s the hardest thing we\'ve ever had to do with my kiddo.
3
offutmihigramina
•
vor 2 Jahren

Yay! Yay! Yay! What a wonderful day.
2
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
Yes ma\'am I am so stoked😓
1
Avatar von u/whoops-im-a-lesbian
whoops-im-a-lesbian
•
vor 2 Jahren
Aww, she\'s adorable! Congratulations on the progress
2
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
Thank you so much!!! 🍷🍷🍷😄
1
MsBlondeViking
•
vor 2 Jahren
Yay!! Such a proud moment! What a cutie ☺
2

1 weitere Antwort
\[gelöscht\]
•
vor 2 Jahren
Ah god bless! That\'s a relief! It only took us 5 long years lol
2
1 weitere Antwort
Avatar von u/silkentab
silkentab
•
vor 2 Jahren

I can\'t wait for my daughter is figure it out!
2
1 weitere Antwort
toanthrax
•
vor 2 Jahren
This is awesome news..a great victory! I am patiently waiting for my kiddo to figure it out too!
2
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
No stress!! They will learn when they are ready they just need a tiny push. We tried last year she just wasn't having it and was very stubborn! Keep showing how to and then keep asking "what do you do". My little one is good with consistency and routine. Once she noticed I was bugging her about it she was like let me just do it so she will leave me alone lol, I asked her if she needed to poop or pee like a thousand times a day. No stress you got this!!
3
toanthrax
•
vor 2 Jahren
Ok, thanks for the advice! I think the routine approach should work. Congrats and have a nice weekend!
1
hegelianhimbo
•
vor 2 Jahren
Omgf she is insanely adorable
2
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
Thank you !!
2
Avatar von u/RichardCleveland
RichardCleveland
•
vor 2 Jahren
Awesome! Congrats on so much awesome progress!
And\\... why is this post marked NSFW\\... lol
2
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee

CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
**Not sure maybe because it's her face. Someone commented a said I was a

horrible parent for posting her here I'm like I'm not the only one that posted here so weird lol..**

1

Avatar von u/RichardCleveland

RichardCleveland

•

vor 2 Jahren

Ya same person probably posted 600 photos of their kid on Facebook.

lol

2

1 weitere Antwort

GrandmasGiantGaper

•

vor 2 Jahren

posting your kid on reddit, especially on autism_parenting is AWFUL parenting. Especially since pic looks like high functioning. Exactly what you\'d expect from a narcissistic parent who posts photos of themselves and their kid on reddit of all places. Shame on you you HORRIBLE parent. Hope you felt real good and rubbed yourself on the back from all the attention you\'ve got.

Sincerely from r/autism .

2

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 2 Jahren

**With no regard to the child having zero consent to her image (and her potty training success) being broadcast to the world by her parent. I

won't go far as to call her names, but your overall sentiment I agree with. Children have no agency. I would say this if it were on Facebook or anywhere else.**

3

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 2 Jahren

Also it would only take a minute to put an emoji over the girl's face, but then mom wouldn't get to be full of herself over all the comments on how cute she is. Really sad.

2

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 2 Jahren

HookersSkein

•

vor 2 Jahren

I\'ve just started potty training my daughter. She\'s 3 now. I\'m curious how long it took to get her to associate the feeling with needing to use the bathroom. My daughter is non verbal and it\'s hard to know when she needs to go or has gone!

2

2 weitere Antworten

BigD0089

•

vor 2 Jahren

Congratulations!

1
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in

•
vor 2 Jahren
Thank you so much!!
2
Jets237
•
vor 2 Jahren
Wooooo!
Hope to join you this year
1
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
YES!! You got this friend, we are resilient!!
2
mangosorbet81
•
vor 2 Jahren
She's gorgeous. Congrats!
1
1 weitere Antwort
ap06869
•
vor 2 Jahren
So proud of your girl!!!!
1

1 weitere Antwort
PassageNew5391
•
vor 2 Jahren
**Yay congrats!! 🥳 Any tips that you can share? What worked? What
didn't?**
1
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
**I honestly stopped using the little training potty and used the actual
toilet attachment which was better. Had a little step to climb up. Then
after a few times of showing her what to do at the beginning of the day,
the rest of the day I ask "what do you do" so she can show me and I
correct her if needed. Filled her up with a bunch of fluids constantly
(and fiber) for the 🍌, so she would have no choice but to get used to
it. I would ask her constantly if she needs to go poop or pee throughout
the day. She honestly would get agitated I asked so much lol.**
2

2 weitere Antworten
Avatar von u/prevails10
prevails10
•
vor 2 Jahren
Congrats!!
1
1 weitere Antwort
PNW_Express
•

vor 2 Jahren
Omg yay!!!! I'm so relieved to say this. PT my first and has autism and idk what to expect!? We're about 3 months into it and honestly he does well but he will NOT tell us when he needs to go. We have to prompt and get a bit of pushback. Any tips??? Or just consistency and persistence?
1

Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•

vor 2 Jahren
No stress you got this!! We actually stopped using the little training potty and used the actual toilet attachment which was better and I'm glad we did. It has a little step to climb up. Then after a few times of showing her what to do at the beginning of the day, the rest of the day I ask "what do you do" so she can show me and I correct her if needed. Filled her up with a bunch of fluids (she had a sippy) constantly (and fiber) for the 🍌, so she would have no choice but to get used to it. I would ask her constantly if she needs to go poop or pee throughout the day. She honestly would get agitated because I asked so much lol. I would ask literally every moment of the day.
2

Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•

vor 2 Jahren
Over time too I stopped asking and she just started doing it herself which was great because I would freak out if I forgot to ask at the start of the day🙄.
2

1 weitere Antwort
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee

Poster*in
•

vor 2 Jahren
Kommentarbild
We used this!
1

Avatar von u/Simplicity91628
Simplicity91628

•
vor 2 Jahren
**omg can you please share how you did it ?? i'm nervous and my boys
turning 3 soon**
1
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
**Heyy! Yeah I honestly stopped using the little training potty and used
the actual toilet attachment which was better. Had a little step to
climb up. Then after a few times of showing her what to do at the
beginning of the day, the rest of the day I ask "what do you do" step by
step so she can show me and I correct her if needed. Filled her up with
a bunch of fluids constantly (and fiber) for the 🍌, so she would have
no choice but to get used to it. I would ask her constantly if she needs
to go poop or pee throughout the day. She honestly would get agitated I
asked so much lol. I asked so many times she would scream at me I'm like
look girl I get but we're gonna get this done🤞. With the poop part when
we began that, I watched her at first and ran her to the bathroom and
propped her down. After that she got it. She tried to sneak a few times
like twice but after that she got it. Constantly asking if she had to go
poop and pee I was in her ear😭.**
2
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee

Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
**Omg they said boys are difficult I want to try to start with my 2yo
boy idk I'll see how it goes🤞. You got this though don't stress it!**
1
Fitnessfan_86
•
vor 2 Jahren
**Awww what a beautiful girl you have!! Congratulations!! We are still
working on it 🍌**
1
Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
CassieLeeLeeLee
Poster*in
•
vor 2 Jahren
**You got this girl!! I am rooting for you guys always🍌!!! Just a
little push is all they need 💖definitely be in their ear and I PROMISE
they will get tired of you asking lol🐱.**
2
\[gelöscht\]
•
vor 2 Jahren
**That\'s so amazing 😄!!! I\'m so happy for you and so incredibly
jealous at the same time lol 🤞. The other day after changing his butt I
just kept smelling it, so I\'m like ok I need to take a shower. I go to

take my shirt off, lift it over my head, poop goes all over my face
😭😭😭😭 lol. 🏆\...poor man\'s award goes to you 😊.**

1

Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee

CassieLeeLeeLee

Poster*in

•

vor 2 Jahren

Thank you 🥰!! Oh my gosh I felt this!! It would literally smell the whole room up I'm like oh naw girl we gotta start this potty training asap👉. The toddler poops just smell TERRIBLE🤢!!

2

Antique-Cattle915

•

vor 2 Jahren

Yasss little queen!! You go!

1

Nächster Post:

What age were your level 1s potty trained? Including #2!

We're currently on the path to diagnosis and I'm curious when this skill was acquired for other parents? Son seems HF but speech delay and clearly a little different then peers. We got #1 down pat, he's 2.10 but #2 he's a little worried to sit and do. Tips? Advice?

15

•

152

Kommentarbereich

DrizzlyOne

•

vor 1 Jahr

4.5 for our son.

Still can't effectively wipe after #2 (pretty sure he's scared of getting poop on his hand) and has the occasional #1 accident (he just forgets to go if no one reminds him...).

12

CircuitSynapse42

•

vor 1 Jahr

Same for us, 4.5. He was almost there at 3 and then changed his mind and waited another year.

4

Tight_Cat_80

•

vor 1 Jahr

**My kiddo was diagnosed at level 2 when he was 3, but he's almost 9 now and seems to straddle between level 1 and 2 (for context). To 🍑 he was able to do that in the toilet around age 5, shortly before he started kindergarten. His ABA clinic made a visual story for him with pics of the bathroom in our home and the clinic to show him where people go potty. He struggled to not keep going in his pull ups, so they'd have us move him from the corner he'd hide in, into the bathroom, to associate that's where we go. Then when we'd change his pull up and drop the 🍑 into the potty we'd have him flush so he saw that's where It goes and

then eventually he was comfortable enough to poop on the potty. He got a Lego city set as a reward and that got him so excited he continued to poop on the potty without incident. Now we are still working on him to wipe his own butt lol**

24

Jrbai

•

vor 1 Jahr

My kid is six and we have tried all of those things. Still no poop in the potty. 😞

I am glad it worked for kiddo, though! 🙌

8

Tight_Cat_80

•

vor 1 Jahr

I hope it's a victory in your household soon!!! In the moment It seemed like It would never happen and then we all were surprised once It did.

5

Minute_Parfait_9752

•

vor 1 Jahr

This is a pretty old comment but I also did the crazy high reward for one single success! It worked really well I think. Far better than small rewards or a sticker chart!

3

Tight_Cat_80

•

vor 1 Jahr

Yay!!! I'm glad that worked for you also!!

2

Minute_Parfait_9752

•

vor 1 Jahr

Like everything in autism parenting, do the exact opposite of the usual suggestions for the best results 😊

3

Setze diesen Thread fort

4 weitere Antworten

Exhausted_Platypus_6

•

vor 1 Jahr

5 and still not there.

23

GMaczac

•

vor 1 Jahr

Same\...

7

Avatar von u/artteacherjo

artteacherjo

•

vor 1 Jahr

Solidarity. Same.
7
Diligent-Ad-5979
•
vor 1 Jahr
Yup same
5
TerraVerde_
•
vor 1 Jahr
samw
5
Avatar von u/fuzzyfuu
fuzzyfuu
•
vor 1 Jahr
4, same tho. And using training underwear seem to terrify them if you try to put them on, he runs away and will find a pull-up and try to put it on himself.
3
Avatar von u/randitogrande
randitogrande

•
vor 1 Jahr
Same. Had a couple moments of success when I put on her favorite music video and sat her in front of it though, trying to work with that.
2
Avatar von u/cant_get_right
cant_get_right
•
vor 1 Jahr
Same. He will pee in the toilet in the morning when he first wakes up and he tends to take his pants off before he poops so occasionally I can run him to the toilet in time and he will use it, but most of the time he still goes in his pull up.
2
\[gelöscht\]
•
vor 1 Jahr
Pooped and peed at 7 1/2, finally wiped his butt this summer to earn a trip to Great Wolf Lodge (he's now 10). He uses tp and wipes.
9
Jrbai
•
vor 1 Jahr
Mine is six and still has the occasional pee accidents. But he does not ever poop in the potty. What did it for your kiddo?
2
Avatar von u/SourMathematicians
SourMathematicians
•
vor 1 Jahr
**3. We didn't try to potty train until kid really wanted to. I will say

there were regressions sometimes. I was surprised this happened relatively smoothly??? Because my kid was nonverbal at the time.**

I would honestly not worry about it at 2.

8

Far_Ruin_2890

Poster*in

•

vor 1 Jahr

He's completely pee trained, even tells me when he has to sometimes but I always take him once an hour or so. No accidents. But poop he'll tell me, we go to the bathroom then he says no? So I don't want to not try since he's so close

0

Evil_Weevill

•

vor 1 Jahr

We had this with my kid too. What we figured out was he was a little constipated and pooping hurt. So he didn't want to do it. He'd know he had to go, but he was afraid of going.

Does your kid drink a lot of milk and maybe not much water? Does he often have dry or hard poop?

Getting our son to drink more water and fruit juices and broadening his diet helped a bit with that.

3

Sbuxshlee

•

vor 1 Jahr

And yogurt or anything else considered probiotic

1

Avatar von u/SourMathematicians

SourMathematicians

•

vor 1 Jahr

I think just keep following his lead and not pushing it. Anxiety around bathrooms is really common for autistic kids.

I'll be interested to see if you get a diagnosis. Where I live, your kid would definitely get diagnosed, but my friends up north have children similar to your son (at least based off the short description), and the providers seem much more hesitant to diagnose until older.

2

Far_Ruin_2890

Poster*in

•

vor 1 Jahr

So he's very HF if he is! Speech and playing with peers(lack there of) are our biggest concern, cognitively he's very there, listens great, silly happy kid. No food, sleep, behavioral issues. Throws himself in the floor when I say no but I'd hardly say that's abnormal. He'll really benefit from developmental preschool but he isn't in until he turns 3!

0

Avatar von u/D4ngflabbitt

D4ngflabbitt

•

vor 1 Jahr

just want to mention that a looooooot of people think their kids are level 1 and absolutely crushed by a level 2 diagnosis (for some reason) so if that's you, please prep yourself before the diagnosis.

6

Minute_Parfait_9752

•

vor 1 Jahr

Also worth noting that if a child is borderline 1/2, putting them in 2 so they can access more therapy is better than level 1 and missing out.

**Just like getting an autism diagnosis in the first place it does not change your child. You take the same child home that you took in. They

are the same bright, funny, quirky kid that you love. But now there is a little extra name so they can get the extra help they need 😊**

4

1 weitere Antwort

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 1 Jahr

At age 3. He still had messy stool accidents but that was from constipation. That was a ongoing issue till age 12.

5

SuperTFAB

•

vor 1 Jahr

He's still little. Even NT kids don't train at 2. Nighttime training can take up until 6/7. All you can do is be positive about it and when he has an accident mention poop/pee goes in the potty and that's it. No biggie. If you make a big deal it causes shame and stress.

My daughter trained at 2, regressed after 3 months (when I say regressed I mean full on would scream her head off and donkey kick the training potty across the room.) I read that if kids do this for a month to give it a break and retrain later. We didn't have an official autism diagnosis until a little over 3 years old.

We trained again at 3 and she regressed after a stomach virus, surprisingly with pee and not poop. Then, we tried again a couple months after she was better and she did well. She was probably 3 and a half by that time and then my grandmother died a few months before she turned four and she regressed a bit and started pooping in her underwear. That resolved by continuing to tell her poop goes in the potty and trying to time things.

**Here we are at 4 and a half and over the last couple nights she's been wearing underwear to bed. This was after keeping a pull up dry at night for the majority of the last couple months. She still has pee accidents here or there. Autistic children can have trouble connecting their brains and their body so we did/do a lot of "Relax the peepee out. Deep breath. Feel how your body feels when you let the peepee out. You feel better." Same with poop. We never tell her to push. I will still explain to her that pee is all the water you drink and that's your bladder telling you that you have to go potty. Same with poop, we explained your body takes what it needs from your food and gets rid of the rest of it. One time when she regressed she started with the "holding on and letting go" struggle which is in part is normal but we did our best to help her

and had to give her fiber gummies here or there. We still do this as needed especially since she has sworn off fruit and veggies. Thank goodness for guacamole and chips.**

We did end up having to use an iPad for poop for a bit because she wouldn't stay on the potty long enough to poop. I was afraid this wouldn't help her ability to connect the feeling of pooping with actually pooping and that may have been the case for a bit but now she is aware and goes when she has to. We are still working on wiping for poop and stopping to wipe for pee since she can rush out. I spoke to her preschool teacher and she said a lot of the kids still struggle with that.

Danielle Tiger's episodes where they have little songs for going potty like, "If you have to go potty, stop and go right away" or "Flush and wash and be on your way." My daughter is a gestalt language processor which a lot of autistic child are, and songs are great for her. I can start repeating a line and she follows the direction (mostly) and then finishes the words to the song. We also have all sorts of books about going potty that we read to her. We also modeled going potty and narrating it all.

Sorry for the wall of text and if it sounds disjointed.

4

Far_Ruin_2890

Poster*in

•

vor 1 Jahr

Thank you so much for this!!! So we don't know if he is or isn't autistic yet, just very suspected. He needs to be trained for preschool that's why we did so early and he's doing great so far there! Jsut no poop lol. He'll go in his pants or wait until he's home.

2

SuperTFAB

•

vor 1 Jahr

Gotcha. I was worried about preschool too but she's doing it. Being in speech and occupational therapy helped my daughter a lot. They worked on pushing down her pants and pulling up underwear first and then pants which was frustrating her. 10/10 recommend speech and occupational therapy as early as possible especially since you suspect it.

1

Far_Ruin_2890

Poster*in

•

vor 1 Jahr

Thank you! We're in speech weekly. He does pull down and pull up his own pants but I help at home.

2

SuperTFAB

•

vor 1 Jahr

You're welcome! Completely normal to still need help. I would suggest the max allowed for speech and get him ealed for OT as well. I wish I would have started sooner. The diagnosis helped us get financial coverage for the therapies.

2

****Jrbai****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****Why did you not encourage pushing for poop?****
****1****
****SuperTFAB****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****It can cause anal fissures and hemorrhoids which can cause pain and then a cycle of holding stool in for fear of it hurting. A little pushing is ok but stool shouldn't need to be forced out. If it does the child is likely constipated. We had our daughter blow bubbles or take big deep breaths to help her feel and relax her pelvic muscles so she can poop without straining.****
****1****
****MinervaZee****
****•****

****vor 1 Jahr****
****For ours, I'd say 3-ish, with pull-ups at night for a long time. The issue was he would be so intent on whatever he was doing he wouldn't be aware of the urge until too late. He has an older neurotypical sister which helped to have an example, and he went to pre-school with an awesome teacher (grandma with a lot of supportive experience).****
****7****
****Grognaç_the_Red****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****3ish? Close to 3.5. There was a time she just wouldn't go and then over the summer somehow it just clicked. However we are experiencing a regression when she is tired or doesn't want to stop her activity, and she is wearing underwear. She just goes right in them. She also doesn't wipe on her own because she will use the tp and play with the water, so she has to be monitored the whole time.****
****3****
****colorful_withdrawl****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****My 8 year old lvl 1. Was pee potty trained at 22 months. But poop potty trained at 4 😊 adding that we still struggle with encopresis with her so bm accidents still happen occasionally if shes constipated. She doesnt like to poop anywhere but at home which makes traveling hard sometimes****
****My 3 year old lvl 1. Has been poop potty trained for over a year. Never has bm accidents. But we still only are about 50/50 for if we make pee in the toilet or not. I notice when he has to pee but very rarely does he self initiate if he has to pee. For bms he always tells us****
****Since i see comments about night training. My 8 year old isnt night trained yet same with my 3 year old. I have 8 kids 8 and under and only one of my five year olds is dry at night. It takes time, genetics and a hormone that the kid needs as well to stay dry at night****
****3****
****1 weitere Antwort****
****onestepbeyondd****
****•****

****vor 1 Jahr****

****Mine is between level 1 and 2 and he just started going pee and poop two months ago on his 5th birthday. I had been trying off and on for 3 years and tried about 6 different methods. I had him go and throw his diapers away in the outside trash cans and something about that clicked because it was pretty immediate after. I still have to be on him all day asking/telling him to go to the bathroom, I still have to wipe him, and he wears a pull up to bed. He's pda, and tends to hold his poop and gets constipated. I started telling him, "go do 3 poops and you'll be done." He takes to this much better, I think because just telling him to poop might feel like an endless thing that he'll be sitting there for, but he knows he just has to do 3 poops and it's done. I've also noticed that if I say "go pee like daddy", he doesn't fight as much and I think it's because he just has to walk up to the toilet and pee standing up rather than having to pull out the potty seat, climb up, sit, etc. like he can get it over with quicker. I also have to give him colace gummies and this helps significantly as well. Potty training is the hardest thing, and we're not completely there. I really hope I don't have to wipe his ass forever😭****

****3****

****C_L_I_C_K_****

****••****

****vor 1 Jahr****

****Around 10 he stopped using diapers for #2. Was huge moment for us****

****2****

****Jrbai****

****••****

****vor 1 Jahr****

****Was going #2 in the potty his choice or were there other things going on?****

****1****

****C_L_I_C_K_****

****••****

****vor 1 Jahr****

****Ran out of diapers one day.. while I was rushing to the store he just went on toilet and did his thing.. I never bought them again****

****2****

****BrandonDill****

****••****

****vor 1 Jahr****

****9 years old for #2. I\'m guessing 3 or 4 for #1.****

****2****

****1 weitere Antwort****

****Stacieinhorrorland****

****••****

****vor 1 Jahr****

****My daughter is level 2. She will be 4 in January and is not potty trained. She will NOT go at home but will go in therapy sometimes. She says simply "because I don't want to" when I ask why she won't go at home****

****2****

****\[gelöscht\]****

****••****

vor 1 Jahr
 Almost 5
 2
 Jrbai
 .*
 vor 1 Jahr
 choirandcooking
 .*
 vor 1 Jahr
 2, but very close to his 3rd birthday. With both kids (younger sibling is not on the autism spectrum) we did the potty training boot camp method. No diapers at all, including overnight. No one left the house or the kid's side, and every time he started to pee we would run him to the bathroom. By the 3rd day he had started to figure it out, and we had very minimal accidents after that.
 2

sbkoxly
 .*
 vor 1 Jahr
 We've not got our Assessment until next week for his autism but he's nearly 4 and out of nowhere this month has started to master doing no.1's. He can go himself but most of the time needs help. He's not a massive talker either but he can say "potty" to let us know. We always high five when he's done which makes him very happy but we're still making no progress on no.2 at all. It's really helped that all his classmates at Nursery can go and he's copying them which is nice. It's a massive weight been lifted from our shoulders. Hopefully no.2 happens before he starts school. He literally just started no.1's out of nowhere and we're so pleased. We've always tried to encourage him but he's never been interested. I really think he'll do the rest whenever he's ready, they're all on their own path.
 1

1 weitere Antwort
 scarypirateamy
 .*
 vor 1 Jahr
 3 for daytime, still waiting on night time (he wears a pull up). He's 4.5 now. We are of the view that the night stuff is hormonal and so we aren't pushing that part.
 1

Far_Ruin_2890
 Poster*in
 .*
 vor 1 Jahr
 Mine is basically night trained he did that on his own, kinda how we knew he was ready.
 2

2 weitere Antworten
 Educational_Fuel9189
 .*

vor 1 Jahr
 2-2.5
 1

Avatar von u/matte_t
 matte_t
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 I was in a similar boat, didn't potty train #2 until nearly 5. My kid had no interest/ was kinda fearful. We didn't want to push him but got to the point where we had to.
 1
 Mike_Danton
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 We started just after she turned 3, and she was fully (day) potty trained just before she turned 4. She is 8 now and still has accidents occasionally.
 I wouldn't worry so much if your kid is only 2. My best potty training advice is to take it slow and keep it child-led. My other daughter will be 3 in December, appears to be NT, and isn't fully potty trained yet (she's almost there!). Totally normal at that age.
 1
 Standard-Trade-2622
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 About 2.5 at home and school. He's 4.5 now and still in pull-ups at night but lately very motivated to try to stay dry at night but having trouble making the connection between going potty before bed/if he wakes up in the night and being dry in the morning so he's dry about half the time in the morning. He says 5 year olds can't have pull-ups so hoping we're almost there.
 1
 Far_Ruin_2890
 Poster*in
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 Thank you for this!! What were some traits you saw in him at 2.5 that lead to diagnosis? That's great how young he grasped it all
 1
 Standard-Trade-2622
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 **He's only recently been diagnosed but even at 2.5 he was super stubborn and if he decided he wasn't going to do something, he was absolutely not going to do it. At swimming lessons and music class, he always had his own agenda and own way of thinking/approaching things and struggled with changes in routine. I remember before my younger son was even born (so before he was even 2) having conferences and stuff and him being called "strong willed". There were a few extreme tantrums/meltdowns and I remember kind of casually looking in to autism at the time and thinking he was way too social and meeting all milestones and kind of brushing it off? He's always been fearless and very sensory seeking (climbing everything, jumping of stuff, etc) but I had no frame of reference for if that was normal or not. By about 3.5 he starting having more behavioral issues at school and I decided he must have ADHD (like me) and we started OT and I got him on a waiting list for evaluation. In the year since then, I did way more research on

autism and other sensory issues, ODD, etc and the more I learned about ASD, the more I realized that really fit with him (and me!). As his brother gets older, I'm also realizing how very different they are (things that would have derailed our entire day when he was that age dont even register for his brother).**

Anyway, he's 4.5 now, finally got evaluated and diagnosed last month with level 1 autism with a PDA profile and ADHD so my instincts were right. Still super high functioning, extremely (overly) verbal and outgoing but with zero filter or awareness, ahead for his age on all academic type measures. But man, don't try to take the "wrong" route to school or make him wear "spiky pants".

1

2 weitere Antworten

Avatar von u/Critical-Positive-85

Critical-Positive-85

•

vor 1 Jahr

I actually don't know what level my kid is as it wasn't assigned to us, but my best guess is that he's level 1 for most aspects of life. He pooped in the potty starting a few months after he turned 3 but we couldn't get him to pee in the potty until he was nearly 4.5. I did not potty train him... not because I didn't try. He simply ended up being the kind of kid that had to have it be his idea and have it be on his own time.

A tip we were given for my daughter is to let her poop in her diaper while in the bathroom, then try to have her sit on the potty while still using her diaper, and then eventually move towards pooping in the potty.

1

kolakube45

•

vor 1 Jahr

2.5y. He just got it somehow! He's low support needs. He usually wakes overnight now too just turned 4, but still wears a pull up incase

1

Avatar von u/chunk84

chunk84

•

vor 1 Jahr

Around 3

1

zmareng

•

vor 1 Jahr

Close to four.

1

Starbuck06

•

vor 1 Jahr

He was potty trained by 3, but he will only use a diaper to poop unfortunately and he's almost 6.

1

Avatar von u/PiesAteMyFace

****PiesAteMyFace****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****4 for both of them.****
****1****
****Lilsammywinchester13****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****My kiddos knew the process at 3 and towards the end of 3 was going pee with me****
****But it was a legitimate fight everytime and tears all around, even if she had a good day, the next day could be hell****
****At 4 when she started school, idk if it was leaving the house but she stopped fighting me to go potty completely and is like 90% potty trained****
****Problem is mostly her needing me to tell her to go, no "do you want to go potty " it's "go potty now"****
****Pooping and night time are still works in progress sadly****
****She only poops in the potty like half the time, but thankfully only poops home****
****1****
****Avatar von u/919_919****
****919_919****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****3. Took two weeks. It was a miracle with no tears. Three accidents in 4 years. We are one of the lucky ones.****
****1****

****Avatar von u/Additional_Set797****
****Additional_Set797****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****She just turned 4 and until now wouldn't sit, now she will sit every hour and even go num 2 if we catch her at the right time. She isn't initiating or letting us know but baby steps. If I would have forced or pushed the issue earlier it wouldn't have gone well.****
****1****
****Lavender_faded****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****\[gelöscht\]****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****First is level 1 and was 2 years old. Second is Level 2 potty trained at 2 as well I think I got lucky.****
****1****
****Far_Ruin_2890****
****Poster*in****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****So lucky! That's great, what were they like at 2? Trying to identify traits vs normal behavior in my son****
****1****
****1 weitere Antwort****

sjyork
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 **2. I didn't know she was autistic at the time. It took us about 2
 weeks.**
 1
 Far_Ruin_2890
 Poster*in
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 **Can you describe to me some of her traits then so I can be on the look
 out for my guy?**
 1
 2 weitere Antworten
 \[gelöscht\]
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 Significant-Job5031
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 **By 3.5 she was day potty trained for #1. Trained at night as of age
 4.5ish. We're almost 5.5 and she simply does not want to #2 in the
 potty. She has to be leaning against her bed mattress or in a corner
 with the door closed. We've offered all kinds of incentives and she has
 a couple times but they're tiny. It's like she has a hard time going, so
 I think it's somewhat constipation related. Idk...searching for answers
 too!**
 1
 I_eat_all_the_cheese
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 **4 years old (in July) and we are still not 100% during the day.
 Pooping it's about 90% of the time he starts pooping in his pants and
 stops himself and runs to the toilet. Pee he is about 80% of the time
 not in his pants at all. Our largest contributor here though is that
 he's almost certainly also ADHD...severely.**
 1
 moonflower311
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 **Our daughter was at age 4 but we dealt with frequent constipation
 problems for years (like regularly until age 8 or so).**
 1
 Evil_Weevill
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 **My son (now 7, level 1 Autistic) was fully potty trained at 4. He was
 most of the way there around 3.5 but didn't stop night time wetting
 until 4.**
 **For what it's worth, my daughter is NT and currently 3.5 and still
 struggling with potty training. It's not always an autism thing. Some
 kids just aren't ready until later.**
 1

PeanutNo7337
•
vor 1 Jahr
5
1
\[gelöscht\]
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vor 1 Jahr
My level 1 daughter was trained daytime by 3, but overnight wasn't until 4, just before starting kindergarten. She would only poop overnight so it took longer to figure out. One day she just decided and hasn't had an accident since lol.
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Celestial_Flamingo
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vor 1 Jahr

My Level 2 was potty trained by 4 without any issues, but try not to compare to other kids, because my neurotypical 4 year old still struggles with it. Potty training is very individual and 2-5 is normal even for kids without disabilities.
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EverywhereIGoHey
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vor 1 Jahr
Right around 30 months or so. 2 1/2. I worried because he had a mild speech delay but he was potty trained in a long weekend using our spin on the Oh Crap method.
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WinstonGreyCat
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vor 1 Jahr
About 2 yrs 9 months except for wiping. That was age 4. It helps he found diapers very uncomfortable.
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Far_Ruin_2890
Poster*in
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vor 1 Jahr
How is he now? Traits you saw in him?
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1 weitere Antwort
Jrbai
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vor 1 Jahr
6 and has accidents with #1 sometimes.
Never has done #2 in the potty.

We are in therapy and working on setting up ABA.
Would also love advice.
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Avatar von u/Makiez
Makiez
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vor 1 Jahr

Not exactly what you asked, but throws more perspective in. We started introducing the potty when my son was around 2 and 3 months. Meaning we would sit him on it every night as part of his bedtime routine, read books about, show him how to do all the steps. First we put him on it in a diaper, then naked bottom half. He accidentally peed a few times and we gave him fruit snacks and made a huge deal about it. After like 2 months, he would go pee every time we set him on the potty (occasionally poop too), but still never told us when he needed to go/had gone in his diaper. When he was 2.5, we attempted full on potty training by having him naked for 3 days in a row, and then switched to underwear (pull ups during sleep). He got it down quickly how to release whenever we put him on the potty, but was still having accidents if we didn't take him at least once an hour. And he never told us when he needed to go. When he turned 3 is when he really started getting it, holding it for a few hours at a time and started telling us when he needed to go. By 3.5, he stopped peeing in his sleep. At first, he'd wait until we put him in his bedtime pull up and we left him in his room for bed to go behind the curtains and poop in his pull up. Oddly enough, we fixed this by using the talk feature on his monitor and telling him to get back in his bed. He learned he can't leave bed at bedtime and he wouldn't poop while in bed so he became very regular about pooping when we took him potty before bed :P He was diagnosed level 3 at age 3.5. They were very surprised during his evaluation when I said he was potty trained. He's 4.5 now and he still waits until the last second to go potty (apparently this is common with autism) she he still has occasional accidents. Being sick and getting soaked (like after being in the pool) seem to cause more accidents. And he just had a UTI and was having accidents, but he's good now. And now when he has an accident, he tells us immediately and is actually distressed (for a long time, he just didn't care when he had an accident)! We know his signs when he has to go - he gets super wiggly and paces and can't sit still so we just tell him to go potty when we notice that behavior. The main hiccup we have now is that he doesn't understand that he can take himself to the potty so he always waits for us to give him permission or come get him out of bed in the morning.

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ProfessionalCall7567

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vor 1 Jahr

Hey, I'm a behavior analyst, and I've potty trained over 50 kids and young adults with ASD. I'm my experience. Usually, boys have a tougher time training poop too. Always rule out medical with the physician first, i.e., constipation first. After that, I always recommend getting rid of pull-ups (these are no different than diapers imo) all together and getting a powerful reward. Many times, if they've already been pee trained, it also takes holding back attention for sitting on the toilet, which is counterintuitive but when you understand how attention is a reward you can see you're rewarding the wrong thing. Most kids already know they are supposed to poop in the toilet. It's just hard to break the routine that they've developed and perfected, and no one likes change!

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nachoteacup

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vor 1 Jahr

Mostly by 3.5, not dry at night until 7. We find in times of stress or overwhelm we see a bit of regression in terms of using the bathroom\... So it\'s ok around 80% of the time but then there may be accidents. Took 3 tries to potty train the first time so we just did it on his schedule in the end.

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SnooBunnies3198

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vor 1 Jahr

Right at 3 years old - same age as our other two children. But the motor skills actually threw us off with a diagnosis. He was super coordinated and athletic but had all these other little quirks. So I think we may have just been an outlier in that area.

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ashhir23

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vor 1 Jahr

Around 3-3.5 for day time. Right before her 5th birthday for night time.

**Our best advice was, encourage, not force. We hyped up the potty alot.

We tried a few times before she was 3 but she was just sobbing and scared so I don\'t think she was ready and that fear pushed it back.**

At 3 something seemed to click. We didn\'t follow a \"get potty trained- 3 day miracle trick\" or any \"do it in a weekend hack\" we took it slow and really let her lead which seemed to help her. Every time she went or attempted we celebrated which I think was a motivator she loves a good mini party.

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prettywannapancake

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vor 1 Jahr

We tried at about 3 and she could understand going on the toilet if you put her there, but her communication wasn\'t quite there and she couldn\'t tell us when she needed to go or pull her pants down to go herself. She would only take herself if she was naked. So we basically put it on hold for a few months and came back to it when she was about 3.75 and had had a big communication break through and that time she did it no problem.

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cici92814

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vor 1 Jahr

3. Just got lucky. Still had accidents until about 4.5. Hasnt had any accidents then

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AnonymousKitten00

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vor 1 Jahr

4 for my daughter

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mystery79

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vor 1 Jahr

**4.5, this was before our diagnosis was official. The biggest struggle

we had was transitioning from a training potty to the big toilet. The one nice thing about him getting it later is that he had very few accidents after.**

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Stargazing-Fig

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vor 1 Jahr

4. We just finally got it going but we're still having accidents on occasion. He doesn't like to go in there alone (toilet is loud) so unless I'm free to follow him in there, accidents tend to happen.

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Mysteriousokra23

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vor 1 Jahr

Around 3, we did pullups at night for a long time due to bedwetting and, even at 5 , still have an occasional accident from holding it during his preferred activities.

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Avatar von u/AccomplishedYam6283

AccomplishedYam6283

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vor 1 Jahr

So we were lazy with toilet training. We didn't try until he turned 3. A month after turned 3, we did the whole going commando method. It took 1 day to learn to pee in the toilet and about 3 to poop. He would hold his poop so he got super constipated. After a laxative or 2, he just got it. He was good at night, too. Never needed overnight pull-ups.

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paleturtleee

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vor 1 Jahr

**Pee trained at 2y11m, 🐛 trained at 3y9m (he's just turned 4 so this is a new development). For the period in between, he'd do some on the potty, most on the floor, some in his pants. My son is level 1

borderline level 2, also had a speech delay and was a bit different than peers. Hopefully the Dx comes soon, it'll open a bunch of doors to resources for your LO. I wouldn't push on the 🐛 training though unless it's an issue at school. As long as you set the foundation and are consistent with teaching that 🐛 goes in the potty, he'll get himself comfortable. My son did quickly learn that home was the place to go and now even though he's trained he only wants to go at home🤔**

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paleturtleee

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ETA: and incentives!!! I call them poopy prizes, lol. Started off with toys but I couldn't deal with tiny trinkets everywhere so we moved to special snacks. Usually a cookie or gummy fruit snacks of his favorite characters. Now he'll go to the bathroom by himself, call me in for clean up, and then say "Mommy, I did a BIG poopy (he does lol), can I have my poopy prize now?"

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Maximum_Distance5697

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vor 1 Jahr

My son level 1 was potty trained fully a month or less before turning 3. He still wears pull ups at night though and when he's really zoned into whatever he's doing or overstimulated he holds it until he's literally about to pee himself and will get a little pee in his undies 😬😬

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Upper_War8365

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vor 1 Jahr

Mmm I have a lot to say and suggest as we struggled and will continue to have many ups and downs. First of all I'm sorry! It's one of the most stressful things. We were able to secure through our one stop shop OT center- speech, some PT & a OT for the last 3 years. Officially diagnosed a little over a year ago, but it's been a known entity even without the proper paper work. Anyway through that office and our BP/PCP we were able to get in to see and pediatric Pelvic Floor therapists. And I can not tell you how amazing it was to have a person who GOT it!

**It took us a little over a year to really make headway and the process was a slow one, and despite still anxiously wanting and needing to be in diapers for #2 specially up until 6 months ago, the progress was profound. I wasn't in any rush to toilet train and knew it would happen as it comes, but as soon as we got to 4 & then 5... things became tricky. ASD kiddos tend to withhold for lots of reasons but slowly we made some progress. The thing that works for my kiddo (HF,lv one HIGH anxiety,PdA profile--- we know the "levels" even shift from day to day, don't they? Linear it is not!) tends to be very content and happy without clothes on, which over the summer have at it kid. After any activity out of the house we filing water play and complete sensory need through her whole body was needed. And with that body freedom she began to get some fits me attempting to squat outside. So the course was that for over a year. Once it became cold and choice was taken away from her (for reasons we felt makes sense but of course to her we took a choice away) she really struggled with intense withholding & therefore constipation. To the point where we needed belly Z-rays & some bowel clean outs. Rough going and a lot of fear, BUT even though constipation is something she will struggle with for a long time, we have a regiment now that works for us... and are finally out of diapers. She has sat on our toilet to go poop in frequently and since it's still warm here is much more comfortable going outside, but I can feel the anxiety and stress lift as it's become easier to pass, and she has matured (almost 6 & started a shortened or adjusted version of Kindergarten through her

IEP/ for the next few months- as we know once those full days commence poop and other withholding patterns will happen again....**

I feel strongly that along with all then there important interventions given to our twice executorial kiddos that pediatric pelvic floor is a game changer! It's worth asking about and starting to do the research.

**Please please feel free to reach out if you'd like. Hang in there!!!

♥**

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CSWorldChamp

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vor 1 Jahr

My daughter was potty trained before age 2. She suffered from anxiety about pooping for a long time, though. Still does, occasionally.

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Sleepyb23

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vor 1 Jahr

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\[gelöscht\]

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vor 1 Jahr

She was almost 4 by the time she was consistently going on the potty. She still has accidents and won't wipe her butt. Damn sensory issues.

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IRiseWithMyRedHair

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vor 1 Jahr

My level 1 kiddo wasn't potty trained until 3. I tried on and off, but didn't force it. It's great your son has #1 down! What worked for us was actually putting the little potty in the living room and having it super accessible, and she could even keep watching cartoons. Anytime she used it, she'd get an MandM candy. I bought some bigger prizes for #2 (toy cars, slime, etc) and it worked. She had no trouble transitioning from the little potty to the regular one with a seat once she had it down. Good luck!

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Avatar von u/No_Music1509

No_Music1509

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vor 1 Jahr

Over age of 3, it took almost a year with a lot of regressions

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Avatar von u/Julesshakes

Julesshakes

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vor 1 Jahr

My level 3 son took from about 3.25-3.75 to train. Now at 4 he's fairly consistent with some accidents rarely

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rosegoldliner

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vor 1 Jahr

Pee trained just after turning 4. Now she's 4.5 and still won't poop though. She'll ask me for a diaper when she has to poop. Reading the advice on this thread!

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Avatar von u/Moist_Field_1502

Moist_Field_1502

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vor 1 Jahr

Our son is between a level 1 and 2. Started potty training at 3. Was fully potty trained by 3.5. He's 4 years, 2 months now and hasn't worn a diaper at night in 7 months. We were lucky.

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YogiGuacomole

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vor 1 Jahr

**Just before 4th bday and we're so proud of him! We were not very forceful with it. Always had plastic potties in each bathroom and in his bedroom, potty books (he loved night potty, Daniel tigers potty book, and Elmo's potty book), and some other tactics that idk made much of a difference. That started around 2 years old. Around 3.5 we got more serious for preschool. We took away pull ups and let him wear underwear, have accidents, and remind him to use the potty instead. We constantly repeated to use the potty when he has to go. He would always say no. But he started to associate naps and night sleep with going potty first. Once that became a routine he would go at those two times of the day consistently with lots of accidents in between. We ramped it up to "make" him sit almost every hour. Eventually he started just going independently and having fits anytime we told him to go. So we've

stopped with the instructions and he's fully independent now. He has a potty in his room and he'll go number 1 and 2 alone, wipe, throw away in the trash can, and put on underwear, and then lay back down until it's time for us to come get him. We're very proud! And came a long way. We have scrubbed so much poop out of carpets and repainted walls because of his sensory seeking behavior in "playing" with his 💩. Not pretty but worth it!**

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Pomelo-Tall

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vor 1 Jahr

3.5 for one kid, right at 4 for the other. She said she was going to poop in the potty when she turned 4, we didn't push it, and on her 4th birthday she just... did. I was stressed out that they wouldn't learn the potty because it seemed like all the other kids their ages were, but they did it on their own schedules.

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babs_is_great

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vor 1 Jahr

My level two kiddo was trained for both day and night, #1 and #2, by 2.75 years. We used the "oh crap" method. It worked as advertised! He is hyper verbal and highly bribable so that was useful in getting him to comply.

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Big_Calligrapher6870

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vor 1 Jahr

My son is 6 and we are ALMOST fully potty trained. He is level 2. I didn't even try to potty train until he was about 4, never had any bed wetting. But the poop, omg the pooping has taken us a full 3-4 years. He is now comfortable pooping in the toilet, but still needs help wiping. But I have been able to get him to practice since he has started 1st grade. The pee was not as hard as the poop, he used to hold it in, hide, poop in his underwear. (We did a cold turkey on the pull ups and he was on the potty/toilet immediately). He even had moments of pooping corners and playing with the poop. His older brother also took longer to poop in the toilet. I just chalked it up to them needing more time and now I figure he will be good within the next year

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Big_Calligrapher6870

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vor 1 Jahr

Also, my son wouldn't poop in his pull up and it turned out the turds were so big the pull-up didn't really give enough space to poop after he was 4. When we were home, I left him without any pants while we were home and it helped to get him to sit on the toilet

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Avatar von u/tiger_fanclub

tiger_fanclub

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vor 1 Jahr

My daughter level 1 was able to get #1 done by age 3 but still asked for diapers for #2 (she wanted to go into hiding under desk or chair or countertop in order to relieve). But we did all kinds of stuff to get her to sit down for #2 (show her diaper #2 and throw it in the toilet to make her flush, then just make her sit there when she looks like she gotta go and praise her plenty, read the book to her about pooping, sing a song while she sits there, rub her back or tummy while she sits, if even a little comes out praise her, make her check inside the toilet and flush etc etc etc). Then she was able to do #2 in the toilet by 3.5 years old but needed someone to be there in the toilet with her.
Age 4, she can do #2 by herself. She still needs help wiping cleanly though (stains).

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teeplusthree

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vor 1 Jahr

My level 1 is 4. He pees pretty well. He definitely has accidents but are becoming less and less. Pooping is still a work in progress. He more often than not will just poop in his underwear. The odd time he will run to the bathroom, but it's not all the time. He's definitely aware he shouldn't do it, because he close his bedroom door when he does it 😊

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OkJuice3729

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vor 1 Jahr

My level 1 son was 3, but it took 6 months.

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Avatar von u/aqua410
 aqua410
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 vor 1 Jahr
 I have a level 1. She was fully potty trained at 3 years, 10 months.
 She still occasionally has a pee accident while sleeping. But its only like 3x/year and when she\'s had a drink too close to bedtime. I wake her up at 2 AM every morning to take her to bathroom to avoid.
 My child has inherited my OCD about cleanliness. That pushed her to get good at wiping.
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 \[gelöscht\]
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 vor 1 Jahr
 Is he using the regular toilet or does he have a potty that he uses?
 My husband bought one of those little training seats that you place on top of the regular toilet and that has been a game changer (not sure why) for our son. They are about \$10 at Walmart.
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 Jonny24v01
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 vor 1 Jahr
 Just after age 6 with no accidents at night for several months and good during the day. The only thing is she is peculiar with who takes her when we are somewhere new and she holds it till the more familiar person or location is present. Also, she is used to going when we stop somewhere when she sees the bathroom. If there is no bathroom at a gas station when stopping for gas, she is really upset even if she doesn\'t have to go that bad.
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 Exciting-Sherbert129
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 vor 1 Jahr
 Both kids not officially diagnosed until high school. Daughter 2.5 bribed with 5 mms, and son just under 2 bribed with mms and super motivated because he wanted to join his older sister at a ball pit that didn\'t allow pull-ups. Daughter had more accidents when first potty trained, she would wait until the last moment and then it was a panic if we were out. My son just wanted to keep up with his sister so we lucked out and he had hardly any accidents.
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 Alienn_Aleeshh
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 vor 1 Jahr
 My 8yo AuDHD daughter still isn\'t potty trained. Her impulsive issue makes it so hard for us. She will sit for a little while, then get up and play with anybwater she finds. She also won\'t tell us when she needs to go. She will, at times, bring us the supplies and tell us when she needs to be changed. I\'m hoping we can get her trained soon, I\'m tired 😞
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 Avatar von u/butternutsquashed42
 butternutsquashed42
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vor 1 Jahr

We started potty training at 3. 95% successful with #1 within a month. Diagnosed lvl 2 at 3.5. At 5, I would say we are now 98% successful with #2. Lots of YouTube on the potty and miralax to support that. Still wears diapers at night.

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ReadsBooksAllDay

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vor 1 Jahr

**My son was diagnosed as level 1 at 3yo. He was potty trained by the

time he was diagnosed, but we still have some accidents at night at 5. My son is a sensory seeker, and he has very few sensory avoidant behaviours, so pooping hasn't been too much of an issue. He just had a very specific book that he wanted read to him as he pooped. Just remember all kids are different. Your son's level doesn't necessarily reflect where he lies on the spectrum. He might have sensory issues with poop that are specific to him.**

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Far_Ruin_2890

Poster*in

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vor 1 Jahr

So that's what it seems we're headed toward, what were some traits your LO had?

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4 weitere Antworten

Avatar von u/Freedombirther

Freedombirther

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vor 1 Jahr

My 2.5 year old isn't diagnosed yet but awaiting assessment and I already have an autistic six year old. We don't have levels here (in the UK), however She's non verbal with a lot of motor delays but managed to toilet train about 8 weeks ago. She does still have accidents if I'm not on at her so I have to be pretty in the ball. It is quite stressful and I do sometimes feel like it would have been easier to keep up the nappies as I'm not sure how much she actually understands! Not sure if that helps really! She will happily go when taken and never puts up a fight though (both #1 and #2).

My six year old was verbal and toilet trained fully by 2.5 although up until a few weeks ago was still having occasional accidents (usually during a meltdown or on purpose to delay bedtime) and was still in nighttime pull ups. I think the whole potty training regime I was going through with her sister helped finally bring those to an end!

Can you try picking up some new fidget toys specifically for the potty/toilet? Best of luck! It's a gruelling task so I'm sending you good vibes!

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LoveIt0007

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vor 1 Jahr

My son at 3, both (1 and 2), my girl (level 2) at 3.5, both #1 and #2.

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 Ok-Mark-1915
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 vor 1 Jahr
 My kid is 5 and diagnosed level 2, she was potty trained poop and pee by 3 years old maybe a few months after 3 but I was still wiping her. She started kindergarten and now she'll wipe if she pees but not if she poos but hey I'll take it lol
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 Ok-Mark-1915
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 I literally just put a tshirt on her and let her run around without underwear on or I'd put big girl undies on her and took her to the potty every 15-20 minutes. I'd set a timer and walk her in there and set her on the potty. She picked it up pretty quickly and I think we only had one poop accident where she pooped in her big girl undies and then took them off and came downstairs without underwear and I was like....oh no but I found the hidden poop quickly lmao.
 2
 Pandasami
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 My ASD child surprisingly potty trained extremely well! We used the three day method right after he turned 2 and he was a pro. Pooping was never an issue for us though we were warned ahead of time that "boys typically have trouble with pooping on the potty". He night time trained around 4.5. It was my NT younger child that actually took longer and is finally potty trained at almost 4 with occasional accidents. He didn't struggle with pooping on the potty- I don't think he liked the sensation of poop in his pants but he definitely didn't care about peeing in them😁

 Pooping on the potty is typically a challenge for all children though and can take a while to tackle. I teach preschool and have had multiple children in each of my classes the past few years who refused to poop in the potty at the beginning of potty training.
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 Avatar von u/mayhem_1622
 mayhem_1622
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 vor 1 Jahr
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 Avatar von u/PlayTraditional7348
 PlayTraditional7348
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 vor 1 Jahr
 **I recently was successful at potty training my 5 year old, he would at first show no signs that he had to go, but I was sick of buying pull ups and knew he could get it so I know that he loves his iPad and when he would go on himself , I would take the iPad and let him know why, that he had to not go on himself, and use the toilet to get it back, he started urinating on his own in the toilet, as he wanted his iPad, he was still going number 2 on himself and I started the same thing no iPad

because you went on your self he then started going number 2 in the toilet, I congratulated him every time he went so he knew that he was doing something right, he then became proud to go and would tell me every time he went looking for the positive reinforcement, still working with wiping as of now, i stopped with the pull ups except at night, convenient yes but he was too comfortable in them, so only underwear, I carried a change of clothes everywhere and a plastic bag (for him to sit on) for when we were in the car in case he went on himself without telling me, he\'s finally got it, keep working you guys got this**

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mamabear27204

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vor 5 Monaten

**Level 1 and Sadly 4.5 and STILL not trained. Not even a little bit\...but hes starting to get sick of diapers though and hes also

against potty as well. So that makes it so much harder when hes against both diapers AND potty. He has so many accidents\...but im praying to God that he caves soon and decides he\'d rather go potty since he doesn\'t want diapers.**

nächster post:

Level 1 autism and potty training

Defeat. That's what I feel. My son screams and cries for chocolate and refuses to use the toilet to be treated with it.

I get so defeated I put his diaper back on.

Yeah, I know. He'll never learn that way and i'm a sh!t parent. Thanks for all those future comments because that's exactly what I need.

Also, I have a puppy to potty train as well. And yes, I'm aware that the timing is stupid. He was a gift, thanks.

26

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64

Kommentarbereich

BladeMist3009

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vor 8 Monaten

Potty training is the absolute worst.

You could try:

free access to all you can drink juice boxes for frequent urges and therefore more practice in a day

a padded seat on the big toilet, especially one with handles

a toddler potty (depending on your kid's age/size)

sitting him on the toilet backward so he has the tank to hold onto

a peepee teepee (or other fun niche to locate the toddler potty in)

a stool he can stand and pee from

tinkle targets

Daniel Tiger's stop and go right away app

waiting another 6 months and trying again

There is no right or wrong way to potty train. Every parent guesses their way through it, and it's different for every kid. I wish you the best of luck.

36

BladeMist3009

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****vor 8 Monaten****
****Also recommended: cover your child's bed and your couches and recliners with leakproof mattress pads for your sanity.****
****19****
****merpixieblossomxo****
****•••****
****vor 8 Monaten****
****This is a big one, and something I wish I\'d done when my daughter was like a year old. I\'ll be picking up a new mattress this weekend because mine is so destroyed that it\'s embarrassing to walk into my bedroom. It\'s an expensive mistake to make, so yes - leakproof your stuff!****
****2****
****Avatar von u/CryptographerKind290****
****CryptographerKind290****
****Poster*in****
****•••****
****vor 8 Monaten****
****thank you!****
****3****
****mevaletuopinion****
****•••****
****vor 8 Monaten****
****So many great suggestions thank you****
****2****

****flickin_the_bean****
****•••****
****vor 8 Monaten****
****My son is 4.5 and literally just pooped on the toilet for the first time last weekend. My son is very sensitive to being pushed to do things. It has to be his idea and lots of fun. He has been peeing on the toilet for probably 6 months but the poop has been a struggle. We have been putting a diaper on just for poops for a while and that's at least helped him gain some control and recognition of it. So I would say "okay time to poop, let's get a diaper" he would get the diaper on and poop almost immediately. But getting him to even sit on the toilet when he had to poop was not happening. This last weekend I went all out on the rewards. Didn't push just told him when he popped on the potty he would get these things. So we have a sticker chart, Spider-Man underwear/pajamas and a big spider man book for him to look at only while he was on the toilet. Also his grandma brought him a shirt and donuts. It took all of that, not pushing him just talking about the process and reminding him of what would happen when he did. Then one time he just went in there, closed the door and pooped. Then yelled for me when he was done. I think it was just the right combo of everything. Honestly, I would take a break and try again in a little bit. When you have the capacity to be patient and mega encouraging/excited and he is more willing. Like others have said, it's a different path for everyone!****
****21****
****Avatar von u/Middle-Instruction36****
****Middle-Instruction36****
****•••****
****vor 8 Monaten****
****That\'s an awesome story! Congrats 🍌****

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 Avatar von u/Ok_Instruction3533
 Ok_Instruction3533
 .*
 vor 8 Monaten
 Mine is 4.5, we tried last week and it was clear she wasn't ready. She is not opposed, but she has no sense of her bodily functions. So we just sit on the potty and read a book every few hours, but she's still in pull ups (with undies over them, at the direction of her teacher.) If he's not ready, he's not ready. It's not your fault.
 8
 Avatar von u/rxn34
 rxn34
 .*
 vor 8 Monaten
 Why undies over? Mine is almost 4.5 and it's tough going
 3
 Avatar von u/Ok_Instruction3533
 Ok_Instruction3533
 .*
 vor 8 Monaten
 That's what her teacher told us to do, and since she's trained in special ed, I trust her. I think it's to get her used to the idea of wearing them, and also a bit of a sense of the waistband. She helped pick out the ones she wanted and it does make her excited about the whole thing, she just doesn't understand her bodily sensations yet.
 2
 Avatar von u/rxn34
 rxn34
 .*
 vor 8 Monaten
 Gotcha! Thanks for answering!
 2
 queenofcatastrophes
 .*
 vor 8 Monaten
 My son is level 1 and he wasn't potty trained until he was almost 6. He's 8 now. I don't have any advice because it just happened one day after struggling for so long... and even now I don't know how or why. But just know you're not alone in this and it does get better!
 6
 journeyreward123
 .*
 vor 8 Monaten
 👉🙏 my girl is 7. Times are tough.
 2
 queenofcatastrophes
 .*
 vor 8 Monaten
 You got this 🍡
 2
 ParsleyandPumpkins
 .*

****vor 8 Monaten****

****Dude potty training suuuuucks!!** One time we tried we went a full 30 days pantsless with both me and husband prompting (but not too much), keeping the toddler potty nearby (but not hovering), basically trying to do everything right and we did not get a single drop of pee in any potty. I tried to incorporate it into our day by asking if she wanted to go and sometimes bringing the reducer to public restrooms but all very halfheartedly because I felt so defeated. She happened to turn a corner on her own. We showed her the new ms rachel potty episode and she cracked up at the whole thing and suddenly became obsessed with the potty. Shes a GLP and picked up like eight new gestalts from the episode which is way more than usual. Now shes getting the majority of her pee/poop in the toddler potty in our living room. This was like a week ago. A week and 1 day ago I could have written your post.**

****Basically all to say, you're doing great even though I know you feel like you're not. It takes A LOT more time than anyone prepares you for. It'll click for him someday and no one on earth can predict when that will be. Keep at it but also keep your sanity. And get yourself some chocolate because you deserve it.****

****5****

****Avatar von u/CryptographerKind290****

****CryptographerKind290****

****Poster*in****

****.*****

****vor 8 Monaten****

****I feel like maybe he's just not ready. But also, I am so tired of the diapers. And then again, every single thing I feel like we have to do with this child, is a project. Like nothing just happens smoothly. I'm losing my mind.****

****12****

****DriveOpen5989****

****.*****

****vor 8 Monaten****

****My son is under the spectrum he also has a speech delay. I trained him over winter break, if he pees on the floor is okay don't scream. Take him to the potty and tell him that's where he pees. it took me a bit but now he is potty trained. He doesn't tell me when he needs to go he just goes on his own. At daycare he still uses pull ups due to his speech delay. As soon as we get home I change him in to his undies.****

****I still use pull ups when we go out to the store so is okay If he takes his time. Nothing will ever go smoothly in raising kids. Don't be too hard on yourself trust me when I say I wanted to give in too.****

****Wishing you all the luck ! 🍀****

****6****

****Strong-Diamond2111****

****.*****

****vor 8 Monaten****

****The potty training in three days for boys book (non ASD but great principles!) suggested if it gets real bad refusal then stop for a month & try it again later. We did this a couple times & eventually he got it fully potty trained age 5 in a few months doing the potty training in three days book method designed for typical one to two-year-olds. If you take a break and start again in a few weeks or a month when you start back up get more gear like books videos & flashcards & be obsessed for**

weeks like in the book they say to be for 3 days. You can do it! My best advice is to focus on the first go of the day as you know it's coming!**

2

Avatar von u/SimbaSleeps

SimbaSleeps

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vor 8 Monaten

How old is he? Is he showing interest and/or trying to do any part of it? I had to be pushed by EI and daycare teacher to try to start because I was not convinced she was ready. Still not 100% but it worked better than I thought. But we didn't start until 3.5 (a year ago), and she's only started pooping in the potty in the last few months. Refused to before that. I figured out how long it took liquids to go through and was very prompt in getting her to go about an hour after drinking. Used a TON of timers.

But I dreaded it for years and hated it the whole time. Still do since she sometimes refuses to go. Also, your last paragraph made me chuckle, but I'm very sorry you're in this predicament.

4

Avatar von u/shitty_owl_lamp

shitty_owl_lamp

•

vor 8 Monaten

Level 1 4yo. We gave up and let the ABA therapist try it. They potty trained him in like a month. Those women are magic lol

4

OutsideHandle7300

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vor 8 Monaten

My story: I hope it helps.

I have 2 ASD kiddos my youngest is lvl 3 non verbal. We finally just got him potty trained a few months before his 9th bday.

We tried and tried before. I gave up several times! I felt as though our son would be in diapers forever. Had even decided to get used to the idea of that. Period. DH and I always discuss the potential future of our son bc he definitely has higher needs. (IE: self care, communication etc.) and we decided to try one more time. We made a plan and stuck to it and our kiddo did great this time!

My point is timing and patience is key. If right now it didn't work it's on to take breaks. It's your sanity and your child's that's more important imho.

**I personally feel your struggle and wanted you to know that you are

doing the best you can and that's good enough! Sending big hugs your way!**

4

ConcernedMomma05

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vor 8 Monaten

How old is he ??

We did Dr Bionics videos on YouTube that talked about peeing/pooping . Poop was harder than pee but he was potty trained by 3.

3

ProperBlacksmith9970

•

vor 8 Monaten

So sorry, my level 1 girl learned how to use the potty for #1 at almost 3 ... Mostly because I hate potty training and dread it. I still haven't tackled #2... she refuses and I'm not about to force her. My adhd girl age 11 now did the same to me and she figured at 6 or 7 none else uses diapers For

2 so one day she pooped in the toilet

3

Momma-Writer-Prof21

•

vor 8 Monaten

Training pants and lots of encouragement and lots of consistency helped our level one son (also has sensory issues and ADHD). We started at 3 and it took about a year and a half for him to want to go poop in the potty. He had a few accidents after he got the hang of the big potty, but we always said it's all right little dude you'll get it! Keep working at it! Always being positive helps, especially when it's something different like potty time.

3

VanityInk

•

vor 8 Monaten

We put a pull up on and off for over 2 years with different attempts at potty training. There's nothing wrong with stepping back and regrouping before trying again later.

3

Dorothy_the_cat

•

vor 8 Monaten

Potty training my son was a mess. I always say the daycare did it for me. They started my son at 3 ish and he would come home and I would put a diaper on him because he had constant accidents and would have massive meltdowns if we asked him to try and use the toilet at regular intervals (what the daycare was doing). I had a baby and was battling post partum and it was just too much.

I made an effort at 3.5 to give rewards for pees and poops (smarties/stickers and books (my parent's saved a bunch of my magic school bus books from when I was a kid!)) and for some reason it finally clicked. But he still has accidents at school a lot and we had some constipation issues when he was 5 where he had poop accidents. It definitely won't be a linear line but you both will get there.

You aren't a shirt parent at all. It's ok to wait and bit and try again. Be kind to yourself, you are doing a great job.

3

mutantmanifesto

•

vor 8 Monaten

My level 1 didn't manage until 4.5. She had to decide she was ready. There was literally no way to force her. She would have panic attacks until one day she didn't! Hang in there.

3

Avatar von u/redthump

redthump

•
vor 8 Monaten
**It'll happen, eventually. One of the finest days you will experience is when you no longer have to deal with your kid's poop. Mine got it and regressed a couple of times, but it is happily in the past now. Now

if he'd just talk.**
3
ILikeHornedAnimals
•
vor 8 Monaten
Hang in there soldier!!! It took my son till almost 4!
5
Avatar von u/Comfortable_Cup8908
Comfortable_Cup8908
•
vor 8 Monaten
My three and a half year old is still in pull ups and I sometimes contemplate just investing in Huggies and giving up. 😊
2
internal_logging
•
vor 8 Monaten
My son is apparently doing great at ABA and is basically potty trained there but at home he screams and won't even go near the potty. 🙄🙄🙄🙄🙄
And yes, I too got a fucking puppy who's now behind on potty training because I'm just beyond burnt out from cleaning up piss
2
Avatar von u/Reyvakitten
Reyvakitten
•
vor 8 Monaten
I hope it gets better. If it will make you feel better, I'm failing, too lol. Just keep doing your best at it. Persistence is key, or so they say.
PS: I don't really think you're failing. ☹

2
Tiny_State3711
•
vor 8 Monaten
I potty trained my son for over a year. One day, he just didn't need to be reminded. He didn't need help. He didn't even want me in the bathroom, and he decided he no longer needed pull-ups anymore. He was 4 years old at this point.
Keep in mind I had plenty of times where I felt I screwed up. I also felt like a shit parent. I had my husband sayin, \"You're not doing something right, \" \"The reason he's not potty trained is because of you,\" etc.
My husband had even taken over and potty trained his way for 2 weeks and told me, \"He's just not ready yet.\"
So, give yourself a little grace. Give your child a little patience. Get back up eventually and dust things off when you both are feeling better. It will happen. You got this. 🍀

2

PotatoPillo

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vor 8 Monaten

I have no idea exactly when it happened for us, because there was progress, then regressions, then progress, then regressions. The last few years have been great during the day (he's 10), but after trying a few times, last summer the nighttime finally clicked. The Bear in the Big Blue House has a cute potty episode.

2

InvestigatorTall6740

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vor 8 Monaten

Mine was four. We tried off and on for WEEKS and the week after we gave up - he did it all on his own. 🐸 I guess he didn't like the pressure!

2

Ploppers00

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vor 8 Monaten

We ordered a little urinal from Amazon in the shape of a frog. It had a little red tongue that would spin if you hit it with your pee stream. That solidified #1 potty training for my son.

2

1 weitere Antwort

Avatar von u/Own_Ad_6137

Own_Ad_6137

•

vor 8 Monaten

Our daughter was about 3 months away from primary school before she started using the toilet. Wouldn't have a bar of it until one day it just switched and started using the toilet.

2

Avatar von u/Massive-Plantain-829

Massive-Plantain-829

•

vor 8 Monaten

My son was the same way and we just waited until he was ready and didn't really "train". Still asked and tried to get him into the routine of trying to go after his bath at night. We did have support as he was in pre-k and ABA but one day he just started going and it's been a year and half. He has had less than 10 accidents since. Recurring thing with him is being stubborn about learning new skills then totally mastering them out of the blue one day. Lol

2

shedsareunderrated

•

vor 8 Monaten

**I don't know how old your kid is but for ours (almost six) we reframed it. He's capable of doing stuff himself but he entirely lacks awareness of his own bodily functions. He's just not ready to potty train. On the other hand, I'm sick of changing nappies and I'm sure his teachers are too! So we looked at independence over training. Kid is

very capable of taking his own nappy off, and can put it in the bin. He can wipe himself (a bit, with help). With encouragement, he can put a fresh one on and get his pants back up. And that, I'd say, is pretty bloody successful. Training may or may not come along later, I've read that between 7 and 9 is a typical age for autistic kids with a potty training delay. But meanwhile I'm not going to stress about it, or get him worked up about it. For us it's been about just teaching him to have a little independence, to take care of himself, instead of rushing him to train before he's ready.**

2

journeyreward123

•

vor 8 Monaten

Thankfully, my 7 year old can change herself fairly well, but still won't go on the toilet 🚽

2

SeriesMindless

•

vor 8 Monaten

Took us till 6. It's hard. Don't get discouraged. If they don't get it organically, just keep talking about it calmly and encouragingly.
There could be a real sensory disconnect there that needs to form. It was that way for us. Eventually at lvl 1 the child will simply get it and understand. Like, conversationally. They need to learn their body as well.

As an older child becomes embarrassed you may not want to openly discuss it in situations. We phrased it as "what's your body telling you?" "Listen to your body" type language.

1

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 8 Monaten

ThePwnR4nger

•

vor 8 Monaten

Lvl 1 4yo son here. We finally are making progress at home. Here's what we've done:

Put a portable potty in the living room

No Pants on

Put on Ms. Rachel's new potty training video. We have watched it like 15 times in the past 10 days.

Place child on potty while they watch it.

Little dude asked to go potty WHILE WE WERE AT CHUCK E CHEESE a few days ago after a week of this. He's made so much progress, and we've even gotten a few poops.

1

kikisaurus

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vor 8 Monaten

**My Level 2 kiddo didn't have interest in the toilet until about 4.5. We did pull ups, stickers, treats, mattress covers, plastic sheets, everything we could think of and at one point he took to peeing on the couch instead of going to the bathroom...nothing worked. When I say one day he woke up and decided he wanted to use the toilet and has been with

minimal accidents in the 3.5 years since, I mean that is literally what happened. You're not a shit parent and he'll get there eventually. One kind person reminded me when I was struggling that it's not like you see high schoolers strutting across the stage in diapers when they graduate, so it'll happen. Hang in there.**

1

LilWitch1472

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vor 8 Monaten

Our girl just turned 4 and while sitting on the potty every 2 hours is part of the routine (and has been for the past year), she absolutely refuses to actually go on the potty. She totally understands what is supposed to happen, we talk about it, we have rewards in place, but here we are. She has a sensory block/anxiety of some sort about letting go on the potty that we are hopeful time will solve. We might try a cold turkey switch to underwear at some point in the future. But trust me - you are not a bad parent. For many kids, ND or not, it ultimately has to be their decision. Keep at it, be patient, and don't force it. If your kiddo is refusing the potty, take a little break and revisit it in a couple months.

1

Avatar von u/No-Builder-2164

No-Builder-2164

•

vor 8 Monaten

My kiddo seemed interested in potty training around 2 1/2-3 (really into potty books and songs) and wanting to wear underwear to school. But it caused so many tears and it was clearly making him anxious to actually have use the potty. Sticker charts and bribery did nothing. So we just stopped pushing it until 4 and then it was breeze.

1

Avatar von u/AlchemistAnna

AlchemistAnna

•

vor 8 Monaten

Yesterday one of our toddlers decided to take off her diaper (becoming her pattern) during her nap and roll around in her poop then stand up and stomp in it. I don't think you're doing anything wrong, it's just a process. I'm hoping it's a quick process but so far there's a lot of poop stomping 🙄

1

Avatar von u/Maleficent_Count_136

Maleficent_Count_136

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vor 8 Monaten

My granddaughter was not progressing with toileting. She loves watching screens and often copies the actions. Recruited her favourite 15 year old female cousin, made a video of cousin using toilet with commentary from Mum. Gave granddaughter the video to watch on her iPad, toilet skills ensued very quickly!!

1

mevaletuopinion

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****vor 8 Monaten****

****I have 4 kids. First two kids(NT)went to childcare since birth and were potty trained by the staff. My last two (ND) one is potty trained and the youngest not potty trained. I don't have a clue how to encourage a child with autism. It's hard to gauge his understanding of why and how to do it. I'm also worried about it for kindergarten. I'm probably a worse parent bc I'm not even trying to train him bc I don't get how to do it.****

****1****

****No-Passenger2600****

****•****

****vor 8 Monaten****

****The book "oh crap potty training" saved me. I was you!!! I read that book and it was so much easier after that. It's a totally chill stress free method (for kids and adults) to potty training. Highly recommend!!! Actually made me LOVE potty training, and again everything you're saying that was me!! I was hysterical crying the first time I hated myself as a parent****

****1****

****Avatar von u/NYBKNC****

****NYBKNC****

****•****

****vor 8 Monaten****

****So we havent started trying with our almost 4 year old yet because when I did try I found him just standing in a puddle of pee and he truly could not have cared less, BUT I have been talking to his OT/BCBA and SLP about how we could possibly go about it so I thought I\'d share.****

****Strict schedule - every 20-30 min, go sit on the potty. Even if they don\'t feel like they have to go.****

****If there is a sensory issue, she once helped a kid by letting them sit in their diaper on the potty and then cut a little hole in the diaper and slowly started making the hole bigger til eventually it was off****

****Apparently there is some sensory thing you can buy that is a little alarm that goes off when they have wet their diaper so you can start to track what their natural schedule is and then get them to the potty before they go.****

****For boys, esp since you\'re potty training a puppy too, if you have a private yard, let him go outside with the dog!****

****Above all, they have all told us it will take a lot of patience and probably a lot more time than a NT kid. Good luck.****

****1****

****Avatar von u/Positive_Strain3226****

****Positive_Strain3226****

****•****

****vor 8 Monaten****

****I have twins who are about to be 5. They both just potty trained within the last 6 months. I honestly waited until they were ready. My level 1 started using the potty around Feb this year and my level 2 has been using potty since May. Just take it one day at a time and maybe do it when he is ready.****

****1****

****PM_ME_YOUR_DND_SHEET****

****•****

****vor 8 Monaten****

Yeah we don't really shame fellow parents here. We get it. It can be rough, especially potty training. I will say that we paused potty training for a few months last year while my youngest was learning. When we came back to it after the break things went a lot better.

Sometimes taking a break from it can be really helpful for everyone.
1

Avatar von u/RichardCleveland

RichardCleveland

•

vor 8 Monaten

Tell him that he's racing the puppy.

1

GENTLEHULK

•

vor 8 Monaten

**My daughter just turned 4.5 and JUST started using the potty. There is

a good Little Critter's book called "My New Potty" that I read to my daughter every night. There is also a couple Daniel Tiger episodes that tackle potty training that are really helpful. I tried at 2, she wasn't ready, I tried at 2.5 she wasn't ready, I tried at 3 and she kept throwing a fit, I tried at 3.5 and she pee'd once using the "just be naked in the house" method which caused a ton of accidents... then we kinda gave up til one day we kept inundating her with this potty content: books, tv shows I mentioned and finally around 4.5 she started embracing it. We lie to her and tell her her underwear has super powers and get her underwear in her favorite color etc.**

1

journeyreward123

•

vor 8 Monaten

Working on this with my 7 year old. 😞

1

Medium-Cheek-6478

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vor 8 Monaten

For my son, it took his preschool teacher telling him he had to wear underwear to school. He was almost 5 at that point and fully capable of using the potty...he just didn't want to do it. As soon as he got home from school he asked for his pull up. Being the quick thinker I was, I told him they only made bedtime pull ups in his size so he could have one, but he would have to go to bed. He thought about it for a moment and said he'd just stay in his underwear. From that day on, he wore underwear during the day. We kept him in pull ups at night until he was around 6.

1

niewueyork

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vor 8 Monaten

**Yeah 11 4.5 years age of first training. We used a reward based program. Unfortunately I can't find the webinar series but it was posted here before. It's here:

<https://www.actcommunity.ca/education/videos/toilet-training-for-everyone-revised-and-expanded/>

1

****Avatar von u/RelationshipSharp964****

****RelationshipSharp964****

****•****

****vor 8 Monaten****

****I used to be a nanny and successfully potty trained multiple children. I potty trained my oldest who also has autism. My youngest? It's an absolute circus and it's been almost 3 years at this point. I've dug deep into potty rewards because nothing seems to entice him. (Candy. Fruit snacks. Confetti. mini piñatas. Treasure chest. Helium tank with balloons.) I tried fun pee targets in the toilet. Multiple different kinds of potties and toppers. No pants, underpants, training pants, cloth diapers, pull ups. Doesn't matter. He doesn't care. He is soooooo demand avoidant that he will do anything to avoid the potty. Even if I let him just leave him naked and he starts peeing, he stops himself from peeing more and rejects his own bodily demand and has a meltdown.****

****To save my sanity and prove to school that we're making some kind of progress in this department, I've pivoted to just teaching him to change his own diapers. Not ideal but so far all week anytime I've been like "hey you need a dry diaper!" He will run and change himself without a fight.****

****nächster post:****

****Effective Potty training methods for autistic children?****

****We attempted to potty train my child last December at 2.5 using the Oh Crap method - the attempt did not go well. They received a diagnosis of autism (level 2) so I'm trying to find the most effective potty training methods for children with developmental disabilities before attempting again. My main concern is that she does not feel uncomfortable in a soaked or poopy diaper and I think that key piece of readiness is missing and am not sure how to work around it.****

****For children with level 1 and level 2 autism, when did your children become potty trained and what method did you use?****

****35****

****•****

****53****

****Kommentarbereich****

****Avatar von u/a_lot_of_cables****

****a_lot_of_cables****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****What I didn't like about the oh crap book is that it states not to use explicit reinforcers like candy, etc. that might work for NT kids who can get by on social praise, but even then it seems very counterintuitive. We gave our kid unlimited tv access and reinforced every successful potty with cotton candy (a preferred treat). Check my post history for more details. We were very successful at 3.5 years over thanksgiving weekend****

****29****

****Defiant_Ad_8489****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****She also states that after 3 or so it'll be more difficult to potty train and emphasized a certain period of time, which ran contrary to so many parents sharing that after 3 is was so much easier to potty train**

their kids. This goes for NT or ND kids. I just stopped reading her book about 50 pages in since my kid didn't seem ready at the time (he was 2). I don't feel like I need to come back to it.**

Some people like Jamie Glowacki, but she comes across as very dogmatic and rude. I have two of her books, and while I appreciate that she has a personality, it can be pretty harsh.

19

nothanks86

•

vor 2 Jahren

Why on earth would it be harder to potty train someone who's three or older? I mean, what's her logic? Like 'no thank you, parents, the more aware I am of social norms and peer pressure, the more I choose to keep on peeing in this diaper. Toilets, not for me! '

14

Defiant_Ad_8489

•

vor 2 Jahren

**Her reasoning is that once they reach that age they will be more defiant and push boundaries, so it makes them harder to train. :/ **

2

russkigirl

•

vor 2 Jahren

Just so inaccurate for my kids. It was absolutely a waiting game with both of them, and if I had tried any harder to train them earlier with that kind of thing in mind, I would have driven myself crazy. My older son trained a couple months ago just before he turned 6, my younger is 3.5 and recently tells us he needs to go once in a while and we offer him opportunities throughout the day and at school, but is still in pull ups. Both of them are very defiant in their own ways, and it was not easy with my older son at all, but once it clicked it was very fast to train him, because he had complete control over his body, he just needed to shift from preventing himself from going to going intentionally, which happened eventually with rewards and patience.

3

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 2 Jahren

tap soft humor smile foolish hobbies station elderly butter husky

This post was mass deleted and anonymized with Redact

4

1 weitere Antwort

1 weitere Antwort

\[gelöscht\]

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vor 2 Jahren

We started potty training a little before age 3 and I can finally say that after a little more than a year we are fully potty trained. My child also didn't really care about being wet with a diaper or pull up on, and the whole pull up and panties combo didn't phase her either.

So here's what we did:

**No more diapers. We only wore a pull up for naps and bedtime. Yes, there were messes....messes all kinds of places, but that's when she

really felt it. She did not like the pee dripping down her legs, wet pants, wet car seats, etc.**

Keep track of pee and bowel movements to know how often they are going.

When we first started we were taking her every 15 minutes to the toilet. If she peed on the toilet we would increase to 30. Peed her pants? Back to 15. As we got better it was every hour.

Make the potty fun. Find songs on YT and all that. Books are cool too.

Reinforcers. In the beginning I would give her a gummy just for sitting on the potty. If she relieved herself on the potty she would get two. Eventually we phased out of the sitting gummies and she only got them when she voided on the potty. Then we got a Dino sticker chart where if she pottied so many times per day she would win a prize. Keep reinforcers fresh and add new things.

Peer pressure. She goes to school with an RBT and she was in potty trained classrooms. Watching other kids go was a huge reinforcer for her.

Towards the end we used a potty watch so that she can go on her own and be more independent.

Patience.

29

supajamu

•

vor 2 Jahren

We had an ABA therapist enforce a reward system at school. The key was adopting the same system at home and being consistent.

If the kiddo goes number 1, 4 skittles are rewarded. If they go number 2, 8 skittles are rewarded.

This was ground breaking for us, our kiddo is now fully potty trained at 7. Number 1 came quick, number 2 took a couple years.

Hang in there, and make sure the same reward system is used in all places the kiddo may be, at home, school, grandparents, etc.

Good luck!

18

Avatar von u/Korwinga

Korwinga

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vor 2 Jahren

We had an ABA therapist enforce a reward system at school. The key was adopting the same system at home and being consistent.

This is where we're at right now. They've gone for about a month now with no accidents at school, though it's still been just number 1 at school (I'm fairly certain he holds in the number 2 until he gets home). He even will use the bathroom in public, like at a grocery store or whatever.

**But at home, we have a lot of difficulty getting him to use the potty. He sits great, and looks like he's going to pee, but then he just doesn't, and he waits until he's off before doing on the floor in the hallway instead. He also loves to strip naked at home, which means that messes are just wherever he happens to be. I know that we just have to be consistent with him, but it's a lot more difficult at home where we have the chaos of the household and siblings interfering. I know that he

will get there eventually, but the journey is hard.**

5

2 weitere Antworten

Avatar von u/Gretel_Cosmonaut

Gretel_Cosmonaut

•

vor 2 Jahren

I used the \"try everything\" method at age 3. Then the \"give up\" method at age 4.

At age 7, my kid woke up one day and was fully potty trained. He just flipped like a switch.

15

HimylittleChickadee

•

vor 2 Jahren

Hello! Below is a copy and paste of a reply I've left on different potty training posts - hope its helpful!

Ok, so we started potty training my guy when he turned 3. The Director of our therapy provider built a plan for us because she specializes in toileting.

**First thing is we got a picture of a potty with a baggie stapled to it. In the baggie we put smarties (his favourite candy at the time). We

told him that when he sits on the potty and when he pees and poos in the potty, he gets a smartie. We got a toilet seat insert that goes over the regular potty to make it more comfortable for him. We also got a step stool that sat in front of the potty - he used it to get on the potty and rest his feet on when he was using it.**

Then we started. The diaper came off and he stayed in his underwear. We set a timer for 15 minutes. Every 15 mins we'd put him on the potty and say, time to pee? Time to poo? Even if he didn't pee or poo, we'd get excited for him and he'd get a smartie. If he started to pee or poo not on the potty, we'd carry him to the potty and have him finish on it. He'd also get a smartie for that.

The next day it changed to every 30 mins and then the next day every 45 mins then every hour the day after. My husband is a stay at home Dad so this worked for us. We also started to phase out the smartie reward by first only giving it when he peed or pooped and then we stopped giving them all together.

I believe he ended up having 2 accidents, which he really hated because he didn't like the feeling of being wet in his underwear at all. We also slept him in his underwear right off the bat because his Therapist said it's confusing for them to go back and forth from underwear to diapers. Before too long we didn't have to take him to the potty anymore, he just said when he needed to go. He has some fine motor challenges, so at first we had to help getting underwear / pants up and down, but he's gotten much better with that.

All the best to you and your family

12

1 weitere Antwort

Avatar von u/One_Struggle_

One_Struggle_

•

vor 2 Jahren

Level 2 around 5yrs.

****This is what we did. Honestly if I committed more, probably would have been potty trained by 4.****

****Before starting, can your child pull down & pull up their pants? Your kiddo needs this dexterity 1st otherwise you're setting them up for failure.****

****Find the perfect bribe, for us it was Skittles. Get kiddo comfortable just sitting on toilet & waiting. Toys, tablet & timer w/bribe reinforcement. Once your kiddo is able to sit about 5 minutes on the toilet can move onto the actual training.****

****I took a week off of work & ordered these training underwear. I like the brand as it goes up to size 9 for older kids, which is helpful for over night training.****

****MooMoo Baby Potty Training Underwear 10 Packs Absorbent Toddler Training Pants for Boys and Girls Cotton Pee Pants 2T-9T
<https://a.co/d/0g6IvAct>****

****Create a visual social story (kid on potty, pic of potty with urine & pick of bribe). Laminate or put it in a clear folder.****

****Pull ups are not your friend, they wick away moisture & you want them to be uncomfortable for motivation, hence the thick cotton training underwear.****

****Camp out near the bathroom. I covered the couch in plastic/blankets to protect it.****

****Offered juice, ice pops, etc & took to the potty every 15 min & waited 2 minutes. Show social story & explain if pee or poop in potty, you get bribe****

****If goes in potty, bribe item & praise. As they become more successful at going in potty, bring to the bathroom every 30 min, then hourly. By the end of the week was potty trained for day time. We then weaned off the bribe. He generally just wants his tablet when sitting to go potty.****

****Nights took a little longer. We still used the thick underwear, but put a washable pad under him in case of an accident so we didn't have to deal with changing the bed in the middle of the night & starting limiting liquids after dinner.****

****RMS Ultra Soft 4-Layer Washable and Reusable Incontinence Bed Pad - Waterproof Bed pads, 18"x24" (3 Pack) <https://a.co/d/00be5Inb>****

****After a year, he was fully potty trained (no accidents because of distractions, etc) and switched to regular underwear.****

****Good luck!****

****10****

****CutestFarts****

****•****

****vor 1 Jahr****

****I just want to add - you're not offering bribes. Bribes are not helpful to most children, especially ND. It can actually make things worse.****

****You're offering a reward. Because they did what you asked. Bribes are**

given before performing, with the promise that they will do what you ask.**

****This distinction is actually very important with ND kids, so it's important to make sure we're using the correct terminology to avoid confusion to parents/caregivers looking for advice.****

****7****

\[gelöscht\]

deetzjuice91

•

vor 2 Jahren

So we did the poops first. Everytime she had to poop we put her on a potty. This was around 2 years old.

Then we started with peeing. She was 2.5 years old. First I tried letting her run around naked for a day and bringing her to the potty every 15 -30 minutes but that didn't work. If I put underwear on her, she would just pee in her underwear, thinking it was a diaper.

So what really worked for us was baggy pants without underwear. She hated the feeling of pee dripping down her leg and the way the pants were sticking to her legs. On the first day of trying this, there were a few accidents yes. But on third day she got it. Day and night immediately. Sure there were still accidents on rare occasions, maybe once a month usually at night but that didn't really bother me.

I never put any pressure on her. Ok, you've peed your pants and we will do better next time. Let's clean you up and you're good to go.

And we did the no underwear and baggy pants for 1-2 weeks and then I slowly started to introduce underwear to her. First I had some underwear that was a bit bigger. So if there was an accident, she would still have the feeling of pee running down. And after a few days we moved to her size.

6

1 weitere Antwort

Avatar von u/struggleneverends

struggleneverends

•

vor 2 Jahren

**I just posted this resource in another post regarding potty training but here it is again:

<https://www.actcommunity.ca/education/videos/toilet-training-for-everyone-revised-and-expanded/>**

Hope it helps.

6

1 weitere Antwort

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 2 Jahren

We potty trained right before kindergarten. He wasn't required to potty train as he was coded special needs but I wanted him to start kindergarten like the other kids if possible.

It was easier with my husband out of the house (he had a week long work trip) so I took a week off and got it done. That way everything was at least consistent (no confusion with me, dad and daycare workers).

Stickers, rewards, charts etc had all previously failed probably because everyone was doing different things.

Laid down towels, stayed home for a week and just did it the old fashioned way. Trained him sitting down (as I don't stand to pee lol).

What helped me was someone telling me my kid ready to toilet train and it was me not ready for him to toilet train. And that I'd just been making excuses as he was low verbal. So once I got my head in the space that it was possible, it was.

5

****Avatar von u/Kezhen****

****Kezhen****

****Poster*in****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****When you say the old-fashioned way, do you mean bottomless?****

****2****

****1 weitere Antwort****

****Electrical_Beyond998****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****Mine was about 4 when he was potty trained for daytime. About nine before he could stop using pull-ups for night. I stopped fighting it and just let him do what he needed to do to get himself ready. No matter what method I tried, and I would stick with each one for about three weeks, he just wasn't interested. One day I guess he just got tired of using pull-ups and made himself get up at night to use the bathroom.****

****4****

****Cat-mom-at-law****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****I recommend the book Ready, Set, Potty which is written about autistic and developmentally delayed kids. It's on Amazon. My son is level 2, we have been potty training for two years and I would say we are 95% there.****

****4****

****ShabuShabu2018****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****I tried a gazillion methods. Gave up for months. Then one day used the bribery method... and it worked. Promised him a trip to the toy shop to get his favourite truck if he used the toilet. He's been dry ever since then! 4,5 years old.****

****3****

****Avatar von u/Critical-Positive-85****

****Critical-Positive-85****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****Behaviorism tactics had zero percent success with my kiddo. We tried the sticker charts, the rewarding with a "treat", prizes, etc. but ultimately he could not have cared less about those things. We had also tried the whole take away the diapers thing... but that back fired big time. He needed to be in control of when and how he learned to use the toilet. Ultimately all we did was read books about going potty, invited him to see us (mom and dad) use the bathroom to normalize it, and offer "diaper or underwear?" each morning when getting dressed. He finally decided, around 4.5, that he would try underwear. And that was that. A**

handful of accidents happened, particularly if he was dysregulated. While the lead up to getting him to use the potty was extremely frustrating, the overall "training" was pretty simple. It's been a few months now and we haven't looked back. Still in pull-ups for nighttime, and I don't expect that to change anytime soon.**

****3****

****honeybvbymom****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****i'm struggling because my 3 year old is NOT at all bothered by being soiled. i don't think it'll be possible until then. :/****

****3****

****1 weitere Antwort****

****cici92814****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****To be honest, theres no one size fits all with potty training. It\'s all about trial and error. I started training my kid around 2.5. I made sure he was OK with toilet sounds, made sure he knew what the toilet was for, we watched a lot of potty videos. I mostly followed the oh crap method supplemented with PECS in the bathroom. I dedicated 2 months straight. I had him bottomless during the day, and with underwear at night. I utilized puppy pads on his bed. We used A LOT of praise when he peed in the potty, and gummies when he pooped in it. We didn\'t wake him up in the middle of the night to pee, only if he popped on himself. I would say he wasn\'t FULLY potty trained till about 5 years old. Lots of accidents before then.****

****3****

****RWRM18929****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****I combined like 3 different methods and only did rewards for poop (not candy) and lots of encouragement.****

****The naked method, did not go anywhere for probably the first week or so. No underwear in regular clothes, just commando. Less stuff to pull down for them for when they did have clothes on, plus it's less confusing.****

****Also did a timer every 30 min, then increased as needed/gradual progress. When sitting on the potty, we counted till 10 to consider it trying. (This gets really tiring, but they get the point)****

****Once we started doing well, whenever there was regression/lack of motivation we basically "grounded" them from favorite things (shows,games, etc) till they were back on track a couple times again consistently. They just get so dang distracted easily that going potty was low on their totem pole of importance.****

****Now we have set times that we prompt to go. Morning when we wake up, after lunch, after dinner, and before bed. If they are rooty tooting a lot and it stinky, then we prompt them to go poop right away.****

****2****

****Mother_of_Kiddens****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****Your child may not be ready. Mine isn't yet at age 4, as frustrating as it is. If you find that the advice here doesn't resonate with you and/or doesn't work, you may need to table it. I wanted to get therapy for my son to help and was basically turned away saying it's normal for autistic boys to not potty train until 5 or 6yo.****

****2****

****Kosmosu****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****I wish I could help. Our 4-year-old nonverbal child has low sensory processing, so he doesn't really feel it all that much. So we have to watch for cues and follow a solid, strict schedule. We have had some success but not enough for him to \"get it.\"****

****People often ask what I mean by low sensory processing. It's things like extremely high pain tolerance, does not notice when something is touching him, doesn't seem to care if his underwear is wet, and can spin for a good solid while without getting dizzy. Things like that. For goodness sake, my kiddo has had 4 stitches on his chin already and took the whole thing like a complete champ. The only reason why he got upset was because we had to hold him steady because he struggled to stop moving.****

****2****

****Hope_for_tendies****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****They'll get it when they are ready. Just try again like once a month or every other month. Being wet never bothered my son either but when he was finally ready he picked up potty training in about a week.****

****Lots of positive reinforcement, for pooping I actually took him to the store to pick out a toy and we left it out with him knowing he could have it once he pooped in the toilet lol. You can get some dollar store items or even just like an m and m or something for successful peeing.****

****It is constant reminders and years of butt wiping to follow, unfortunately.****

****3****

****Avatar von u/General_Elephant****

****General_Elephant****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****If you put underwear over the diaper/pull-up it causes more discomfort if they go so they naturally retain more. Pairing that with having the child see their parent use the bathroom (weird but effective if you feel comfortable doing it) they get the hang of it a bit quicker.****

****Also scheduled attempts every 30 mins or so help.****

****2****

****Flimsy-Judge****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****My kids' doctor told us that they'd be potty trained as soon as their nervous systems were ready, and advised us to gently suggest but never force them. At 3.5 my daughter basically potty trained herself all I did was letting her go \"Donald Duck\" (wearing nothing below waist). She was day and night potty trained in 2 weeks. For my son, it took a weekend, but we aren't sure if he's ND as well.****

****1****

****Pomelo-Tall****

****•****

****vor 2 Jahren****

****3.5/4 for each kid, and what worked was waiting until they were ready. Seriously. Easiest potty training ever because I didn't force it before they were ready****

1
 Avatar von u/matte_t
 matte_t
 •
 vor 2 Jahren
 Tbh, my kid wasn't fully potty trained until about 6 when he he had to be for school. It was on and off for 2 years. #1 was easy, but #2 he would be so distracted with what he was doing, he would soil himself when he couldn't hold it in. We had to use a reward system. I would say wait until they are ready. Otherwise, they'll regress.
 1
 Specialist-Smoke
 •
 vor 2 Jahren
 My husband started taking my son to the bathroom. He would ask if he had to go. I allowed him to run free around the house as long as he went to the bathroom. He was first potty trained at 5, but he regressed. By 7 he was fully potty trained at home and school. He sleeps in his pull ups and wears one for long car rides..
 1
 LazyClerk408
 •
 vor 2 Jahren
 Candy, putting them on these toilet ever. 1-2 hours celebrating the wins had help from Aba n school good luck
 1
 Parttimelooker
 •
 vor 2 Jahren
 Wait till he's 4. Too early.

 1
 Stunning_Ad4419
 •
 vor 2 Jahren
 **With my oldest, he was nearly 5 before he could be in underwear during the day. He was 7 when he was fully potty trained. It was breaking routine that he hated. I created a sticker chart, set up rewards, started with low demands, and kept him nude at home for 5 days straight. I never used food as a reward. He has access to water, meals and saltier snacks. My washing machine hated me. Waterproof bed liners, every sheet you can find.. yep, get prepared for a week of pee and poop everywhere... Kid peed on curtains, carpet, rugs. Ect.... But we made it, so just be prepared. Within a week, we were essentially accident free and in regular underwear. Introduced sticker chart, set timer for 5 minutes. Treated it like a game... level 1, all he had to do was go to the bathroom on his own for 3 times, each time, earning a sticker... BAM, first reward... a toy truck from the dollar store. That carried on where that demand was all that was asked for half the first day. Next level... go to bathroom and lift toilet lid.... He knew what he was earning ahead of time. Next level, increase wait time to 10 minutes... you get the idea.... I showed him the timer, his sticker chart, everything... The visuals helped. He also got a ton of positive reinforcements, and absolutely ZERO response if he did not reach goal or peed everywhere. Poop was harder to train, as he would like to hold it

in until I put him in a night time trainer pant, so just focus on pee.**
1

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 2 Jahren

We got lucky. At around 3 years of age. We put our son in day care due to our hybrid work schedule. Somehow he followed and learnt from the other kids and the rest was history. We do have to help wipe but we'll take the win. This was only 3 months of daycare as we now WFH. He's now 4.5.

Not sure if daycare will help? Toddler gathering?

1

Avatar von u/Kezhen

Kezhen

Poster*in

•

vor 2 Jahren

She's going to inclusive preschool in the fall so I hope that will help.

2

1 weitere Antwort

Defiant_Ad_8489

•

vor 2 Jahren

The Autism Consultant

I haven't used her course but I bought a course from another person that uses a lot of the same techniques. I haven't tried potty training my son yet but I've done a lot of the preparation for it so he isn't afraid of it. I just gotta roll my sleeves up and start.

0

phyl21

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vor 1 Jahr

My 3.5 year old just started school and we still haven't been able to potty train him. I have tried everything at this point.

1

Avatar von u/Flame-Flower812

Flame-Flower812

•

vor 1 Jahr

My grandson just turned six and has no interest in toilet training. HELP!

1

Avatar von u/Even-Ad-7240

Even-Ad-7240

•

vor 1 Jahr

**Being \"ready\" to potty train is based upon whether or not your child noticing something is happening. Grabbing front part of pants or grunting to have a bowel movement. Be able to change their underwear. These are observable moments where either a language prompt needs to take place or a movement to the toileting area. Children really need to be dry or drier upon waking up after 8 hrs of sleep to try any

timed method. The bladder needs to be big enough to hold urine for a period of time. When ready (listed above) remove pull up/diaper place in underwear only and begin observations. They will have accidents throughout the day, it is how you react that matters most. When an accident occurs, let them change their underwear themselves and be reminded they should sit on the toilet before peeing in their pants. No one likes urine running down their leg! I am not a big fan of giving kids a reward of any kind. After all the reward is staying dry.**

nächster post:

I Can't Potty Train My Kid

I don't know what I'm supposed to do. My 5 year old starts kindergarten in the fall and we already know he'll be in the special needs class, but I want him to be potty trained before then. We've been trying on and off for years and nothing really seems to work. We tried setting him on the toilet every hour or so - he'd scream and fight the whole time. Eventually he'd let us put him on it but it seemed like he would withhold. We tried encouraging him to tell us "potty" when he has to go or catching him preparing to go - he has super poor interoception skills and won't say anything. He doesn't even squat, so there's no warning that he's about to go. We tried letting him soil himself without a diaper on, just pants - he barely notices. He plays in water with socks and sneakers on so wet clothes are nothing to him. We tried a sticker system - he didn't care. The only thing we haven't tried is letting him run around the house without clothes on his bottom half. People we know with neurotypical kids said it works super well, but I really don't want to try that. Half of my house is carpet and my kid is hard to wrangle. Has anyone found any other method that worked for them?*

27

47

Kommentarbereich

SylviaPellicore

vor 2 Monaten

**This is the absolute best resource I know for potty training autistic

kids. It's a long course, but it's totally free.**

<https://youtube.com/playlist?list=PLHFkezvbgdDZatJWdty-NHAn2jSJdxSOB>

33

aliie_627

vor 2 Monaten

Do you know if this is appropriate for a kid with lower receptive communication but does catch on if interested (I don't know if that is the correct term) and no verbal skills, some on his AAC and signs?*

3

StrayGoldfish

vor 2 Monaten

I used it for my son who had very little receptive communication at the time, and it worked so well for him.

They talk about giving the child a method to communicate the need to potty, but that communication can be in any form: on an AAC, via sign language, pointing, etc.

3
1 weitere Antwort
SylviaPellicore
•
vor 2 Monaten
Yes, it covers kids at all levels of communication. (In fact, the full method might be too much for fully verbal kids. We toned it down for my level 1 kid.)
3
1 weitere Antwort
1 weitere Antwort
AuDHDacious
•

vor 2 Monaten
My son was potty trained at school well before being potty trained at home. Seeing all the other kids do it made him want to try.
27
bluev0lta
•
vor 2 Monaten
Yep! Teachers/aides can help with this as well. That's how my daughter was potty trained (for peeing at least). Her teachers encouraged her to use the toilet and she would. Nothing we did at home worked, and we tried everything we could think of on and off for probably three years.
She's level 1, 7yo, and now she will pee but not poop in the toilet. She's just not ready. OP, I suspect your son isn't ready. Many of us have this same experience! It sucks but you have to meet them where they are.
13
curlysqirelly
•
vor 2 Monaten
Yes, I completely agree with this. My son decided he was ready right before kindergarten started but if he hadn't that would've been ok too! I totally understand what you are going through, though. I stressed myself out over it, and looking back I wish I hadn't put so much pressure on him or myself!
3
Jessiey81
•
vor 2 Monaten
When my son was 5 I had tried everything as well, what ended up working for my son is he loves Mario (even now) and his potty was white so inside the bowl I drew a couple question blocks, a cpl gumbas and I think 1 or 2 of the shells and had him aim to hit the targets inside his bowl, sure there were a ton of misses but he caught on and loved peeing. The pooping issue was a tad harder but once he realized he could poop and look (little icky but whatever worked) he seemed pleased and by the time he turned 6 he could do both no problems, I mean I still was wiping his bottom at that point and helping him wash his hands but thats all

10
ExistingAd3115

****Poster*in****
****•****
****vor 2 Monaten****
****My son also loves Mario! I haven't found a kid's potty that will fit my son (he's 5 but is the size of a 7 year old), so we have him on the normal sized toilet with that step stool toilet seat thing.****
****7****
****Jessiey81****
****•****
****vor 2 Monaten****
****If you own your toilet you can drain the water and use permanent markers, I contemplated it but my boy stayed quite small for awhile do to seizure meds, so he fit his potty for a hot minute****
****5****
****1 weitere Antwort****
****sappire12****
****•****
****vor 2 Monaten****
****We struggled for a while but found setting an alarm helped our son. He didn't care about rewards or getting wet or anything. We used the same phone alarm sound and honestly we took him every 15 minutes until he peed and then we would move it to about an hour before starting every 15 minutes again. It was a lot but he started getting in a routine with it and knew what to expect when the alarm sound went off. We also just let him stand to pee because he wasn't too crazy about sitting on the potty. The only reason we didn't have to worry about poop was because he was on a routine poop schedule of his own doing lol. He really likes routine.****
****10****
****ExistingAd3115****
****Poster*in****
****•****

****vor 2 Monaten****
****Did it take a long time for him to actually be potty trained?****
****3****
****sappire12****
****•****
****vor 2 Monaten****
****We did the above for about a week or two. We still have to remind him, but he has gone on his own. I think it's a confidence thing now. We did this around 4/5. He's about to turn seven now. He lets us know when he needs to go with nonverbal cues (he's level 2 nonverbal). We still have to put him in night times but night time training is difficult for anyone.****
****2****
****moltenrhino****
****•****
****vor 2 Monaten****
****Honestly it just sounds like he is not ready. He may never be tbh.****
****Try to take the pressure off yourself and him. He may never toilet train or he might be ready in a few months or years. No one has a crystal ball to know.****
****One thing when he is older a good tool is a smart watch like a Fitbit. It can vibrate alarms so it\'s only him who knows it\'s happening to remind him to go to the bathroom.****

14
Avatar von u/Antique-Pumpkin-9756
Antique-Pumpkin-9756
•
vor 2 Monaten
I believe you can add info about potty training on his IEP
4
ExistingAd3115
Poster*in

•
vor 2 Monaten
They did and the school has been pushing to get him potty trained. But since it's against their policy to pick up or carry kids, they can't really do anything if he won't willingly go to the toilet.
4
Avatar von u/Born-Jacket
Born-Jacket
•
vor 2 Monaten
My AuDHD daughter had troubles through 2nd or 3rd grade (would have 4-5 accidents a day). She \"couldn't feel it\". When we started on Dexmethylphenidate, it stopped immediately.
I have lots of reservations about medication for kids, but in this case, it really, really helped her have better awareness and control that. She's 13 now and hasn't had an accident since.
4
AdAgile604
•
vor 2 Monaten
My son just turned 5 and just became potty trained, have hope!
4
2 weitere Antworten
Avatar von u/Ok_Lingonberry8995
Ok_Lingonberry8995
•
vor 2 Monaten
Have you tried different rewards like a piece of candy? My daughter was super hard to train but he would at least sit and try for an m&m. I would use whatever candy is most motivating. My daughter could care less about a sticker.
3

1 weitere Antwort
KeepGoingLazy
•
vor 2 Monaten
**What worked for my son is giving him a special toy he could only play with on the potty. We used kinetic sand with sea animals in it. It was a slow build to first get him in the bathroom to play with it, then to sit on the toilet with pants on, then with no pants on. Before and during we also read the potty training book my Mrs. Rachel and bought the stuffed animal Bean to model going to the potty. Once he realized sitting on the potty wasn't scary we switched the reward to him getting the kinetic sand when he sat for 3 minutes. If he successfully used the bathroom he would

get a mini oreo as a reward.**

He is very motivated by oreos and quickly figured out if he did anything he could get his proffered treat.

Also this last and final attempt we opted to potty train in underwear rather than pull-ups. He did not like the sensation of having accidents and it took maybe a week for him to realize going in the potty would mean he wouldn't get messy. I think that made the biggest difference after multiple attempts.

The last thing I will say is if you have someone else/ preschool teacher, family, etc that's willing to try sometime kids are more receptive with a trusted adult rather than parents.

3

journeyreward123

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vor 2 Monaten

My daughter will be 8 this spring, and still wears a pull up for bowel movements. She pees in the toilet just fine. We've tried rewards, potty time activities, watches, underwear, a consult with a pediatric GI doc... it's not clicking. I'm sorry you're going through it too. She has an IEP and thankfully she did learn how to change her own pull up with proper hygiene back in kindergarten, but she still is not grasping actually going in the toilet. Someone posted a link in another comment, so I'll check that out. Maybe that could help you guys too 🙏

3

MamaGRN

•

vor 2 Monaten

We are in the same boat at almost 6. Poop is just not clicking (in fact we've taken a few hellish detours into constipation) and it's so defeating. He's finally pee trained which I am grateful for. One of our huge issues is that he isn't motivated at all by anything- I wish to God he liked chocolate or something so that would motivate him. 😞

3

ExistingAd3115

Poster*in

•

vor 2 Monaten

Same! It seems like by the time we finally find something that motivates him, he changes it. It's impossible to keep up with, which seems to upset him even more.

2

marle217

•

vor 2 Monaten

I can't potty train either of my kids. They're 6 and 3.

My oldest is nonverbal. She's finally starting to learn to follow directions, but we don't have the communication for her to understand the potty at all. I can put her on the potty, and if she happens to need to go she'll go, but if she has to go 10 minutes later she'll pee her clothes and didn't seem to understand. She does take her diaper off when she's uncomfortable now, and we're working on getting her to tell us instead of just taking it off anywhere, but that's a work in progress.

**My 3 year old I'm actually more upset that he isn't potty training.

He talks, though he\'s quiet and doesn\'t say much. But he understands a lot and he follows directions. He loves to make sure everything\'s in order. If I ask him to go to the potty, he can go over to the little potty and pull down his pants and get himself dressed again. He likes his underwear and will ask to wear it. But he just doesn\'t get it. He\'ll pee in his underwear and will just sit in it wet. He\'ll even poop in his underwear, and we only know because he smells. We\'ve tried the naked method and I\'ve pointed out to him when he pees in front of me (on the carpet\....) and he just doesn\'t understand. I\'ve tried explaining so many times. We\'ve watched ms Rachel and elmo and cocomelon explain potties. He just doesn\'t have the self awareness to know when he is peeing, let alone when he\'s going to pee, or how to hold it and release on the potty. He has an IEP so he\'s been able to go to public preschool with diapers, and i know many of his classmates are

potty trained (unlike my oldest\'s self contained classroom) so at least he can see his peers modeling. I just have to hope one day he\'ll get it.**

3

Avatar von u/the-dante

the-dante

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vor 2 Monaten

I am struggling with the exact same problem. My kid turns 5 late spring and we\'ve tried almost everything. Same things here that he doesn\'t care, communicate or show any signs. Even naked he just does his needs where he is.

I hope anyone else that has gone through this situation has insights to share!

2

Numerous-Western174

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vor 2 Monaten

My son will be 6 in April and he still doesn\'t care. Finally got him to flush the toilet but no progress on sitting on the toilet. I currently homeschool but want him to be potty trained more than anything in this world

3

Avatar von u/at0thela

at0thela

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vor 2 Monaten

**Honestly, I potty trained my level 3 semi nonverbal sonshine a month and a half before his 5th birthday which also coincidentally the day after school started for us, so I made it a goal of mine to start and succeeded potty training, mind you I have a two-year-old toddler as well - but with that said, I took a whole week off of life, took a week off from speech and occupational therapy, we go twice a week for both but I took a week off of life and just focused on potty training, he was never afraid of the toilet, which made it easy, and he was starting to get uncomfortable in his pull-up, which was also helpful. We would constantly watch videos, my favorite ones were simple songs, potty

training video which got him super interested and any time we would go to the restroom, I would play it for him obviously we had accidents, but

that normal - I would take him every 15 minutes. I made sure to give him as much liquids as possible so he understands the concept of this is the feeling when I pee and go to the toilet - I even let him have his favorite anything to get him more comfortable but after day 5 it's like he started going on his own to the bathroom. I never did a reward system because my son doesn't really care for the candy, the toys or anything of that nature - so after a whole week of being home, we started slowly going out and I would make sure anywhere that we would go, I would take him straight to the bathroom, no matter where we were - i'm not saying it's easy by any means, it was the hardest thing I've had to do. But unfortunately, I had to do it because like you I don't want him going into kindergarten and still in a pull-ups, even though he was also going into a specialspecial needs class. But these kids are so smart, and as we know consistency is key with them the more you are consistent the more they realize it's a part of their routine, I even did a visual board, with things that he needs to do, so it would be like wake up use the restroom, wash hands, wash face, brush teeth, have breakfast, play etc, and I also added the toilet to that list, visual aids, even timers as well, because again these are all things that have helped me and what made it even easier for us it's the fact that it was summertime, but I feel like if you guys have the ability to be home for one week straight and really be consistent I'm pretty sure this nontraditional way will help**

2

Avatar von u/luckyelectric

luckyelectric

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vor 2 Monaten

My son just this year (at six) gained the ability to comprehend going/trying to go. Now he can sometimes go with intention. We work on it everyday. (He currently is all salty about it and often refuses.) So we still have a LONG way to go... maybe even a lifetime to make it work functionally enough that pull-ups aren't required. To work and work on it without them understanding or getting the process is BRUTAL.

2

Avatar von u/stay_curious_ -

stay_curious_ -

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vor 2 Monaten

**Consult with OT or get him into OT if you can. A certain level of interoception is a prerequisite skill for potty training. An OT can work

on interoception/body awareness in general, which includes things like awareness of being too hot, too cold, identifying discomfort, hunger, etc. OT can work on those things while also letting you know if he's in a place where potty training makes sense.**

If he doesn't feel the sensation, it's not helpful for either of you to spend time and effort on potty training.

2

nightowl6221

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vor 2 Monaten

The naked method is the only thing that worked for my son, and it worked in two days. Just cover your couch and carpet with towels or sheets.

2

ThePwnR4nger

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vor 2 Monaten

My son started watching the Ms. Rachel potty training video every day, sometimes twice per day. We also got the doll that is featured in the video so that he could do some imaginative play with it.

We put a floor potty in the living room and took away his pants, and he often would just sit on the potty watching Ms. Rachel's potty video, and then would go. After a few weeks, pee was pretty well handled, and poop was starting to go where it was supposed to after 3 months. It's been a good 2-3 months now since we've had any accidents, and he's getting more comfortable going in public bathrooms.

When he started getting the hang of pee, we let him have underpants at home instead of being full Winnie the Pooh. If he had any accidents, we would then take them away again. After a few days of being accident free, we would give him pants, then any accidents would mean back to underwear.

Give it time, reinforce, and be consistent. You've got this!

2

Avatar von u/hdorsettcase

hdorsettcase

•

vor 2 Monaten

My autistic nephew was potty trained at 5 by using train videos. My 3 year old knows what the potty is but says, \"No\" and runs away whenever it is suggested. We've tried videos, but since he's becoming more food motivated we're going to try candy.

1

Over_Evidence_5272

•

vor 2 Monaten

My son is level 3, I started trying to potty train him with EC (elimination communication), at 6 months old. He was MOSTLY potty trained at 9 YEARS old. He is now 12, and I still have to wipe him but we are working on that! Other than having to wipe him he's fully potty trained, he knows when to go, puts the seat up/down etc. I had the most success by teaching him in tiny steps and breaking it down. ❤️ the more steps you can break it into the better. For example step 1- learning when they need to go step two- going IN the bathroom step 3- learning to pull pants up and down. And each step took a very long time, but it's been so worth it! Don't give up

1

wambulanse

•

vor 2 Monaten

**I went through the same thing with my son. He would poop standing and it was quick, and sometimes no shame he wouldn't even hide. His only interest was the Toy Story 4 movie and candy. He's almost 6 now and level 3. It was a lot of work in the beginning and it's still a process but he now does poops and pee in the toilets. Minimal accidents. We've been poop accident free for a weeks and pee free for 2months. I started the potty training process when he turn 4. It's a long process to write on here, but I can tell you the steps I took if you like and you can

take what you want from it. It\'s just a lot to write in one comment.**

1

ChangeStartsHere

•

vor 2 Monaten

Hugs, I have been there. We are still not potty trained at 8.

Get accommendation and scheduled sits on his IEP.

1

Jiggypig

•

vor 2 Monaten

My son just turned 6 and we are finally 99% potty trained. Every once in a while we have a one off pee accident but ill take it.

Honestly what made a difference for us was getting his ADHD medicated. It wasn't over night but was definitely the game changer.

1

Avatar von u/RubyPearlGA

RubyPearlGA

•

vor 2 Monaten

This is my experience. My son is in special needs kindergarten and turns 6 next month. His special needs pre-k spent an entire year potty training and was able to get him pee trained. We have tried all the sticker charts, treats, schedules, visuals, etc to get this child to poop in the potty. We bought a potty seat that has steps on it and it more sturdy than a potty seat you just place on top of the adult sized one. We had him sit on it for 5 minutes after dinner every night with his tablet. For 3 months he would sit there, get his night time pullup on, poop in it and go on his merry way :-) We promised him a camping trip if he pooped in the potty. That night, he pooped in the potty!!! He hasn't done it since but still have him sit on the seat every night and now he recognizes that he might have to poop and goes voluntarily to try.

It is so hard. There is so much pressure from the school. Don't stress about it...it\'s not worth the energy. Give him time and when he is ready, he will do it.

1

Avatar von u/caramire

caramire

•

vor 2 Monaten

**It was a process for our 4 year old. She would only pee or poop standing up in a certain spot in her room for a long time. So when we

started potty training we tried to get her to sit on the potty but she is so strong willed and would hold in her pee for like 12 hours and just refuse to go. We then started putting down pee pads and having her in underwear in her specific spot to stand and pee for a while. Then using pull ups for bowel movements. Then we moved the pee pads to the bathroom where she would pee on that in the bathroom. Then she started doing her bowel movements on the potty but still not peeing. We used first then charts for her. First (picture of pee or poop) then you can get juice, certain toy, chocolate, whatever is HIGHLY motivating. Seeing the visual pictures really helped her and one day she just peed in the potty and

then never went back and rarely had accidents. We still have to have designated potty times with her because if she\'s busy playing she can just ignore it. But sometimes she will let us know when she needs to go.**

All to say, it can be a process! I think it was a full month before she got it. And this was our 3rd attempt at potty training. Hang in there, it may just not be the right time for him or you haven\'t found the thing that will make it work for him. Best of luck!!

1

Creative_Exchange_59

•

vor 2 Monaten

Check with a urologist that he is not constipated. If he is, it lowers the ability to feel what is happening, and can prevent potty training.

1

What age did your kiddo learn potty training?

My kiddo is 5 and is still not potty trained. I\'m worried because his speech is also very behind. Not sure what to do besides the therapies.

20

•

55

Kommentarbereich

llamadrama2021

•

vor 1 Jahr

**6. He was in kindergarten. They trained him. Here\'s how: They took him to the potty every 15 minutes, and logged whether he went pee or poo. That gave them an idea of his body\'s schedule. And after a week or

two he was potty trained. He did have a regression a year later, but we went right back to the 15 minute schedule and he went back to being trained within a week.**

26

Avatar von u/goosh2

goosh2

Poster*in

•

vor 1 Jahr

Thank you for sharing! Will try this with my kiddo. How is your kiddo doing now?

4

1 weitere Antwort

fivehots

•

vor 1 Jahr

I actually really like this idea too! Is it while he\'s awake? Or is there like a set window they did it in? I guess obviously while he was at kindergarten, but what did the home work look like?

2

llamadrama2021

•

vor 1 Jahr

**Same thing at home. From wake up until bedtime. Takes a lot of work but it actually works in just a few days. We actually used an egg timer which would go off every 15 minutes, and he knew what it meant and would

just go without us saying anything.**

2

fivehots

•

vor 1 Jahr

🔥🔥🔥

Genius! Ordering it right now!

2

Creative_Judgment_50

•

vor 1 Jahr

4 and he's close to nonverbal. Develop a plan with his therapists and school if you don't already have one would be my suggestion. We did bathroom breaks every 30 min initially and had a rewards system in place. We also didn't leave the house for 3 days straight

10

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 1 Jahr

When you took him, how long did you wait before letting him get off? Started potty training my 2 yo girl rn and she'll sit on the potty forever if she could. I take her every hour, but think I might do every 30 mins now this weekend

1

Creative_Judgment_50

•

vor 1 Jahr

I copied and pasted my comment from another post so I apologize if it's redundant. Please let me know if you have other questions!
**We potty trained my 4 year old and he is almost nonverbal. Consistency is key and a rewards system. We also used a lot of pictures. We had pictures of toilets all over the house so he could tell us he needed to go. We had a visual outlining all the steps of using the toilet and we had a timer set for every 30 minutes where he was required to sit on the toilet where we repeatedly told him "go potty". We started small and required him to sit on the toilet for I think just a minute or two and would reward him with a single skittle just for sitting. If he actually went number 1 or 2 he was rewarded with screen time on his iPad for 15 minutes. It took 6 days for him to master going number 1 and about 10 days to master number 2. He still wears pull ups at night and needs help wiping and washing his hands but he independently uses the restroom. I was in your position where I thought it wasn't possible at different points during our potty training journey and wanted to throw in the towel because there is just so much poop and pee everywhere 🤔 but

assume competency with your child always and don't give up. Good luck!**

10

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 1 Jahr

Tysm!! ♡

2

Slow-Unit-8372

•

****vor 1 Jahr****
****My kid turned 5 in June and just got potty trained. He learned to pee in the potty first and just recently (I\'d say about a month ago) learned to poop in the potty. His pediatrician said it\'s normal for autistic kiddos to be potty trained around the age of 6.****
****8****
****Avatar von u/Frequent_Owl_5605****
****Frequent_Owl_5605****
****•****
****vor 2 Monaten****
****Did he have any issues pulling down/up his pants? Mine is 3.5 years old nonverbal but will go to the training potty when he needs to, we just started a week ago and have done pantsless. When I tried training underwear he would just sit on the potty and go in them:/ he doesn\'t seem to grasp that he has to pull them down and he\'ll also try to get into the shower fully clothed \...****
****2****
****Slow-Unit-8372****
****•****
****vor 2 Monaten****
****Yeah he had issues at first but we put him in just pull ups and had him see his dad when he would go to the bathroom so he would get the concept. I will say that we did try to potty train him as soon as he turned 3 but it wasn\'t working so we stopped and then tried again once he turned 5. He learned easier at 5, and he\'s six now and still has accidents from time to time but I would say he makes it to the potty about 85% of the time.****
****1****
****cinderparty****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****My one son didn\'t potty train til a weekish before he turned 8. At 5 he was still non verbal with no indication he understood what we were saying to him either. His receptive speech delay was always as severe as his expressive speech delay.****
****8****
****momoishere21****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****Did his receptive speech delay improve?****
****1****
****cinderparty****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****Definitely. He is 17 now, has been conversational for around 7 years, he has no receptive delay now, he still has articulation issues, sentence planning issues, and some other things that make it so he still is behind in expressive speech.****
****4****
****1 weitere Antwort****
****NecessaryPossible976****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****At 6. After 3 years of training one day she decided to go by herself**

😬**

8

LilWitch1472

•

vor 1 Jahr

Our girl is 3.5 and we're working on it. It's been slow progress, but we're not in a rush. Pressuring her always backfires. It will happen when she's ready.

4

Grendel_82

•

vor 1 Jahr

Early 4. We devoted an entire weekend to basically nothing but potty training (and the first day was literally not leaving the house and just doing potty training and making sure we got him to potty immediately when he had to go). But had success within 48 hours. Accidents were pretty rare within a couple of days and usually involved some situation where we forgot to take him to the potty. It took months before he would take himself.

3

Happygabincital

•

vor 1 Jahr

My son at 7, he was always constipated. I began to give him homemade Kefir, two full glasses and raw honey every day, after two months, he began to be regular and he began to use the restroom by himself.

3

jonchihuahua

•

vor 1 Jahr

10 and still struggling. Was fully trained at 4, had one issue with constipation, regressed completely. Now stool withholding is a huge issue. About to start therapy again for it.

3

myredserenity

•

vor 1 Jahr

Mine is 6, and I recently had a specialist tell me she will probably \"get it\" around 10. It was not pleasant to hear. Stool withholding is a nightmare cycle.

2

Avatar von u/Short_Sort_9881

Short_Sort_9881

•

vor 1 Jahr

He was about 5.5 before peeing on the toilet was consistent. He wears underwear all the time now and we struggle with pooping on the toilet\.... But I\'d say it\'s getting better every week! He always poops before bed and sometimes it\'s in his underwear while he\'s laying in bed and sometimes it\'s in the toilet and sometimes he starts pooping in his underwear and realizes it and then runs to the toilet.

2

parad0xme

•
 vor 1 Jahr
 **6. i did it over winter break and cancelled her aba for a week and
 just stayed home**
 2
 half_yeti
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 **We tried on and off since he was 2 but didn't really take until he
 was 4. I did it over winter break with his preschool and I set a visual
 timer with him. First we did 30 minutes and after a few days we went to
 an hour. Once he was got into being comfortable with being in the
 bathroom he started doing number 2s as well and for the most part we
 have been going strong.**
 **We only had one accident when he started kindergarten and it was first
 day. We do have the occasional accident at home lately because he will
 fixate on his games or tablet and wait until the very last second or
 just go in his pants but we've also been working on that with limiting
 screen time with games and/or making sure he goes before starting his
 screen time.**

 2
 dmxspy
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 **Here is a link on teaching autistic children to use the potty, it is
 long but has great info.**
 **[https://m.youtube.com/watch?v=Qx-A_B3Tb-8&pp=ygUwU2VhdHRsZSBjaGlzZHJlbnMgaG9zcGl0YWw
 gYXV0aXNtIH BvdHR5IHRyYWluaW5n](https://m.youtube.com/watch?v=Qx-A_B3Tb-8&pp=ygUwU2VhdHRsZSBjaGlzZHJlbnMgaG9zcGl0YWw gYXV0aXNtIH BvdHR5IHRyYWluaW5n)**
 **\[Off topic\] There is another video by Seattle children's hospital
 /feeding therapy for autistic kids and poor diet, and how they would go
 about helping very picky eaters.**
 **[https://m.youtube.com/watch?v=s3muo4pcODA&pp=ygUsU2VhdHRsdyBjaGlzZHJlbnMgaG9zcGl0YWw
 gcGljayBlYXRlciBhdXRpc20%3D](https://m.youtube.com/watch?v=s3muo4pcODA&pp=ygUsU2VhdHRsdyBjaGlzZHJlbnMgaG9zcGl0YWw gcGljayBlYXRlciBhdXRpc20%3D)**
 2
 sjyork
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 **Full potty trained at 2 didn't get an autism diagnosis until she was
 5**
 2
 Livid_Refrigerator69
 •
 vor 1 Jahr
 18 months, 3 years, 2 years, 13 months & she trained herself.
 2
 1 weitere Antwort
 Avatar von u/CassieLeeLeeLee
 CassieLeeLeeLee
 •
 vor 1 Jahr

 **My girl was potty trained by 3 years old💕. Consistency and treats
 lol.**
 1

****FIRExRIFE****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****Im not sure middle of 3 y/o but he needs hug always because his constipated. Just a question is your kid also constipated? When mine learn to potty his just do it once a day unless his tummy is not ok. Im also not sure if he is just stopping it thats why its once a day.****
****-2****
****\[gelöscht\]****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****5-6 happened in kindergarten year****
****1****
****Avatar von u/CombinationAny5516****
****CombinationAny5516****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****Our son was 8 for "potty" training and 11 before we finally got him to poop in a toilet****
****1****
****polkaspotteapot****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****My boy was three and a half \-- I definitely thought he would be much later because he was very against using the toilet, but he ended up making the transition pretty easily.****
****The signs we saw that it might be good to try: he kept taking off his pants and nappy, hated having his nappy changed, always did a wee as soon as we put him in the bath.****

****Our approach was: cut out nappies and made the switch straight to undies, took him to the toilet every 15-30 minutes, got a toilet seat that had a second seat with a smaller hole so he was less afraid of falling in. It took him about two days but only a few accidents to get tha hang of it and now he is very confident.****
****That being said, my son was definitely ready. I work in early childhood and kids really are ready at different times, especially ND kids. If you want to start moving towards it, maybe start by having him sit on the toilet at every change and do all the associated rituals, even if he doesn\'t go? Like wiping, flushing, washing hands. My kids enjoyed that routine and it helped them become more familiar with the toilet.****
****1****
****rothrowaway24****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****day and night trained now at 4 (turned 4 in early november) i just waited for her to show she was ready because she was NOT going to do it on my ideal timeline lol****
****1****
****Thejenfo****
****•****
****vor 1 Jahr****
****5 for my son my daughter is 9 and still untrained.****
****She has much more dietary/bathroom issues. Also refuses certain**

bathrooms (including one we lived in!)**
Every kid has their own pace and you'll kind of sense when they're actually ready
My daughter is close but still intimidated by the toilet itself - not the bathroom anymore
Sigh one step at a time
1
LadyFyreFox
•
vor 1 Jahr

My daughter just turned 5, and as of today she requested to go to the potty without any prompting, and actually went! They have had way more luck at ABA than we have had at home, but this coming week we plan to do a week of \"potty training boot camp\" as our BCBA has dubbed it. Lots of changes of underwear and pants, I've gotten copies of all their little signs and even got the same training seat for our toilet (ours had characters on it.... Which she was too distracted by to sit on 🤪) we will try for a week with no diapers and if it does not take we will back off and keep practicing a little longer. She has been waking up dry for a while now but often refuses potty first thing so that is my first task. She loves Minnie and baby shark so all the potty signs have a character on the potty.... And potty is actually called \"potty shark\".... But whatever works ❤️
1
Avatar von u/Pew_Jackman
Pew_Jackman
•
vor 1 Jahr
Just hang in there. We turned 6 in August and maybe by September out of nowhere we were going to the potty full-time. No accidents so far, but cleaning can be a challenge. Not seeing poop on the walls or hair anymore so that's a plus.
1
Avatar von u/Routine_Lifeguard228
Routine_Lifeguard228
•
vor 1 Jahr
3 yo .. boy
1
barberc5
•
vor 1 Jahr
We're at 8 and still working on it. Undies at home but wear pull-ups to go anywhere
1
sarbri08

•
vor 1 Jahr
My son is 4 (will be 5 in April) and he will only pee in the potty. He still doesn't understand the concept of pooping on the potty yet. But he will only go try to pee when prompted. Otherwise he will not initiate it on his own. I prompt him every 30 min-1 hour and I reward him with jelly beans (his favorite candy) when he goes.

1

Avatar von u/kelkelrb

kelkelrb

•

vor 1 Jahr

My son was 5. It's a long story about how I squandered the initial opportunity when he was 20 months old. He had gotten into the routine of sitting and peeing in the potty after bath time. I stopped encouraging that for a brief period of time (couple of weeks) and we didn't go right back into it. When I did legitimately start trying to potty train he wanted nothing to do with sitting on the toilet. Thus the let's go every 15-30 minutes was a negative experience and I couldn't get to an hour with that method. We tried naked for 3 days, just switching cold turkey to regular underwear. I also made the mistake of trying to potty train him at the same time as his little brother. Little brother was getting the hang of running to the bathroom when he had to potty, but he noticed big brother not doing that and by day 2-3 he wasn't even trying to avoid potty accidents.

My mistake was not acting on the potty in the toilet at night by encouraging it during the day. Another mistake I made was thinking he wasn't ready because when I would ask if he had to potty he would say no and less than an hour later the blue indicator showed he did need to potty.

When I made my last/successful attempt I finally looked into potty training advice for neurodivergent kids and it's very much schedule oriented. Instead of asking if they have to go potty it was "it's time to go potty". He got free access to his tablet the entire day when we started. What ended up happening is he held his pee the entire first day 4:30 in the afternoon, once he finally peed it clicked. He had been ready, but I fumbled it. We went straight to underwear during day and night and never looked back. We used "potty presents" to encourage it as well. Initially every successful pee in the potty he could choose a present and after the first couple of days it was only for poo in the potty and by the end of the first week he wasn't expecting or asking for presents as a reward it was just something he knew to do. But while out and about we would encourage potty use at a two hour interval. "Hey, it's time to try to potty".

Good luck in your journey!

1

Alittlebitfluffy

•

vor 1 Jahr

Our oldest was potty trained by 5 and a half but still continued to poop himself just once in a while. He is 7 and nearly fully trustworthy bathroom-wise, now.

Our second born realized he wouldn't be able to go to kindergarten if he didn't know how to pee in the toilet, so the spring or summer right before school started, he just decided to start going poop and pee in the toilet and has had zero accidents since.

My husband and I were inconsistent with training and just waited for them to be more ready.

1

Bushpylot

•

vor 1 Jahr
10yo and almost there; working on cleanup now. We\'re starting to get real authentic language, though it\'s still in the beginning stages.
For us, it\'s been a lot of dedicated positive parenting.
1
1 weitere Antwort
\[gelöscht\]
•
vor 1 Jahr
My son fully trained at 3.5 years.
1
Pure_Information1148
•
vor 1 Jahr

I just potty trained my daughter a month ago. She\'s almost 5. I watched this video and printed a pre-school step by step cartoon for potty training to show my kid. She would sit in her little toilet for hours to potty with her iPad on while I show her the potty step cartoon. Eventually it worked. We used about one to two weeks. Now she\'s going on her own or needs a remind every hour. Few accidents happened initially but I followed the video method to handle it. Hope this helps. Seattle Children\'s Hospital
1
Avatar von u/BigGayNarwhal
BigGayNarwhal
•
vor 1 Jahr
6.5, and even then only pee. She is 7 and we are still working on the other one 🙄
1
Avatar von u/fivebyfive12
fivebyfive12
•
vor 1 Jahr
Totally other end of the scale here, he was out of nappies just before his 2nd birthday. He always hated them, he started going behind sofas when he was doing a poo and he\'d pull at his nappy as soon as it was even slightly damp so we decided to bite the bullet and try. He\'s 5 now and I still can\'t quite believe we (as in parents and child) managed it. We still need to help him with wiping etc as he gets quite anxious about it.
1
Avatar von u/kushvols
kushvols
•
vor 1 Jahr
It took until 6 for our son and was a very long battle with ups and downs. We tore it down to the studs and took him every few 30 minutes and it eventually clicked. Was one of the most frustrating journeys of my life but we did make it.

1
\[gelöscht\]
•

****vor 1 Jahr****

****My daughter is 4 and is potty training right now. She started a few weeks ago. ABA is helping. She is going every 30 minutes. She does better at school than at home but we knew it was going to be a difficult task as she is non verbal. She pees in the potty about 1/3 times but refuses to poop. We have also has the flu the past few days and I haven't been able to take her as often as I should but will start back next week.****

****1****

****Ok-Tooth-4306****

****.****

****vor 1 Jahr****

****My daughter was around 5, but still needed constant reminders. Thankfully her first year of kindergarten, there was a bathroom in the class and the teacher reminded them. She went into year 2 of kindergarten this year and needed reminders. She did have an issue with a labial fusion that we had to do estrogen cream for twice, first time at 2 and last summer. A few months ago, something just clicked and she has had zero accidents and goes on her own. Still remind her if it's been a while. She's never had issues with #2 though. That one she was quick to know when she had to.****

****1****

****TeamInternational898****

****.****

****vor 1 Jahr****

****The week after his 6th birthday!****

****1****

****Avatar von u/Living-Teach-7553****

****Living-Teach-7553****

****.****

****vor 1 Jahr****

****2.5 years old, but my little one is diagnosed with GDD (which is very broad) not diagnosed with ASD yet and he is speech delayed (expressive + receptive).****

****nächster post:****

****For those of you who have kids who aren't potty trained.****

****Why aren't they potty trained? Be honest. Aside from the autism. Consistency has been a struggle with us because we have LOTS of extra curriculums during the week, so I'm forced to put him in a pull up when we leave home.****

****10****

****.****

****46****

****Kommentarbereich****

****dani_-_142****

****.****

****vor 5 Monaten****

****I'm pretty sure it's the autism for us. We have profound communication challenges.****

****59****

****emperorspenguin****

****.****

****vor 5 Monaten****

****Because we pushed it too hard with my oldest who ended up withholding**

and causing chronic GI problems that we\'re still dealing with 4 years later. So now we\'re probably being too lenient and nice about it so we don\'t traumatize him too**

22

gentlynavigating

•

vor 5 Monaten

It\'s the level 3 autism. That\'s the reason why he\'s not potty trained. I do everything right as far as potty training. This is not my first rodeo.

He can go to the bathroom with on the dot prompting every hour but he does not care if he goes on himself and doesn\'t feel uncomfortable. He\'s 6. We\'ve been at this for 2 years, I hope one day he will go independently.

41

NanaIsABrokenRose

•

vor 5 Monaten

This is where we are. My kiddo can keep a schedule but can\'t recognize the \'need\'.

11

1 weitere Antwort

ChaucersDuchess

•

vor 5 Monaten

Be honest you say?

Okay.

My level 3 autistic daughter also has a microdeletion and microduplication on her 16th chromosome, and she has spina bifida occulta. No amount of consistency or effort will reverse the nerve damage from the SB and from having had a tethered spinal cord. She is sometimes able to feel it and use the potty for both functions, and other times not all. She\'s seen urologists and GI specialists for many years. She\'s 16 and will always be in adult diapers.

I\'m happy for those who do get their kids potty trained. Jealous, even. But not every single kid can be.

16

Avatar von u/bentreflection

bentreflection

•

vor 5 Monaten

How did you get it diagnosed? My daughter cannot feel when she needs to go and also cannot bend her back much at all. We got an x-ray but the dr did not see any spinal issues. Clearly something is going on though

4

ChaucersDuchess

•

vor 5 Monaten

We had an MRI. She\'s had three so far, but two were focused solely on brain through to the bottom of her spinal cord. She\'s was in pain constantly and couldn\'t walk far without needing to rest, and her urologist wanted to see if his hunch was correct.

**She now walks laps in her school\'s gym to "get the sillies out" as she

likes to say. @**

**But surgery and a hospital stay during the pandemic was not a blast
 🙄**

4

Disastrous_Bison_910

•

vor 5 Monaten

He holds it like a champ. Can go way to long without going, but they say everything is fine.

14

taajmanian_devil

•

vor 5 Monaten

My kiddo too! I thought he was the only one. The longest he held was 12 hours.

4

1 weitere Antwort

1 weitere Antwort

Ok_Solution9803

•

vor 5 Monaten

My son was not fully potty trained until 6 years old. I found that once I said no more to pull-ups, and we had to go through the exercise of changing our clothes in public, etc. he finally got it. Not saying this will work for everyone... but, he knew when he had to go (he would go to a private area to go #2 in his pull-up). So, once we took the pull-ups he finally figured it out.

7

2 weitere Antworten

Avatar von u/GMan1593

GMan1593

•

vor 5 Monaten

My son is 9 and just starting to have somewhat routine poops in the toilet on a regimented schedule. We did pelvic floor therapy, yoga and food therapy. I think those helped and it was also super important to avoid negative reactions to accidents. This included coaching the grandparents to be more understanding. But our big breakthrough was finding the right motivator. For him it was swimming. He wasn't allowed to swim until after he pooped. We're not through the woods yet but we can see some light with this part of the journey.

7

Avatar von u/MPG54

MPG54

•

vor 5 Monaten

**Constipation/bowel issues is the most common health condition for autistic individuals. I was trying to figure out why my child was walking on his toes so I mimicked his behavior. After a bit I felt something and realized- oh that's why. Some can't feel the signs. Others can feel them intensely and hold out for days to avoid pain. After years of getting yelled at, disciplined or otherwise frustrating the adults in their lives they can develop emotional problems around it as well. In my opinion the physical discomfort they feel is a major

impediment/distracton which makes it difficult to communicate. I encourage every parent to take it very seriously as a sign of what their child is dealing with aside from the frustration from the delays in mastering a necessary life skill. Some doctors have figured it out, others not yet.**

14

Avatar von u/EmmerdoesNOTrepme

EmmerdoesNOTrepme

•

vor 5 Monaten

Speaking to the \"physical discomfort\" side of things?

Getting either a \"squatty potty\" type footrest, or even just some type of small stool, so their feet don't dangle, can help a TON, with \"helping create the abdominal pressure to push it out\"!

As a kid (and frankly, even as an adult, at barely over 5' tall!), most of the time my feet \"dangled\" without anything except maybe my toes touching the floor, when I sat on a toilet.

So I basically was \"balancing\" on the front edge of the seat, and using my abdominal muscles to balance rather than create enough pressure to \"push\" while I went to the bathroom.

I originally bought the folding stool (the little plastic one-step type that folds flat), when we had a roommate whose daughter couldn't reach the sink easily.

But because the bathroom had a \"comfort height\" toilet, I began to also use the stool to put my feet on, when I went to the bathroom.

And just like those \"squatty potty\" stories, having my knees above my hips as I sat, helped a ton!

So if I have Pre-K'ers i'm working with, who also seem to need to go #2, but who are struggling and have feet that can't touch the floor?

I grab the step by the sink, for them to put their feet on, as they sit! (Edit to clarify, I work in Pre-K Special education, and part of our job as support staff is helping with bathrooming!)

And most of the time, that does the trick!💖

It is just a simple \"logistics and body mechanics\" issue sometimes.

7

AuthenticAwkwardness

•

vor 5 Monaten

A stool is a game changer! My son could sit there for 5 mins and nothing. Then the second I slide the stool over, he goes almost immediately.

3

Livid-Improvement953

•

vor 5 Monaten

**Because my kid hates it and will literally attack me if I try to enforce sitting in the toilet. Even when she isn't aggressive, if we try to push it she has other maladaptive behaviors like disrobing in public, refusing to wear anything on her lower half, refusing all bathroom activities including bathing and grooming tasks, being combative about diaper changes, retaliatory destruction. She desperately wants to be in control, and there is no reinforcement on earth that she

cares about more than just NOT sitting on the toilet. She knows the basics and we are just waiting for her to decide she can handle it. So far we have gotten to once in the morning when she wakes up and once at night before she sleeps and it has taken years to get there. I also don't think she has complete bodily control over how to make it happen, and is unsure what the urgency feels like, so I can understand why she doesn't want to waste time trying. She's 7, and we had almost 4 complete years of ABA, 2 of which they tried to help with potty training and made everything much worse.**

8

journeyfromone

•

vor 5 Monaten

My child has been using the potty from 6 months old, I did EC, he's still not trained at 4.5. He's mostly fine when he's naked but can't figure out pants/clothes. Then like yesterday he ran to the bathroom and pooped in the bath instead of the potty. He knew what he was doing but can't always get his body to do what he wants. So although he understands the concept he just isn't ready for the next phase. At daycare he sits on the potty a few times a day but never goes. It's pretty normal to take until 7-8 years for autistic kids.

4

cinderparty

•

vor 5 Monaten

My son wasn't trained til a few weeks before he turned 8. It was the autism. Preschool, ABA, ot, and us all tried to train him, none of us had any success for years...

4

caritadeatun

•

vor 5 Monaten

He won't sit on the toilet . He knows when he has to do number 2, even gives me a pull up - but will run off to hide somewhere to poop or at the bathroom but not the toilet. If I try to sit him he'd fight me or push me out. I think it would have been possible when he was little but he was withholding it to the point he wouldn't poop in days and I'd have to get him cleansed at the ER (GI exams confirmed he was not celiac or had any stomach issue) . Now he's too big to forcibly or gently get him sit on the toilet. He did learn to pee in the toilet thanks to ABA

6

1 weitere Antwort

Fun_Television_1289

•

vor 5 Monaten

She can't communicate, doesn't understand. Mines level 3 - I have full faith if she was NT, she would be potty trained by now

5

fivehots

•

vor 5 Monaten

Why not limit the extracurricular to focus on the more important curricular?

4

\[gelöscht\]

•

vor 5 Monaten

Mine is almost 4 and when we tried the first few times he would flat out refuse to sit on the toilet. He would scream and have a major meltdown. We were pretty much forcing him until we realized what a mistake that was. We backed off and is now showing interest in it.

3

Avatar von u/stripesforlyfe

stripesforlyfe

•

vor 5 Monaten

I don't agree with you blaming yourself for needing to put him in a pull up when you leave the house. My NT daughter recently potty trained and I'd have her in a pull up when we'd leave the house or if she was at her babysitter and she still wanted to take it off to use the potty, so I think in your case it is also due to autism. Kudos for continuing to try and I hope it becomes successful on his own timeline

3

Fancy_Username36

•

vor 5 Monaten

He is incredibly stubborn and refuses. He knows when he has to go and will hold it until he has a diaper on.

3

fallingforeve

•

vor 5 Monaten

My son cannot communicate or comprehend well enough yet.

3

Avatar von u/r000r

r000r

•

vor 5 Monaten

Mine is 8. It is a combination of being nonverbal and autism. He will pee on the toilet, but he has no desire to poop there ever. He also won't tell or signal in any way when he has to go.

2

1 weitere Antwort

Electrical-Still-980

•

vor 5 Monaten

I'm trying to be kind here but I am slightly offended by this post and the way it's worded.

my son is seventeen and has autism and cerebral palsy and I still have to wash him, dress him, shave him, help him use the toilet during the day and he's still not continent overnight. He weighs as much as me now and I'm just grateful he isn't combative and no longer poop smears.

If you want me to be honest I would say I'm just grateful he can communicate with me at all and only uses a wheelchair sometimes. I am luckier than some other parents of children with severe autism.

2

\[gelöscht\]

****Poster*in****
****•****
****vor 5 Monaten****
****Not meant to offend anyway. Just trying to find something that might work for me. Apologies if it did, bless you and your son. I pray it gets easier ****
****1****
****nanlinr****
****•****
****vor 5 Monaten****
****He keeps pooping in his pants no matter what we tell him. He pees in thw potty just fine!****
****1****
****Avatar von u/Dean_Kuhner****
****Dean_Kuhner****
****•****
****vor 5 Monaten****
****He just refuses to go in the potty. He will  himself and be completely unbothered by it regardless of underwear or diaper. So obviously he wears diaper. We have been trying for years without pause. He's 5.****

****1****
****Avatar von u/ButterflysAndFlowers****
****ButterflysAndFlowers****
****•****
****vor 5 Monaten****
****My son is level 3 nonverbal. Potty training is extremely difficult. My son will sit on the toilet but will not go, and he is unable to let me know when he has to go, no signals or anything. I keep it at it with him as much as I can, but for now he still wears pull ups. I am hoping one day we will be successful with the potty training. I am quite tired of still having to wipe him honestly at 7 years old. I will keep trying with him though.****
****1****
****Avatar von u/sylforshort****
****sylforshort****
****•****
****vor 5 Monaten****
****Mine is 3.5 years old. Even without autism (that we know of; at least two have ADHD though), none of my older boys were ready to potty train until 3.5. I tried sooner with my oldest and it was a nightmare so with my others I waited until they were fully ready and it was way easier.****
****With this kid\'s developmental delays I\'m waiting even longer. Also, he\'s really big for his age and toddler potty chairs are too small for him so I can\'t just have him sitting on a potty chair all the time waiting for him to go. So it\'s going to be trickier. And also the verbal delay is a barrier.****
****I am infinitely grateful that size 8 diapers exist now (they didn\'t ten years ago when I had my other kids) because pull-ups just aren\'t absorbent enough for him.****
****I have a (as far as we know) NT 15mo girl, too, who might be ready to potty train around the same time as her big brother, so I might be tandem training\...****
****0****

****LividChildhood8643****

****•****

****vor 5 Monaten****

****Introspection issue for us I think. She really doesn't feel the urge until too late. We deal with chronic constipation and being non verbal means we really struggle communicating simple tasks. It's a ton of stuff stacked against us but after 9 years I'm kinda tired of wiping and changing bums.****

****1****

****internal_logging****

****•****

****vor 5 Monaten****

****It\'s that for us. We blamed the autism, but he\'s picked it up so quick in ABA there\'s no reason other than my husband and I are so burnt out it\'s hard to keep up with it.****

****1****

****Frequent_Breath8210****

****•****

****vor 5 Monaten****

****13 and still frequently has accidents. Cant figure out why 🤔****

****1****

****Avatar von u/AlternativePrior393****

****AlternativePrior393****

****•****

****vor 5 Monaten****

****Potty trained now, but one of my kids took until 4 1/2 to start using bathroom. Issue was due to not being able to feel the need to go.****

****Trips to the bathroom are still almost all emergencies a few years later, as only feels the need when needing to go ASAP, and rare accidents when too absorbed and missing body signals.****

****1****

****Grognaç_the_Red****

****•****

****vor 5 Monaten****

****At night she doesn\'t hold it. I try to get her to go before bed, but she doesn\'t always, so we use a cloth pad in her underwear****

****1****

****PNW_Express****

****•****

****vor 5 Monaten****

****I know you said not potty trained - but my son is 5.5 and we started at 3.5 and it's been work ever since we started. It's taking so much consistency. He mostly has pee down but does still regularly have poop accidents. He's gone through periods where there were no accidents so I am totally confident it's the autism. He just doesn't totally get it. So we're in it for the long haul and being as patient and consistent as possibles. It's so exhausting. Meanwhile because we spend so much time dealing with it our younger freshly 2 year old NT child totally gets it just by watching us with his older brother.****

****But overall I think it's a mix of sensory issues and not quite understanding. He also still wears a pull up at night and likely will for the foreseeable future.****

****1****

Avatar von u/nomad_usurper
nomad_usurper
•
vor 5 Monaten
My daughter will go sit on the potty happily if I tell her too. 1st grade teacher takes her to the potty every hour in special Ed class in public school.
Heck my daughter will even use the potty if she happens to need to if she\'s sitting on it.
But IF she\'s not sitting on the potty she\'s more than happy to do it in her pullup and not say a word! 😞
She\'s close, it\'s coming, she\'s wearing underwear (with a pullup over it) but she\'s just not ready yet. Soon though \... I hope! 😊
1
throwaway_12131415
•
vor 5 Monaten
Our psychologist basically said she expects him to be ready when he's closer to 5yo
We're so overwhelmed with all his behavioural issues anyway that honestly I don't have the bandwidth to challenge her
And tbh he's just not there yet developmentally. He's still got the development progress of a 8 month old
nächster post:
Potty training level 3 non verbal kids? Advice?
Daughter will be 5 tomorrow.
Level 3. Completely 100% non verbal, zero words ever, zero babbles or mouth sounds. Suspected possible intellectual disability but not confirmed. Has an AAC, can't really use it but we try every day.
I'm over the diapers. Done. I want to give potty training a try to see if it'll click for her. Obviously if it absolutely doesn't work at all whatsoever I'm not going to drive us crazy and I'll just try again later.
If your kiddo is level 3 and/or nonverbal, please give me tips if you did this successfully!
25
•
7
Kommentarbereich
Different-Oil-1933
•
vor 2 Jahren
We posted colorful potty training photos and had them handy around the house. I bought 3 sets of the large potty time photos off of amazon. When I had a feeling a potty moment was coming I would direct them to the photo and get him to the bathroom. It is not 100% but helps with #2 a lot! 5 yr old in DEC and Legvel 3 and 100% non verbal. Wakes up each morning with a dry diaper, but we have not gotten the #1 under control. Good luck!
9
SignificantRing4766
Poster*in
•

vor 2 Jahren
Thank you! 🙏
1
Nice_Competition_494
•
vor 2 Jahren
My son really took to the images of this one 🍌....
We switched to pull ups and I fed him a lot of liquids (he loves milk I usually cap it off, not for that week). I sat him on the toilet when I had time and I sat there till he went pee. We watched potty videos, bathroom time stuff while we waited. I gave him a lolly pop the first few times for just even sitting or indicating he needed to go. He learned to say po-po and tap himself to indicate he need to go. We also bought a static one word button that says potty and he can tap that when he wants.
Currently regressing but we are moving and it is causing a lot of anxiety, so I am not pressuring my son currently to do either way. I just give him the option of what he is comfortable with.
<https://images.app.goo.gl/fBWWTkqmorWZLSWz5>
5
GlazedOverDonut
•
vor 2 Jahren
My now 7 year (level 3) old was fully potty trained in a month at the age of 3. Here's what I did.
Waited until summer.
Put him in pants (nappies at bed).
Gave him squash (juice) for the first time ever to drink all the time.
Set a timer on repeat every 20 mins and put him on the potty for 3 minutes.
Whenever he did a wee on the potty, I gave him chocolate and showed him the toilet symbol.
As soon as he mastered that (2 weeks), I stopped remarking wees and only gave chocolate for number 2s.
At 7, he still will not wipe his bum or wash his hands, but he will if reminded.
I decided that the best thing for my kid was to focus on one thing at a time. People who have a visual checklist of 5-10 steps are delusional. Master one skill (the most important) and move on to the next.
He pretty much was out of nappies within a month, including bedtime and has only had a handful of accidents since the age of 3, day or night.
Be ready for accidents as he learns though, and stay chill about it.
5
Avatar von u/Notcreativeatall1234
Notcreativeatall1234
•
vor 2 Jahren
My daughter is 21 now still nonverbal and uses an AAC device. Her autism is caused by a congenital brain defect so she also has an intellectual disability.
**She took to the potty mostly on her own at the age of 7. I tried many times before that, but one day she refused a pull up and that was the

last day she ever wore one.**

Before that we just repeatedly and periodically put her on the toilet, watched Elmo episodes about the potty, etc. basically all the things you'd normally do.

So all this to say that she might be picking up on how to do it even if it doesn't seem like it right away. So just keep giving her the tools and hang in there. I think a lot of our kids do things in their own time.

2

PopPopLolliop

•

vor 2 Jahren

<https://www.actcommunity.ca/education/videos/toilet-training-for-everyone-revised-and-expanded/>

1

Avatar von u/WhatAGolfBall

WhatAGolfBall

•

vor 2 Jahren

Hi. This is from my last post about our potty training journey.

I stole some ideas from a book \"ready set potty\" for kids on the spectrum and other developmental differences.

When he was about 3.5, we tried the going every 15-minute method and also tracking what was happening.

I think it was good to know popular times to go #1/2. We tried no diaper and just undies and had lots of accidents. I think some kids at this age on the spectrum lack the introspection to know when they need to go. That urge that we feel and just know. They don't quite get that yet. So after trying this for 3 days, we gave up as the natural urge to go, and cleaning up poopy undies was too much.

We basically tried from that time and really kicking off at 4 to just try going whenever possible. Maybe once an hour. With pull-ups. just making it a habit.

We started getting good reports at his aba center that he would be dry in between bathroom breaks and then go. Also prompting when he had to go sometimes!

We noticed around 5 that he was staying dry. But our theory is with our son being a sensory seeker. He liked the feeling of being able to squeeze out a pee or poo whenever he wanted in his diaper. We were changing a pull-up 7 times a day. All this while getting reports of being dry at ei preschool and aba.

He fought a bit of bad diaper rash around then, and I finally had it. I just said, listen bro! We are going with big boy undies and shorts, no pull-ups.

We also went to potty every 20 minutes or so at first to get it really times then we realized when he liked to go. So we had a better idea.

We had a couple of accidents, but he really took to it. We prompted a lot, especially when he would normally go. And just tried a lot. He would start looking nervous sometimes, and we would ask. And then he started prompting us. Now, for a few months, he's been just going on his own.

And the past few weeks, he's been waking up dry in his oull up. So all this week, we started going to bed with no pullup. We make sure to go potty right before bed.

**I think it\'s patience and also just allowing them to learn their

body. Now, for us, wiping is the final step. He does it, but just once, and he runs. Lol. I\'m trying to teach him tp then wipes if needed. Then wash hands.**

2

nächster post : (poop related)

6 y/o not potty trained, we\'re all losing our minds

I don\'t even know what to do. We have been trying to get our son to use the potty for *years* now. He just doesn\'t care. He has gone months without dirty diapers and then suddenly he just stopped. We\'ve tried just about everything we can think of. We\'ve rewarded good behavior, we have ignored \"accidents\" we have just accepted that he\'ll be in diapers. But he doesn\'t have to be! He chooses the poops! We send him to the potty and he\'ll go pee and refuse to go poop. I\'ve let him take toys, books, tablet, into the bathroom with him. It\'ll work for a day or two and then he doesn\'t care. We\'ve taken toys away. He doesn\'t care. He has been without pants or diaper all week and we\'ve had to wash his sheets and change his clothes constantly because they get covered in poop. When he finally does sit on the potty and poop he uses his hand to wipe the poop on the toilet, himself, his clothes, the wall. He\'ll unroll an entire roll of toilet paper while he\'s sitting there instead of pooping and the minute he\'s in his clothes or a diaper again he is covered in poop. We can have him sit on the toilet for an hour (we don\'t have him do that but we could) and he would get up and poop in a diaper the second it\'s on, which means every night he goes to bed and we go in 10 minutes later and he\'s covered in poop. He will climb into bed next to me at night without waking me up and I wake up to poop in his diaper next to me.

He\'s high functioning, he\'s an amazing, smart, funny, goofy, sweet, loving guy. We just are losing our minds with the poop. Grandparents don\'t want to take him places because of the poop. We have spent so much money on his diapers, undies that get thrown away because of the poop. We want him to be able to play, spend time with us, etc. We\'re so exhausted. I don\'t know what to do. Help. :(

59

.

72

Kommentarbereich

OnceInABlueMoon

.

vor 7 Monaten

**I\'m a bit in the same boat but one thing I\'ve learned recently is that the rewards and such don\'t matter as much as the consistency of

the poop. If he has normal healthy poops then it\'s more likely that he will poop in the potty but if they\'re too soft or too hard then he won\'t. It\'s been a bit of a revelation after we spent so much time and trying different strategies and tactics. Still a work in progress but that knowledge has helped us.**

36

Avatar von u/needleandpen

needleandpen

Poster*in

.

vor 7 Monaten
He poops *all day long*
Every time he gets a new diaper, he poops. If we take the diaper off, he holds it. I\'m at the point of just having him just be naked even while he sleeps. I just want to cry because we\'re so exhausted from it.
16
stircrazyathome
.*
vor 7 Monaten
How many times a day is he pooping? I wonder if there is some sort of underlying GI issue if it\'s more than 2-3 times a day. Also, you mention how much you spend on diapers. While it won\'t do anything to help with training, you might be able to get diapers covered by insurance as incontinence supplies.
21
8 weitere Antworten
OnceInABlueMoon
.*
vor 7 Monaten
Yeah my son has been like that at times too. I think it\'s when he holds it for so long and gets backed up until he cannot hold it anymore and then it comes out in small poops quite often. Does you child ever poop in the potty or are you still working on getting that?
3

2 weitere Antworten
Avatar von u/tiny-greyhound
tiny-greyhound
.*
vor 7 Monaten
I agree, even though he\'s going regularly, it sounds like he\'s constipated.
I didn\'t think my son was, but his pediatrician could tell from feeling his belly. She had X-rays done to confirm. Yup really backed up, even though he was still going. She said, "he needs to be roto-rooted"
We cleared him out with laxative chocolate, and now give miralax regularly. His urologist said daily! He gave a tip that shaking it mixes it in a drink better than stirring. And we use an off brand and it works. Name brand is so expensive!
It\'s still a struggle. He\'ll go in his pants and not say anything. A doctor told us to have him sit at the same time daily and try to go, and his body will get used to going at that time. In our case, it\'s the morning. So far what semi is working is letting him have iPad time on the john. And just doing it every day so he gets used to it.
Now he will sit and doesn\'t need the iPad. The miralax makes his poops easy and quick. solid and smooth. He was surprised the first time. He said "it just slid out!"
But when he\'s in a bad mood, it\'s harder to get him to go... we are still working on it. He just turned 7. Good luck.
13
Avatar von u/W808203
W808203
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vor 7 Monaten

**Oh my\... my daughter is 5\... still in diapers for the \"just in case\" moment. We removed the TV because we felt that when she was engaged nothing else mattered. It\'s almost 2 months. She\'s improved by a lil bit. She is now verbalized that she has to go. In the past she would say it after the deed in dine or not at all. Yes its very frustrating. These days I make sure I afford her the opportunity to go anywhere. And even that\'s annoying because she\'ll wanna touch everything. It\'s not easy. My heart goes out to yall\... I pray this passes fast. Right now she wearing nighttime diapers\... its all I can

find to fit her.**

13

Avatar von u/needleandpen

needleandpen

Poster*in

•

vor 7 Monaten

We\'re lucky he\'s a skinny guy so he\'s still fitting into the size 5t-6t parents choice pull ups but even those are getting a bit short on him. He just doesn\'t seem to care. We talk to him and he rolls his eyes at us. We took every toy out of his room (he still had access to the toy closet, just wasn\'t allowed toys in his room) and it worked for 2 days, then he quit caring. We took all tv away, he doesn\'t care. We took his tablet away, he doesn\'t care. We ask him to sit and try to poop and he says \"I don\'t need to poop\" and has a meltdown. If we do get him to sit and he doesn\'t have a fit, he poops almost immediately and says that\'s all he can do but it\'s the tiniest poop. And if we have him sit to try to do more he plays in the poop. If we aren\'t staring at him 24/7 he plays in it. Last night he pooped, I was cooking dinner and my husband took 2 minutes to get to him. He had taken the toilet scrubber and was mashing the poop, splashing poop water all over himself, the toilet, and the floor. It\'s just never ending.

5

Avatar von u/W808203

W808203

•

vor 7 Monaten

  the meltdowns\... and poop                        

3

redditor-est2024

•

vor 7 Monaten

If you are in US, because of your son\'s age, you can get diapers prescribed like us. Pediatrician can prescribe it! I know it won\'t help with potty training but it\'ll help save the cost of purchasing diapers

10

Avatar von u/needleandpen

needleandpen

Poster*in

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vor 7 Monaten

I will look into it for him. We had tried a few months ago but he was 5 at the time, maybe now we can get them now that he\'s 6.

2

****2 weitere Antworten****

****100percentEV****

****•****

****vor 7 Monaten****

****TMI:** My daughter has had GI issues her whole life. Rather than going in her pants, hers involved the opposite. She would hold it until she became violently ill. Sweating, stabbing pain, then a softball sized poop would eventually make its way to the toilet, too big to flush. We had to give her miralax on a regular basis.**

****She still has the same issue with BMs, even at 25. She is on a twice daily stool softener, and still has difficulty sometimes. We got her a bidet this year and she actually LOVES it! It's been encouraging her to sit for longer, so we're hoping she relaxes and actually uses the potty more.****

****6****

****P00kiemonster****

****•****

****vor 7 Monaten****

****Time to throw in my hard earned two cents. My (now) 7yo. Struggled with chronic constipation and encopresis. He was not officially potty trained until 6 years old.****

****What worked was a total cleanout. MiraLAX mixed with his favorite drink and the BRAT diet (fine tuned to his dietary preferences) this took about a week to get totally cleaned out. We went through many pull-ups and had to invest in a carpet cleaner. Once he was cleaned out, he had to learn to use his rectal muscles appropriately, he had to learn his body's signals for poop time and we had to be ready at a moment's notice to shove a potty seat (much too small for him but whatever) under**

his booty.**

****Then we just ran out of pull-ups altogether, I had a stash in case of relapse but I just told him they were all gone. There was much protest and refusal of undies.****

****Eventually he just got the hang of it, idk if it was because tablet time was allocated for poop time only or if it was because it finally clicked in his brain either way I'm not complaining.****

****Nowadays we have emergency lactulose for when he's constipated and (with his pediatrician's approval) decaf coffee. I am not joking, he will ask for a cup of (decaf) coffee and a creamer of his choice if he feels like he's having a hard time. This miraculous remedy was discovered by my son when he was sneaking sips of his dad's coffee thinking we were drinking hot chocolate without him.****

****I wish you luck.****

****Edited to add. Encopresis is hoarding of poop until it leaks around the blockage. The hoarding is intentional (at least in my son's case) but it gets to a point where the liquid just involuntarily leaks around the solids causing accidents. It's painful and stressful for both you and your kid, if this is the case then please know that he's past the point of doing it intentionally and it's a real medical issue. Several small poops a day sounds like a fit. Please talk to the GI doc.****

****5****

****BetOnLetty****

****•****

****vor 7 Monaten****

****We're still dealing with encopresis and accidents after three years on**

miralax. Last doc said "just ignore it and don't talk about it." I'm lucky he's never gotten into smearing. I think part of the reason he withholds is he is so grossed out by the poop. It's the only thing keeping him on an IEP instead of a 504. I don't know if he'll ever get it. 🙄

1

Avatar von u/tiny-greyhound

tiny-greyhound

vor 7 Monaten

Have you tried cutting a hole in a diaper and having him sit on the potty?

4

Avatar von u/needleandpen

needleandpen

Poster*in

vor 7 Monaten

!!! I haven't !!! That's a great idea. I will add it to the list of things to try.

2

Avatar von u/tiny-greyhound

tiny-greyhound

vor 7 Monaten

I've also heard of people putting a training potty in the child's room, like their closet. Maybe the child wants more privacy. Have you tried different potties too? What kind of support does the big potty have? We like the one with two seats- big hole and small hole. I've also heard of people letting their kids sit backwards on the potty and draw with a dry erase marker on the lid... I haven't had to do that...

There are no rules, so do what you need to do!

I let my kids poo in the yard 🤢 during our pants free days. So they could connect the urge with going right away and not hold it in.

There's tips on YouTube too... my husband found one that said to put Vaseline on their bum so the poo will slide out easier. I hadn't needed to go that far.

It also helped my kids to show them science videos about digestion and poop.

And my husband: " kids, the poo wants to go down the waterslide!" Haha whatever it takes, right 😊

2

ConcernedMomma05

vor 7 Monaten

I had my son watch poop kids videos on YouTube . My son is level 1 high functioning as well. Poop was harder than pee and he was fully potty trained by 3. He held it in for so long at one point but I would sit him on the toilet and let him watch his poop show and eventually he just started going on his own.

4

Determined_doc

vor 7 Monaten

Please what videos are these. I've been trying to find what to make him watch so he understands what to do on the potty

1

Avatar von u/salty-lemons

salty-lemons

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vor 7 Monaten

I second everyone saying to see a GI doc. Pooping a single little poop 9+ times per day is not normal. Autistic people are more likely to have GI issues than the average person.

It could also be poor interoception- meaning he doesn't feel that he has to go and a little poop squeaks out before he knows it. As he makes leaps in some areas, other areas fall back. So it is possible he was able to feel it, but now that he is maturing and noticing other things, he has lost track of feeling his bowels. It isn't that he CAN'T feel it, it is that other sensations are overpowering his ability to notice.

If you rule everything physical out, I would look at how he has learned other lessons and try to implement that. My son has never cared about unrelated rewards or consequences. It would make no sense to him to get a lollipop if he pooped in the potty, or have a toy taken away if he pooped in his pants. Logical or related consequences work for him. A logical consequence would be to teach him, without shame, how to clean himself up, his underwear, his pants, and change his clothes. If he wipes poop anywhere, he has to clean it up. It'll be a terrible PITA for you for several weeks, because he is very bad at it right now. But if he makes a mess, he cleans it up. If he doesn't make a mess, he won't have to clean it up.

4

rationalomega

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vor 7 Monaten

My 6.5 year old is really good at cleaning poop accidents. Still happens every day.

2

Avatar von u/salty-lemons

salty-lemons

•••

vor 7 Monaten

There is a lot you can't control. you can't force someone to poop. You can't make their body ready or their bowels function properly. You can teach them how to accommodate and take care of themselves. You are accomplishing that.

My NT (????? I have my doubts, but never diagnosed) brother had trouble pooping his pants until 12. My parents tried everything. Spanking, rewards, charts. As a kid I would find hidden poopy underwear and smuggle them out of the house so he wouldn't get caught. My mom said that if she had it to do over, she would teach him how to clean himself and wash his underwear and clothes as best as possible and buy bulk sets of underwear. Nothing worked for him except time.

1

Las_Vegan

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vor 7 Monaten

I don't blame you for being frustrated, this is tough. I have some ideas as a fellow ASD parent so take all I say with a giant pinch of salt.

I'm wondering why he's pooping so often. Is he eating/snacking all the time? This is something I learned when my twins were babies- I got them on a schedule of discrete meal times at certain times of the day. That trained their bowels to produce waste at certain intervals instead of constantly. At 6 I imagine he's in a day program in a school. They definitely have a set meal schedule so I wonder when he would be in school, would this behavior change or improve?

3

TheMidnightSunflower

•

vor 7 Monaten

😄 Was in the same boat until recently. Not much help because he one day just walked himself up to the loo and pooped and that was that.

But I will say that having a bidet helped a lot. Mine did not like cleaning his poop (so would then smear it all over his hands? Child logic!). The bidet gave him an opportunity not to do that. We also have toilet paper to get the rest.

3

StarWars_Girl_

•

vor 7 Monaten

YMMV on the bidet. I'm ND (ADHD definitely with the sensory issues) and my brother is AuDHD. Neither of us can stand a bidet. 😞 We hate the feeling of it. We can do the same thing in the shower ourselves, but have a bidet do it? Giant nope, lol.

2

TheMidnightSunflower

•

vor 7 Monaten

That sucks! It was the only way we could get our one to consider cleaning himself properly. The idea of not having to touch too much poo (and he loves gadgets) really helped us.

But yeah, definitely not for everyone.

2

StarWars_Girl_

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vor 7 Monaten

That makes sense for him.

**Unfortunately, all of us NDs are different as to what sensory issues we have. I guess the fortunate thing with me and my brother is that we have very similar sensory triggers, so he may not communicate what is triggering him, but I usually have a pretty good idea. He is verbal, but his intellectual disability is a language processing issue, so he doesn't communicate effectively all the time, and he struggles with processing what was said. So a lot of times, we can tell there's a

sensory issue going on, but he can't tell us what it is. I can sometimes tell because the same thing is triggering me or I can sense it's something that could trigger me and my brain is filtering it out.**

**Except we both very clearly communicated a resounding NO to the bidet.

😬**

With him, wiping wasn't the issue because we did that for him initially to make sure he was getting clean. I'd love to know what the issue was, but even at 23, he still is very sensitive about where he goes. Like, he will not use a public bathroom if he needs to go #2. He will hold it and ask to go home or to our hotel room instead. I can occasionally get him to use a companion restroom. He used a regular one a total of one time, and it was a case of stomach upset; he took off for it. We knew he was comfortable over at my mom's friend's house because he went there. And he has only one toilet in the house that he'll use. We cannot figure it out. Also, we can tell when he needs to go because he gets cranky and very verbal right before he goes.

I'd love to unlock that section of his brain that can tell me what the sensory issue is around #2.

2

Due-Beautiful-6118

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vor 7 Monaten

For the poop smearing, get him a footie they have them footless or you can cut them out & out it on backwards, we did this for years until he stopped but we never knew until he got tired of pajamas I guess & he hasn't had an issue (yet) 🙏 I'm in the same boat, my son, 6 yrs old/level 2, could care less & since our last try before summer began he is now extremely protective of his privates & screams when I try to put underwear instead of a pull up on him. He is getting to the point he doesn't even want his pull up changed, that sensitive. I wish I had some advice hopefully combing through your comments will help me as well. Hang in there, I am trying to have faith it gets better and like everything else they'll do it on their own time. Meanwhile we're going into kindergarten not potty trained, although they know & it's not a huge deal, idt 🙄

3

Avatar von u/needleandpen

needleandpen

Poster*in

•

vor 7 Monaten

We did kindergarten last year. He started the year in undies but quickly decided he needed diapers. The teachers set up an area to change him in the teachers bathroom. I feel so bad for his teachers having to change him every day.

1

Due-Beautiful-6118

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vor 7 Monaten

I actually feel worse when they have to do the brunt of potty training. Taking them non stop, having to clean up accidents, change their clothes a lot. I think of changing a usually pee pee pull up not so bad :)

2

CalmRepresentative86

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vor 7 Monaten

****This sounds like more than a behavior issue. Might be about control, sensory signals, or emotional overwhelm. A pause from the pressure, plus support from an OT who understands interoception, could help reset the pattern.****

****2****

****fivehots****

****•****

****vor 7 Monaten****

****You've said everything that isn't working, so my advice would be to stop trying diapers and stop ignoring accidents (they won't go away because you put them online). Put him in underwear or Leave him Winnie the Pooh'd. Cold turkey. Throw 96% of the diapers away and hide the other 4% where he can't find them for emergencies.****

****You understand that he's choosing when to poop. So if he doesn't poop for 3 days, he doesn't poop for three days. He's not concerned about the feeling of poop more than he's concerned about comfort.****

****He needs to be put in a situation where his comfort is out shadowed by how uncomfortable he is. If you want to potty train him, cancel your plans for the next couple of months because you have to be vigilant when he isn't wearing pants or diapers. It's a full time job with these kids.**

I've sat with my son on the toilet for 2hours and 16 minutes. I timed it. Because I read a book and did homework in the silence. He needs to fully appreciate the lengths you will go to. And it doesn't seem like you're willing to go far.**

****Also, most importantly. The rewards for pooping in the toilet need to be massive and over the top. Every. Single. Time. His favorite reward. His favorite snack. Every time. Drive the companies stock up. But reward him every single time. Massively.****

****5****

****Avatar von u/needleandpen****

****needleandpen****

****Poster*in****

****•****

****vor 7 Monaten****

****Oh what I meant by ignoring the accidents is we don't lecture him on it or get angry, don't take things away because of it. We still change him and have him go sit on the potty. I have not had him sit for that long because he does just scream and cry and we have found when he is more relaxed he's more able to go. I have had him go every 10 minutes to sit for 5 minutes and that didn't work. The second he gets a bedtime diaper he poops. Or he poops in his undies and we have to throw them away. I told him I would throw him a party when he only poops in the potty. He seemed interested in that but we can't throw him a party, or buy him a cake every time he goes. He will poop the tiniest poop and hold the rest and then do that 10 times a day. Ugh. Idk. I'm taking your comment to heart though. Will discuss with my husband. I'm so heartbroken that he just smells like poop all the time and he gets massive rashes in his butt. He screams and cries and just keeps doing it!****

****4****

****fivehots****

****•****

****vor 7 Monaten****

****You said, "we offer no discipline or recourse." You should see by now,**

he's choosing to do this. It's not an accident.**
You need to lecture him. You need to get upset. How will he know if something is an issue if your reaction is the same good or bad?
My kid can scream. He can cry. He can yell. He can tantrum til the cops come. All on the toilet. I tell him all time with any number of things, "you can do it quiet. Or you can do it crying. But you're going to do it."
Don't offer him something you can't commit on. Imagine asking him for a commitment when you and he knows you're lying. And I know you know he knows you're lying. They're observant. My kid's favorite thing is pudding. So I bought soooooo many puddings. It's sustainable and cheap. Your kid has a thing. Get it. In excess. Make sure he sees you buying it. Make sure he he knows it's for poop. And make sure you hold your ground against your kid.
All kids cry. Such is things. So, let him cry. I'm sure you'd rather his tail be red from sitting on the toilet all day than from rashes.
4
4 weitere Antworten
StarWars_Girl_
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vor 7 Monaten
So I am a sibling (and also neurodivergent) but I'm a big believer in that just because they're autistic doesn't mean they shouldn't have any discipline.
I'm not saying yell or get angry because that doesn't help anything. But taking away the TV or the tablet when he does it? Valid.
My brother was almost the same age as your son when he was fully potty trained. I echo the sentiment of taking away the diapers...don't let it be an option. If he goes in his underwear, he gets to be uncomfortable. My parents used a combo of rewards and positive punishment to get him to go. When he went, he got a \"special cookie\" (a Nilla Wafer) that he only got when he went on the toilet. I forget exactly what he got taken away when he didn't go; I think TV. It wasn't easy, but it did eventually work. He's 23 and has in fact used a toilet for a very long time now.
Also, not yelling or getting angry doesn't mean you can't show your kid that you're disappointed in their behavior. Very firmly expressing disappointment while not yelling or getting angry can be very effective.
2
frogsgoribbit737
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vor 7 Monaten
Withholding causes constipation. It IS a problem.

3
fivehots
.*
vor 7 Monaten
Not for my kid. Anything else?
-3
tinyfeeds
.*
vor 7 Monaten

This sounds like he's fed up with his GI tract - he's telling you he can't manage it, that he's confused about what's happening and he's over it. I suspect he has some gastro emptying issues or motility issues. Motility issues are common in autism. It means the gut's waves (muscle action that moves the poop through the intestines) are not orderly. So you get a little bit through while a little kicks back into the system. His urge to poop is probably constant right now and he sick of this shit. And the urge may be disordered as well. Sometimes he knows and sometimes he tuned it out because it's there often enough that he can't take another trip to the bathroom. And he's fed up enough that he's abusing the poop and himself and you all by wiping it on things. He's saying this problem is a horrible experience for him and he's not articulating it, he's demonstrating it. Fighting the toilet is probably just straight being sick of sitting there to find the problem is only partly solved and he'll be back again 5 more times. So a GI doc is a good idea. Have them look at whether he's hypermobile as well - there's a lot of crossover with EDS/gut issues and neurodivergence. If he's hypermobile, that raises the chance that this is a motility issue. In the short term, laxatives, fluids and fiber to keep things moving. And what you'll want to ask for from the doc if these things don't help is treatments for IBS. As for him, tell him it's not his fault that there's so much pooping going on, that you're going to get help and try some things to make him more comfortable and ask him to stick it out with you - that poop everywhere is no fun, it's smelly and dangerous and that you know the toilet is no fun, but that help is on the way and you'll all work together to solve his discomfort.

0

Avatar von u/needleandpen

needleandpen

Poster*in

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vor 7 Monaten

omg I love your comment. Thank you so much for the advice and the kind way you said it. We try to not make him feel bad about having so many poops. He's definitely hypermobile, like me, but neither of us has had any testing done. I told everyone who watches him we are doing miralax every morning until he can start having normal poops. He has the GI doc in September.

2

3 weitere Antworten

MoonDancer83

•

vor 7 Monaten

Look into finding an larger size potty or one of those portable camping toilets they kind of look like a bucket with a toilet seat attached, because with my oldest (not poop potty trained till 5) he hated the splash back (the water splash touched his bottom once) so I used a larger size potty with a nappy lining the bottom (you can use paper towel also) he started pooping in the potty and the nappy was removed and thrown away making for easier clean up, it took another year to transition to the big toilet. It's worth a try because I do have one in nappies and hes a teenager now and I would do anything for him to able to toilet train but due to his complex medical conditions that will never be possible.

1
\[gelöscht\]
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vor 7 Monaten
I guess this is what I have to look forward to with my five-year-old. He refuses to use the bathroom altogether.
1
frogsgoribbit737
•
vor 7 Monaten
My son was pee trained for 2 years before poop. I worked really really hard to get him comfortable on the toilet. We started with him pooping in the bathroom in a pull up. Then he moved to pooping on the potty with pull up. Then we worked on pooping on potty without pull up. Hes 5 and still requires an adult in the bathroom with him.

Having him sit forever on the toilet NEVER worked. In fact, it made things worse.
1
Avatar von u/Mysterious-Pie-4738
Mysterious-Pie-4738
•
vor 7 Monaten
Reiterating what others have said regarding no MiraLAX/Restoralax. I found this very helpful to give every day/other day. I would mix it in his water bottle for the day and leave him to it.
After seeking out help with local services (Ontario, Canada), we found a process that worked for us with potty training - Preference Assessment/what motivates him and "First, Then" approach.
The preference assessment was basically lining up all the things he liked (candy,toys, drinks, etc) and seeing what he would go to first. We did an assessment regularly. My child liked gum & Swedish berries. Every time he used the toilet, we would say - First toilet and then gum/candy etc. Building the routine and staying/trying to remain consistent was definitely the hardest.
We worked on peeing first; he used to poop in the shower as he didn't really know how to tell us he needed to go (non verbal). We used a lot of pictures around the house (toileting routine, wash hands etc). We even have a camping toilet in the car wherever we go - this is a game changer as it has helped avoid meltdowns when he holds his pee for too long.
He is now at a point where he goes pee on his own, will pull us to the car toilet when travelling, and will request a diaper for pooping.
We tried potty training for 2 years, then last fall when we got some supports, we pushed through. It was very hard and we had a tonne of accidents, lots of poop. But I am so grateful we did the preference thing and first,then.
I find routine, some sort of consistency, and pictures have been incredibly helpful and important in getting us through this milestone.
Seek out any services in your area to help you. The overwhelming amount of info on social media can be too much and not everyone has family/friends to help them out.
1
1baby2cats

vor 7 Monaten

So I was in the exact same situation 6 months ago. I tried everything suggested to us by our BI/BC, physio, occupational therapist, etc. She knew when she had to poop, knew she was supposed to go in the toilet, but just refused to do it. She even refused to sit on the toilet with a diaper on, she would only go on her diaper while squatting on the ground. She would have a meltdown and just hold in her poop if we tried to sit her on the potty. Our BC said, maybe she's just not ready?

So after many stressful months of trying, we simply gave up. For 3 months we didn't even try to get her to go on the toilet, just let her go in her diaper. Then one night in the middle of dinner, she got up and went to the bathroom, we assumed she went to pee. After a few minutes we could hear her yelling " I did it! I pooped in the toilet!". I went in not believing her, but to my surprise, she did! After praising her effusively, I asked why she suddenly pooped in the toilet, and she just said "it's easy!"

So I know that is not super advice for OP, but sometimes you just have to wait til they're ready? I wouldn't believe it if it didn't happen to myself!

1

Avatar von u/Left-Bat989

Left-Bat989

vor 7 Monaten

Someone recommended the "seemegopotty" app on here when I posted asking for tips and advice on potty training. It does cost to buy but It got my son copying the actions and sitting on the toilet and the occasional pee or poo. We have the early years working involved and she said make it apart of a routine getting them on the toilet. Have bubbles as the blowing sometimes helps them pee and activities to distract them so they'll still there and hopefully do a pee or a poo!

1

Avatar von u/needleandpen

needleandpen

Poster*in

vor 7 Monaten

We have let him take balloons to try to blow them up while he's sitting. He tends to just put everything into the toilet so we have to be very careful about what we actually let him do while he's in there.

1

Jaded_Apple_8935

vor 7 Monaten

**I do not know what state you are in, but in 49 of 50 states, kids with disabilities qualify for Medicaid regardless of their family income. It is called a Katie Beckett or a TEFRA waiver. They are just considered by themselves through age 18 then if they are income eligible at that point they get put on regular adult Medicaid. I would look at your state's department of Medicaid and see if you can apply for him only based on his disability. I would definitely try and call and talk to a person when you apply because otherwise the computer systems usually

will just consider household income instead of "waiving" it.**
1

Avatar von u/needleandpen
needleandpen
Poster*in
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vor 7 Monaten
I will look into that! Thank you! Our household is right above the cut off so it has been very frustrating and expensive!
1

Jaded_Apple_8935
•

vor 7 Monaten
Yes, we spent easily 1,000 a month on therapies between my 2 kids until I figured this out.
1

KeepGoingLazy
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vor 7 Monaten
If he is holding the poop until he has a diaper have you considered trying to use miralx or something to help him to make going easier? Also, it might be helpful to make sure he is comfortable in the way he is sat to have a BM.
1

Avatar von u/LongHoodFool
LongHoodFool
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vor 7 Monaten
Don't give up- my 9 yr old finally was potty trained around 7. He still would poop sometimes. The worst experience was when he pooped in the public pool and it had to be closed down while they cleaned. I was so embarrassed - I have ptsd from it. 😂
He still sometimes pees the bed - I have another asd son 7yrs old- he potty trained faster ~5 yrs old but he still wets the bed. I'm that house always doing laundry. 😞
1

Bunchasticks
•

vor 7 Monaten
Autistic person here. I was a significantly difficult child to potty train, and I had the same refusal around pooping. Its called encopresis. My parents set up two bags in the bathroom. The \"I tried\" bag and the \"I did it!\" Bag. The \"I tried\" bag was for when I made a solid attempt to poop, and I was given a small sticker or something as a reward. The \"I did it!\" Bag was for when I actually pooped in the toilet, ans it had a bigger toy inside. The bag system combined with this thing called \"Potty University\", which im not even sure is still around anymore, but its a training course that taught me how to go to the bathroom. I was either in a doctor's office doing the training or at home with someone, I dont remember. But after I completed the course I didnt need any more potty training.
1

GotAnyGrapes5390
•

****vor 6 Monaten****

****I\`m in the same predicament with our 7 year old ass daughter she knows how to use the potty but refuses and soils herself. She knows how to change herself and was doing so for a while but regressed and she refuses to do it without my help. I\`ve tried sticker charts and incentives and everything else including bribery with prizes. I\`ve even tried telling her that it\`s nasty to pee and poop herself without trying to sound belittling. I\`ve expressed to her my frustration and sadness that she won\`t wear underwear and use the potty. She will at school most of the time and we\`re trying to encourage underwear at school but she has accidents when wearing them. She knows how to use the potty and I\`ve tried making it fun and rewarding and tried all the videos I was thinking about trying to make it seem like we don\`t have any pull ups to see how that goes. Also talk to his pediatrician about his incontinence and they can write a prescription for pull ups and pee pads and gloves. We were spending so much on pull ups and her care coordinator through her insurance told me about that. If he has medicade some states have a amount every month you can spend on over the counter items like wipes and pull ups too. It has helped us so much. It\`s crazy a box of 52 pull ups Walmart brand is almost \\\\$30 it\`s criminal****

****1****

****GotAnyGrapes5390****

****.*****

****vor 6 Monaten****

****If he\`s not on medicaid your regular insurance provider may have an over the counter allowance for qualified items like pull ups and wipes and pads. They have people who are care coordinators for your insurance company and he definitely qualifies for a care coordinator. Ours has helped so much and has pushed for her pediatricians office to write a letter for personal care services and is trying to get me into an agency because she qualifies for 22 hours of personal care services like caregiver services and is trying to make me her caregiver to help us out because she freaks out if I\`m not at home with her so having a job is hard we have a very small family and she has bad separation anxiety. I can\`t work due to it my husband does. She even cries when I put her on the bus for school and says she misses me. I\`m pretty sure your son could qualify for pcs and you could be his caregiver. It certainly helps to be able to be a stay at home mom for him. I don\`t know your situation and employment but it definitely helps.****

****nächster post:****

****Am I the only one who feels like potty training with autism is impossible?****

****I\`m honestly at my breaking point with potty training my son who\`s on the spectrum. Every single method I\`ve tried just falls apart (visual schedules, rewards, timers, you name it). The sensory issues make everything 10X harder and I feel like I\`m constantly cleaning up accidents while my daughter toddles around getting into everything else.****

****Does anyone else feel like they\`re completely failing at this? I\`m so tired of the meltdowns every time we even mention the bathroom, and I swear some days I just want to give up and let him wear diapers forever. My husband keeps saying \\\`he\`ll get it eventually\`" but I\`m drowning here and nothing seems to work for more than a day or two before we\`re**

back at square one.**
19
.
30
Kommentarbereich
Avatar von u/TraKat1219
TraKat1219
.
vor 7 Monaten
**I see you. My 6 year old grandson is also on the spectrum and still in
diapers. He refuses to even try sitting on the potty. We're at a loss
here too.**
6
Expert_Razzmatazz_72
.
vor 7 Monaten
**Same my son turns 5 in November and sits on the potty for half a
second then says "all done"**
3
1 weitere Antwort
Minute_Parfait_9752
.
vor 7 Monaten
**My daughter was 3, so much smaller but I used to literally sit her
down and give her chocolate. Then it graduated to me getting the
chocolate out and saying \"potty\" and she'd sit herself down. There
was a grade from literally bum touch seat get chocolate to dragging it
out and making her wait a bit though**

3
taaajmanian_devil
.
vor 7 Monaten
**No. I feel the same way with my autistic 3 year old. The ABA is trying
to work with him which I appreciate. As for me, I've given up
completely. I don't even try. Here's your pull up little dude.**
**The clean ups, the stress, the crying (both me and him). I just
decided to let it go for now. Next step is to get him scheduled with
regular OT sessions. His pediatrician recommended it. To be honest, my
faith is completely gone so we'll see how this goes.**
5
nothanks86
.
vor 7 Monaten
He's three. It's far from a hopeless case. Really.
**I don't know where your son's at, but my adhd kid decided to potty
train at 3.5. Very her led. I was actually pregnant at the time, and
super unimpressed when her dad immediately leaned into it because
pregnancy sucked and I did not want to deal with one more thing. But it
went really well, once I figured out that underpants were out of the
question for a whiile, because she couldn't tell the difference between
the feel of diapers and underpants, and the pants-free thing we'd tried
was going to stick around.**
**My adhd kid is...potty training at around the same age, a little
later. She's not as into dresses, so it works best when she's just

bottomless, although she generally just ends up completely nude at home.**

Oh, also, for my audhd kid, we had the potty in the living room where she played, so it was right there if the urge struck, and she didn't have to deal with all the transitions of leaving the room to go to the bathroom. That helped cut out a lot of barriers, too.

3

Beautiful_May_34

Poster*in

•

vor 7 Monaten

**I\`ve been nervous about making the association of potty in the living room rather than the bathroom. Have you seen that become a problem at all?*

1

TheAngryTradesman

•

vor 7 Monaten

Currently potty training my ADHD 3 year old son, completely led by him, I waited until he wanted to start, and having a similar experience. We're 2 weeks in, he has a potty in the living room which he now uses consistently.

Poos took a few days of screaming, shaking meltdowns and withholding, but then it just suddenly clicked and the last couple of days.

He wears a pull up at nap time and overnight, and if we go out anywhere because I do not want to give him the added stress until he's ready and 100% comfortable using the toilet when he needs. He's also still completely naked from the waist down at home during the day as he has similar issues with recognising his body's cues when he has underwear on.

We'll keep going at his pace and not worry about how long it takes, he'll get there eventually!

1

T-rex-x

•

vor 7 Monaten

I have potty trained a few kids with autism in a psychology centre for kids i worked at

It was completely different to anything you see posted on mainstream media etc. it was VERY regimented.

If you google something along the lines of potty training for learning disability peer reviewed it will show you two different methods but the one we mostly used was a long the lines of:

No nappy - then sit on the potty until they go. Literally. They can do whatever they want to keep them there , ipad etc . But must stay on potty (or in bathroom if meltdown over sitting). They can leave once they go - and they immediately get a MASSIVE reinforcement such as lollipop, cream egg, toy car etc ... something they dont normally get

Then they can go out and play again. Then 30 minutes later back and repeat - for example i sat in the bathroom for almost an hour at one point. You also up their liquid intake to get more success.

**I did this with a child 3 days a week for 3 hours and his mum put him back in nappies otherwise and it took maybe around 2/3 months for him to

be completely potty trained**
9

Beautiful_May_34
Poster*in
•

vor 7 Monaten
Not sure how I would get my kid to sit there without moving, that sounds impossible.
3
T-rex-x
•

vor 7 Monaten
Use anything that gets them sitting, books, ipad , videos etc ... if that is too hard work up to it. Reinforcer for 1 minute sitting , then work up to 2 minutes sitting etc. it can be a lengthy process for some kids
1
Avatar von u/Dashcamkitty
Dashcamkitty
•

vor 7 Monaten
What did the children wear? Just pants or nothing. We're trying this method with my son.
1
T-rex-x
•

vor 7 Monaten

They wore trousers and pants! Just normal clothes - and had LOTS of accidents which is completely normal. When you do it spaced and not intensively it takes time to click
1
xoxosecretsally
•

vor 7 Monaten
Currently on day 74 of this, my 3 year son (Likely ASD I or maybe 2). We started a month after he turned 3 using the \"Oh Crap\" method.
He even slept overnight without any accidents on day 4, and was peeing in the adult toilet by day 7 & pooping at Day 30.
No rewards. He was communicative & told us when he needed to go. He hated all the toddler potties, he would run to the bathroom to go (he's also extremely tall, he's the size of an almost 5 year old child)
Amazingly, son did great, but regressed heavily around day 45 and we've been battling that ever since, so now I bribe him with 2 chocolate chips for peeing in the toilet, 4 for pooping in the toilet.
Amazon has a great sale right now for our favorite Enzyme Cleaner (Kids n Pets) & also on Oxiclean Free and Clear & Lysol laundry sanitizer. I can't stand the pee smell on clothes & sheets.
Also, son has a flushing stim, he snuck over to the bathroom in the middle of the night a month ago and clogged up the toilet with TP & flooded the house 😊
1
T-rex-x
•

vor 7 Monaten

Thats so amazing!! Regressions are so common and likely!! Even for completely potty trained neurotypical children

It sounds like your son is doing really well with it

1

Avatar von u/Lost-Purple-7020

Lost-Purple-7020

•

vor 7 Monaten

I'm on attempt #2 right now with an almost 4 year old and I'm going crazy.

4

WeekendAshamed6355

•

vor 7 Monaten

me too with my 4yo 😞 it's so hard

3

lucymilesatx

•

vor 7 Monaten

My daughter has mild to moderate autism and we potty trained her using the Oh Crap Potty Training method. It was a bit intense, but she got the hang of it after a couple of weeks. Avoiding diapers and pull-ups seemed to help her with the learning process. That said, we had to dedicate about 2-3 weeks of staying at home with very short outings.

3

Beautiful_May_34

Poster*in

•

vor 7 Monaten

I'll look into this, thank you.

1

Expert_Razzmatazz_72

•

vor 7 Monaten

**Yes same it's super hard. I potty trained my other son who isn't autistic, over summer vacation super easy. Now he's all set for pre k and being in underwear. I have given up with potty training my autistic son, he would withheld his pee the whole day. Now I'm having him change himself now. Take of his pull up put it in the garbage now get. A new pull up on. Reality is he's getting bigger and harder for me to change

him. Hes super tall for his age. He starts kindergarten next year, hoping something clicks one day.**

3

ShitShow_Coordinator

•

vor 7 Monaten

Starting this method this weekend cause lord knows nothing else has worked for us. I swear I feel like I'm going through postpartum depression again 3 years after having a baby and all because of potty training but it's emotional, hard, and an absolute mind f*%.

<https://www.actcommunity.ca/education/videos/toilet-training-for-everyone-revised-and-expanded/>

3

Beautiful_May_34

Poster*in

•

vor 7 Monaten

I will look into this, thank you.

1

No-Slide3677

•

vor 7 Monaten

Currently struggling with this. My mild ASD daughter is 3yrs 9mo and she has been holding it to the point of not peeing/pooping for up to 24hrs. The wait list at our hospital is 7-10mo to get into the toileting program for developmentally delayed children. Sending positive vibes your way 🍀

3

Avatar von u/LowPlane2578

LowPlane2578

•

vor 7 Monaten

My son has autism. He is 5, nearly 6 and we have only just mastered #2. Toilet training him was the most relentless and frustrating journey.

The only thing I could make sense of was that he couldn\'t sense his need or urgency to use the bathroom. His brain/body connection was just different. To add to the mix he has a speech delay.

Once we got #1 happening on the toilet, it became a whole new game of getting to the toilet on time. I was very regimented. At one point I would take him to the toilet every 20-30 mins just in the hope that I would catch a wee. I felt insane at times. But eventually, my son also caught on. I would add, that I would not wait more than a minute or two, 5 at max when taking him to the toilet. If he did nothing, I would take him off and come back again 30 mins later and repeat the process. At one stage he would hold his wees for hours and I would take him to the loo, know full-well he needed the toilet. In those moments I would leave him on the toilet longer than 5 minutes and nothing. Then the moment I took him off the toilet, not a moment later he would pee himself. This was an ongoing thing for a while. I just asked him why - I even cried.

Another big thing was no distractions. I had much greater success when the TV was off. In fact, it sort became a bargaining chip. The aim was to help my son to be more in tune with his body. I would give him lots of reminders about using the toilet, but I mostly took him to the toilet on a schedule. We only really managed all of this in the last 12 months.

He eventually began to recognise his own need to use the toilet to do wees. Again, that wasn\'t smooth sailing. Even when he would go independently to do a wee, he would also still wet himself. So my husband and I would constantly be reminding him and taking him to the toilet.

We followed the same process with #2. It has really only been in the last 2 months that he\'s actually going to the toilet independently. There will still be an occasional accident, but he cleans himself up - there\'s that.

There was a lot of stopping and starting along the way.

**All I can say is keep at it. It is such a different process. You

cannot compare the journey to any other child. It\'s not linear. Even when you think you\'ve had a success you might find yourself right back at the beginning. But those little moments of success are actually building connections. Plus the other thing was prayer. I was so desperate for my kid to use the loo - I prayed.**

My heart is with you in this.

2

Avatar von u/horusluprecall

horusluprecall

•

vor 7 Monaten

I feel you wholeheartedly on this my 6-year-old non-speaking autistic son is learning and he is sometimes good about telling us he needs to go and sometimes good about going when we take him but most of the time not and as someone as well with disabilities (ehlers danlos syndrome but she and I share) I fully understand that not every person who has a condition is exactly the same as any other person who has that same condition just because two people have a condition that has the same name doesn\'t mean their bodies are going to function the same way. For example I\'m also a type 2 diabetic but my type 2 diabetes is very different from some of the other type two diabetic people that I have known, as I seem to have been able to get my glucose levels well within normal range with no medication and simply relying on dietary changes and exercise.

Let us hope that Nicolas can be further along in his journey by the time School returns. We\'ve been lucky in that he has a really great cea who is happy to deal with any accidents that he has during school and we\'re very lucky that she is going to be his cea again next year because she requested that she be allowed to continue with him and the school district has allowed her to do that.

1

Nurse_Tamika_01

•

vor 7 Monaten

We\'ve had some good success with our Goally tablet. We set up a routine for \"going potty\" and it will remind my son to go potty every 30 mins. It then shows the visuals of the whole process so he can see what he is suppose to do first, then and next so he knows what to expect. However, potty training a kid with autism is next level and is so hard.

2

helloSarah95

•

vor 7 Monaten

We also use Goally for our routines and the emotional regulation app.

2

Beautiful_May_34

Poster*in

•

vor 7 Monaten

I will check out Goally, thank you.

1

****awwwkweird****

****•••****

****vor 7 Monaten****

****I feel you. My 4 year old ASD kiddo has been training for going pee in the potty for over a year. For the most part he has it down but still regresses because he's still in Pull Ups. We tried taking the Pull Ups away and he either withheld to the point where he kept sharting for days or he would just poop in the underwear. It's so tough.****

****1****

****Avatar von u/sunnybunny1313****

****sunnybunny1313****

****•••****

****vor 5 Monaten****

****I feel your pain. Im trying to potty training my nonverbal 4 year old but since he cant even tell me when he needs to go to the bathroom, it feels truly impossible and its putting me into a depression. Im hoping as he gets older and continues on his therapy which we began recently that it will get easier but for now it feels like a pointless battle tbh****

Light Research GPT

Markt- und Kundenintelligenz: Potty-Training-Unterwäsche für autistische und sensorisch sensitive Kinder

Methodik und Datenbasis

Diese Analyse kombiniert qualitative „Voice-of-Customer“-Daten (Forenposts, Kommentare, Produktrezensionen) mit quantitativen Ankern aus Gesundheits-/Fachquellen zu Autismusprävalenz und Toileting-Barrieren. Der Fokus liegt explizit auf Potty-Training/Toileting bei autistischen Kindern sowie Kindern mit sensorischer Überempfindlichkeit (taktile Aversionen, Geräuschsensitivität, Interozeption).

Primäre qualitative Quellen (öffentlich zugänglich, exemplarisch):

Eltern-Threads und Kommentare auf Reddit (v. a.

Eltern-/Autismus-Subcommunities), Diskussionsstränge auf Mumsnet, Langform-Austausch auf Autism Forums, öffentliche Diskussionen/Posts in Facebook-Gruppen (nur frei sichtbare Snippets), sowie öffentlich sichtbare Produktrezensionen bei Target (inkl. 1-Stern-Kritik & 5-Stern-Lob).

Sekundäre Fachquellen (für Muster, Ursachenhypothesen, Zahlen):

u. a. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (Prävalenz), World Health Organization (globale Einordnung), The National Autistic Society (Toileting-Ursachen/Barrieren, Druck von Außen), Autism Speaks (Expert-Q&A-Stil, Alltagsstrategien), Autism New Zealand (sensorisch-praktische Toileting-Hinweise), sowie peer-reviewte Evidenz zu Toileting-Resistance in ASD.

Wichtige Limitierungen (transparent):

Ein Teil der vom Auftrag gewünschten Plattformen ist technisch/robotisch eingeschränkt (z. B. BabyCenter / What to Expect nicht abrufbar; TikTok gesperrt; Amazon-Detailseiten nicht zuverlässig abrufbar; einzelne Retailer-Reviews blocken Bot-Traffic). Deshalb wurden vergleichbare, öffentlich erreichbare Review-Korpora (Target-Reviews), öffentliche Foren und Marken-/Fachwebsites als Ersatz herangezogen. Die „Raw Language Vault“ basiert daher überproportional auf Foren- und Community-O-Ton, weniger auf Amazon-Rezensionen.

Zielkunden-Intelligenz und emotionale Landschaft

Kundenprofil in der Realität

Der Kernkunde ist nicht „Eltern von Kleinkindern“. Es sind Eltern, die zugleich (a) Toileting als täglichen Krisenprozess erleben und (b) das Gefühl haben, im System „Schule/Daycare/Ärzte/Therapie“ permanent liefern zu müssen -- inklusive Rechtfertigung, warum ihr Kind „noch“ nicht trocken ist. Das zeigt sich wiederholt in Posts, die nicht nur nach Tipps fragen, sondern nach sozialer Entlastung („nicht faul“, „nicht schlechtere Eltern“).

Soziodemografie (aus offen erkennbaren Signalen; vorsichtig interpretiert):

Elterngeschlecht: In den Threads dominiert „Mom-Voice“, aber eine sichtbare Minderheit sind Väter („I'm a dad in my forties...“).

Elternalter: Selten explizit genannt; wenn, dann häufig 30--40+ (z. B. „dad in my forties“; „I was 42 at his birth“ in öffentlichen Social-Snippets). Daraus folgt: Viele sind in einer Lebensphase, in der Zeit/Arbeitsdruck stark sind und „nochmal drei Monate Bootcamp“ kaum machbar ist.

Kindesalter: Der „Hot-Zone“-Zeitraum ist 3 bis 6 Jahre (klassisch: „My daughter is 3...“, „my son is 4...“, „my son is 5...“, „nearly 6...“),

mit einem langen Tail bis ins Schulalter und sogar

Jugend/Erwachsenenalter bei höherem Supportbedarf.

Haushaltsform: Häufig Paarhaushalte („me and my wife...“), aber auch Single Parents mit deutlich höherer Emotions- und Logistiklast.

Ökonomische Einordnung: Direkte Einkommen selten. Indirekt deuten

Therapy-Stack (OT, Speech, IEP, ABA-Programme) und Aussagen wie „taken SO MUCH time off work“ auf Haushalte, die zumindest zeitweise Ressourcen mobilisieren -- oder daran zerbrechen.

Die dominanten emotionalen Treiber

Das wiederkehrende Muster ist: Toileting ist nicht „ein Skill“, sondern ein sozialer Marker (School readiness, „big kid“, „nicht auffallen“).

Genau deshalb eskaliert die Emotion.

Scham & sozialer Blick („pull-up showing“, „staring“):

Eltern beschreiben Scham sehr konkret, körperlich („I can just feel the looks... they stare...“). Das ist keine abstrakte Sorge -- es ist ein Alltagsmoment in der Öffentlichkeit.

Burnout & Erschöpfung („surviving, not living“):

Erschöpfung wird nicht als „müde“ beschrieben, sondern als

Funktionsausfall („so tired... zoning out... surviving, not living“).

Toileting ist darin ein weiterer Druckpunkt.

Angst vor „hinten sein“ & Vergleichspanik:

„One of the last kids...“ / „behind his twin brother...“ / „starting school“ -- Vergleich ist nicht freiwillig, er ist strukturell erzwungen (Daycare/School Gatekeeping).

Angst vor „Regression“ & Kontrollverlust:

Schon die Titel („toilet training down the drain“, „potty training hell“) zeigen: Eltern erwarten Rückschritte, weil sie sie erlebt haben.

Die psychologische Konsequenz ist Hypervigilanz, Timer-Diktatur und „Camp“-Denken.

Hopes & Desires unter der Oberfläche

Unter „dry“ steckt selten „trocken“. Es steckt:

„Ich will nicht mehr verhandeln müssen“ (mit Kind, mit Schule, mit Partner, mit dem eigenen Nervensystem).

„Ich will, dass mein Kind Würde hat“ (kein „babyish diaper“, kein Bloßstellen, keine Kommentare). Dazu passt, dass Marken stark über „big

kid confidence" kommunizieren -- und Eltern diese Identitätsbrücke tatsächlich nutzen („felt like a big boy", „big girl undies"). „Ich will, dass Institutionen uns nicht ausschließen" („impossible to

find a school... not potty trained"; „asked to leave because..."). Das ist nicht Komfort, das ist Teilhabe.

Outside Forces und „Villains"

Die „Bösewichte" sind selten einzelne Personen. Es sind Systeme und Normen:

Schule/Daycare als Gatekeeper: „won't take him because he's not potty trained" -- Toileting wird Eintrittskarte.

Professioneller Druck + teilweise schlechtes Advice: The National Autistic Society beschreibt explizit den Druck von Familie/Freunden/Professionals und dass daraus „unhelpful or even misleading" Advice entstehen kann.

Ärzte, die Timeline moralisch aufladen: Eltern berichten, von Ärzt:innen „chastised" worden zu sein, weil ein Kind „mit 3" nicht trocken ist -- das übersetzt sich direkt in Schuld/Scham.

„Comparison Culture" in Familien: „peer pressure will kick in" ist die internalisierte Familien-/Peer-Norm, die Eltern selbst reproduzieren, weil sie keine Alternative sehen.

Autismus-spezifische Toileting-Hürden

Die wiederkehrenden Mechanismen hinter „Es klappt nicht"

Autistische Kinder haben -- je nach Profil -- zusätzliche Hürden, die in Elternsprache oft als „Sturheit" oder „doesn't care" erscheinen, sachlich aber häufig erklärbar sind:

Interozeption (Körper-Signale werden nicht erkannt/zu spät erkannt): Fachquellen beschreiben, dass innere Signale (Blase/Darm) schwerer interpretierbar sein können und Toileting-Programme darauf angepasst werden müssen.

Eltern formulieren es in Rohsprache brutal klar: „it's almost like he can't even tell he needs to pee" oder „They don't give me cues".

Sensorik/Umwelt (Bad als Overload-Raum):

Die typischen Trigger sind dokumentiert: Flush-Geräusch, Gerüche (Reinigungsmittel), kalter Boden, Licht, Spiegel, „big hole".

Rigidität/Change-Resistance:

Ein „banaler" Wechsel (Windel → Unterhose) kann als massiver Verlust von Vorhersagbarkeit erlebt werden. Ein Elternbeispiel beschreibt eine graduelle Kette (Garten → Eimer → Toilette) über nahezu ein Jahr -- reine Change-Desensibilisierung.

Kommunikationsbarrieren (nonverbal/limited expressive):

„He just won't tell you he needs to go" ist eines der häufigsten Muster; es taucht in School/Daycare-Kontexten besonders häufig auf.

Häufigste Trigger in Elternsprache

Aus dem Korpus lassen sich Trigger-Cluster ableiten (mit typischem O-Ton):

Sitzen/Position: „he won't sit... goes stiff, screams/moans"; häufig auch „planks".

Timer/Prompting als Demand: „every 30 minutes... complete meltdown"; bei PDA-Profilen wird Toileting selbst als „ultimate ... demand" beschrieben.

Kleidung an/aus, Wechselstress: Kinder, die das Nasssein hassen, fordern „changing all the time"; andere tolerieren Nasssein komplett („doesn't care"). Beide Extreme erzeugen Stress -- entweder durch Dauerwechsel

oder durch fehlende Lernkopplung.

Gerüche & sensorisch aversive Produkte: „smell horrible“ (Trainingpants nach dem Urinieren), „chemical smell“.

Sensorik-spezifische „Underwear“-Probleme

Für euer Produkt zentral: Viele Kinder scheitern nicht am „Toilette“, sondern an Unterwäsche als taktilem Objekt.

Naht/Seam-Aversion: Eltern vermuten explizit „it is the seams... overstimulation“; andere suchen nach „no crotch seam“.

Crotch-Kontakt: Extremform: „cannot have anything touching her crotch, at all“.

Tags/Elastic/Wedgies: Trigger werden als „tags, seams, elastic waistbands“ beschrieben; Eltern wählen deshalb dickere Stoffe („less likely to wedgie“) oder wechseln auf Boxers.

Konsequenz: Ein Produkt, das „nur“ wie Training Underwear aussieht, aber innen Druckpunkte (Naht, Label, harte Kanten) hat, wird von einem Teil der Zielgruppe nicht toleriert -- egal wie gut die Absorption ist.

Bestehende Lösungen und ihre Bruchstellen

Hier wird nicht „was es gibt“ aufgezählt, sondern warum Eltern es hassen oder doch nutzen.

Disposables: Training Pants, Pull-Ups, Nighttime Underwear

Warum Eltern sie kaufen (Likes):

Leckschutz & „Peace of mind“ ist der Nummer-1 Treiber -- nicht „Training“. Markenversprechen sind „leak-free nights“, „odor absorbing“, „12 hours“.

Einfacheres Wechseln in Daycare/unterwegs: Refastenable sides („keep pants and shoes on“) werden von Eltern und Institutionen aktiv nachgefragt. Ein Review benennt explizit: „day care specifically requests Pull-ups because of their closures“.

Sensorik/„cleaner ingredients“ (bei sensibler Haut): Eltern mit empfindlicher Haut (Eczema) heben „scent-free“ und „soft“ als Kaufgründe hervor.

Warum Eltern sie hassen (Hates / Failure Stories):

„Too diaper-like“ / Lernsignal fehlt: Wenn Kinder „dry and comfy“ bleiben, fehlt der Body-Cue-Lernmoment. Eltern formulieren dasselbe Problem als Objection: „does not care that they're wet“ oder „he couldn't care less“.

Produktversagen: Risse, Sides, Absorption: 1-Stern-Review (Verified purchase) ist gnadenlos: „They are so thin & the sides rip so easily... don't absorb well“.

Geruch nach Urin/„chemical smell“: Geruch ist ein massiver Trigger (für Eltern und sensorisch empfindliche Kinder). Ein Beispiel aus Community-Diskussion: „they smell horrible“.

Emotionaler Preis: Disposables lösen kurzfristig Chaos, verlängern aber oft die Zeit, in der Eltern „erklären müssen“, warum das Kind noch in Pull-Ups ist. Genau daraus entsteht Scham-O-Ton („pull up is showing... the looks“).

„Naked method“ / Unterwäsche pur / Bootcamps

Warum es empfohlen wird: Das Setting erzwingt Rückmeldung („wet = uncomfortable“), was bei vielen neurotypischen Kindern schnell funktioniert. In Autismus-Kontexten wird es als „full throttle day one“ beschrieben -- mit dem Ziel, Awareness schneller zu verankern.

Warum es bei eurer Zielgruppe oft kollabiert:

Kinder merken es nicht / es stört sie nicht: mehrfach belegt („neither boy was bothered...“; „does not care if he's wet or dirty“). Das ist

euer Kernproblem.

Eltern-Kapazität: Bootcamp-Methoden verlangen Zeitblöcke („stay home for a few days" wird in Fachmaterial als Option genannt), aber viele Haushalte können das nicht leisten -- insbesondere in Single-Parent-Konstellationen oder wenn Geschwister da sind.

Meltdown-Risiko & Demand-Spirale: Timer + „now sit" triggert Eskalation („every 30 minutes... complete meltdown"; „huge, long lasting meltdowns").

Scheduled sitting / Timer / Visuals / Rewards / Social stories / Therapy
Das ist der „Standard-Stack": Timer-Sitzen, Visual schedules, Rewards (Sticker/Prizes), ggf. OT-Support, teilweise ABA. Fachquellen nennen

diese Elemente als typische Bausteine (Routine, Visual sequence, kurze Sitzzeiten, Reinforcer).

Was Eltern mögen: Struktur gibt kurzfristig Kontrolle (Toilet diary, feste Times, Visuals).

Was Eltern hassen:

Belohnungen funktionieren nicht: „She doesn't care about candy... doesn't really care about stickers either."

„Books and videos" übersetzen nicht in Verhalten: „obsessed with potty books but it doesn't translate".

Timer wird als „Agent of parents" enttarnt: „She understands that's just an agent of her parents."

Horror Stories / extreme Fälle (nicht als Norm, aber als realer Tail):

Es gibt Familien, die jahrelang trainieren und dennoch scheitern („for years... rock the toilet... adult diapers..."). Das ist wichtig, weil es den Skepsis-Layer formt: „Vielleicht geht es nie."

Marktreife, Skepsis und Kaufbarrieren

Die wiederkehrenden Objections (in Originalsprache)

Diese Einwände sind nicht „Kauf-Ausreden". Es sind Erklärmodelle, mit denen Eltern versuchen, ein chaotisches System zu verstehen.

„does not care if she's wet"

„he couldn't care less"

„They don't give me cues"

„He just won't tell you he needs to go"

„He's nonverbal"

„huge, long lasting meltdowns"

„Half the daycares ... won't take him"

Zentral für euer Produkt: Der häufigste Objection-Frame ist nicht „zu teuer", sondern „mein Kind kann das mechanisch nicht"

(Interozeption/Kommunikation/Sensorik).

Warum Eltern skeptisch gegenüber „Training Underwear" sind

Es gibt drei Skepsis-Schichten:

Schicht A: „Underwear löst kein Body-Signal-Problem"

Wenn Eltern glauben, dass das Kind „die Signals nicht hat", wirkt

Unterwäsche wie Marketing-Kosmetik. („doesn't seem to get those 'signals'").

Schicht B: „Entweder zu absorbent oder zu wenig" (No-Win):

Wenn zu absorbent: kein Lernsignal („stuck" in dry comfort). Wenn zu wenig: Chaos/Putzen/Scham. Dieses Dilemma steckt hinter fast allen Produktdebatten, auch wenn Eltern es nicht so sauber formulieren.

Schicht C: „Ich glaube nur noch an Therapie/Programme"

Eltern berichten, dass in Arzt-/Recherche-Kontexten „ABA" oft als einziges Angebot erscheint -- und manche sind dagegen („I'm not

interested in ABA... for a number of reasons"). Das erzeugt Marktsplaltung: „Therapie-Only" vs. „neuroaffirming/OT-Sensory". Markt-Sophistication-Level (Evidence-based Einordnung)
Ich ordne den Markt nicht nach Werbe-Awareness, sondern nach Kausallogik, die Eltern bereits internalisiert haben.
Problem aware (sehr hoch):
Eltern erkennen klar „Potty training ist anders bei ASD" („autistic children may... sensory differences... pressure..."; „interoception...").
Solution aware (mittel):
Timer, Visuals, Rewards, Sitzzeiten, OT/ABA, Kopfhörer beim Flush -- sind bekannt.
Product aware (niedrig bis mittel):
Eltern kennen Disposables (Pull-Ups, Nighttime Underwear) und einige Reusables. „Sensory underwear" als Mechanismus wird von einzelnen Marken erklärt, ist aber keine Mainstream-Kategorie.
Highly skeptical (relevanter Slice):
Entsteht aus (a) jahrelangem Scheitern, (b) Schul-/Daycare-Druck, (c) Fällern, wo Kinder „nicht merken/nicht caring" + (d) hoher Erschöpfung. Beispiel dafür ist die Sprache „absolute hell", „we've backed the fuck off", „I don't know what else to do".
Quantitative Realität als Kontext (nicht als Ersatz für O-Ton)
Wenn ihr DTC baut, müsst ihr wissen: Das ist kein Mini-Nischenmarkt.
In den USA liegt die ASD-Prävalenz laut CDC-Überwachung inzwischen bei ca. 1 in 31 (8-Jährige; Monitoring-Sites).
ASD wird weiterhin deutlich häufiger bei Jungen identifiziert (CDC: „over 3 times more common among boys").

Toileting-Resistance ist in ASD deutlich höher als in Vergleichsgruppen:
In einer großen Studie war Toileting-Resistance bei Kindern mit ASD bei ~49% (vs. ~8% in Population Peers).

Das bestätigt, warum Elternforen so „voll" davon sind: Das Problem ist systematisch, nicht individuell.

Mechanismus- und Positionierungschancen

Wiederholte Produkt-Failures, die direkt in Chancen übersetzen

Failure 1: „Diaper in disguise" (too comfy, too dry, no learning)

Eltern sagen in Rohsprache: „doesn't care"; Marken positionieren zugleich „leak-free, absorbent, odor control". Das ist ein Zielkonflikt: Erfolg im Retail-Versprechen kann Training sabotieren (bei einem Teil der Kinder).

Opportunity: Positioniert euer Produkt nicht als „more absorbent".

Positioniert es als „targeted learning feedback" + „mess-bounded". Der Mechanismus muss explizit benannt und glaubwürdig gemacht werden (nicht Wellness-Flausch).

Failure 2: Unterwäsche wird nicht toleriert (Seams/Tags/Crotch Pressure)

Wenn ein Kind „cannot have anything touching her crotch" oder Eltern „seams... overstimulation" nennen, ist die Produktentscheidung nicht rational, sondern sensorisch binär: tragbar vs. untragbar.

Opportunity: Eure Differenzierung ist konstruktiv, nicht kosmetisch:

0-Tag / 0-Crotch-Seam Design (oder Seam-Placement außerhalb Triggerzone)

Ultra-soft elastics, breit, druckarm, optional „compression-tunable"

(weil manche Kinder Druck mögen, andere nicht)

Innenmaterial, das Nasssein spürbar macht, aber nicht

brennt/klebt/krümelt (kein „paper towel hack").

Failure 3: Wechselstress als Meltdown-Trigger

Daycare-Realität: „keep pants and shoes on“; Eltern: „closures that can be reattached“. Produkte, die nur „pull-down“ können, erhöhen den Wechselstress.

Opportunity: Sensorisch-freundlich heißt auch: Wechsel-freundlich.

Side-opens (Snap/Velcro-Analog) sind nicht „Convenience“, sondern meltdown-präventive Infrastruktur (weniger Ziehen, weniger Umziehen, weniger „Demand“).

Mechanism Opportunities als „Claim-Stack“ (was ihr sagen dürft vs. was ihr beweisen müsst)

Ihr könnt die Kategorie sauber aufspannen über drei Ebenen:

Sensorik-Komfort (tragbar trotz Naht/Tag/Elastic-Aversion).

Biofeedback-Prinzip (Nassheit spürbar → Brain-Body-Link). Das wird als Konzept im Toileting-Kontext diskutiert (Interozeption + Bladder cues) und ist anschlussfähig, muss aber vorsichtig formuliert werden.

Containment ohne „Diaper feeling“: Eltern wollen Würde + weniger Putzen; aber keine „Babyish diaper“-Ästhetik.

Wenn ihr daraus ein „Miracle Underwear“ macht, seid ihr tot. Diese Zielgruppe riecht Bullshit auf 10 km -- weil sie seit Jahren im „Expert-Tipps-Content“ ertrinkt.

Wettbewerbslandschaft und Positionierungslücken

Kategorie-Karte: Wer besetzt was?

Mainstream Disposables (Brand-Versprechen: Leckschutz + „Big Kid“):

Pull-Ups kommuniziert stark über Underwear-Fit, Refastenable sides, Designs, und Schutz (inkl. Nighttime „absorb up to 25% more...“, „leak-free“).

Goodnites positioniert „thin, underwear-like“, „odor absorbing“, große Größenrange bis 165 lbs -- wichtig für älteren Tail.

Reusable Trainers / Transition Wear (oft cloth/TPU, „one accident“):

Kanga Care (Lil Learnerz u. ä.) wird als „Reusable Toilet Training Pants“ verkauft; Reviews zeigen Nutzen („never leaked“), aber auch Fit-Probleme („shrunk... tight“).

Peejamas besetzt „nighttime dignity“ (Pajama-Form, Absorption „2-3 pees“).

Super Undies positioniert explizit „sensory underwear“ als

Biofeedback-Mechanismus und grenzt sich von „thin diapers in disguise“ ab.

Sensory-Friendly Underwear (nicht primär Toileting, aber relevant):

City Threads bewirbt „sensory friendly“ Kleidung/Unterwäsche (sensitive skin, enclosed elastic).

Blusss erwähnt in Testimonials explizit: „no label“, „no crotch seam“, „no elastic band“. Das ist exakt eure Material-/Konstruktions-DNA.

Messaging-Gaps und Blind Spots

Blind Spot 1: Mainstream „Big Kid“-Narrativ ignoriert Interozeption

„Fading designs“, „learn to stay dry“ setzt voraus, dass das Kind „wet = relevant“ wahrnimmt. Eltern sagen aber: „she will pee herself and not even care“. Hier klafft der größte Gap.

Blind Spot 2: „Sensitive skin“ ≠ „sensory tolerable“

Skin-Claims („hypoallergenic, no fragrance“) helfen bei Rash, aber lösen nicht Naht-/Druck-/Wedgie-Trigger. Eltern sprechen explizit über Naht-Overload.

Blind Spot 3: Daycare Logistics wird unterschätzt

Viele Reusables sind sensorisch okay, aber organisatorisch schlecht

(Umziehen, Inserts, nass in Bag). Eltern und Daycare wollen fast, clean,

minimal struggle. Das sieht man daran, dass „re-attach closures“ zur institutionellen Anforderung wird.

Blind Spot 4: Die ältere Tail-Gruppe wird kaum würdevoll bedient
Goodnites löst das nachts mit großen Größen; tagsüber fehlt häufig
„dignity + training + sensory“. Posts zeigen Kinder 6, 8, 13, 19 --
diese Familien sind extrem kaufbereit, aber extrem skeptisch.

Raw Language Vault

Die folgenden O-Töne sind nicht geglättet. Das ist die Sprache, in der eure Zielgruppe denkt, schreibt und (später) kauft. Wo nicht anders angegeben, sind es öffentliche Elternposts/Kommentare.

Identität, Selbstbild und soziale Rolle

„special needs mom“

„autism mom“

„I'm a dad in my forties...”

„Sometimes this journey can be so lonely.”

„I'm the sole breadwinner...”

„I feel like I'm surviving, not living.”

„I just feel like I'm falling behind.”

„I don't want to force him.”

„This is not my first rodeo.”

„You care and that is one part of the equation.”

Scham, Schuld, Vergleich, Angst „behind“

„When we're in public... I can just feel the looks...”

„they stare... wondering why that kid isn't potty trained“

„...makes me feel better like I'm not a lazy mom“

„he's one of the last kids... still in pull ups“

„It's been impossible to find a school... not potty trained.”

„Half the daycares... won't take him.”

„asked to leave because my child wasn't potty trained... He was 2...
2!!!“

„He's starting school... it was really important to me...”

„peer pressure will kick in“

„I was chastised... by her doctor.”

Burnout, Frust, Overwhelm

„I'm just beyond burnt out“

„Hard solidarity.”

„We've backed the fuck off“

„Potty training has been absolute hell.”

„...a disaster everyday.”

„I don't know what else to do.”

„It ruins our entire day and causes physical harm.”

„I just don't know how to help him.”

„It feels like I'm surviving, not living.”

„my energy is already on empty.”

Objection-Language: „Mein Kind ist anders“

„she will pee herself and not even care“

„he just does the same as when wearing a diaper“

„he doesn't care that they're wet“

„He 100% does not care if he's wet or dirty“

„it's almost like he can't even tell he needs to pee“

„They don't give me cues“

„He just won't tell you he needs to go“

„He's nonverbal“

„he doesn't understand the concept... at all"
„It's the level 3 autism... that's the reason"
Sensorik-Rohsprache: Nähte, Druck, Overstimulation
„I am starting to worry it is the seams... overstimulation."
„raised seam"
„her panties... extreme sensory issues"
„cannot have anything touching her crotch, at all."
„Tags, seams, elastic waistbands"
„He goes stiff, screams/moans"
„hates the feeling of being wet"
„nightgowns without underwear were good"
„seam at the crotch"
„hates them all (it\'s been months and \\\\$\\\$\\\$)"
Demand, Meltdowns, Aggression rund um Toileting
„every 30 minutes... complete meltdown"
„throws the books, bites and hits herself"
„kicks off her diapers and underwear"
„screams and planks"
„refusal... huge, long lasting meltdowns"
„she bites us and herself"
„punches us in the face"
„quiet time... went potty ALL OVER HIS BEDROOM"
„it's him vs us"
„he gets extremely angry... runs around, and screams"
Produkte: Likes/Hates in Review-Sprache
„day care specifically requests Pull-ups because of their closures"
„scent-free... very sensitive to scented products"
„material feels... soft and breathable"

„They are so thin & the sides rip so easily"
„don't absorb well at all"
„smell horrible"
„shrunk... a little tight after washing"
„not interested in ABA... for a number of reasons"
Hoffnung, Würde, Teilhabe
„I just wanted him to start getting the socialization..."
„...felt like a big boy"
„He needs to be somewhere... trained and experienced"
„I wanted to give him one skill!"
„Keep looking!"
„take your time, and go at your child's pace"
„Accidents are normal"
„Toilets can be scary"
„You're doing a great job."
(Hinweis: Der Vault ist bewusst „brutal real". Wenn euch diese Sprache nicht aushält, solltet ihr dieses Produkt nicht für diese Zielgruppe bauen.)
Synthese und strategische Positionierungsimplicationen
Was ihr wirklich verkauft
Ihr verkauft nicht Unterwäsche. Ihr verkauft einen Deal zwischen drei Parteien:
Kind: „Das Ding fühlt sich nicht falsch an." (Sensorik-Akzeptanz)
Eltern: „Es reduziert Chaos und erhöht Fortschritt." (Mess-bounded + Lernsignal)
Institution: „Es ist schnell zu wechseln, würdevoll, planbar."

(Closures, weniger Umziehen, weniger Meltdown-Risiko)
Wenn ihr nur 1) und 2) löst und 3) ignoriert, verliert ihr einen großen Kauf-Trigger: Daycare/School pressure.
Die Positionierungslücke, die offen steht

„Sensory-tolerable + biofeedback-klar + caregiver-wechselbar“ ist die seltene Dreifach-Kombination. Heute sind Produkte meist nur 1--2 davon: Mainstream: caregiver-wechselbar + trocken (aber biofeedback-schwach). Sensory-Underwear-Brands: biofeedback-Narrativ, aber nicht zwingend autism-spezifisch im Underwear-Bauplan (No-crotch-seam etc.). Sensory-Clothing-Brands: no seam/no label, aber nicht toileting-funktional (kein Leak-Containment). Messaging-Gaps, die ihr nutzen könnt (ohne „Miracle“-Bullshit)
Sag nicht: „Potty training wird easy.“
Sag (mit Belegen/Mechanismus):
„Für Kinder, die Nähte/Tags/Druck nicht tolerieren.“
„Für Kinder, die Nassein nicht merken oder ignorieren -- wir verstärken die Rückmeldung, ohne das Haus zu fluten.“
„Für Eltern, die Daycare-Wechsel ohne komplettes Entkleiden brauchen.“
Brutale Realität und Risikoanalyse
Jetzt der gnadenlose Teil, damit eure Idee kugelsicher wird:
Produkt-Alleinlösung ist für viele Familien Müll. Nicht, weil sie dumm sind, sondern weil Interozeption + Kommunikation + Demand-Stress nicht weggenäht werden können. Wenn ihr das implizit verspricht, bekommt ihr Backlash und Retouren.
Return-/Fit-Risiko ist hoch. Sensorik ist binär. Ein Millimeter falsche Nahtposition = „untragbar“. Und Eltern sind bereits „(it\'s been months and \\$\\$\\$)“-geschädigt.
Euer härtester Gegner ist nicht ein Wettbewerber, sondern Erschöpfung. Wenn ein Elternteil „surviving, not living“ ist, kauft er entweder Hoffnung -- oder gar nichts. Euer Onboarding und eure Claims müssen wie ein Rettungsring funktionieren, nicht wie ein Produktlaunch.
Ethik: Wenn eure Marke auch nur ein bisschen nach „Ausnutzen von Special-Needs-Eltern“ riecht („paid reviews!!!!“), seid ihr erledigt. Ihr braucht Transparenz, Belege, Grenzen dessen, was das Produkt kann.
Summary Insights am Ende
Die marktdominante Wahrheit ist paradox: Eltern brauchen ein Produkt, das weniger wie eine Windel ist (Würde, „big kid“), aber mehr wie ein Systembaustein wirkt (Wechselbarkeit, Sensorik-Toleranz, Lernfeedback). Die größten „Jobs-to-be-done“ sind deshalb: Scham reduzieren, Meltdowns vermeiden, Institutionen bedienen, Interozeptions-Gap respektieren, ohne Therapie-Gatekeeping zu predigen.

Claude deep research

The interoception gap: A market research report for ASD potty training dominance
Your child isn\'t refusing to use the potty --- their body isn\'t sending them the signal. This is the core market insight that separates a dominant brand from another commodity product in the ASD potty training space. Nearly **49% of autistic children aged 4--5 are not toilet trained**, compared to just 8% of neurotypical peers. These parents have tried everything --- pull-ups, timers, sticker charts, naked methods, ABA protocols --- and every method failed because every method addresses behavior while ignoring the neurological root: a sensory system called interoception that their child\'s brain processes differently. Training underwear that provides real physical sensation

feedback is the only product category that can credibly claim to address this root cause. No pull-up, no app, no reward chart can own this mechanism. This report maps the complete competitive landscape, decodes the psychology of the target buyer, autopsies every failed solution she's tried, and establishes the scientific and emotional architecture for a positioning strategy built to dominate.

PART 1: MARKET STRUCTURE & COMPETITION (Blue Ocean Lens)

1.1 The competitive landscape is fragmented and no one owns the whole journey

The ASD potty training market is split across nine product/service categories with no single brand commanding the full customer relationship. This fragmentation creates a massive positioning opportunity.

****Training Pants / Underwear.**** ****Super Undies**** (\\$20--35/pair) is the only significant brand marketing directly to the ASD community with waterproof training underwear. They claim the product "feels like real underwear" while being waterproof, and they have a dedicated autism landing page. ****SmartKnitKIDS**** (\\$12--18/pair) sells patented seamless sensory underwear but these are comfort products, not training tools --- they have no absorbency or training mechanism. ****EcoAble**** (\\$40--60 on Amazon) targets ages 6--16 with pull-on cloth diapers for special needs. Mainstream brands like ****Gerber**** training pants (\\$3--5/pair) and ****Hanes**** tag-free underwear are commonly recommended in forums but are not designed for ASD-specific needs.

****Diapers / Pull-Ups for Older Children.**** ****Goodnites**** (Kimberly-Clark) dominates nighttime with the widest size range through XXL (up to 165 lbs, ~\\$0.50--0.80/unit). ****Youth Crews**** is a newer brand "created by a dad who's been there" --- purpose-built for kids who've outgrown standard sizes, up to Size 9, with age-appropriate designs. ****NorthShore Care Supply**** specializes in medical-grade youth incontinence. ****Prevail SleepOvers**** offers medical-supply-distributed youth pants. Key dynamic: Medicaid covers diapers for children 3+ with a qualifying diagnosis, reducing urgency for some families to switch.

****Books.**** The category is dominated by ****"The Potty Journey"***** by Judith Coucouvanis (2008) --- the most-cited ASD toilet training book recommended by Autism Speaks and SPARK. ****"Toilet Training for**

Individuals with Autism"*** by Maria Wheeler features 50+ case studies. The mainstream juggernaut ****"Oh Crap! Potty Training"***** by Jamie Glowacki is the most attempted method by ASD parents, and some of its certified consultants have added ASD specialization training. The free ****Autism Speaks ATN/AIR-P Toilet Training Guide**** is the most widely recommended first resource.

****Therapy Programs.**** ABA-based toilet training (Foxy & Azrin protocol, modernized) is offered by major therapy chains including ****Rise Up For Autism****, ****On Target ABA****, ****Hopebridge****, and ****ABA Centers of America**** --- often insurance-covered. OT programs address sensory and motor components. ****Kennedy Krieger Institute**** (Elizabeth Cross, Ph.D.) is a leading clinical center. Emerging: ****pelvic floor therapy**** as a specialty (Enliven OT's Carly Rosenthal partnering with Oh Crap consultants).

****Apps.**** ****Potty Training Social Story**** by Touch Autism (iOS, \\$2--5) is the only ASD-specific app of note. ****AvaKid See Me Go Potty**** helps nonverbal children signal bathroom needs. ****Potty Time with Elmo**** is mainstream but widely used. There is no dominant ASD potty training app. A research-grade iOS urine alarm app (Mruzek et al., 2019) exists but

isn't commercially available.

Visual Aids. **Autism Little Learners** (Tara, SLP, 25+ years experience) dominates Teachers Pay Teachers with a full visual supports bundle (\\$18--20, 4.8/5 stars, 151+ reviews). Free resources include visual sequence charts from Autism Speaks, Autism Little Learners, and Raising Children Network Australia.

Timers & Tools. **Kidnovations Premium Potty Training Watch** (\\$20--30, vibration-only mode ideal for school/special needs) and **Potty Monkey Watch** (\\$25--30) are the leading devices. **The Toilet Timer** sand timer (\\$10--15) is marketed specifically to the autism community.

Online Programs & Coaching. **Dr. Mary Barbera** (BCBA, RN) offers a free potty training ebook and paid courses. **The Autism Consultant** (Molly Johnson) charges \\$47/month for a full membership. **The Potty School** offers in-home and video consultations. **Autism Times** sells a questionable "3 Days Autism Potty Training Program" for \\$23.95.

Communities. **MyAutismTeam** (150,000+ members) is the largest dedicated social network. Facebook groups include **Autism Inclusivity** (142,000+ members), **Autism Parenting**, and **Getting to the Bottom of Potty Issues** (~1,000 members, managed by a pelvic floor therapist). Reddit's **r/Autism_Parenting** and **r/pottytraining** are active but less structured.

1.2 The strategy canvas: where every competitor crowds the same space

Factor **Current** **Notes**
Market
Emphasis

Absorbency **HIGH** Central claim for
diapers/pull-ups and waterproof
underwear
Fun designs/characters MEDIUM Goodnites, Pull-Ups use
characters; less relevant in
ASD-specific products
Reward systems **HIGH** Foundational to ABA; sticker
charts bundled with nearly every
program
Sensory-friendly **HIGH** Primary differentiator;
claims SmartKnitKIDS leads with
seamless tech
ASD-specific branding **HIGH** Most products/services
explicitly market to ASD
families
Price point MEDIUM-HIGH Wide range; Medicaid coverage is
a major dynamic
Medical/professional **HIGH** BCBA, OT, SLP credentials near
authority table-stakes for credibility
Community/peer support **HIGH** Facebook groups drive product
discovery and validation
Ease-of-use for **HIGH** All programs emphasize
parents simplicity and visual supports
Emotional reassurance **HIGH** "Every child's timeline is
different" messaging is
universal

"Feels like real MEDIUM-HIGH Super Undies and Cuties both underwear\" claim this Customizable approach **HIGH** ABA is inherently individualized; \"tailored to your child\" is standard Speed/timeline **LOW** Most ASD resources explicitly promises caution against speed expectations

Interoception / body **VERY LOW Only Kelly Mahler and a handful signal education** of OTs discuss this explicitly

Root-cause mechanism **VERY LOW Almost no product explains WHY explanation** the child can't train

🎯 **Critical insight:** Every competitor clusters around the same

factors --- sensory comfort, reward systems, professional authority, emotional reassurance, ease-of-use. **No product owns the mechanism explanation.** No brand tells parents WHY their child can't feel the signal. This is the Blue Ocean.

1.3 Four Actions Framework: where to build the Blue Ocean

ELIMINATE --- What can be completely removed:

- Generic \"patience\" messaging (\"every child learns at their own > pace\"). This mother has heard it 500 times. It no longer > reassures --- it dismisses. 🎯
- Speed/timeline promises. Any claim resembling \"3 days\" or \"1 > week\" triggers instant distrust in this audience. They have been > burned.
- Character-driven design as a selling point. This mother's > 5-year-old doesn't care about Paw Patrol on their pull-up. The > child who can't feel their bladder won't be motivated by Elmo.
- Generic reward system bundling. Sticker charts are the #1 most-tried > and most-failed method. Bundling another one says \"we don't > understand your child.\"

REDUCE --- What is over-emphasized:

- Absorbency as a primary claim. The market over-indexes on containing > accidents. But for training to occur, the child needs to FEEL the > accident --- absorbency is the enemy of the mechanism. *Reduce the > emphasis on how much the product absorbs; raise the emphasis on > what the child FEELS.* 🧠
- Professional credential stacking. The market leads with > \"BCBA-approved, OT-recommended, evidence-based.\" This mother is > credential-fatigued. She's been to the BCBA, the OT, the > pediatrician. What she needs is understanding, not another > credential badge.
- Sensory-comfort-as-selling-point. While comfort matters, leading > with \"seamless, tagless, soft\" positions the product as > underwear-for-comfort rather than underwear-that-teaches.

RAISE --- What must be dramatically amplified:

- **Mechanism education.** No competitor explains interoception to > parents in their language. The mother who understands \"your child > can't feel the signal\" has her guilt removed and a new framework > for action. This is the highest-leverage factor to raise. 🎯🧠
- **Sensory feedback as learning tool.** Reposition the feel of > wetness from \"unpleasant accident\" to \"critical learning signal > their brain needs.\" Super Undies hints at this but doesn't own

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> it.

- **Validation of the mother\'s entire failed journey.** No product
> explicitly says: \\'You tried sticker charts and they didn\'t work
> --- here\'s why. You tried timers and they didn\'t work ---
> here\'s why. You tried pull-ups and they didn\'t work --- here\'s
> why. None of these failed because of you. They failed because they
> target behavior, not the body\'s signal system.\" 🛡️
- **Specific differentiation from pull-ups.** The argument that
> pull-ups structurally prevent learning by eliminating sensory
> feedback is clinically supported but under-marketed.
**CREATE --- What has never existed in this market:**
- **An \\'interoception score\' or readiness framework** --- a simple
> self-assessment that helps parents understand their child\'s
> interoceptive awareness level, replacing the vague \\'readiness
> signs\' every other resource uses. 🧠
- **A \\'failed solutions decoder\'** --- content that explicitly names
> the 10 methods she\'s tried and explains the specific neurological
> reason each one failed for her ASD child. This converts a
> frustrated buyer into a believing customer. 🧠🛡️
- **\'Signal building\' language** --- an entirely new vocabulary for
> potty training that replaces \\'training\' (behavioral) with
> \\'signal building\' (neurological). This reframes the product from
> \\'another training tool\' to \\'the first tool that actually
> develops the missing sense.\" 🧠
- **Parent-to-parent mechanism bridge content** --- short explanations
> using the analogies real parents use (\\'It\'s like a GPS that\'s
> glitchy,\" \\'The signal doesn\'t reach the brain\') embedded in
> product marketing. 🧠
### **1.4 Three tiers of non-customers who should be buying**
**Tier 1: \\'On the edge\' --- Parents using pull-ups who know they
should switch but fear the mess.** These parents have heard the advice
to transition to underwear. They understand intellectually that pull-ups
\'feel like diapers.\" But they are paralyzed by the prospect of daily
accidents --- one parent described \\'fecal smearing happening throughout
the day for the first month.\" They continue buying pull-ups as the safe
option. **What holds them back:** No product bridges mess containment
WITH interoceptive feedback. They need both simultaneously. **What pulls
them in:** \\'You won\'t be cleaning the couch, AND your child will feel
the signal.\" 🧠
**Tier 2: \\'Given up\' --- Parents who\'ve decided their child \\'isn\'t
ready\' and paused training.** These parents attempted training multiple
times and failed. They\'ve been told by professionals to \\'wait until
they\'re ready.\" Some have accepted long-term diaper use and use
Medicaid to cover costs. They view the problem as developmental timing,
not solvable through products. **What holds them back:** They\'ve lost
hope in any product. **What pulls them in:** Reframing from
\'readiness\' to \\'building the sense.\" Message: \\'Your child doesn\'t
need to be \'ready.\" They need help developing the sense that tells
them it\'s time to go.\" 🧠🛡️
**Tier 3: \\'Adjacent markets\' --- Parents of SPD, ADHD, and
developmentally delayed children without ASD diagnosis.** An OT noted:
\'Kids who are otherwise typically developing may also have difficulties
with potty training due to interoception difficulties.\" Parents of

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children with ADHD face similar interoceptive challenges but no ADHD-specific potty training products exist. Parents of older children (8+) who've moved past "training" into "management" mode are spending hundreds per month on disposable products. **What holds them back:** They don't identify with ASD-specific products; they don't know interoception is their core issue. **What pulls them in:** A product positioned around interoception rather than autism, broadening the addressable market dramatically. ☹️

PART 2: DEEP PSYCHOLOGY OF THE AVATAR (Breakthrough Advertising Lens)

2a. The emotional arc --- from first doubt to final purchase (or resignation)

PHASE 1: THE SLOW REALIZATION (Child age 2.5--3.5)

The realization arrives not as a single moment but as an accumulating weight. She watches her child's same-age peers at the playground, hears other mothers casually mention their child "just got it one weekend." Her pediatrician asks about toileting readiness at the 3-year checkup. She dismisses it initially --- "boys are slower," "he's just not ready yet." But the seed is planted.

☹️ The first trigger is usually comparison. One mother wrote: "When children who are younger than my kid ask their mommies to go potty, it makes me want to chew off my own arm. IDK what I'm doing wrong." (The Autism Cafe blog comment)

PHASE 2: THE FIRST REAL ATTEMPT (Child age 3--4)

She buys the Oh Crap book because everyone recommends it. She clears a long weekend. She strips the child naked per the instructions. She watches for "the pee-pee dance." But there is no dance. The child urinates without any warning signal, without any apparent awareness. The 3-day method stretches into a week of escalating stress and no progress. She wrote: "I used the Oh Crap method which totally stressed her and me out." (Berkeley Parents Network) She retreats to pull-ups, calling it "a break."

☹️ This is the first hope-destruction cycle. She believed the promise, executed the method, and it failed in a way that felt like her fault.

PHASE 3: THE PROFESSIONAL INTERVENTION (Child age 3.5--5)

She mentions it to the BCBA, the OT, the pediatrician. They implement scheduled sits, timer systems, reward charts. The child sits on the toilet every 20 minutes. Data sheets are kept. Stickers are given. But one mother captured the central paradox perfectly: "The walls of his bedroom is full of charts showing the treats he got since we started."

(101Autism.com comment) Yet the child still doesn't initiate. The child goes when prompted but never independently.

This is the "prompt-dependent" trap. ABA can teach a child to comply with being taken to the toilet --- but if the child never develops the internal signal recognition, they become dependent on an adult to tell them it's time to go. Kelly Mahler named this directly: "This isn't a failure of the child or caregiver, it's a mismatch between what behavior-based approaches ask for and what toileting actually requires."

PHASE 4: THE MICRO-MOMENTS OF PAIN

These are the seconds that embed deepest:

- *The diaper upgrade.* "The first time I had to order size 7 diaper > I cried. It was tough for me and I felt really sad about it. Now > he is almost into a size 8. Sigh." (Kate Swenson, Finding > Cooper's Voice) ☹️
- *The public incident.* Changing a soiled 5-year-old at a birthday

> party while other children run past. \"We actually use feminine
> pads for school & outings for the little spills but he typically
> ends up with wet pants anyways 😞\" (Finding Cooper's Voice
> comment)

- *The school rejection.* \"Toileting can be an added barrier for
> school, as many daycares, preschools and elementary schools
> require children older than a certain age to use the restroom
> independently prior to entering the classroom.\" (Hopebridge BCBA)
- *The physical resistance.* \"My 6 year old son kicked me in the face
> today, while having a meltdown when I changed his diaper.\"
> (Finding Cooper's Voice comment) 🌀
- *The near-miss.* \"This morning we sat on the potty for almost 10
> minutes. I knew he had to pee cause his diaper from about 4am was
> dry. But alas, nothing. We went downstairs and I put him in a
> diaper to sit and eat breakfast and he peed before breakfast.\"
> (The Autism Helper blog comment) 🌀
- *The outgrowing.* \"We stuff him into the size 6 diapers but that is
> as big as they get at the grocery store.\" (Finding Cooper's
> Voice comment)

****PHASE 5: RESIGNATION VS. DETERMINATION --- The Fork****

The parents who resign sound like this:

- \"It was just easier to give in and go back to using Pull-Ups.\"
> (Maureen Bennie, Autism Awareness Centre)
- \"So it is, I guess.\" (Elise, Finding Cooper's Voice, accepting
> 11-year-old in pull-ups)
- \"When either of us begins to get stressed over it we take a
> break.\" (The Autism Cafe comment)

The parents who persist sound like this:

- \"I know my son is nonverbal, but I refuse to put in a box before
> even trying.\" (Quora parent)
- \"All we can do is get up every day, wipe the slate clean and try
> again.\" (Sasha Long, The Autism Helper)
- \"We finally got him trained at age 9.5 years after trying just
> about everything.\" (Maureen Bennie)

🌀 ****What separates them:**** The parents who persist tend to (a) reframe
tiny progress as victory, (b) have professional support they trust, (c)
share their story with a community, and (d) fundamentally believe their
child CAN learn. The parents who resign tend to be isolated, facing
co-parent conflict, lacking a framework that explains what's actually
happening, and interpreting failure as evidence their child can't do
it.

****This is the exact insertion point for the brand.**** The mother at the
resignation fork needs two things simultaneously: a ****new explanation****
(\"It's not your fault AND it's not their fault --- it's
interoception\") and a ****new mechanism**** (\"This product works
differently because it does something no other product does\"). 🌀

****2b. Verbatim language --- raw quotes by category****

****Category 1: How they describe their child's condition****

- > \"He doesnt tell me he is soiled and he doesnt seem to show discomfort
> by it.\" --- The Autism Cafe blog comment 🌀
- >
- > \"She doesn't have the ability to feel when she needs to use the
> bathroom, she under sensitive...we need to raise her level of
> sensitivity before we can even begin toilet training..now that's

```

> fun!\ " --- 101Autism.com comment, \@kiaora224 🗯️🧠
>
> \ "These children seem to \'go without warning,\ ' making it more
> difficult for the caregiver to get the child to the toilet in time.\ "
> --- Autism Speaks psychologists Aponte & Mruzek 🗯️
>
> \ "Neither boy was bothered or even seem to notice if they are wet or
> dirty.\ " --- Sasha Long, The Autism Helper 🗯️
>
> \ "When it comes to passing stool she will hold it so hard that she
> won\'t even sit on potty. She will make her limbs stiff.\ " --- The
> Autism Cafe comment (family member of 7-year-old)
>
> \ "My son was very clever and would hold his bowel movement all day
> until he knew he was going to get the Pull-Up at night. As soon as the
> Pull-Up went on, the poop came out.\ " --- Maureen Bennie, Autism
> Awareness Centre
>
> \ "Was it having to sit down on toilet rather than stand? Was this a
> fear of having something fall away from Marc\'s body? Did he think he
> was losing a part of himself?\ " --- Maureen Bennie, Autism Awareness
> Centre 🧠
**Category 2: How they describe failed solutions**
> \ "We have tried everything from stickers to time training.\ " --- The
> Autism Cafe comment (parent of 5.5-year-old)
>
> \ "We used picture symbols breaking down the process of toileting on a
> Velcro strip. We kept a bowel movement chart for 3 weeks\... We
> created a social story for toileting. When none of those methods
> worked, we used a behavioural contingency plan with photos\... None of
> these methods worked.\ " --- Maureen Bennie, Autism Awareness Centre 🗯️
>
> \ "I\'ve tried charts. I\'ve tried a potty chair, a seat on the big
> toilet, peeing outside, having him pee his underwear, peeing standing
> up. He\'s watched Jamie. We\'ve read books, movies, etc. Nothing
> works.\ " --- Kate Swenson, Finding Cooper\'s Voice 🗯️
>
> \ "I was discouraged when the Power Cards didn\'t work. I combed the
> internet for some words of wisdom and found nothing.\ " --- Maureen
> Bennie 🗯️
>
> \ "I have been at a lose at how to potty train him after so many failed
> attempts.\ " --- The Autism Cafe comment
>
> \ "I have a son with autism and I have found that potty training is one
> of the most difficult things for him. I have tried everything and I am
> at my wits end.\ " --- Autism Little Learners blog comment 🗯️
>
> \ "We feel like failures and just don\'t see an end in sight.\ " ---
> ParentData survey respondent 🗯️
>
> \ "Each time we try now, it seems like she digs her feet more and more
> into the sand.\ " --- ParentData survey respondent
**Category 3: How they describe their own emotional state**

```

> \"Potty training is not fun at all. Nope, not a single tiny ounce of
> it. In fact it's one of my most grueling and excruciating parenting
> experiences to date.\" --- Sasha Long, The Autism Helper 🇬🇧

>

> \"Mentally we can work ourselves in a TIZZY of frustration and fear
> that this will never happen.\" --- Sasha Long, The Autism Helper 🇬🇧

>

> \"Having a child with autism, I worry about not knowing whether or not
> my son will ever be able to take care of himself.\" --- Eileen Lamb,
> The Autism Cafe

>

> \"I'm not gonna lie, I was skeptical. How was he supposed to
> understand the concept of peeing in the potty, let alone accepting
> sitting on the potty? It seemed impossible.\" --- Eileen Lamb, The

> Autism Cafe 🇬🇧

>

> \"I wanted to give up when the fecal smearing was happening throughout
> the day for the first month.\" --- Maureen Bennie

>

> \"The reason I didn't want to potty train him was because I knew it
> will be a lot of work for me. I kept asking myself, does my hesitation
> has to do with him or me. And mostly it was me.\" --- Quora parent

>

> \"He just peed in the floor and to keep from getting upset, I picked
> up my phone to scroll for a few minutes.\" --- The Autism Cafe comment

>

> \"My heart truly believed that his autism was going to go away. If we
> just did more therapy. More teaching. More of everything... That
> fantasy world almost killed me.\" --- Kate Swenson, Finding Cooper's
> Voice 🇬🇧

>

> \"I live each day between hopelessness, and holding on to any drop of
> hope just to fall asleep at night.\" --- Finding Cooper's Voice
> comment 🇬🇧

Category 4: How they describe external judgment

> \"His dad has been giving me grief and arguing with me saying that he
> should not be going this way and needs to be trained. I too want him
> trained and I have tried countless methods.\" --- The Autism Cafe
> comment 🇬🇧

>

> \"It's hard when you hear a parent of a typical child say --- 'Potty
> training was so hard --- it took us a week.'\" --- Sasha Long, The
> Autism Helper 🇬🇧

>

> \"His therapist said he could be 7 or 8 before he is trained and we
> have been wondering what we were going to do.\" --- Finding Cooper's
> Voice comment 🇬🇧

>

> \"Not to be incendiary, but are you saying parents who fail to train
> children w/autism are doing something wrong?\" --- The Autism Cafe
> comment (responding defensively to advice) 🇬🇧

>

> \"His biological father does not believe that he's autistic.\" ---
> The Autism Cafe comment

>

> \"It is also a topic that carries a lot of stigma and feelings of
> shame.\" --- Hopebridge BCBA 🧠🎯

****Category 5: How they describe successes --- what hope sounds like****

> \"Success came two days later. Marc used the toilet without any
> prompts from us. He didn't flush the toilet and came and got us. He
> said, 'Poo in the toilet. I want chips.' It was a celebration.\" ---
> Maureen Bennie (after 9 years of trying) 🧠🎯

>

> \"This is the first time he seems to be getting it!\" --- The Autism
> Cafe comment 🧠🎯

>

> \"Our first breakthrough was after the first seven days --- Marc went
> on the bathroom floor. This was progress because even though he
> wasn't on the toilet, he was in the right area so we rewarded him for
> that.\" --- Maureen Bennie 🧠🎯

>

> \"I feel like I might be able to help you with this, as I have just
> spent our 6 month lockdown (UK) toilet training my severely Autistic 9
> year old son. He is now completely toilet trained! Even at school and
> out in public!\" --- Quora parent 🧠🎯

>

> \"It took Grey about 3 weeks to finally just start to get the process
> and soon after that for his daily successes to grow bigger in number
> than his accidents.\" --- Sasha Long, The Autism Helper

****Category 6: How they explain the problem to someone who doesn't
understand****

> \"The other problem is interoceptive awareness. Receptors located
> throughout the inside of our body, in our organs, muscles, skin, bones
> gather information from the inside of our body and send it to brain.
> People with autism tend to have impairment in this area. This means
> the signal of a full bladder or needing to eliminate does not reach
> the brain so there is no impetus to get to the toilet.\" --- Maureen
> Bennie, Autism Awareness Centre 🧠🎯

>

> \"It's not that simple. It's feeling that full sensation,
> recognizing that I have to act on that sensation, walking into the
> bathroom, pulling down my pants.\" --- Molly Johnson, autism
> consultant 🧠🎯

>

> \"Try toilet training an almost completely non verbal 4yr old autistic
> child. Fun!...\" --- 101Autism.com comment

>

> \"Thomas took nearly 6 months to learn to pee in a toilet. We used
> trainer pants that were plastic on the inside and fluffy cotton on the
> outside. They were completely useless as protection but as he hated
> wet clothes, he would remove his clothing and then be directed to the
> toilet hopefully to finish there.\" --- Finding Cooper's Voice
> comment 🧠🎯

****2c. State of awareness per Schwartz --- she knows the problem, not the
mechanism****

****She is PROBLEM AWARE, transitioning to SOLUTION AWARE.**** She knows the
problem with painful intensity. She's tried multiple solution
categories (pull-ups, timers, charts, ABA, OT). But she does NOT know

the root cause has a name, and she does NOT know a product category exists that specifically addresses it.

****What she thinks causes the difficulty (in order of frequency):****

1. \"Sensory issues\" --- the catch-all. She knows her child has
> sensory differences but hasn't connected this to internal body
> signals specifically.
2. \"Developmental delay\" --- resigned acceptance that autistic
> children \"just take longer.\"
3. Anxiety/fear of the toilet, bathroom environment, routine change.
4. GI issues/constipation (nearly 40% of ASD children have GI
> comorbidities).
5. Communication barriers --- can't tell her they need to go.
6. Resistance to routine change.
7. \"He doesn't care\" / \"She doesn't notice\" --- this IS
> interoception, unnamed. 🧠🧠

****Does she know the term \"interoception\"? Estimated awareness:**
****10--15% of highly-engaged ASD parents.**** An OT with 10 years of experience admitted: \"I've been an OT for about 10 years and have not heard of this.\" An autism educator framed it: \"Part of it is because of something called 'interoception.' Have you heard that word? If not, you aren't alone. I've only been hearing about it for a few years now.\" (Autism Little Learners) The discovery pathway runs: OT clinic → Kelly Mahler's work → autism blogs → community forums. Parents who discover the concept consistently describe an \"aha moment\" --- the emotional shift from behavioral to neurological framing. 🧠

****Claims she ACTIVELY REJECTS:****

- \"Just be patient, they'll do it when they're ready\" --- she's
> been patient for YEARS 🛡️
- \"3-day potty training methods\" --- she's tried and failed at
> least one 🛡️
- \"Just use sticker charts and rewards\" --- her walls are covered in
> failed sticker charts 🛡️
- \"Just put them in underwear and they'll figure it out\" --- she's
> tried this and drowned in accidents 🛡️
- Anything implying bad parenting --- she is DEEPLY sensitive; an
> autistic adult shared: \"I was shamed, punished and belittled and
> I wet the bed until I was THIRTEEN\" (NeuroClastic) 🛡️

****What would make her immediately stop scrolling:**** 🧠🧠🧠

> \"Your child isn't refusing to use the potty. They literally can't
> feel when they need to go.\"

>

> \"The reason the sticker charts didn't work? Your child's body
> isn't sending them the signal.\"

>

> \"There's a sense most people don't know about --- it's why your
> child doesn't notice they're wet.\"

The concept that the problem is ****NEUROLOGICAL, NOT BEHAVIORAL**** is the emotional release valve. It simultaneously removes guilt, provides an explanation, validates her failed journey, and opens the door to a specific, different solution.

**PART 3: FAILED SOLUTIONS --- MECHANISM LEVEL**

**1. Pull-Ups / Extended Diaper Use**

**** (a) What parents expected:**** A gentle bridge --- gradual, less messy,

gives the child practice pulling pants up/down while catching accidents.

**** (b) Why it specifically fails for ASD nervous systems: **** 🧠 Pull-ups wick moisture away from the skin, ****eliminating the sensory feedback**** ASD children need to build the interoception connection between `"I peed"` and `"I feel wet."` For children who already have muted interoceptive signals, pull-ups make it neurologically impossible to learn --- because the one external signal they might notice (wetness) has been engineered away. Research shows `"extended use of diapers can increase resistance to potty training, making it more challenging to make the transition"` (Tarbox et al., 2004, cited by Bierman Autism). As SPARK researcher Cross states: `"If they're in a pull-up or diaper, that gives them permission to use the pull-up or diaper."` For ASD children with routine rigidity, the pull-up IS the routine.

**** (c) Emotional scars: **** Profound shame and social exclusion. One parent: `"Potty training has precluded us from him going to the afterschool program due to no staff available to change his diaper there."` (Hechinger Report) The financial burden compounds --- families spend hundreds monthly on disposable products for years.

**** (d) Parent quotes: ****

> `"I always gave up with the training the third week into it because I couldn't handle the daily clean up. It was just easier to give in and go back to using Pull-Ups."` --- Maureen Bennie 🧠 `"My 5 (and a half) year old son is still in diapers... I can assure you that we have tried everything. He will sit in it if he has to."` --- Hechinger Report comment 🧠 `"My eight-year-old son with autism still wears diapers or training pants. We have tried toilet training, and while he will sometimes go on the potty, it's still one of the hardest struggles of his life."` --- Autism Parenting Magazine contributor 🧠

****2. "Oh Crap" Potty Training Method****

**** (a) What parents expected: **** The method that `"works for everyone"` --- results in 3--7 days through naked → commando → clothed blocks.

**** (b) Why it specifically fails for ASD nervous systems: **** 🧠 The method relies on four neurological prerequisites ASD children often lack: (1) recognizing the `"pee-pee dance"` or internal cue (interoception), (2) stopping a preferred activity to respond (executive function), (3) understanding abstract social motivation (`"being a big kid"`), and (4) tolerating massive routine disruption over 3 days (flexibility). The

method's core instruction --- `"read your child's signals"` --- fails when the child literally has no signals to read. As Autism Speaks clinicians note, `"these children seem to 'go without warning.'"` The rapid phase transitions (naked → commando → pants) directly clash with ASD rigidity.

**** (c) Emotional scars: **** Devastation when the method that `"worked for everyone else"` fails catastrophically. The book's confident, prescriptive tone makes parents feel they did something wrong. Often produces meltdowns, withholding, and regression.

**** (d) Parent quotes: ****

> `"I used the Oh Crap method which totally stressed her and me out. After going back to pull ups for awhile, we ended up doing [an entirely different approach]."` --- Berkeley Parents Network 🧠 `"She had it down when we did the intensive potty training; then we traveled, and she went back to pull-ups and has lost all interest in the potty. Each time we try now, it seems like she digs her feet more and more into the sand. We feel like failures and just don't see an`

> end in sight.\" --- ParentData survey 🎯 \"If you have tried popular
> \"three-day methods\" or traditional reward charts and ended up with
> meltdowns, resistance, or total avoidance, you are not alone.\" ---
> Regency ABA 🛡️

3. Timer-Based Sitting Schedules

** (a) What parents expected:** Taking the child to the toilet every
20--30 minutes will \"catch\" voids by chance and eventually build the
connection.

** (b) Why it specifically fails for ASD nervous systems:** 🧠
Timer-based schedules are an externally-driven approach that **never
teaches the child to recognize internal body signals.** Kelly Mahler
states directly: \"Many toileting approaches focus on surface behaviors:
how often accidents happen, how long a child sits on the toilet, or
whether they comply with schedules, reminders, or rewards... these
approaches often miss the body's role in toileting readiness.\" The
timer creates a Pavlovian prompt but bypasses the interoception system
entirely. The result: years of \"schedule-dependent\" toileting --- the
child goes when prompted but never independently initiates. The repeated
sensory assaults of forced toilet sitting (cold seat, bathroom
acoustics, posture demands) can create negative associations.

** (c) Emotional scars:** Life revolves around the timer. The parent
becomes a drill sergeant. Burnout is severe. Lack of progress despite
exhausting consistency creates hopelessness.

** (d) Parent quotes:**

> \"Speaking from experience, it's a long road to get some autistic
> children potty trained. My son's road has been going on for six
> years, and it's been more miss than hit.\" --- Autism Parenting
> Magazine parent contributor 🎯 \"It took Grey about 3 weeks to finally
> just start to get the process\" --- Sasha Long, describing even the

> *success* story as grueling 🎯 \"Set a timer for 20 minutes and
> consistently take the child to sit on the toilet... Mark on the
> datasheet the time...\" --- Autism Parenting Magazine, illustrating
> the clinical intensity parents are asked to maintain 🎯

4. Reward Charts & Bribery Systems

** (a) What parents expected:** M&Ms, sticker charts, iPad time ---
surely SOMETHING will motivate the child enough.

** (b) Why it specifically fails for ASD nervous systems:** 🧠 Kelly
Mahler states it definitively: \"Rewards can't create or clarify
internal body signals. When interoceptive cues are quiet, delayed, or
confusing, no sticker or prize can dictate what the body actually needs
or is trying to tell us.\" **You cannot reward a child for responding to
a signal they don't receive.** Many ASD children also struggle with the
abstract, deferred logic of \"If you pee in the potty, you can have 5
minutes of iPad\" (Autism Speaks). Added pressure from reward systems
\"can actually make it harder for a child to tune into subtle body cues,
thus making toileting more difficult\" (Kelly Mahler). The reward fights
the mechanism.

** (c) Emotional scars:** The implicit message of reward failure is
devastating: \"My child isn't motivated enough\" or \"I haven't found
the right reward\" --- when the real issue is neurological, not
motivational.

** (d) Parent quotes:**

> \"Your child may not understand, 'If you pee in the potty, you can
> have 5 minutes of iPad.'\" --- Autism Speaks psychologists 🧠 \"He

> still refuses to do no 2 on the toilet. The walls of his bedroom is
> full of charts showing the treats he got since we started.\" ---
> 101Autism.com comment 🧠 🧠 \"Rewards can't create or clarify internal
> body signals.\" --- Kelly Mahler 🧠 🧠

5. Naked Method / Commando Training

** (a) What parents expected:** Without diapers, the child will see/feel
urine, creating an \"aha moment.\"

** (b) Why it specifically fails for ASD nervous systems:** 🧠 For
interoception-impaired children, seeing urine run down their legs
doesn't create the expected internal connection --- they may observe it
as an external event without linking it to an internal sensation. For
sensory-averse children, urine on bare skin triggers anxiety and
withholding, leading to constipation and UTIs. Critically, many ASD
children find \"the sensory feeling of the weight of the nappy\"
comforting (National Autistic Society UK). Removing that sensory input
without replacement causes distress. The child's nervous system shifts
to threat response, making the relaxation needed for voiding impossible.

** (c) Emotional scars:** Homes become \"biohazard zones.\" Children hold
for hours creating medical concern. Impossibility of leaving the house.

** (d) Parent quotes:**

> \"Mine would hold and hold and hold. She'd get to the point of
> bursting.\" --- Berkeley Parents Network 🧠 🧠 \"Some children find the
> feel of a full nappy comforting, and may enjoy the sensory feeling of
> the weight of the nappy.\" --- National Autistic Society UK 🧠 🧠 \"It is
> hard. This is like... incredibly hard. She has Frozen-character
> underwear; we aren't yelling or shaming her when she has accidents;
> we've tried letting her run around naked, tried candy and video
> bribes. Nothing is working.\" --- ParentData survey 🧠 🧠

6. Punishment / Negative Consequences

** (a) What parents expected:** Out of desperation --- hoping the child
will be motivated to avoid punishment.

** (b) Why it specifically fails for ASD nervous systems:** 🧠 Punishing
a child for an interoception deficit is like punishing a deaf child for
not hearing. Punishment creates anxiety, activating the sympathetic
nervous system (fight-or-flight), which either triggers urgency or shuts
down the voiding reflex entirely. For ASD children already struggling
with emotional regulation, punishment around toileting creates lasting
aversion to the bathroom.

** (c) Emotional scars:** Parents who've resorted to punishment carry
tremendous guilt. An autistic adult shared: \"I was shamed, punished and
belittled and I wet the bed until I was THIRTEEN.\" (NeuroClastic)

** (d) Parent quotes:**

> \"There is no place for punishment when it comes to potty training
> your child with autism.\" --- Milestones Autism Resources 🛡️
> \"Accidents happen. Parents or caregivers should stay calm, help the
> child change his wet or soiled clothes as quickly as possible, and
> avoid scolding.\" --- SPARK researcher Elizabeth Cross 🛡️
> \"Punishment, shame, or expressing disappointment can create anxiety
> around toileting --- making the regression worse.\" --- The Learning
> Tree ABA 🧠 🧠

7. Social Stories & Visual Schedules (Alone)

** (a) What parents expected:** Cartoon-illustrated step-by-step
instructions will help the child understand and feel motivated.

** (b) Why it specifically fails for ASD nervous systems:** 🧠 Social

stories address COGNITIVE and PROCEDURAL aspects --- the \"what\" and \"how.\" They cannot address the BODY. A child can perfectly understand every step in the story and still be unable to independently initiate because they never receive the internal signal to begin the sequence. Kelly Mahler: \"Toileting is not just a behavior to perform. It's a whole-body process that depends on internal awareness, body trust, and the ability to notice and interpret physical signals.\" The National Autistic Society adds: \"It is rare for an autistic child to have the social motivation to want to be like mummy/daddy/friend and use the toilet.\"

(c) Emotional scars: Parents invest significant time creating personalized stories --- only to find the child can recite the story perfectly but still has daily accidents. The gap between understanding and execution feels inexplicable.

(d) Parent quotes:

> \"We used picture symbols breaking down the process of toileting on a
> Velcro strip... We created a social story for toileting... None of
> these methods worked.\" --- Maureen Bennie 🧠 \"It is rare for an
> autistic child to have the social motivation to want to be like
> mummy/daddy/friend and use the toilet.\" --- National Autistic Society
> UK 🧠 \"Many toileting approaches focus on surface behaviors... these
> approaches often miss the body's role in toileting readiness.\" ---
> Kelly Mahler 🧠

8. ABA-Based Toilet Training

(a) What parents expected: The gold standard --- data-driven, BCBA-supervised, evidence-based. If anything will work, ABA will.

(b) Why it specifically fails for ASD nervous systems (when done without interoception focus): 🧠 Traditional ABA focuses on observable behavior chains and external reinforcement but may not address the underlying interoceptive deficit. As Kelly Mahler states: \"This isn't a failure of the child or caregiver, it's a mismatch between what behavior-based approaches ask for and what toileting actually requires. Supporting toileting means supporting the body, not managing behavior.\" ABA can successfully teach a child to sit, pull pants down, and respond to prompts --- but without internal signal recognition, the child becomes **prompt-dependent**, only going when taken.

(c) Emotional scars: Parents who've invested thousands of dollars and years of therapy feel betrayed when their child performs on command at the clinic but still has accidents at home.

(d) Parent quotes:

> \"Potty training is not fun at all. Nope, not a single tiny ounce of
> it. In fact it's one of my most grueling and excruciating parenting
> experiences to date.\" --- Sasha Long, who used ABA with both autistic
> sons 🧠 \"This isn't a failure of the child or caregiver, it's a
> mismatch between what behavior-based approaches ask for and what
> toileting actually requires.\" --- Kelly Mahler 🧠🧠 \"Due to a range
> of challenges associated with ASD, toileting can be frustrating for
> neurodivergent individuals as well as discouraging for their
> caregivers.\" --- Hopebridge BCBA Katie

9. Occupational Therapy (General)

(a) What parents expected: The \"sensory expert\" will solve the puzzle --- desensitize bathroom fears, address motor planning, build comfort.

**** (b) Why it specifically fails for ASD nervous systems: **** 🧠 General OT focuses on EXTERNAL sensory environment (noise, temperature, texture) and motor skills (pulling pants, sitting balance) without addressing INTEROCEPTION. Miss Jenny OT (30+ years as pediatric OT): \"Individuals with weak interoception systems often have difficulty learning when to use the toilet. They may not notice when their diaper is soiled, the feeling when their bladder is full, or the presence of stool in their rectum.\" Standard OT makes the bathroom comfortable and the motor sequence achievable --- but if the child never receives the internal signal, they still cannot independently initiate. The ****STAR Institute for SPD**** states plainly: \"Many professionals, including doctors and occupational therapists, do not know about this 8th sensory system.\" **** (c) Emotional scars: **** OT becomes \"one more appointment\" that addresses pieces without solving it.

**** (d) Parent quotes: ****

> \"His main issue is interoception... we've spent the last year
> struggling.\" --- Your Kids Table comment 🧠🧠 \"I am an OT at special
> school. Have a 12 years old learner with autism spectrum disorder. He
> soils and wets his pants daily.\" --- OT professional admitting the
> challenge, Your Kids Table 🧠 \"She just sleeps so deeply that she
> does not feel when she has to go to the bathroom.\" --- Parent, Your
> Kids Table 🧠

****10. \"Just Wait Until He's Ready\" / Child-Led Approach****

**** (a) What parents expected: **** Their child will one day spontaneously show interest in the toilet and the process will unfold naturally.

**** (b) Why it specifically fails for ASD nervous systems: **** 🧠 For neurotypical children, readiness signs emerge organically: interest in the toilet, discomfort with wet diapers, desire to be like peers. For ASD children, ****these motivators may never emerge spontaneously.**** The National Autistic Society states: \"It is rare for an autistic child to have the social motivation to want to be like mummy/daddy/friend.\" Due to interoception deficits, many ASD children genuinely don't feel discomfort in a wet diaper --- so the \"discomfort motivator\" never activates. Research shows \"extended use of diapers can increase resistance to potty training\" (Tarbox et al., 2004), and children incontinent beyond age 8 are less likely to ever become continent (Singh et al., 2006). Clinical experience now advises \"starting earlier is better\" --- directly contradicting the \"just wait\" advice.

**** (c) Emotional scars: **** The most insidious failure because it comes disguised as patience. Parents who wait lose critical years while the diaper routine entrenches.

**** (d) Parent quotes: ****

> \"My son took 3 years to train for a bowel movement... We finally got
> him trained at age 9.5 years after trying just about everything.\" ---
> Maureen Bennie 🧠 \"There is a temptation to delay toilet training
> with autistic children. However, clinical experience and research is

> now saying that starting earlier is better.\" --- National Autistic
> Society UK 🧠 \"His therapist said he could be 7 or 8 before he is
> trained.\" --- Finding Cooper's Voice comment 🧠

****The thread connecting all 10 failures****

🧠🧠 ****Not a single one of these methods addresses interoception --- the child's ability to detect and interpret internal body signals.**** Every method is a behavior-based or environment-based intervention applied to what is fundamentally a neurological body-signal problem. Pull-ups

remove sensory feedback. Timers replace internal signals with external ones. Rewards motivate action the child physically cannot detect. Punishment creates anxiety that further disrupts body-signal processing. Social stories teach the "what" but not the "feel." ABA shapes the behavior without building the sensation. OT fixes the environment but not the internal awareness. Waiting assumes readiness signals will eventually emerge when the interoceptive system may never develop them without targeted support.

PART 4: THE UNIQUE MECHANISM --- INTEROCEPTION

4.1 Scientific foundation: the sense she's never heard of
Interoception is the process by which the nervous system senses, interprets, and integrates signals originating from within the body. First described by Nobel Prize-winning scientist Charles Sherrington in 1906, it has been called "the eighth sense." It governs awareness of hunger, thirst, heart rate, temperature, pain, **bladder fullness**, and bowel fullness. It is mediated by sensory receptors throughout internal organs that send signals via the vagus nerve to the **insular cortex** (insula) in the brain.

Key researchers and findings:

Kelly Mahler, OTD, OTR/L is the world's leading clinical expert on interoception in autism. Winner of the **2020 American Occupational Therapy Association Emerging and Innovative Practice Award**, author of 10+ interoception-focused resources used in **30+ countries** by **180,000+ professionals and caregivers**. Her Interoception Curriculum is the first structured intervention for building interoceptive awareness. She states: "Toileting is not just a behavior to perform. It's a whole-body process that depends on internal awareness, body trust, and the ability to notice and interpret signals." 🧠🎯
Prof. Sarah Garfinkel (University College London) established the three-dimensional model of interoception (Garfinkel et al., 2015, *Biological Psychology*). Her landmark 2016 study found that autistic individuals had **reduced interoceptive accuracy** (objectively worse at detecting internal signals) but **exaggerated interoceptive sensibility** (over-inflated belief in their body awareness). This "trait prediction error" --- the gap between what they think they feel and what they actually detect --- correlated with both emotion processing deficits and anxiety. 292+ citations on Scopus. 🧠
Williams et al. (2023) conducted a systematic review and

meta-analysis (15 studies, n=945) published in *Journal of Autism and Developmental Disorders*. Finding: Autistic participants showed **significantly reduced heartbeat counting performance** ($g=-0.333$) and **higher confidence in their heartbeat counting abilities** ($g=0.430$) --- worse at detecting signals, more confident they can. 🧠

Mahler et al. (2022) published the first pediatric interoception intervention study in *Occupational Therapy International* --- a 25-week school-based intervention using The Interoception Curriculum with 14 autistic students aged 9--19. Results: significant improvements in emotion regulation AND homeostatic regulation including eating, thirst, and pain awareness. The study confirmed that interoceptive abilities CAN be developed through intervention. 🧠🎯

Prevalence data: **49% of autistic 4--5 year olds were not toilet trained**, compared to 24% of children with developmental delay and only 8% of neurotypical peers (SPARK, citing 2022 study). The average toilet training age for autistic children is **3.3 years** versus 2.5 for

neurotypical children (Williams et al., 2003) --- but this average obscures the long tail where many children remain untrained at 5, 6, 7, and beyond. Average duration of urine training for ASD children was ***1.6 years***; bowel training ***2.1 years*** (Dalrymple & Ruble, 1992). Nearly ***40% of individuals with autism*** have gastrointestinal conditions compounding toileting difficulty (Ward et al., 2023). Approximately ***98% of autistics*** experience some form of interoceptive difference --- `"over feeling," "under feeling,"` or `"confusing"` their body signals (Autism Parenting Magazine). 🧠

4.2 Market awareness: at the perfect inflection point

Roughly 10--15% of highly-engaged ASD parents know the term "interoception." The vast majority describe the identical phenomenon using lay language: `"he doesn't feel it," "she can't tell when her bladder is full," "he doesn't notice when he's wet."` The term is standard in OT/clinical literature but hasn't crossed into mainstream parent discourse.

Discovery pathway: The overwhelming majority learn the term from an OT therapist, often after years of failed training. The next most common source is Kelly Mahler's work, followed by autism blogs (Autism Little Learners, Autism Awareness Centre, Autism Parenting Magazine) and community forums.

🎯 ***This is the perfect market inflection point for owning the term.*** Interoception is validated enough by professionals to be credible (AOTA award, peer-reviewed research, used in 30+ countries) but unknown enough to most parents that naming it creates an instant `"aha moment."` The brand that names interoception for parents --- giving them the word they didn't have --- becomes the authority.

The "aha moment" is real and documented. When parents learn about interoception, the shift is consistently described as transformative --- from `"my child is defiant/unmotivated"` to `"my child literally can't feel it."` An autistic psychologist wrote: `"Once I learned about the connection between interoception and autism, I gained a better`

`understanding of why my body has often felt confusing to occupy."` The STAR Institute states: `"A child with toileting issues may actually be struggling with a little known sensory system called interoception..."` Many professionals, including doctors and occupational therapists, do not know about this 8th sensory system." 🧠

4.3 Explanation bridges --- how parents teach each other (ad copy gold)

When parents who understand interoception explain it to other parents, they reach for specific analogies. These are the exact language bridges for ad copy:

🎯 ***"Internal GPS that's glitchy"*** --- `"It's kind of like your body's internal GPS --- it helps you to know how you're feeling physically and emotionally. Now, imagine if that GPS was a little glitchy."` (Goally parent guide)

🎯 ***"The signal doesn't reach the brain"*** --- `"The signal of a full bladder or needing to eliminate does not reach the brain so there is no impetus to get to the toilet."` (Maureen Bennie, parent of 2 autistic children)

🎯 ***"The 8th sense"*** --- Used by virtually every source. Works because parents already understand the 5 senses and many know about proprioception/vestibular.

🎯 ***"Full bladder to the point of bursting"*** --- `"The sensation of needing to go is felt too late --- a full bladder to the point of`

bursting.\" (Autism Awareness Centre)

🌀 **\"Volume dial turned down\"** --- Parents describe interoception as either \"turned up to max\" or \"turned all the way down.\"

🌀 **\"Over feel, under feel, or confuse\"** --- \"Most 'over feel,' 'under feel,' or 'confuse' what their sensory system is trying to tell them.\" (Autism Parenting Magazine)

🌀 **The balloon bladder** (tactile demonstration) --- \"We use balloons to simulate our bladders. First, we fill them up then hold them near our bellies to show where the full bladder would be. Then we empty the balloon into the toilet to simulate peeing.\" (Miss Jenny OT)

4.4 The mechanism chain --- strongest proof points

The complete causal chain:

Interoception difference → muted/absent bladder fullness signals → no \"I need to go\" urge → no anticipatory behavior (no squirming, no leg-crossing, no potty dance) → child voids without awareness → if wearing pull-ups, child doesn't feel wetness after voiding either → zero sensory feedback at any point → brain cannot build or strengthen the neural pathway connecting fullness sensation to voiding action → cycle repeats indefinitely 🧠

Strongest proof points for a skeptical parent:

1. **The statistic:** \"49% of autistic 4--5 year olds are not toilet > trained vs. 8% of neurotypical peers.\" This isn't a parenting > problem --- it's a neurological pattern. 🧠🛡️
2. **The expert quote:** Kelly Mahler: \"Rewards can't create or > clarify internal body signals. When interoceptive cues are quiet, > delayed, or confusing, no sticker or prize can dictate what the > body actually needs.\" This validates every failed reward chart. > 🧠🌀
3. **The clinical observation:** Miss Jenny OT (30+ years): > \"Individuals with weak interoception systems often have > difficulty learning when to use the toilet. They may not notice > when their diaper is soiled, the feeling when their bladder is > full, or the presence of stool in their rectum.\" 🧠
4. **The research:** Garfinkel et al. (2016) demonstrated that autistic > individuals have reduced accuracy in detecting internal signals > but HIGHER confidence they can --- explaining why the child may > say \"I don't need to go\" and genuinely believe it. 🧠
5. **The intervention evidence:** Mahler et al. (2022) proved > interoceptive awareness CAN be developed through structured > intervention --- it's not permanent. This is the hope. 🌀🧠
6. **The lived experience:** Maureen Bennie (parent, Autism Awareness > Centre): \"People with autism tend to have impairment in this > area. This means the signal of a full bladder or needing to > eliminate does not reach the brain so there is no impetus to get > to the toilet.\" This comes from a mother who trained her son at > 9.5 years after trying everything. 🌀

Important epistemic note: The specific claim that \"feeling wetness through training underwear builds interoceptive neural pathways\" is a theoretically sound inference from neuroplasticity research and sensory feedback learning principles, supported by expert clinical recommendation (Miss Jenny OT, multiple BCBAs, Kelly Mahler), but there are no published randomized controlled trials testing training underwear versus pull-ups specifically for interoception development in ASD children. The argument is strong but should be framed as \"clinically

supported\" rather than \"proven in controlled studies.\" The ERIC Children's Bowel and Bladder Charity states: \"There is evidence that some children learn to recognise their body signals of a full bladder and bowel AFTER they learn to use the potty and toilet and have developed a toileting routine.\" This supports the learning-through-feedback mechanism. 🛡️

4.5 Why no competitor can credibly claim this mechanism

The logical exclusion argument:

Pull-Ups are structurally designed to eliminate wetness sensation. Their core engineering purpose --- moisture-wicking absorbency --- is the exact opposite of what interoception development requires.

Kimberly-Clark cannot credibly claim to build body awareness when their product's entire value proposition is removing the body signal. \"Modern diapers and pull-ups can be too good at whisking away the pee. As a result, your child may not even realize that he has urinated.\"

(Autism Speaks) 🧠🎯

Timer apps replace internal signals with external prompts. They teach schedule compliance, not body awareness. Kelly Mahler: \"Many toileting approaches focus on surface behaviors... these approaches often miss the body's role in toileting readiness.\" A timer will never teach a child to feel their bladder. 🧠

Reward charts attempt to motivate action the child physically cannot detect. You cannot incentivize response to a signal that doesn't exist in the child's conscious awareness. 🧠

ABA protocols (without interoception focus) shape observable behavior without building the underlying sensation. They create prompt-dependent toileting, not independent toileting. 🧠

Standard cotton underwear provides wetness sensation but no mess containment --- so parents abandon it after days of uncontrollable accidents, ending the learning process before it can work. 🛡️

This leaves one product category uniquely positioned: Training underwear that provides BOTH real physical sensation feedback (the child feels wetness --- the learning signal) AND sufficient containment to make the process sustainable for parents over the weeks/months required. This is the structural sweet spot that no competitor can occupy:

- Pull-ups have containment but no sensation → **no learning**
- Regular underwear has sensation but no containment → **unsustainable
- > for parents**
- Training underwear with controlled sensation AND containment →
- > **sustainable learning** 🎯🧠

As one parent validated: \"Thomas took nearly 6 months to learn to pee in a toilet. We used trainer pants that were plastic on the inside and fluffy cotton on the outside. They were completely useless as protection but as he hated wet clothes, he would remove his clothing and then be directed to the toilet hopefully to finish there.\" (Finding Cooper's Voice comment) The learning happened BECAUSE of the sensation. 🎯

The mechanism sentence for product positioning: **\"Training underwear lets your child's brain feel what pull-ups hide --- the sensation of wetness that builds the body-brain connection their interoception system needs to develop.\"** 🎯🧠

Kelly Mahler's three-step interoception model maps directly to the product function:

1. **Noticing** a body signal → Training underwear creates the signal
- > (wetness) that pull-ups eliminate

2. **Understanding** what that signal means → Repeated experience of
 > "I feel wet → I just peed" builds the neural connection

3. **Responding** in a way that works → Over time, the brain learns to
 > attend to the pre-emptive signal (bladder fullness) that comes
 > BEFORE wetness

"As practice develops, more connections are facilitated across the somatosensory cortex, enabling greater ability to feel sensory cues across the entire body." (Cayoun, neuroplasticity research) 🧠

This mechanism is exclusively ownable because it requires a physical product that delivers a physical sensation. No app, no book, no therapy protocol, no visual schedule can replicate what underwear fabric does against skin. The mechanism lives in the material. 🎯

FINAL SYNTHESIS

The one sentence she has never read anywhere

After analyzing hundreds of parent statements, clinical sources, and failed-solution autopsies, the central unspoken truth of this market crystallizes into a single insight.

Every source tells this mother WHAT to do. No source tells her WHY nothing has worked.

She has been told to wait. She has been told to try harder. She has been told to use charts, timers, candy, ABA, OT, books, apps, social stories, and more patience than she thought she had. Every method assumed her child's body was sending the signal and the problem was getting the child to respond. None of them asked the question: **what if the signal isn't arriving?**

🎯🧠 **The one sentence:**

> **"Your child's brain isn't ignoring the signal to use the potty
 > --- their body isn't sending one --- and that's not a flaw in your
 > child or your parenting, it's a sensory system called interoception
 > that simply needs to be built, the same way any sense develops:
 > through real, physical feedback their body can actually feel."**

This sentence does four things simultaneously:

1. **Removes guilt** --- "not a flaw in your child or your parenting"
2. **Names the invisible** --- "a sensory system called
 > interoception"
3. **Reframes from permanent to developmental** --- "simply needs to
 > be built"
4. **Points to a specific mechanism** --- "real, physical feedback
 > their body can actually feel"

And in doing so, it disqualifies every competitor. Pull-ups can't build what they prevent feeling. Timers can't develop what they replace. Rewards can't motivate response to what doesn't exist yet. Only a product that delivers real sensation to the body can claim to serve this mechanism.

That is market dominance through superior messaging.

COMPREHENSIVE MARKET RESEARCH REPORT: POTTY TRAINING FOR CHILDREN WITH ASD

Parts 5, 6 & 7 --- Market Timing, Messaging Strategy & Blue Ocean Positioning

PART 5: MARKET TIMING & URGENCY TRIGGERS

5.1 Institutional Triggers

Institutional pressure is the single most reliable external force that converts a passive, resigned parent into an active buyer. These triggers work because they impose hard deadlines on a problem the parent has been able to postpone. The emotional cocktail is shame + urgency + fear of

exclusion for their child.

Preschool and daycare enrollment requirements

Private preschools and daycares impose the earliest and hardest deadlines. **Most private programs require full toilet independence by age 3** for entry into 3-year-old classrooms. The language is blunt and non-negotiable.

One preschool policy shared by Dr. Steve Hodges, pediatric urologist, reads: *\"If a child has multiple accidents in a day or over a period of days, and we realize a child is not fully toilet trained, then we may ask that parents keep the child home for a week or two to complete toilet learning. If accidents persist, families may be asked to leave school.\"* 🚫

This is not hypothetical. NBC News documented a federal case against Chesterbrook Academy Preschool, which *\"told the toddler's parents that the girl had to be potty trained by a certain date\"* and then expelled a child with Down syndrome in 2015 despite medical documentation --- citing *\"corporate policy says that 3-year-olds in certain classrooms have to be fully trained.\"* The facility was fined \$30,000.

Dr. Mary Barbera, BCBA and autism parent, reports that a 2023 research study indicates **1 in 6 children with autism will be asked to leave their daycare or preschool setting** --- with potty training delays explicitly listed as a cause. Her own son Lucas was told he *\"wasn't ready to move up to the three-year-old class, where potty training and greater independence were expected.\"* 🚫

The parent response is desperate scrambling. One mother on the West Seattle Blog wrote: *\"I have a 3 year old son who is on the mild end of the autism spectrum and is not yet fully potty trained. I need a summer

program for him that allows him to wear diapers\... they require potty trained kids\...so I have to cancel that. HELP!\"* 🚫

Another parent on FW Moms described being *\"kicked out of 3 daycares; one school and a summer camp\"* and being *\"constantly on the brink of losing my job.\"*

Kindergarten and elementary school requirements

Public schools technically cannot deny enrollment under IDEA, but the practical barriers are enormous. A parent on the Hechinger Report shared: *\"My 5 (and a half) year old son is still in diapers\... he has a developmental disorder, is on an IEP, and in a Special Ed Kindergarten class. There are 11 kids (10 boys) in the class & 8 of the 11 are in full diapers.\"* The critical downstream effect: *\"Potty training has precluded us from him going to the afterschool program, (which we need for a time after school because we work) due to no staff available to change his diaper there.\"* 🚫

One parent chose homeschooling entirely because the school's response to her un-potty-trained child was: *\"well, once he goes in school, we'll send him home for a month to work on it.\"* Her bitter response: *\"Whatever. Wow, awesome advice.\"*

Some states are making requirements explicit. **Utah passed HB 331 (effective May 2024) requiring students to be toilet trained before kindergarten enrollment**, with exceptions only for children with IEP/504 plans. California's TK programs technically can't deny enrollment but send letters stating: *\"We STRONGLY encourage you to potty train your child\... Fully potty-trained means that the pupil comes to school in big kid underpants (not pull-ups).\"* 🚫

A special education teacher on MyAutismTeam described a **3rd grader (age ~8-9) still in diapers**: *\"I change him when needed. I added working on toilet training as a goal on his IEP. My poor little guy does not want to use the potty! He yells 'No' at me every time I tell him it is time to go try!\"*

IEP meetings as pressure moments

IEP meetings create institutional urgency layered with bureaucratic frustration. Parents report being told *\"that's not an IEP item\"* when requesting toileting goals --- despite clear legal precedent supporting adaptive living skills in IEPs. The advocacy site A Day in Our Shoes responds: *\"Ask them to show you where it says in IDEA that potty training should not be part of an IEP. They'll be looking for a really long time.\"* 🛡️

CHOP (Children's Hospital of Philadelphia) explicitly notes a critical gap: *\"If you plan on enrolling your child in a private school or preschool where he or she will not have an IEP, the school may refuse to admit children who are not potty trained, even if they have a disability.\"* 🎯

Summer camp and after-school exclusion

This is where the long-term consequences become visible. Jess Ronne, mother of Lucas (severe autism, age 17), documented the devastating scope of exclusion:

> *\"By the time he was 14, there wasn't a single place I could find
> that would include him --- after-school programs, summer camps, the
> YMCA, and vacation Bible schools (and I called them all!) and you know
> why they wouldn't include him? Because he wasn't capable of using
> the toilet independently. He was still in briefs, that was the
> deciding factor in every single case --- even the ones that served the
> special needs population.\"* 🎯

She added: *\"It is beyond frustrating to me that we, as a society, claim to accept everyone and everything in this day and age, but we can't accept an individual who needs help with bathroom issues.\"*

The fact that a camp (Autism Center for Kids) markets *\"Diapers Allowed --- No Potty Training Needed!\"* as a headline selling point reveals how pervasive the exclusion is. 🧠

Insurance and Medicaid reviews

Medical Assistance and many insurance plans cover diapers for children over age 3 with documented disabilities --- but the process creates its own institutional trigger. A physician letter of medical necessity is required, describing *\"not just that your child has ASD, but how individual features, such as inability to communicate, are preventing your child from learning to toilet independently\"* (CHOP Research). Aeroflow Urology notes a **hard age-3 cutoff**: *\"Medicaid cannot make any exceptions for diaper coverage based on age, even under appeal or with medical necessity.\"* The financial pressure of larger, more expensive diapers/pull-ups compounds over years --- one parent described it as *\"a permanent fixture in the budget.\"* 🎯

ABA therapy requirements

ABA centers sometimes require baseline toilet readiness or make toileting a treatment condition. The Autism Café documented a parent whose *\"Son With Autism Got Kicked Out Of ABA Therapy.\"* Hopebridge ABA acknowledged the systemic pressure: *\"Toileting can be an added barrier for school, as many daycares, preschools and elementary schools require children older than a certain age to use the restroom

independently.\"* LEARN Behavioral notes that extended diaper use can
*\"restrict participation in social activities (e.g., camp, after school
program, etc.).\"*

Summary table of institutional triggers:

Institution **Typical Requirement** **Age** **Consequence**
Trigger**

Private \"Must be potty trained Age 3 Enrollment denied
preschool/daycare by age 3\" or expulsion

Public kindergarten Varies; practical Age 5 Sent home; nurse
barriers exist even if calls; isolation
legally protected

After-school Must be toilet All ages No access (\"no
programs independent staff to change
diapers\")

Summer camps \"Must be potty All ages Cannot attend
(mainstream) trained\"

Special needs Often still require Varies \"Did not qualify
programs toilet independence due to the toilet
issue\"

ABA therapy centers May require baseline Varies Expulsion from
readiness program

IEP system Should include toileting School age Bureaucratic
goals resistance

Medicaid diaper Begins age 3; requires Age 3+ Financial burden,
coverage medical necessity letter ongoing paperwork

5.2 Social Triggers

Social triggers are slower-burning but emotionally more devastating than
institutional deadlines. They attack identity rather than logistics.

Family gatherings and grandparent pressure

The tolerance cliff is steep. One parent described it this way: *\"The
diapers weren't a big deal to most --- while he was little --- and then
he grew and the cute little boy started to have opinions and would
scream, and he was still in diapers.\"* The implicit judgment shifts as
the child ages --- from sympathetic to uncomfortable to openly critical.



Grandparent conflict is a recurring trigger. One mother on Reddit
(preserved by Romper) described three years of intensive training
attempts, starting at age 2, and then blamed her own mother for
undermining the process. The public comments were vicious: *\"If your
child has gotten to FOUR years old and still isn't potty trained/wears
pull-ups, it's your own fault and nobody else's.\"*

Amy Mantravadi, parent of a 5-year-old with ASD still in diapers,
described the cascading effect: *\"Grandparents, often first in line to
care for little ones, may struggle to deal with children who need more
constant attention, including physical support while going to the
toilet... Potential caregivers may also balk at having to change
diapers for an older child.\"* The result: parents can never get a break
because potential caregivers refuse to help.

The National Autistic Society formally acknowledges the dynamic:
*\"Parents may have felt incredible pressure around toileting from

family, friends and other professionals, and some of the resulting advice may have been unhelpful or even misleading.\"* 🛡️

Playdates, birthday parties, and public visibility

A parent shared on a forum aggregated by SheKnows: her sister *\"asked that he doesn't swim in the pool with the other kids\"... She then became really condescending, saying her nephew could play in the pool once he's potty trained.\"* Family members publicly excluding a child from a pool party because of diapers. 🗣️

A mother of an older autistic daughter explained: *\"I would never leave my daughter alone at a party and she is older than 8 years old\"* --- meaning the mother must always hover, drawing attention to the child's differences.

The logistics of public outings compound the shame. A parent wrote in Autism Parenting Magazine: *\"My son is very sensitive to sound and doesn't like public restrooms due to the echoes. He fights going into public toilets. Meanwhile, when my son defecates, he will try to clean it himself, and that can create a bigger problem as he smears it wherever he is.\"* 🗣️

Another parent in the same publication: *\"My eight-year-old son with autism still wears diapers or training pants\"... It can be hard to send him to school knowing how profound his needs are especially when it comes to potty training and diapers.\"*

A parent on Autism Forums captured the daily reality: *\"How do you deal with people who have difficulty understanding that even older children can wear diapers? I'm so tired of getting that question. I met some friends yesterday who felt the need to comment on it. Do I have to try to hide the fact that he still wears diapers?\"* 🗣️

Comparison with neurotypical peers

The comparison wound is reopened constantly. Chrissy Kelly of The Autism Helper named it: *\"It's hard when you hear a parent of a typical child say --- 'Potty training was so hard --- it took us a week.' I know there are some of you that have been working at this for months and even longer without success.\"* 🗣️

The statistics make it worse: **49% of autistic children ages 4-5 are not toilet trained** vs. 8% of typically developing peers (SPARK/SEED study, Wiggins et al., 2022). This is the backdrop to every playground encounter. 🧠

Amy Mantravadi described finding a pediatrician-recommended potty training book that identified *\"a six-month window around age two in which parents must get their child toilet trained. Delay past this point, she warned, could be fatal.\"* Her response: *\"My son is five and a half years old and still wears diapers\"... Every battle-tested strategy has failed. Where is the manual for us?\"* 🗣️

Partner and co-parent conflict

Partner disagreement is so common that clinical guides explicitly address it. Bierman Autism notes: *\"If one parent is actively working on training the child, but the other parent keeps the child in diapers, this could significantly stall the process and confuse the child.\"* One parent on The Autism Café described: *\"His dad has been giving me grief and arguing with me saying that he should not be going this way and needs to be trained.\"*

A Wrong Planet forum parent revealed the stealth sabotage pattern: *\"My husband is still not 100% committed\"... Some days, he still sneaks in pull-ups from the store and puts DS in them, especially if we are

visiting friends or going on a long road trip.\"* 🎯

A single mother captured the compounding isolation: *\"He's so kind and sweet otherwise, but as a single parent, this is starting to become challenging to handle.\"* The word \"starting\" suggests she's approaching a breaking point. Another single mother documented: *\"I was a single mother... I had very little income. The amount of time and money I could have saved... I had to provide the school with diapers and wipes for years.\"*

5.3 Medical Triggers

Medical professionals create urgency or --- dangerously for this market --- reassurance that leads to inaction. The gap between what doctors say and what parents need to hear is the key insight.

What pediatricians say at well-child visits

The dominant clinical stance remains reassurance-oriented. North Shore Pediatric Therapy reflects the consensus: *\"There is no magic age to start potty training.\"* The AAP advises parents to consult their pediatrician to rule out medical issues first, but the operational advice often amounts to *\"he'll do it when he's ready.\"** 🧠 This creates a dangerous paradox. Parents hear \"wait\" from the doctor while hearing \"hurry\" from every institution around them.

Elizabeth Cross, PhD, Kennedy Krieger Institute, is more direct: *\"We know these children thrive on routine, and this is a huge routine change. They've been using diapers their whole life, and now we're asking them to do something completely different.\"* She also provides the critical reframe: *\"The vast majority of autistic children CAN be potty trained.\"** This statement --- hope with realism --- is the most effective medical trigger language found in this research. 🎯🛡️

Research shows the consequences of waiting are real. Bakker et al. (2002) found **higher rates of incontinence and urinary tract infections in children trained later than 42 months.** Tarbox et al. (2004) found that **extended diaper use increases resistance to potty training.** These are the facts that should be triggering urgency but rarely reach parents. 🧠

What BCBAs say when ABA isn't working

ABA toilet training follows a structured protocol: baseline data collection, scheduled sits every 15--30 minutes, immediate reinforcement, dry pants checks. When this doesn't work, BCBAs face a professional frustration that sometimes transmits to parents.

Dr. Yannick Espinoza (BCBA) notes: *\"In most cases, about 98% of children in the US learn to use the restroom by age 3, however, this is usually not the case for children with autism.\"*

The Autism Café parent captured the moment the BCBA gives the green light: *\"When Charlie's BCBA told us that she didn't see any reasons not to try potty training, I'm not gonna lie, I was skeptical. How was he supposed to understand the concept of peeing in the potty, let alone accepting sitting on the potty? It seemed impossible.\"* The outcome was partial success: *\"We still have to take him or else he won't go on his own. He's not fully potty-trained but if we remember to take him every hour or so, he will stay dry.\"* 🎯

Frank Cicero, PhD, BCBA-D, identifies three reasons ABA fails: **skill deficit** (the child literally doesn't know), **noncompliance** (active holding/resistance), and **rituals/routines** (rigid associations about elimination). The critical blind spot: **ABA focuses on behavior, but the underlying issue may be interoceptive --- the child cannot feel the

urge.** As one BCBA-informed source acknowledged: *\"Sensory issues, communication barriers, and strict routines can all impact the process.\"* 🧠

What OT evaluations reveal about interoception

This is where the mechanism understanding becomes a purchase trigger. OTs assess body awareness, sensory sensitivities, motor planning, proprioceptive processing, vestibular stability, and --- critically --- **interoceptive awareness** (can the child sense a full bladder?). Fun and Function (OT resource) explains: *\"Using the toilet requires you to recognize that you feel a certain way physically, and then connect that sensation to the need to use the bathroom. Children with autism or other sensory processing disorders often have poor interoceptive skills.\"* 🧠

Laura Petix, The OT Butterfly, identifies the critical misdiagnosis pattern: *\"Interoception is the last one for people to really recognize. It is so discreet because no one can see it and it can be disguised as behavior. So when we're relating to hunger, potty training, emotional regulation, the first thing people think of is behavioral approaches... when in reality it is interoception based.\"* 🧠🎯

KidSense Therapy Group lists specific interoceptive deficits affecting toileting: decreased awareness of wet/soiled diapers, decreased awareness of needing to go, decreased awareness of full bladder/bowel, difficulty discriminating between urinating and defecating, and

difficulties coordinating muscles to push and eliminate. 🧠

The parent \"aha moment\" is documented by the STAR Institute: *\"She had an 'aha' moment when I mentioned how hard it can be for our kids to potty train and sort out those internal signals provided by this 'hidden' sensory system.\"* This is the clinical trigger that creates readiness for a new approach. 🎯

A parent on Miss Jaime OT described the exact interoceptive failure: *\"I've talked to her OTs, pediatrician, urologist, and GI and no one has been able to provide assistance on figuring out how to make those muscles work to release the urine. If she's trying to use the potty, she ends up holding it all day until she explodes.\"* Another: *\"She says it hurts and feels like snakes.\"* And: *\"My 4-year-old struggles to know when he needs to wee during the day. His main issue is interoception.\"* 🎯

GI specialist visits

Children with ASD are **approximately 4 times more likely to experience GI symptoms** than typically developing peers (McElhanon et al., *Pediatrics*). **35% of children with ASD have constipation** vs. 15.6% of the typical population (Wiggins et al., SEED study). GI prevalence in ASD ranges from 4.2% to 96.8% across studies, with a median of 46.8%. The constipation-withholding cycle is vicious. Maureen Bennie of the Autism Awareness Centre explains: *\"The problem with constipation is the longer poop stays inside the bowel, the harder it gets and becomes more painful to pass. This can become a vicious cycle because the child will do everything they can to avoid the pain of pooping. This painful elimination memory can stay with children for years.\"* 🧠

ERIC UK describes the child's internal logic: *\"Poo is pain. I want to stop it.\"* The compounding effect: *\"Children with constipation often have wee problems too as the large bowel may occupy the space where the bladder wants to expand.\"*

****Constipation was significantly associated with toileting resistance****
in ASD children (aOR=1.64; Wiggins et al.). The interoception
connection: *\"People with autism tend to have impairment in
interoception. This means the signal of a full bladder or needing to
eliminate does not reach the brain.\"* 🧠

****5.4 Internal Triggers --- The Psychological Tipping Point****

****The \"I can't do this anymore\" moment****

This moment is not abstract. It is triggered by a specific incident ---
usually a cleanup that breaks the last thread of emotional capacity.
Maureen Bennie described it precisely: *\"My son took 3 years to train
for a bowel movement. He could withhold a bowel movement for up to one
week at a time, was frequently constipated, and smeared feces. I always
gave up with the training the third week into it because I couldn't
handle the daily cleanup.\"* 🌀

Chrissy Kelly of The Autism Helper named the specific fear: *\"There
were days we easily had 10+ accidents, and I was CERTAIN we were going
to be in the Diapers For Life Club.\"* 🌀

Another parent: *\"Potty training is not fun at all. Nope, not a single
tiny ounce of it. In fact it's one of my most grueling and excruciating
parenting experiences to date.\"*

The cycle is: Try → Fail → \"I can't handle the daily cleanup\" → Go
back to pull-ups → Feel guilty → Months pass → Some trigger restarts the
cycle. Each iteration depletes emotional reserves further. 🧠

****The \"I have to try one more thing\" moment****

This moment is triggered by an external event colliding with accumulated
internal pressure. Common catalysts:

A school deadline approaching. A birthday milestone (*\"He's turning 5
next month and still in diapers\"*). A family event where the child was
excluded. A younger sibling starting to potty train. An IEP meeting
where toileting was discussed.

One parent captured the renewal: *\"We've been trying on and off for
years! He seems ready and then he backslides or gets sick. This summer
we are trying harder to get him potty trained. I just started again
yesterday with underwear only and taking him to the potty every
15-30min.\"* 🌀

Another: *\"It took us nine years to get my son Marc using the toilet on
his own... I combed the internet for some words of wisdom and found
nothing.\"* 🌀

****The 2am Google search****

Amy Mantravadi described the existential isolation that drives the
midnight search: *\"One medical professional after another has
steadfastly refused to forecast our son's developmental trajectory...
I have often felt like a sailor using one of those old timey maps, the
features near the edge less clear than those in the center... We are
off the edge of the map.\"* 🌀

What she types: \"potty training autism 5 year old nothing works.\"
\"Why can't my autistic child feel when he needs to pee.\" \"Autism
still in diapers age 6.\" \"Interoception potty training autism.\"
\"Tried everything potty training autism.\"

What she's feeling: exhaustion, shame, isolation, terror that this will
never change, guilt that she's failing her child.

****What would make her click:**** A headline that names her specific
experience --- not generic potty training advice, not \"10 tips,\" but
something that describes the precise reality she is living. Something

that explains WHY her child can't do this --- in a way that removes blame from both of them. 🧠

The "this is different" moment

This mother has been burned by hope so many times that her default mode is skepticism. What penetrates that armor is specificity of mechanism --- not "this works!" but "here's WHY nothing else worked, and here's why this addresses that specific gap."

Kelly Mahler provides the language: "Rewards like stickers, special snacks or iPad time are often suggested because our systems default to behavior-based solutions. But rewards can't create or clarify internal body signals." 🧠

When a parent reads that sentence, the "this is different" moment happens because it validates every failed sticker chart, every M&M bribe, every reward system that felt hollow. It gives a NAME to the gap. And it implies a different solution.

5.5 Seasonal and Temporal Patterns

Summer (May--August) --- primary peak

Summer is consistently cited as the #1 recommended time to attempt potty training for ASD children. Autism Parenting Magazine explicitly recommends: "Set a date when potty training will begin. Suggested times to start potty training are during Spring Break or the beginning of the summer." 🧠

The mechanisms: fewer clothing layers, parent availability for intensive approaches, no competing school transitions, and the "boot camp" mentality that aligns with 3--5 day intensive protocols.

Parent behavior confirms this. One mother wrote: "This summer we are trying harder to get him potty trained" --- the seasonal renewal of determination that drives fresh product searches.

Back-to-school (July--September) --- urgency peak

School enrollment deadlines create the most acute urgency. A Mumsnet parent wrote: "My son's 4, starting school in Sep and still in nappies. I have tried everything. Nothing has/is working... My goal is to get him on the toilet for starting in Sep!" 🧠

This window sees parents in desperation mode --- willing to try new products, spend money, and attempt intensive protocols because a hard deadline looms.

Spring enrollment (February--April) --- secondary peak

Many preschool enrollment decisions for fall placement occur in spring. Growing Tree Preschool's enrollment form states: "Children must be potty trained (no Pull-Ups)." Parents discovering this requirement in February--March begin urgently searching for solutions. 🧠

Birthday milestones --- year-round acute spikes

Birthday milestones (ages 4, 5, 6, and 7) create acute urgency spikes. The parent response is: "He's turning [age] and still in diapers." Each birthday is a comparison event --- against neurotypical peers, against developmental expectations, against the parent's own hopes. The SPARK study's finding that **49% of autistic 4-5 year olds are not toilet trained** means nearly half of ASD families experience an acute crisis during this age window.

January --- resolution energy

New Year resolution mentality creates a secondary bump. Parents returning from holiday breaks have spent concentrated time with their child and seen family judgment. Tax season awareness (medical supply

deductions for incontinence products) adds financial motivation.

Post-diagnosis window --- aseasional but critical

The average age of ASD diagnosis in the US is approximately 4.5 years. Many parents begin intensive potty training efforts immediately after diagnosis in a \"catch-up\" mentality that can occur at any time of year. This creates an unpredictable but high-intent search window. 🧠

PART 6: HOOKS, HEADLINES & MESSAGING (Schwartz Stage 3--4 Strategy)

6a. Ten Hook Hypotheses

HOOK 1: The Invisible Sense

Emotional register: Discovery / revelation

Component 1 --- The Unspoken Thought: *\"I don't understand why he doesn't care that he's wet. He doesn't even seem to notice. It's like he literally can't feel it.\"*

This is not a thought from an article. This is the thought she has after pulling off a soaked pull-up and seeing her child's face show zero recognition that anything happened. She has watched neurotypical children squirm, grab themselves, do the \"potty dance.\" Her child does none of these. She doesn't have the word for it yet, but she has observed it hundreds of times: her child cannot feel the signal. 🧠

Component 2 --- The Bridge to Mechanism: This hook connects directly to the interoceptive deficit. The child LITERALLY cannot feel it --- not because of willfulness, not because of lack of training, but because the neural pathway between bladder and brain (the insular cortex) processes signals differently in ASD. Pull-ups ELIMINATE the one external sensation (wetness on skin) that could compensate for the weak internal signal. Training underwear that lets the child feel wetness gives the brain an alternative feedback pathway to learn from. The hook creates a logical bridge: \"If he can't feel it → he can't learn it → the product restores the feeling → now he can learn.\" 🧠

Component 3 --- Headline Direction: *\"Your child isn't ignoring

the urge to go. Their brain never received the signal.\"*

HOOK 2: The Pull-Up Paradox

Emotional register: Guilt / relief

Component 1 --- The Unspoken Thought: *\"I keep buying pull-ups because they're easier. But somewhere in the back of my mind I know they might be part of the problem. I just can't face the mess of going without them.\"*

She knows. Multiple therapists have told her to switch to underwear. She's read it online. But the mess --- 10+ accidents a day, cleaning couches, carrying supplies everywhere --- overwhelms her. She buys pull-ups out of survival, not ignorance, and she carries quiet guilt about it. 🧠

Component 2 --- The Bridge to Mechanism: This hook directly addresses what Autism Speaks psychologists Aponte and Mruzek call out: *\"Modern diapers and pull-ups can be too good at whisking away the pee. As a result, your child may not even realize that he has urinated.\"*

The bridge: pull-ups remove the consequence signal the brain needs. Training underwear with controlled wetness feedback restores it --- without the full-underwear mess disaster that broke her last time. The product IS the middle ground between pull-up paralysis and underwear chaos. 🧠

Component 3 --- Headline Direction: *\"Pull-ups keep your house clean. They also keep your child's brain from learning when it's time to go.\"*

HOOK 3: The Sticker Chart Graveyard
Emotional register: Validation / vindication
Component 1 --- The Unspoken Thought: *\"I have tried sticker charts, M&Ms, iPads, timers, special seats, favorite toys, praise, and literally everything the internet told me. None of it worked. The charts are still on the bathroom wall, empty. I\\'m not lazy. I\\'ve done everything right. So why won\\'t this work?\"*
This is the central wound. She has followed every protocol. She has tried every behavioral incentive system. And they all assume the child can feel the urge and is choosing not to act on it. She\\'s never been told that the foundational assumption was wrong. 🌀
Component 2 --- The Bridge to Mechanism: Kelly Mahler provides the bridge language: *\"Rewards can\\'t create or clarify internal body signals. When interoceptive cues are quiet, delayed, or confusing, no sticker or prize can dictate what the body actually needs.\"* Every behavioral intervention assumes the child can perceive the signal and just needs motivation to act on it. For ASD children with interoceptive differences, the signal never arrives clearly --- so motivation is irrelevant. The product doesn\\'t motivate the child to go. It teaches the child\\'s body WHAT GOING FEELS LIKE. 🧠

Component 3 --- Headline Direction: *\"Sticker charts can\\'t teach a brain to feel. That\\'s not what was missing.\"*
HOOK 4: The Diapers-For-Life Terror
Emotional register: Fear / urgency
Component 1 --- The Unspoken Thought: *\"What if he\\'s in diapers forever? What happens when he\\'s 10? 15? Who changes him when I\\'m gone? I can\\'t say this out loud because people will think I\\'m being dramatic, but I genuinely don\\'t know if this will ever end.\"*
This is the 2am terror. Not the daily mess. Not the school deadline. The existential fear. Chrissy Kelly named it: *\"I was CERTAIN we were going to be in the Diapers For Life Club.\"* Amy Mantravadi wrote: *\"We are off the edge of the map.\"* This fear is too big and too shameful to say to anyone, even a spouse. 🌀
Component 2 --- The Bridge to Mechanism: The bridge is scientific hope. Elizabeth Cross, PhD, Kennedy Krieger: *\"The vast majority of autistic children CAN be potty trained.\"* The reason they haven\\'t been isn\\'t permanent brain damage --- it\\'s that the training approach didn\\'t address the sensory learning channel. The child\\'s brain CAN build the bladder-brain connection. It just needs the right input signal. The product delivers that signal. The mechanism converts terror into qualified hope. 🧠
Component 3 --- Headline Direction: *\"Your child\\'s brain can learn this. It just hasn\\'t been given the signal it needs.\"*
HOOK 5: The Younger Sibling Wound
Emotional register: Shame / comparison pain
Component 1 --- The Unspoken Thought: *\"My 2-year-old just potty trained herself in a week. My 6-year-old with autism is still in pull-ups. I\\'m watching the same body learn the same skill at completely different speeds and I don\\'t understand why. It makes me feel like I failed him specifically.\"*
This isn\\'t theoretical. It happens in the same house. The younger sibling\\'s ease makes the older child\\'s struggle visible in a way that creates a specific, sharp guilt. She didn\\'t fail at parenting --- she failed one specific child. That\\'s worse. 🌀

****Component 2 --- The Bridge to Mechanism:**** The younger sibling potty trained because her interoceptive system works typically --- she FELT her bladder fill, she FELT the wetness when she had an accident, and her brain connected the two. The older child's brain processes those signals differently. Same house, same parenting, same love --- different neurology. The product addresses the specific neurological difference, not the parenting. 🧠

****Component 3 --- Headline Direction:**** *\"Same parents. Same bathroom.

Different neurology. That's why your younger one trained in a week and your older one hasn't.\"*

****HOOK 6: The School Letter****

****Emotional register: Urgency / institutional pressure****

****Component 1 --- The Unspoken Thought:**** *\"I got the letter. He can't start in the 3-year-old class unless he's potty trained. I have 8 weeks. I feel like I'm going to throw up.\"*

This is the institutional trigger at its most acute. The letter transforms a chronic problem into a crisis with a deadline. She is not buying a product out of curiosity --- she is buying a solution because her child's education, her childcare, and possibly her job depend on it. 🎯

****Component 2 --- The Bridge to Mechanism:**** Eight weeks is actually a realistic timeline for interoceptive learning with consistent sensory feedback. The product doesn't promise overnight results --- it promises a mechanism that works within the timeframe she actually has. The bridge: behavioral approaches take months of timed sits with inconsistent results. Sensation-based learning through the product provides continuous, passive learning every time the child wears it. 🧠

****Component 3 --- Headline Direction:**** *\"School starts in 8 weeks. Your child's brain needs sensation --- not more sticker charts --- to learn this in time.\"*

****HOOK 7: The Behavioral Red Herring****

****Emotional register: Intellectual curiosity / reframe****

****Component 1 --- The Unspoken Thought:**** *\"Everyone keeps treating this as a behavior problem. The BCBA says he's 'non-compliant.' But he's not refusing to pee --- he doesn't know he needs to. I can see it in his face. He's not being defiant. He's confused.\"*

This mother observes her child more closely than any therapist. She has noticed that her child's face during an accident doesn't show defiance --- it shows surprise or blankness. She can't articulate the clinical distinction between a behavioral issue and a sensory processing issue, but she has seen the evidence every day. 🎯

****Component 2 --- The Bridge to Mechanism:**** Laura Petix, OT, names the exact misdiagnosis: *\"Interoception can be disguised as behavior. When we're relating to potty training, the first thing people think of is behavioral approaches... when in reality it is interoception based.\"* The product addresses the correct root cause. It doesn't try to change behavior --- it builds sensory awareness. 🧠

****Component 3 --- Headline Direction:**** *\"Your child isn't refusing to use the toilet. Their body hasn't learned to send the signal yet.\"*

****HOOK 8: The Birthday Party Diaper Bag****

****Emotional register: Specific-scenario recognition****

****Component 1 --- The Unspoken Thought:**** *\"I packed a diaper bag for my 6-year-old's friend's birthday party. I stood in the bathroom at

someone else\'s house trying to change a pull-up on a child who is too big for a changing table. I could hear the kids singing Happy Birthday outside. That was the moment I knew something has to change.\"*

This is the scene. Not abstracted, not generalized. The specific physical reality of wrestling a large child into a pull-up in a stranger\'s bathroom while the party happens without them. This mother can smell the pull-up, hear the singing, feel the ceramic tile. 🌀

****Component 2 --- The Bridge to Mechanism:**** The diaper bag exists because the child has no awareness of bladder status. The birthday party humiliation is the symptom. The missing interoceptive signal is the cause. The product replaces the diaper bag with training underwear that looks like real underwear (social dignity) while teaching the brain to recognize wetness (functional learning). 🧠

****Component 3 --- Headline Direction:**** *\"She was changing a pull-up while the other kids sang Happy Birthday. That night, she searched for something different.\"*

****HOOK 9: The \"He\'ll Do It When He\'s Ready\" Lie****

****Emotional register: Frustration / anger at bad advice****

****Component 1 --- The Unspoken Thought:**** *\"The pediatrician said \'he\'ll do it when he\'s ready\' when he was 3. He said it again at 4. And 5. My child is not getting \'ready.\' He\'s getting older. And bigger. And harder to change. And the advice hasn\'t changed once.\"*

This mother is angry. She was told to wait by the one authority she trusted. She waited. It didn\'t happen. She now suspects she wasted years on reassurance that was designed for neurotypical children. She feels betrayed by the system. 🌀

****Component 2 --- The Bridge to Mechanism:**** \"Readiness\" in neurotypical children means the interoceptive system has matured enough for the child to feel the urge. In ASD children, that maturation may be delayed or require external support. Waiting for readiness that may not arrive naturally is not a strategy --- it\'s abandonment. The product provides the external sensory input that accelerates the brain\'s ability to detect the internal signal. It doesn\'t wait for readiness. It builds it. 🧠

****Component 3 --- Headline Direction:**** *\"\'He\'ll do it when he\'s ready\' assumes his brain is getting the signal. What if it\'s not?\"*

****HOOK 10: The Quiet Victory****

****Emotional register: Hope / emotional resolution****

****Component 1 --- The Unspoken Thought:**** *\"I don\'t need \'fully potty trained in 3 days.\' I need him to NOTICE he\'s wet. Just once. Just notice. Because if he can notice, he can learn. And if he can learn, we\'re not stuck forever.\"*

This is the whisper of hope she allows herself. Not the big dream. The tiny one. The one that seems almost achievable. She doesn\'t dare hope for full independence --- she\'s been burned too many times. But if his eyes widen when he feels wetness. If he looks down. If he grabs at the underwear. That one moment of awareness would be enough to change everything she believes about his potential. 🌀

****Component 2 --- The Bridge to Mechanism:**** That one moment IS the mechanism working. When the child notices wetness --- pauses, looks down, reacts --- that is the interoceptive pathway activating. The product is engineered to create exactly that moment: wetness the child can actually feel, as the first link in the chain from sensation → awareness → association → voluntary control. The first \"notice\" is not

a small win. It is proof that the brain can learn this. 🧠

****Component 3 --- Headline Direction:**** *\"The first time he looked down and noticed he was wet, I cried. That was the moment I knew his brain was learning.\"*

**6b. Complete Objection Inventory**

**Category A: Objections against the product category (Training Pants)**

****A1. \"Training pants are just thin diapers. They didn't work before.\"****

- ****Exact thought pattern:**** *\"I tried training pants when he was 3.
> He treated them exactly like diapers. They just leaked more. We
> went back to pull-ups within a week.\"*
- ****Intensity:**** HIGH
- ****Counter-strategy:**** Differentiate on mechanism, not on form
> factor. The problem with past training pants wasn't the category
> --- it was that they were designed for neurotypical children who
> already have interoceptive awareness. The Body-Signal Learning
> Layer™ is designed for the child who CAN'T feel the signal yet.
> It's not \"thinner diaper\" --- it's \"sensation teacher.\" 🛡️

****A2. \"Underwear just means more laundry and more mess.\"****

- ****Exact thought pattern:**** *\"The last time I tried underwear, we
> had 10+ accidents in a day. I was cleaning the couch, the car
> seat, the floor. I couldn't sustain it. It wasn't teaching him
> anything --- it was just creating chaos.\"*
- ****Intensity:**** HIGH
- ****Counter-strategy:**** Acknowledge the mess directly. Use Maureen
> Bennie's exact quote: *\"I always gave up the third week because

> I couldn't handle the daily cleanup.\"* Then explain the
> difference: past underwear let the mess flow everywhere with no
> containment. This product contains the mess while still allowing
> the child to feel wetness. It bridges the gap between \"pull-up
> paralysis\" and \"underwear chaos.\" 🛡️

****A3. \"Pull-ups are fine for now. We'll deal with it later.\"****

- ****Exact thought pattern:**** *\"Pull-ups aren't ideal but they keep
> things manageable. We have so many other things to deal with ---
> therapy, school, behaviors. This is the one thing I can just...
> not fight about right now.\"*
- ****Intensity:**** MEDIUM
- ****Counter-strategy:**** Don't attack pull-ups (she'll feel judged).
> Instead, gently introduce the research: Tarbox et al. (2004) found
> **extended diaper use increases resistance to potty training.**
> Present the Body-Signal Learning Layer™ as equally easy to use as
> pull-ups --- but with the one feature pull-ups lack: sensation
> feedback. It's not \"more work.\" It's \"same routine, different
> underwear, different result.\" 🛡️

****A4. \"All this paraphernalia is just a marketing ploy.\"****

- ****Exact thought pattern:**** *\"I've bought special seats, timers,
> visual charts, social stories, reward kits. None of it worked.
> This is just another product trying to profit off desperate
> parents.\"*
- ****Intensity:**** MEDIUM
- ****Counter-strategy:**** Lead with mechanism transparency. Don't hide
> behind branding. Explain exactly what the product does and
> doesn't do: \"This underwear lets your child feel wetness.
> That's it. That sensation --- which pull-ups eliminate --- is

> what your child's brain needs to build the bladder-awareness
> connection. We're not selling magic. We're restoring a feedback
> loop." 🛡️

Category B: Objections against the mechanism (Interoception / sensation-based learning)

B1. "I don't understand interoception and I don't trust things I can't understand."

- **Exact thought pattern:** "I've never heard of interoception.
> This sounds like another fancy word therapists use. How do I know
> this is real and not made-up marketing science?"
- **Intensity:** MEDIUM
- **Counter-strategy:** Use Kelly Mahler's Mom's Choice Gold
> Medal-winning curriculum as proof that this is established
> science, not invented marketing language. Use the OT endorsement

> specifically. Most importantly, connect it to her observation:
> "You've noticed your child doesn't react to wetness? That's
> interoception. You've already seen this --- you just didn't have
> the word for it." 🛡️ 🧠

B2. "I tried underwear and it just created more laundry --- he didn't learn anything from feeling wet."

- **Exact thought pattern:** "Unfortunately neither boy was bothered
> or even seemed to notice if they are wet or dirty."
- **Intensity:** HIGH
- **Counter-strategy:** This is the most dangerous objection because
> it appears to disprove the mechanism. The counter: plain underwear
> creates a sensation that is immediate and then immediately
> uncomfortable. For a child with hypo-responsive interoception, the
> signal may be too brief or too diffuse to register. The
> Body-Signal Learning Layer™ creates a sustained, localized wetness
> sensation --- longer contact time with the skin, designed for a
> nervous system that needs more signal, not less. The difference is
> signal duration and intensity, not just "wet vs. dry." 🛡️ 🧠

B3. "My child LIKES being wet. He doesn't find it uncomfortable at all."

- **Exact thought pattern:** "He sits in a soaking pull-up and
> doesn't care. If being wet doesn't bother him, how would feeling
> wet teach him anything?"
- **Intensity:** MEDIUM
- **Counter-strategy:** The goal is not discomfort --- it's
> awareness. The child who "doesn't care" about wetness likely
> has such muted interoceptive signals that the wetness doesn't
> register as a distinct sensation. The product doesn't rely on
> wetness being unpleasant --- it relies on wetness being
> NOTICEABLE. Over repeated exposures, the brain begins to register
> the pattern: sensation → association with elimination. Discomfort
> is not the teacher. Awareness is. 🛡️ 🧠

B4. "Rewards and motivation work better than just 'feeling wet.'"

- **Exact thought pattern:** "His BCBA has a whole protocol.
> Scheduled sits, reinforcement, data collection. I trust that more
> than underwear."
- **Intensity:** LOW-MEDIUM
- **Counter-strategy:** Don't oppose ABA. Position the product as the
> missing complement. Kelly Mahler: "Rewards can't create or

> clarify internal body signals.\"** ABA protocols work for the
> behavioral component. The product works for the sensory component.
> Together, they close both gaps. 🛡️

Category C: Objections against the brand (Unknown, no social proof)

C1. \"I've never heard of this brand. Why should I trust them?\"

- **Exact thought pattern:** \"Another Instagram ad. I don't know
> these people. Where are the reviews? Who actually uses this?\"
- **Intensity:** HIGH
- **Counter-strategy:** Lead with testimonials from ASD parents at the
> same support level as her child. Include the child's age,
> diagnosis specificity, and number of prior failed attempts in
> every testimonial. Get OT and BCBA co-signs. No polished marketing
> --- raw parent language. 🛡️

C2. \"I need to see it works for kids LIKE MINE.\"

- **Exact thought pattern:** \"A Level 1 success story doesn't help
> me. My child is Level 3 / non-verbal / 7 years old / has GI
> issues. Show me someone whose kid is like mine.\"
- **Intensity:** HIGH
- **Counter-strategy:** Segment testimonials by support level, age,
> verbal/non-verbal, and comorbidities. This is not optional --- it
> is the single most important trust-building element. One parent on
> Raising Children Network described: \"For our son, it all
> revolved around change. This took nearly a year!\" That
> specificity of journey length and approach is what creates belief.
> 🛡️

**C3. \"Is this worth \$30-50 when I've already wasted so much
money?\"**

- **Exact thought pattern:** \"After much, much research and wasted
> money...\" / \"Pull-ups cost \$0.30--0.50 each and I'm already
> buying those.\"
- **Intensity:** MEDIUM
- **Counter-strategy:** Frame the math: if she spends \$0.40/pull-up ×
> 6/day × 365 days = ~\$876/year on pull-ups that prevent learning.
> Reusable training underwear at \$35--50 pays for itself in weeks
> AND accelerates the timeline to independence. 🛡️

Category D: Objections against herself

D1. \"I've tried everything --- why would this be different?\"

- **Exact thought pattern:** \"My husband and I had tried various
> methods over the past 3 years. We used picture symbols...social
> stories...behavioral contingency plans...None of these methods
> worked.\"

- **Intensity:** HIGH
- **Counter-strategy:** Name every method she's tried: sticker
> charts, visual schedules, social stories, timed sits, ABA
> protocols, special seats, reward systems. Then explain: \"All of
> these assume your child can feel the urge and just needs
> motivation to act on it. What if the signal never arrives? That's
> the gap this product fills.\" The reframe: you didn't fail. You
> were solving the wrong problem. 🛡️🎯

D2. \"Maybe I'm the problem.\"

- **Exact thought pattern:** \"Maybe I'm not consistent enough.
> Maybe I give in too easily. Maybe if I were a better parent...\"
- **Intensity:** HIGH

- **Counter-strategy:** Direct, explicit absolution. *\"You are not > the problem. Your child's nervous system processes internal > signals differently. No amount of consistency can create a > sensation that the brain isn't receiving.\"* Then cite the SPARK > study: 49% of ASD children ages 4-5 are not toilet trained. She is > not alone and she is not failing. 🛡️🔴
- **D3. \"What if I get my hopes up again and it fails?\"**
- **Exact thought pattern:** *\"I was discouraged when the Power Cards > didn't work. I combed the internet for some words of wisdom and > found nothing.\"*
- **Intensity:** HIGH
- **Counter-strategy:** Don't promise success. Promise a different > mechanism. *\"We're not asking you to hope. We're asking you to > understand WHY the other approaches didn't address the root > issue. Then decide if this mechanism makes sense for your > child.\"* Intellectual engagement reduces emotional risk. 🛡️
- **D4. \"He's too old / too severe / too resistant for any product to help.\"**
- **Exact thought pattern:** *\"The greater the developmental delay, > the greater the toileting delay tends to be.\"* / *\"Due to the > spectrum that he is on it took 4 years for him to even qualify for > therapy.\"*
- **Intensity:** MEDIUM-HIGH
- **Counter-strategy:** Use Elizabeth Cross, PhD: *\"The vast majority > of autistic children CAN be potty trained.\"* Show testimonials > from children who trained at 7, 8, 9+ years old. Maureen Bennie's > son trained at 9.5. The Autism Awareness Centre documented a > family that took 9 years. Late is not never. 🛡️
- ## **6c. Proof Elements --- What Actually Convinces This Mother**
- ### **1. ASD parent testimonials --- the highest-trust proof**
- Format that works:** Long-form stories with specific details. Not polished quotes --- raw, messy, real. The credibility markers are:
- **Prior failure acknowledgment.** The testimonial MUST include what > didn't work before. *\"My husband and I had tried various methods > over the past 3 years...None of these methods worked\"* --- then > what changed. Without the failure context, success stories sound > fake. 🔴
- **Realistic timelines.** *\"It took Grey about 3 weeks to finally > just start to get the process\"* and *\"The turning point was > persisting for 6 weeks. Our son showed signs during the 5th > week\"* are credible. \"Trained in 3 days\" for an ASD child > triggers instant skepticism.
- **Partial outcomes celebrated.** The most believable testimonial in > this entire research: *\"We still have to take him or else he > won't go on his own. He's not fully potty-trained but if we > remember to take him every hour or so, he will stay dry. It's a > big success for us.\"* Imperfect results are dramatically more > persuasive than perfect ones. 🔴
- **Sensory-specific details.** Parents want to hear about the moment > of awareness: \"He looked down at the wet spot.\" \"She pulled at > her pants.\" \"He said 'wet!'\" These micro-moments are the > proof that the mechanism works.
- **Child profile matching.** A testimonial from a Level 1 verbal > 4-year-old will not convince the parent of a Level 3 non-verbal

> 7-year-old. Testimonials must be segmented by support level, age,
> verbal status, and comorbidities.

****Five examples of maximally credible testimonial language:****

1. *\"After 3 years of sticker charts, ABA protocols, and 4 different
> potty seats, we were still at zero. His OT mentioned interoception
> and I started researching. Day 3 in these, he paused. Just paused,
> looked at his legs. He felt the wetness for the first time. That
> pause was the beginning of everything.\"\
> *
2. *\"She's 6, Level 2, mostly non-verbal. I'd given up twice. We
> used these every day for 5 weeks before anything changed. Week 5,
> she started holding the front of the underwear right before an
> accident. She was feeling the signal come. We're 4 months in now
> and down to 1-2 accidents a day from 8+.\"\
> *
3. *\"I'll be honest --- week 1 was rough. More accidents, more
> laundry. But unlike plain underwear, these actually contained most
> of it. And by week 2, something shifted. He started walking toward
> the bathroom BEFORE the accident, not after. That had never

> happened in 4 years of trying.\"\
> *
4. *\"We still use pull-ups at night and that's fine. During the day,
> he's in these. He's not fully independent --- I still remind him
> every 90 minutes. But he GOES when I take him. Before, he'd sit
> on the toilet for 20 minutes and nothing would happen. Now his
> body seems to know what to do.\"\
> *
5. *\"I cried the first time he said 'wet.' Not because it was a big
> word. Because it was proof he could feel it. Three years of people
> telling me he'd 'do it when he's ready' and what he actually
> needed was to feel it.\"\
> *

****2. Expert endorsements --- the credibility architecture****

****Trust hierarchy for this specific avatar:****

The most credible endorsement combines two professional voices: ****OT**
(for the sensory/interoception mechanism)****** and ****BCBA** (for the
behavioral integration)******. Neither alone is sufficient.

****OT endorsement**** validates the science of interoception: *\"This OT
has worked with 300 ASD families on toileting\"* is more powerful than
\"Dr. Smith, OT, recommends this product.\" Specificity of experience
> credential alone. Kelly Mahler is the gold-standard name in
interoception --- her association (even indirect) would be the single
most credible expert signal. She received the ****2020 AOTA Emerging and
Innovative Practice Award**** and her curriculum is used in ****over 25
countries****. 🧠

****BCBA endorsement**** validates the behavioral application: *\"I
incorporate this into my toilet training protocols\"* signals that this
is compatible with the ABA approach many families are already using.
This neutralizes the \"my BCBA says\" objection.

****Pediatrician endorsement**** is helpful but secondary. Parents of ASD
children frequently express frustration with pediatricians: *\"I was
just told my child had 'sensory issues' by a physician and given no
further explanation.\"* Pediatrician endorsements signal mainstream
acceptance but lack the ASD-specific credibility of OT/BCBA voices.

****Format that works:**** Video testimonials from professionals who name specific case counts. *\"In my 12 years working with autistic children on toileting, I've seen sensation-based approaches succeed where reward-based approaches stalled\"* is more persuasive than a logo or a quote card. 🎯

****3. Before/After scenarios --- the believable arc****

****The most credible before/after is NOT \"in diapers → fully trained.\"**** That arc triggers immediate skepticism.

The believable arc has three stages:

****Weeks 1--2 (Before → First Signal):**** Before: \"He has zero awareness of wetness. Pull-up soaked, no reaction.\" After: \"He paused when he felt wetness on his legs. He looked down. First awareness in 4 years.\"

****Weeks 3--4 (Signal → Early Association):**** Before: \"He never walked toward the bathroom independently.\" After: \"He started holding his pants right before an accident --- he could feel the signal ARRIVING, even if he couldn't act on it in time.\"

****Weeks 6--8 (Association → Emerging Control):**** Before: \"8-10 accidents per day. No dry stretches longer than 30 minutes.\" After: \"2-3 accidents per day. Staying dry 2+ hours. Going when brought to the toilet instead of sitting and doing nothing.\"

The language parents use for small victories: *\"He KNEW he was peeing.\"* *\"She pulled at her pants.\"* *\"He peed in the toilet ONCE today and I cried.\"* *\"We went from 10 accidents to 3.\"* These are the milestones that matter. 🎯

****4. Scientific references --- the \"why it works\" layer****

****This mother wants the WHY, not the citation.**** She does not want: \"A meta-analysis of 31 studies found inconsistent interoceptive accuracy measures across ASD cohorts (Frontiers in Psychiatry, 2025).\" She does want: *\"Your child's brain has a region called the insula that processes body signals like bladder fullness. In many autistic children, this region works differently --- it sends a weaker signal or sends it too late. That's why your child doesn't do the 'potty dance' that other kids do. They literally don't feel it in time.\"* 🧠

****The three most persuasive scientific facts for this audience:****

- **The 49% statistic.**** *\"49% of autistic children ages 4--5 are not > toilet trained, compared to 8% of neurotypical peers.\"* This > normalizes her experience and removes self-blame. 🎯🛡️
- **The reward futility fact.**** Kelly Mahler: *\"Rewards can't create > or clarify internal body signals.\"* This explains every failed > sticker chart and validates every frustration. 🧠🎯
- **The pull-up paradox fact.**** *\"Modern pull-ups wick away moisture > so effectively that your child may not even realize they've > urinated\"* (Autism Speaks). This creates the causal bridge to the > product. 🧠🎯

****Format preference:**** Infographic \> paragraph \> citation. A simple visual showing \"Brain signal → Bladder → Pull-up blocks sensation / Training underwear allows sensation → Brain learns\" would be more persuasive than any study abstract. The parent wants to SEE the mechanism, not read about it.

****PART 7: BLUE OCEAN OPPORTUNITY MAP****

****7.1 The White Ocean --- the unaddressed market space****

The unaddressed space is not \"emotional support\" or \"ASD-friendly products.\" It is something far more precise.

****The experiential gap is this:**** No brand, product, or service has ever told this mother WHY her child specifically failed at toilet training --- in a way that simultaneously removes blame from her, removes blame from her child, and opens a door to a specific, actionable solution. Every resource she has encountered does one of three things:

- ****Blames behavior**** (ABA protocols that frame the child as
 - > **"non-compliant"** or **"not ready"**)
- ****Blames the parent**** (implicitly, through advice that assumes more
 - > consistency/effort would fix it)
- ****Reassures into paralysis**** (**"he'll do it when he's ready"** ---
 - > which provides comfort but zero direction)

****No one has told her this:**** Your child's body sends a weaker bladder signal than a neurotypical child's body. Every product you've used has further muted that already-weak signal. Every method you've tried has assumed the signal is there and just needs motivation. The signal was never reliably there. That's not a defect in your child or a failure in your parenting. It's a sensory processing difference, and it's addressable.

What she needs to ****BELIEVE**** before she can take action: that there is a specific, nameable, physiological REASON this hasn't worked --- not a vague **"every child is different"** but a concrete mechanism she can understand and her child's experience confirms.

What she needs to ****UNDERSTAND**** that no one has explained: the interoception framework, in plain language, connected to her daily observations. Not as a clinical concept but as an explanation for every specific failure she's experienced.

What she needs to ****FEEL****: That she is not a member of a vague **"special needs community"** but the holder of specific knowledge about her child's neurology that she can act on. Not pity. Not solidarity.

****Agency.**** 🌀

What narrative she needs about her ****PAST FAILURES****: That every method she tried was designed for a brain that receives the bladder signal at full strength. Her child's brain receives it at reduced strength or delayed. She was using the right effort with the wrong inputs. The sticker charts, the reward systems, the scheduled sits --- they were all downstream of a sensory gap that was never addressed. She wasn't failing. She was operating with incomplete information. 🛡️

****7.2 The New Value Curve****

A brand operating in this white ocean would look and sound fundamentally

different from every player currently in this market. It would ****raise dramatically**** the factors of mechanism education (explaining WHY the child struggles), parent identity validation (speaking to HER experience, not generic parenting advice), age-range inclusivity (designing for 3-10 year olds, not just toddlers), and sensory-specific design (engineering for the ASD nervous system, not adapting a neurotypical product).

It would ****eliminate entirely**** the factors of infantilizing language (**"big kid"** messaging that shames a 7-year-old), generic milestone framing (**"most children by age 3..."**), cartoon branding that signals toddler products, and any implication that effort or consistency is the missing ingredient.

Its customer communication would differ from every other brand because it would ****lead with the parent's experience, not the product's features.**** The first thing she reads would describe her life --- not

the underwear. The brand would sound like a knowledgeable friend who has read the same OT research she hasn't found yet, who can name the specific phenomenon she has observed in her child (he doesn't notice he's wet) and give it a clinical name (interoceptive difference) and then a solution (sensation-based feedback through the product).

****The brand would sound like:**** an OT who is also a parent of an autistic child --- clinically informed but emotionally raw. Not corporate. Not clinical. Not inspirational. Clear, specific, and direct. ****After reading the brand's first piece of content, the customer would feel:**** "Someone finally explained why this hasn't worked. And they're not selling hope --- they're selling a mechanism that matches what I've observed in my child."

**7.3 The Tipping Point Message**

**** (a) The old story the market tells her:**** "Potty training is a behavioral milestone. Your child needs to be 'ready.' Use rewards, schedules, and consistency. If it's not working, wait longer or try harder. Every child gets there eventually."

**** (b) The new story only this brand can tell:**** "Your child's brain processes body signals differently. The sensation of a full bladder --- the signal that tells neurotypical children 'it's time to go' --- arrives weaker, later, or not at all for many children with ASD. This is called an interoceptive difference, and it explains every failed sticker chart, every empty reward jar, every 'he'll do it when he's ready' that turned into another year of diapers. Pull-ups make it worse by removing the one external sensation that could compensate. Training underwear designed to let your child feel wetness gives the brain the input signal it needs to build the bladder-awareness connection. This isn't about motivation. It's about sensation."

**** (c) The sentence that performs the shift:**** ****** "Your child didn't fail at potty training. Potty training failed your child --- because every method assumed a body signal that their brain doesn't reliably receive." ****** 🧠🔍

**FINAL SYNTHESIS**

****The one sentence this mother has never read anywhere --- that names WHY her child cannot be trained AND simultaneously gives her a different explanation than "my child is just more difficult":****

> ** "Your child's brain doesn't receive the bladder signal at full strength --- and every pull-up, every reward chart, and every 'wait until he's ready' has been treating the behavior without ever addressing the missing sensation. It's not that your child can't learn this. It's that no one gave their brain the signal it needs to learn from." ****** 🧠🔍🛡️

This sentence works because it accomplishes four things simultaneously: it names the specific physiological mechanism (weak interoceptive signal), it explains every past failure (methods that bypassed the sensory gap), it removes blame from both parent and child (not willfulness, not bad parenting --- a processing difference), and it opens a door to a specific, logical solution (restore the sensation → the brain learns). It converts "my child is broken" into "my child's inputs were wrong" --- a difference that changes everything.